

1990 Conference (40th General Service Conference)

Agenda

- Suggested continuation of a "What's On Your Mind?" session early in the week
- Agreed the chairperson write the Policy/Admissions Committee requesting that Conference members be present at all sessions

Cooperation with the Professional Community

- Discussed feasibility of a C.P.C. video; found it not practical at this time
- Accepted the trustees' recommendation to delay printing "A.A. and Employee Assistance Programs" until current supply is exhausted
- Considered developing additional tabletop displays for C.P.C. work; suggested a survey letter to area committees
- Tabled the suggestion to change "What Professionals Are Saying" (C.P.C. Workbook, section 1, pp. 6–8) until after the 1990 International Convention
- Reviewed ideas for future issues of *About A.A.*; encouraged issues devoted to minorities and to the Grapevine
- Reaffirmed the minority initiative and encouraged area C.P.C. committees to reach minority populations
- Discussed court programs in detail; encouraged more area assemblies to hold workshops on cooperating with court/A.S.A.P. programs (*Note: The International Convention and Public Information committees had no items in this category.*)

Correctional Facilities

- Discussed methods of stimulating interest in correctional service work; shared several approaches (open meetings at conventions with incarcerated speakers, groups adopting individual facilities, corrections workshops)
- Requested shared experience be added to the Correctional Facilities Workbook
- Discussed methods of financing area corrections committees
- Discussed usefulness of audio tapes in corrections work
- Discussed use of speaker tapes as supplement to one-on-one conversations

- Noted the video "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell" has not gotten sufficient exposure; suggested trustees' P.I. Committee consider a storyboard or other materials to increase prison-system use

Finance

- Discussed various aspects of self-support; agreed on seven items for the General Service Office and Self-Support Committee to consider (e.g., Birthday Plan, individual participation, Grapevine contribution envelopes, making Self-Support a standing A.A.W.S. committee)
- Discussed the order of "examples" in the self-support pamphlet (area first, then district, then G.S.O., then intergroup)

Grapevine

- Reviewed the revised Grapevine Representative Handbook manuscript; suggested redesigned format
- Discussed elimination of hotel locations from the Grapevine Calendar of Events; agreed listing is not necessary
- Suggested updating the 1989 background sheet on Grapevine financial support and distributing to Panel 39 and 40 delegates
- Suggested the Grapevine periodically distribute back issues through delegates for T.F., C.F., P.I., and C.P.C. committees
- Discussed singleness of purpose as reflected in the Grapevine; came to no conclusion; referred topic to 1991 Conference Grapevine Committee
- Discussed the role of the area/district service structure in increasing Grapevine awareness

Literature

- Reviewed distribution of Big Book Workshop Questions (part of 50th anniversary commemoration); noted positive results
- Reviewed a request for a new pamphlet based on the Canadian "Who Me?" pamphlet; saw no need for additional literature of this kind

Policy/Admissions

- Reviewed the 1990 Conference Evaluation Questionnaire; suggested no changes for 1991

- Discussed a request from ICYPAA to attend the Conference as an observer; denied because their interests are served through the area general service structure
- Discussed the election procedure for committee chairperson and alternate; suggested reviewing election by plurality vs. drawing by lot in 1991

Report and Charter

- Discussed whether The A.A. Service Manual need address eligibility requirements for area positions; concluded this is a matter of area autonomy
- Discussed whether The A.A. Service Manual need address what happens if a delegate-elect declines before January 1; concluded area autonomy
- Considered publishing The A.A. Service Manual in ring-binder format; decided against it (cost and inconsistent G.S.R. rotation)
- Considered adding special terms to the Glossary; decided against it as repetitive and an imposition on local autonomy
- Reviewed the rough draft of the Early Bird edition of *Box 4-5-9*
- Established a deadline for examining the rough draft of the 1990 Final Report

Treatment Facilities

- Reviewed the Treatment Facilities Workbook; agreed with trustees' suggestions for revisions and additions
- Suggested adding a paragraph offering two alternatives when non-alcoholic drug addicts are present in meetings
- Suggested including three items from 1986 Treatment Facilities recommendations in future newsletters (Grapevine tapes, conducting Workbook workshops, sending liaisons to other service entities)

1991 Conference (41st General Service Conference)

Agenda

- Suggested the chairperson of the A.A. meeting following the Opening Dinner gently remind speakers to honor the light system
- Suggested continuation of three "What's On Your Mind?" sessions, with one on Monday of Conference week

Cooperation with the Professional Community

- Reviewed the service piece "Sponsor Your Doctor" from Southern California; suggested it not be published (no need, and use of "sponsor" may cause confusion)
- Reviewed the new C.P.C. Workbook copy; suggested inclusion except for the "Working With Treatment Facilities" section, to be updated
- Discussed minority initiative and special populations; suggested constructive courses of action (literature, *About A.A.*, radio/TV targeting minority interests, schools with high minority populations, exhibits at professional gatherings; also creating more Hispanic districts, using translators, contacting tribal officials, providing signers)
- Made a list of professionals A.A. needs to reach in the 1990s (parole officers, public defenders, judges, counselors, treatment administrators, psychiatrists, clergy, health care professionals, school administrators, athletic directors, E.A.P.s, outpatient program professionals)
- Discussed new C.P.C. tabletop exhibits; suggested a letter to area committees about availability to purchase or borrow; encouraged C.P.C., P.I., T.F., and C.F. committees to share use of the exhibit

Correctional Facilities

- Discussed need to publish *As Bill Sees It* in soft cover; saw no need for an additional soft-cover publication at this time
- Suggested a confidential list of area correctional facilities committee chairpersons be used as an A.A. pre-release contact list
- Reviewed the Correctional Facilities Workbook; suggested adding examples of effective correctional programs and experience on Seventh Tradition support
- Discussed need for a bridging-the-gap pamphlet specifically for corrections; saw no need at this time given existing resources
- Discussed cooperation between C.F./H&I committees and local area structures; concluded this is a matter of area autonomy
- Recognized the need for the trustees' C.P.C. Committee to maintain an active presence at professional meetings of correctional administrators

Finance

- Discussed changing quarterly contribution printouts to include inactivated groups; decided not to proceed

Grapevine

- Discussed singleness of purpose as reflected in the Grapevine; affirmed editorial policy is in accordance with singleness of purpose
- Reviewed results of the Grapevine questionnaire; determined it should continue on an ongoing basis, available to all delegates by mid-July
- Discussed distribution of back issues by delegates; determined distribution should continue when possible
- Discussed format of the wall calendar; suggested enlarging numbers and exploring a 14-month calendar
- Discussed placement of the editorial disclaimer; concluded the page number be included in the monthly table of contents
- Discussed what could be done to support and encourage GvRs
- Discussed whether the Grapevine has a responsibility for message consistency; requested a change in writer's guidelines to reflect singleness of purpose
- Discussed a Grapevine mailing to all groups on the G.S.O. mailing list

Literature

- The following recommendation did not receive a two-thirds majority: that the trustees' Literature Committee develop a simple, concise pamphlet on "unity" for a draft to be presented to the 1992 Conference Literature Committee
- Considered producing *Daily Reflections* on audiocassette; agreed insufficient need at this time
- Strongly suggested an ongoing advisory committee of trustees, delegates, and G.S.O. staff be established to review all current and proposed Conference-approved material, with a report to the 1993 Conference
- Suggested the 1992 Conference Literature Committee consider the request from Area 78 to produce an anonymity card similar to Al-Anon's

Policy/Admissions

- Reviewed the 1991 Conference Evaluation Questionnaire; suggested it remain the same for 1992
- Considered the suggestion that committees refrain from negative recommendations; suggested phrasing be as clear and concise as possible
- Reviewed the present election policy for committee chairpersons; suggested continuing election by plurality
- Considered the Agenda Committee's request for all members to be present at all sessions; concluded this is the responsibility of trusted servants
- Considered developing guidelines for G.S.O. staff in implementing Advisory Actions; determined existing mechanisms are adequate
- Considered sharing Conference agenda items with central/intergroup offices in advance; concluded this is each delegate's responsibility
- Considered an ad hoc committee to review intergroup/central office concerns; concluded no need, problems are local, doors of communication exist at area level
- Considered a request to review the guest policy at the Opening Dinner; suggested referral to the trustees' Conference Committee

Public Information

- Asked the trustees' Membership Survey subcommittee to consider allowing only one response on question #5 and changing question #10 to ask about home group membership
- Requested the trustees' P.I. Committee review in depth the Public Information Workbook and report back on updates
- Requested the trustees' P.I. Committee develop a category of questions for the 1992 Membership Survey addressing Fellowship needs and concerns (sponsorship, service, recovery); also requested all survey questions be studied for appropriate distribution

Report and Charter

- Discussed a request to include more information about L.C.M.s in The A.A. Service Manual; concluded this is best left to local autonomy
- Considered the description of an A.A. group in The A.A. Service Manual in relation to Warranty Six; felt it was adequately covered under Advisory Action #31

- Reviewed the structure chart (p. S-23); satisfied with it
- Suggested a 1992 Conference presentation by a board member, G.S.O. staff, and delegate on "Percentage and Participation of Conference Membership"
- Reviewed the Bar Graph on p. 27 of the 1990 Final Report; found it historically accurate

Treatment Facilities

- Reviewed the Treatment Facilities Workbook; agreed an editor is needed to correlate, streamline, and update it; suggested D-ring binders and better quality printing
- Unanimously agreed a service piece is needed to assist A.A. members making informational presentations in treatment facilities; suggested it be derived from a Southern Minnesota leaflet and be printed on card stock the size of a video container, inserted with the video "Hope: Alcoholics Anonymous"
- Discussed improving communication with H&I committees; suggested G.S.O. encourage sharing experience through the Treatment Facilities Newsletter; noted area-level liaisons between H&I and general service committees have been helpful

Trustees

- Reviewed (with minor editorial changes) the trustees' Nominating Committee's guidelines for hiring the general manager of the General Service Office; also accepted emergency hiring procedures
- Reviewed guidelines for selection of non-trustee directors of corporate boards; agreed the description of how A.A. chooses directors be forwarded to the Report and Charter Committee for inclusion in The A.A. Service Manual
- Agreed the Nominating Committee's description of how appointed committee members are chosen be forwarded to Report and Charter for The A.A. Service Manual
- Discussed rotation of A.A.W.S. and Grapevine directors; suggested more background material be sent for review and future discussion at the 1992 Conference

1992 Conference (42nd General Service Conference)

Agenda

- Reaffirmed a 1971 Advisory Action about placing lower-priority agenda items as optional
- Reaffirmed a 1979 Advisory Action that Conference members should stand when their names are called
- Discussed and suggested continuation of the practice of a trip to Stepping Stones every other year
- Discussed and suggested continuation of trips to G.S.O. during Conference week
- Discussed a request to reduce the number of Conference session days; decided not feasible
- Reviewed a suggestion from a past trustee regarding communications; agreed it would be available in the archives as background
- Disapproved the recommendation that agenda items requested by a delegate or area assembly automatically be included on the appropriate Conference committee's agenda

Cooperation with the Professional Community

- Asked the Conference Literature Committee to consider deletion of the six-point definition of an A.A. group from a C.P.C. pamphlet
- Reviewed the C.P.C. Workbook; suggested retaining the current ring-binder format and including the updated "Working with Treatment Facilities" section
- Discussed A.A. informational meetings/presentations for court-referred persons; found no Tradition violations; agreed this is a matter of local autonomy

Correctional Facilities

- Considered the need for another "bridging the gap" pamphlet for pre-release contact; saw no need as material is in the Workbook
- Considered whether G.S.O. should be a coordinating temporary contact point for correctional facilities; felt this is better handled at the area level
- Considered whether the Conference should host an annual event related to "bridging the gap" between A.A. and treatment/correctional facilities; felt this need is best met at the area level

- Expressed displeasure regarding the delay in producing the audiotape of "A.A. in Prison: Inmate to Inmate"
- Suggested a guide letter directed to parole officers be prepared for inclusion in the Correctional Facilities Workbook, for the 1993 committee's consideration

Finance

- Discussed the pamphlet "Self-Supporting Through Our Own Contributions"; concluded no revision needed at this time

Grapevine

- Discussed a suggestion to develop a "Statement of Purpose"; affirmed the statement adopted by the Grapevine Corporate Board at their January 1992 meeting
- Discussed a suggestion that the Grapevine Editorial Board have regional advisory representation; took no action
- Discussed results of the 1992 questionnaire; decided to send a similar questionnaire in 1993; requested Grapevine staff mail results to all delegates and area chairs
- Discussed a suggestion that GvR Guidelines be translated into Spanish; took no action at this time
- Discussed a letter from Eastern Massachusetts regarding area/district committee support; reaffirmed support for area and district Grapevine committees
- Discussed possible special items; suggested a 1993 booklet of past Grapevine articles on "The A.A. Group (Our Key to Unity)"
- Discussed a proposal for a sobriety token for anniversaries; concluded production of sobriety tokens is inconsistent with the Grapevine's practice

1993 Conference (43rd General Service Conference)

Ad Hoc Committee on Chips/Medallions

- Committee recommendations not adopted by Conference: (1) That initiating trademark/service mark litigation is a violation of Warranty Five; (2) That the General Service Board take steps to bring policies into conformity with the spirit of the Warranties

- Committee recommendation withdrawn: Because the above two were not adopted, the third (developing a new policy statement on "Use of A.A.'s Trademarks and Logos") was withdrawn

Agenda

- Reviewed the Annual Conference Questionnaire; accepted as presented
- Investigated possibility of forming an ad hoc committee similar to the inventory committee; decided not to pursue
- Requested a sharing session entitled "The Spirit of Sacrifice: The Twelfth Step in Action" be scheduled after the workshop

Cooperation with the Professional Community

- Considered text revisions to "How A.A. Members Cooperate with Other Community Efforts"; suggested no changes at this time
- Strongly suggested that the original intent of that pamphlet be investigated, its scope defined by the trustees' C.P.C. Committee, and provided to the 1994 Conference C.P.C. Committee
- Discussed concerns about expenses, value, and Traditions involved in exhibiting at national professional conferences; supportive of current practice; also discussed financial assistance for local exhibits with differing views about the Seventh Tradition

Correctional Facilities

- Considered a suggestion to clarify the status of correctional facility groups vis-à-vis "outside" A.A. groups; agreed this is best described by Warranty Six and Tradition Three (long form); left G.S.R. voting status to local autonomy
- Reviewed pamphlets "A.A. in Correctional Facilities" and "A Message to Correctional Facilities Administrators"; agreed additional information on duties of group sponsors and "inside" G.S.R.s is needed; asked trustees' committee to prepare copy for 1994 review
- Agreed additional emphasis on pre-release contacts should be added to "A Message to Correctional Facilities Administrators"; asked trustees' committee to revise
- Discussed the Corrections Correspondence Service; agreed it's important but difficult to staff from G.S.O.; suggested areas become more involved

- Suggested G.S.O. contact the C.F. chairperson when an inmate from that area requests an outside correspondent
- Suggested C.F. Committees obtain permanent mailing addresses or P.O. boxes for inmate use
- Discussed ways committees can keep members aware of A.A. tools; suggested table displays at area events, group purchases of Grapevines and literature, district workshops, newsletters
- Reviewed page proofs of the new Correctional Facilities Workbook format; endorsed the new soft-cover format

Finance

- Decided not to reaffirm past 1986 self-support Actions; strongly suggested the Seventh Tradition is each member's responsibility; recommended a new pamphlet be prepared
- Discussed a proposal for creating a "self-support program and position"; determined it was inadvisable

Grapevine

- Discussed Grapevine history of self-support; wanted to reestablish focus on the magazine and affirm it should be self-supporting through subscription income only
- Discussed and considered questionnaire results in all deliberations
- Discussed the proposal to tape the magazine quarterly; took no action
- Endorsed the Grapevine Corporate Board's proposal for new materials: a history tape in 1994, a humor/cartoons book in 1995
- Discussed a concern about advertising special items in the Grapevine; concluded it is consistent with founders' intent and the Twelve Traditions
- By consensus, felt it is not necessary to add "Pass Me On" to the Grapevine cover
- Discussed moving the Responsibility Declaration; agreed and referred it to editors and Editorial Advisory Board
- *Strong suggestion:* That Wall Calendars and Pocket Planners (not adhering to primary purpose) be phased out after 1994; recognized financial impact must be made up by increased subscriptions

- *Recommendations not adopted by Conference:* (1) That the "About Alcoholism" section (gray pages) be reinstated with a disclaimer; (2) That the words "Our meeting in print" be removed from the cover

International Convention

- Discussed a request that badges and program not identify people by title; agreed people may use whatever names they wish, as long as anonymity is observed

Literature

- Discussed the trustees' subcommittee report on "minorities"; suggested emphasizing commonality and discouraging the term "minorities"
- Made the strong suggestion that no new specialty pamphlets be produced for at least two years; suggested the Literature Review Subcommittee continue and forward revisions to the 1994 committee
- Extended gratitude to the trustees' Literature Review Subcommittee
- Considered proposed changes to "Twelve Traditions Illustrated"; referred to the subcommittee for further study
- Considered proposed changes to "The A.A. Group" pamphlet; decided none needed at this time
- Considered proposed changes to the "G.S.R." pamphlet; suggested it be revised and updated by the Literature Review Subcommittee
- Considered a request for district/area literature committee guidelines; suggested the trustees' Literature Committee develop guidelines from shared Fellowship experience
- Discussed proposed changes to *Living Sober*; decided none needed
- Discussed suggested update to "A Message to Teenagers"; referred to the trustees' P.I. Committee
- Discussed a request for a simplified version of the Big Book; determined insufficient expressed need
- Discussed a request for a new book of stories similar to the Big Book; suggested seeking area input on need
- Considered adding the Preamble to the Big Book; took no action (most of the Preamble was taken from the foreword to the first edition)

- Discussed a change in the foreword to the second edition; took no action
- Discussed a request to change the title of "Doctor, Alcoholic, Addict"; took no action
- Discussed a request for reaffirmation of certain Literature Advisory Actions from 1969, 1971, and 1986; suggested they be included in proposed Literature Committee Guidelines
- Suggested delegates have agenda items brought to area assemblies for broader exposure before submission

Policy/Admissions

- Decided that formation of a standing Conference Committee on A.A.W.S. is unnecessary
- Reviewed Conference policy on restricted/confidential matters; agreed restrictions apply only to pending legal matters and works in progress
- Considered suggestions to create a recommendation review panel and new procedures for calling the question; agreed present procedures are adequate
- Suggested the trustees' Conference Committee examine current smoking/nonsmoking arrangements at the Conference

Public Information

- Considered the request from an area to change the method for selecting groups for the Membership Survey; decided the proposed change would not result in random sampling
- Regretted time constraints prevented full discussion of the P.I. Workbook; requested the trustees' P.I. Committee begin updating it for 1994 review; also requested a simpler, more concise and less expensive format
- Suggested the 1994 Agenda Committee consider "Anonymity—Our Spiritual Foundation" as the theme for the 1995 Conference
- *Recommendations not adopted by Conference:* (1) That distribution of any Membership Survey information be limited to the 1992 pamphlet, poster, and one-way display; (2) That there be a moratorium on any Membership Survey until the trustees' P.I. Committee's report is forwarded no later than February 15, 1996

Report and Charter

- Considered a report from the trustees' Literature Committee on Service Sponsorship; voted to send it back to the trustees' committee to consider adding material to the Sponsorship pamphlet or as a service piece
- Considered a proposal to delete a passage from the essay accompanying Concept XI; decided not to rewrite Bill's essay
- Considered a request to adopt the long form of the Traditions as Conference by-laws; decided the Conference Charter is adequate
- Considered adding the language from 1977 Advisory Action No. 52 (delegate not eligible as trustee candidate until one year after last Conference) to The A.A. Service Manual; voted to instruct Publications at G.S.O. to add that language
- Considered a request to label descriptions on the Concepts section contents page; directed Publications to change "Contents" to "The Twelve Concepts (Short Form)"
- Considered identifying trustee committee members by position in the Final Conference Report; voted to ask Publications to identify appointed committee members by asterisks
- Considered a request to reconsider a 1988 Advisory Action about distributing the Final Report to all G.S.R.s; decided to continue distributing as before
- Requested G.S.O. find a way to accent town names in group directories
- Requested Publications update the list of by-law amendments on p. S106 of The A.A. Service Manual
- Reviewed page proofs of the Early Bird edition of *Box 4-5-9*; agreed on a two-week return deadline for uncorrected page proofs
- Considered a request to reaffirm the 1962 Conference vote accepting Bill's Twelve Concepts manuscript; agreed it was well accepted and did not need reaffirmation
- Considered a request to include hiring guidelines for the general manager in The A.A. Service Manual; decided this is an employment matter readily available on request from G.S.O.
- Considered a request to review/revise material on the Past Delegate; decided the section is adequate
- Considered a proposal to change Chapter V, "The Delegate"; voted no change at this time

- Considered a request to delete individual group contributions from the Canadian Directory; voted no change (should be consistent with 1977 Advisory Action)
- Considered a request for guidelines for publication of the Final Conference Report; decided adequate guidelines are in place
- Considered a proposal to add brief biographies of non-trustee corporate directors in the Final Conference Report; saw no need at this time
- Declined to consider a proposed change in the "Structure of the Fellowship" chart on p. S23; requested G.S.O. staff prepare a revised chart for the 1994 Report and Charter Committee

Treatment Facilities

- Felt the newly revised Treatment Facilities Workbook was clear and needed no revisions; affirmed the 1½" three-ring binder is most useful
- Discussed how changes and cutbacks in treatment facilities affect A.A. service in various areas; identified preparation for Twelfth Step calls on wet drunks as important
- Discussed how A.A. might enhance cooperation with outpatient programs; emphasized making groups more aware and welcoming of newcomers from treatment facilities, and the importance of sponsorship

1994 Conference (44th General Service Conference)

Agenda

- Reviewed the Annual General Service Conference Questionnaire and Summary Results; suggested some editorial changes to be forwarded to the trustees' Committee on the Conference

Cooperation with the Professional Community

- Discussed traveling C.P.C. exhibits and the need for general guidelines; requested referral of the following recommendation to the trustees' C.P.C. Committee for a report to the 1995 committee: (a) continue sending exhibits to relevant national professional conventions within budget; (b) review the list of exhibits at least twice a year; (c) encourage local committees to exhibit at local/regional professional conventions; (d) the C.P.C. staff person continue to facilitate such requests with attention to attraction, cooperation, and self-support

Correctional Facilities

- Considered a suggestion that a letter about A.A. and its C.F. services be sent to wardens in the U.S. and Canada; asked the trustees' C.F. Committee to consider having staff develop and distribute such a letter
- Suggested the trustees' C.F. Committee have staff develop a letter to all U.S./Canada C.F. chairpersons outlining long-term goals and asking about their needs
- Asked the trustees' C.F. Committee to review the C.F. Workbook with particular attention to: (a) removing "being concerned" with inmates coping with denial on p. 23; (b) singleness of purpose guidelines for prison meetings; (c) more C.F. involvement at district and group level; (d) guidelines for working with young offenders; (e) guidelines for statewide/area P.O. box addresses for inmate correspondence; (f) guidelines for gender-appropriate pre-release contacts

Finance

- Considered publication of a one-page explanation of the Reserve Fund; suggested the explanation from the Finance Guidelines be included in the self-support pamphlet
- After review, concluded the G.S.O. General Ledger is a viable, workable package for ongoing up-to-date reporting to the general manager and Board; believed it helps explain to the Fellowship where money goes
- Reviewed a letter and trustees' Finance Committee reply concerning a proposal to split G.S.O.; took no action

Grapevine

- Reaffirmed 1992 Conference Advisory Action #23 regarding Conference input to Grapevine special items (building on the model of *The Language of the Heart*)
- Discussed a suggestion to cease production of all special items not containing articles taken directly from the magazine; took no action
- Discussed feasibility of discontinuing Grapevine special items that no longer seem useful; encouraged the Grapevine Corporate Board to establish guidelines for discontinuance and to inform the Conference Committee prior to any final discontinuance

- Endorsed the Grapevine Corporate Board's proposal for producing an undated, generic Grapevine in 1996; suggested consideration of a Spanish edition
- *Strong suggestion:* That Wall Calendars and Pocket Planners be discontinued after the 1995 edition (estimated net loss of \$35,000–\$40,000)

International Convention

- Suggested that area/state/provincial convention committees lovingly consider not planning conventions six weeks before or after the 1995 International Convention

Literature

- Discussed a request for a pocket-sized edition of the Big Book stories packaged with the pocket-sized first 164 pages; suggested no expressed need for this at this time

Policy/Admissions

- Discussed a request to set the Conference theme two Conferences ahead instead of one; decided the annual custom remains sensitive to current Fellowship needs
- Discussed a request to include central offices/intergroups in the general service structure; affirmed they perform vital functions independent from the Conference structure, and that local A.A. has the responsibility to recognize, support, and cooperate with them
- Considered suggestions to improve relations with intergroups/central offices; reaffirmed the 1991 Policy/Admissions Committee's suggestions about local communication and delegates' responsibility
- Considered a request for a nonsmoking Conference policy; suggested: (a) no nonsmoking policy at this time; (b) smoking/nonsmoking sections remain as at the 1994 Conference; (c) each committee exercise autonomy regarding smoking in committee meetings
- Considered changing the deadline for proposed Conference agenda items; reaffirmed 1993 Advisory Action #26 (items submitted no later than January 15; final agendas sent by February 15; background material by February 15)
- Considered a suggestion that all delegates receive copies of all material sent to any delegate; encouraged G.S.O. to continue forwarding to all Conference members any material that could affect the Conference as a whole
- Considered that all recommendations be accompanied by a sign-off sheet initialed by committee members; decided no action needed

Public Information

- Reviewed the Composition, Scope and Procedure; suggested revising paragraph two of the Composition to reflect how the committee is selected
- Listened to radio spot #5 in P.S.A. R-09; agreed with and accepted the trustees' P.I. Committee's report that it contains a positive and honest message
- Discussed adding a "Public Service Announcement" tag line to existing radio/TV P.S.A.s; agreed it can sometimes be done by the station; suggested noting this in the P.I. Workbook
- Considered a request for a special anonymity letter or packet for talk show producers; agreed the annual anonymity letter to the media is sufficient; follow-up is a matter of local autonomy
- Accepted (with substantial unanimity) the trustees' P.I. Committee report on the Membership Survey; endorsed going forward with a sample survey but delaying one year to ensure sound methodology; suggested the trustees consider sharing from Eastern Ontario in formulating questions
- Reviewed the 1993 anonymity discussion questions; requested the trustees' P.I. Committee continue encouraging discussion on the spiritual principles of anonymity, focusing on posthumous anonymity of the co-founders; requested consideration of including questions with a future *Box 4-5-9* mailing

Report and Charter

- Discussed a request to make a distinction in The A.A. Service Manual between Advisory Actions and informational text; felt no need for this change
- Discussed a suggestion to eliminate a sentence on p. S34 (General Service Board's reserved right of decision) and replace it with language emphasizing the Conference's right to reverse board actions; felt no need for this change
- Discussed reinstating a deleted paragraph from the section on General Services and Local Intergroup Services; felt no need for this change
- Discussed initiating a review of The A.A. Service Manual to consider if it adequately serves the Fellowship; felt no need at this time
- Considered a request to review the size and content of the Final Conference Report; suggested shortening it by: (a) further editing board and staff reports and trustee

biographies; (b) eliminating the Regional Map; (c) eliminating the Conference Membership Chart; (d) only listing contributions by Delegate Area

- Discussed the Early Bird edition; suggested reducing it to four pages (overview of Conference, highlights of Advisory Actions, financial overview), with full reports to appear in the June/July *Box 4-5-9* (projected savings \$8,000–\$9,000)

A note on coverage: The "Additional Committee Considerations" section was formally established by Advisory Action 40 of the 1990 Conference. The 1982–1989 reports in your first file predate this requirement, so no such section appears for those years. The sections above cover all years for which the section exists across your three files: **1990, 1991, 1992, 1993, and 1994.**

Texas (Southwest): Audrey C., with only ninety days sobriety and at her first workshop, suggested the theme "To Live It—Give It" for our January Workshop. We wanted to have something centered around the Conference theme. "Preserving Our Fellowship—Our Challenge" is, actually, *my* challenge. So my personal challenge is to listen more, talk less, and pray. Our area has purchased translation equipment; this is important as we now have seven Spanish districts, 27 in all, and 442 groups. We have just appointed an ad hoc committee to consider budgets for all the area officers/committees. We have over 1,000 subscriptions for the Spanish Grapevine. Southwest Texas knows that there are other areas that love A.A. as much as we do, but we also know that there is no other area that loves A.A. more than we do.— *Tom McMullen*

Vermont: We have approximately 250 groups and hold four full area assemblies and six area committee meetings. Our convention this year picked the theme "Back to Basics." We have an active Grapevine chair and our out-going treasurer did a good job at making sure our finances were in order. My service sponsor some twenty-five years ago was Herb Morse, who was called office manager for years at the old G.S.O. when Bill W. was still alive. I'd like to pass along his message. He used to tell me: "Don't tell me how I'm doing it wrong—tell me how *we* can do it better."— *Don McGee*

Washington State East: Area 92, the first new area since 1973, includes small parts of four areas outside of Washington state, one of these being B.C. Yukon. We also include northern Idaho, a small piece of western Montana and a small piece of northeast Oregon. We decided to keep most of the existing Washington Area structure with three quarterlies and one assembly a year. That seems to have worked very well with over 40% of the registered groups coming to the assembly and 100% of the districts at all quarterlies. At our first quarterly we had 70-90 people, along with all of our 17 districts. We have approximately 400 groups in our new area. It is an honor beyond words to be allowed to be the first delegate from Washington State East Area.— *Ben Beigler*

Wisconsin (Northern)/Upper Peninsula Michigan: Area 74 serves over 600 registered groups through 22 districts. We hold two area conferences and two area assemblies. After years of struggling with the issue of a constitution and bylaws, the last assembly adopted guidelines that describe the area's service structure and its practices, screens area officer reimbursements, standing committee funding requests, and other budgetary matters. It was also empowered to investigate and report on such issues as prudent reserve and tax status, aiding in the development of an informed group conscience. Our Archives committee has begun to interview all members having 35 or more years of sobriety. This will preserve their experience, strength, and hope for future generations of alcoholics.— *Tom Canard*

Wyoming: We have 11 districts, 125 registered groups, and more than 2,000 members. We have two area assemblies; area conventions are held in May and October. Our finance committee enacted an area budget; our challenge is to adhere to this well-drafted work. All area committees are active; Grapevine and Archives have exhibits. Many districts have service workshops and area 76 for the most part is very much Big Book oriented. We have many meetings that aren't groups, which we try to encourage to become groups. Our small intimate groups are full of love and sharing. Our prayer is that we will always be united in Recovery and Service.— *Nina VanPatten*

Additional Committee Considerations That Did Not Result in Recommendations

Advisory Action 40 of the 1990 General Service Conference states: "Items discussed, but no action taken or recommendation made, as well as committee recommendations which are not adopted, be included in a separate section of the Final Conference Report." Those committee recommendations which are not adopted (less than 2/3 of the total Conference votes in favor), but which received at least a simple majority of the votes, are considered "strong suggestions" of the Conference. All items, listed by committee, are as follows:

AGENDA

- The committee reviewed the Conference Evaluation Questionnaire and forwarded to the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference some minor format changes.
- The committee asked the staff and trustees' Committee on Conference to search for ways to be sure that discussion and question time be available following presentations.
- The committee discussed the committee's conference calls and decided they should be held only on an "as needed" basis at the discretion of the chairperson of the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference.

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

- The committee reviewed with appreciation the Progress Report of the trustees' C.P.C. Committee Review of C.P.C. Literature and Service Material. The committee made some modifications, and suggested that these:
 - a) Be returned to the trustees' C.P.C. Committee for their follow up; and that
 - b) after considering the Conference C.P.C. Committee's suggestions, a final report of the review of C.P.C. Literature and Service Material be prepared by the trustees' Committee on C.P.C. and forwarded to the 1997 Conference Committee on C.P.C.
- The committee reviewed the C.P.C. Workbook, and requested that a typographic omission of the word "other" in the explanatory line about Tradition Three on page 10 be fixed. The line ought to read "There are no other requirements for A.A. membership."
- The committee decided that since the C.P.C. Workbook was revised only last year, they would make no further changes this year.
- Although it might add a little expense and weight to the C.P.C. Kit, the committee would like to include in the kit the items (not already included) listed on page 29 of the C.P.C. Workbook; and also add a sample of the *About A.A.* sign-up card.

When Panel 45 delegate Sandra Kelly (Central Michigan) and her husband arrived at the hotel Saturday morning they discovered they had left their carry-on bag (containing return airline tickets, camera, grandchildren's pictures, etc.) in the taxi. After making the necessary phone calls, Sandra turned it over to God. At 8:00 am the next day the cab driver showed up at the hotel with the lost luggage. Who says New York is a cold town and cab drivers are not honest?

CORRECTIONAL FACILITIES

- The committee reviewed the Correctional Facilities Workbook and requested that the trustees' Correctional Facilities Committee prepare copy on youth detention centers, women's institutions, and short-term correctional facilities for the workbook, and present it to the 1997 Conference Correctional Facilities Committee for approval.

FINANCE

- The committee discussed the need for an alternative approach to pie charts and determined it was not necessary.
- The committee discussed the agenda item, "unless literature sales or contributions, or both, increase substantially we will have to raise prices and cut discounts or reduce services." Some thought this statement threatening while others saw it as a realistic assessment in light of the steady decline of contributions. The committee discussed finances in general and the spirit of the Seventh Tradition as it related to A.A. as a whole. It also discussed the need for education within the Fellowship. Raising the level of awareness through discussion may be one of the reasons for the increase of donations in the first quarter. Education could also decrease the "them vs. us" perception as well as the feeling that everyone does it "my way." We more clearly defined an overall goal, which is not necessarily to get groups to increase donations, or even to get groups who do not contribute to finally contribute but that donations are an expression of participation and gratitude. Everyone can claim ownership to a piece of the A.A. miracle, regardless of the size of his or her donation, and no one should be embarrassed if they can't send a large amount.
- The committee discussed methods of communication within the Fellowship and realized that there are many tools available to aid in the communication/education process. Some of these are:
 - a) "They [delegates] have the job of helping their committees obtain the financial support their areas and G.S.O. need." (*The A.A. Service Manual*, p. S69)
 - b) The Quarterly Contribution Letter, sent to delegates by G.S.O., which reflects area contribution activity.
 - c) Quarterly Contribution Reports, sent by G.S.O. to the delegates, with group contribution activity.
 - d) Quarterly Contribution Letter, sent by G.S.O. to each group, reflects the group's contribution activity.
 - e) General Service Conference presentations.
 - f) General Service *Final Conference Report* to each group.
 - g) A.A.W.S. Highlights.
 - h) *Box 4-5-9*.
 - i) Regional service assemblies.
 - j) Regional Forums information that can be disseminated further to those who were not able to attend.
 - k) Invite speakers to local/regional events.
 - l) Area information packages generated by each area and an emphasis on the delegate's use of: the new services video, when available; the Inflation Chart, What's Wrong With This Picture flyer.

- The committee also felt that more detailed, fully-encompassing information should be available concerning the routine services G.S.O. provides—such as free literature, translations, new

items published, and awards received. Perhaps the delegates should approach the education of their area as a challenge to sustain the spirit of the Seventh Tradition.

GRAPEVINE

- The committee discussed returning the "About Alcoholism" section (gray pages) to the Grapevine and felt that no action was necessary. The committee saw no clear need or desire in the Fellowship for the section. Information from the alcoholism field does not promote A.A.'s primary purpose and is readily available elsewhere.
- The committee discussed several suggestions for related materials for possible production in 1998 and forwarded to the Grapevine Corporate Board for development: 1) a third volume of *Best of the Grapevine*, and 2) audio recordings by and about young people in Alcoholics Anonymous.
- The committee discussed a suggested rewording of the A.A. Preamble and felt that no change is needed.
- The committee reviewed the A.A. Grapevine Workbook and endorsed it with minor editorial changes and updating.

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/REGIONAL FORUMS

- The committee suggested that at the 1997 joint meeting of the Conference and trustees' Committees on International Conventions/Regional Forums there be a review of the background information that led to the 1995 Conference Policy and Admissions Advisory Action: "The Conference Committee on International Conventions continue to meet on an annual basis, discussing Regional Forums when there are no International Convention items; and that the committee be renamed Conference Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums."
- The committee also suggested that at the 1997 joint meeting of the Conference and trustees' Committees on International Conventions/Regional Forums, a Composition, Scope and Procedure for the Conference Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums be discussed.
- After lengthy discussion, the committee agreed that all current Convention Site Committee members participate in voting for possible site cities for the International Convention in 2005.

LITERATURE

- The committee discussed whether a story of a bisexual alcoholic be included in the pamphlet, "Do You Think You're Different?" and made no recommendations.
- In light of the fact that *Box 4-5-9* is in the process of preparing an article on the importance of sharing our experience, strength

Another Small Miracle

When Rodney Rabren left SE Texas for the Conference, his new grandson was in critical condition. "I came here to do what I could to carry the message and God did His job with my problems at home," said Rodney. When he returned to Texas his grandson was there to meet him. "When I came to A.A. I was told that if I did my job to stay sober and help others, God would take care of the rest. This is so clear to me today."

and hope with newcomers in regard to confidentiality within Alcoholics Anonymous, the committee decided to defer the decision for publication of other material in regard to confidentiality and review the question again at the 1997 General Service Conference.

- The committee considered a request for a pamphlet directed to the concerns of the nonbeliever (atheist and/or agnostic) and made no recommendations.
- The committee considered a request for feedback and further guidance on how to proceed concerning the topic of Big Book Questionnaire and Outline and decided not to proceed with a questionnaire at this time.

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

- The committee discussed the issue of floor actions and suggested that the committees responsible continue to establish the Conference agenda's order of business.
- The committee discussed requests to identify the source of agenda items and concluded that the proper procedures are already in place.
- The committee discussed the policy for Conference observers and suggested that the trustees' Committee on the Conference create a guideline letter explaining the role of an observer.
- The committee discussed the feasibility of forming a Conference Archives Committee and determined that at present a sufficient need had not been articulated. The committee further asked that any additional input from areas on this issue be forwarded to the trustees' Archives Committee for further review.
- The committee discussed the future growth of the Conference and its effect on A.A. as a whole and suggested that the trustees' Committee on the Conference furnish a report with more guidance on this issue for the Conference Policy/Admissions Committee at the 47th General Service Conference.
- The committee discussed a request from the Conference Literature Committee to approve filming in designated areas of the Conference and took no action.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

- The committee reviewed the 1996 Membership Survey Questionnaire approved by the 1995 General Service Conference and decided to make no changes.
- The committee discussed at length the proposal to remove the following questions from the 1996 Membership Survey Questionnaire: race; marital status; anything to do with drugs; and decided unanimously to take no action on this proposal. The committee recognized that there is no reference to drugs in the 1996 Membership Survey Questionnaire approved by the 1995 General Service Conference.
- The committee considered a request to undertake a complete review of public information pamphlets looking for duplication with other A.A. literature and emphasis on A.A.'s primary purpose and agreed that there was no need to undertake a complete review of public information pamphlets at this time.
- The committee deferred discussion of the A.A. Web Site as a public information tool until the 1997 General Service Conference.
- The committee reviewed the Public Information Workbook and suggested that information about "cards and signs" and "tele-

phone directories" be added to the Workbook. The committee also suggested that the following information be added to the Public Information Workbook folder: Radio and television public service announcement scripts; service piece "Suggestions for Working with Your Local Radio and Television Stations to Help Carry the Message"; and service piece "A.A. Fact Sheet."

REPORT AND CHARTER

- After reviewing the chart submitted, illustrating Third Legacy Procedure, the committee agreed that an illustration in *The A.A. Service Manual* might help people new in general service understand the procedure and suggested that diagrams of Third Legacy Procedure be prepared for consideration by the 1997 Conference Report and Charter Committee.
- The committee discussed clarifying who is eligible to vote in the "How Do We Elect the D.C.M." section of *The A.A. Service Manual* and agreed that the current information is adequate since *The A.A. Service Manual* offers some options, and districts and areas may determine the best way to conduct their elections.
- The committee considered adding a footnote to "A Resolution" on page S35 of *The A.A. Service Manual* indicating that the 1995 General Service Conference recommended that the first 164 pages of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, the Preface, the Forewords, "The Doctor's Opinion," "Doctor Bob's Nightmare" and the Appendices remain as is and decided that no action is necessary since the Conference has historically resisted any effort to change the Big Book, with the exception of updating some of the stories.
- The committee discussed whether or not the first 164 pages of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, should have the same rewrite status as the Steps, Traditions, and Warranties of Article XII of the Conference Charter. Since one Conference's actions are not binding on another and the Conference has historically resisted any effort to change the Big Book in any way other than updating stories, the committee saw no need for a recommendation.
- The committee considered a small, two-or three-ring-binder format for *The A.A. Service Manual* and agreed that it is not financially feasible.
- The committee considered printing *The A.A. Service Manual* every two to five years and agreed that the practice of printing *The A.A. Service Manual* annually should continue, since the Fellowship should be kept informed and savings would be negligible.
- The committee considered the need for a footnote following the Introduction in *Twelve Concepts for World Service* indicating that, with permission of A.A. World Services, other Twelve Step programs, as well as A.A. service structures in other countries, have adapted their own Twelve Concepts, rewording them in an appropriate manner to reflect their own governmental/legal requirements and service structures. It was the consensus that this matter be reviewed by the 1997 Conference Report and Charter Committee to allow time to gather additional background information with regard to which body ultimately has responsibility for granting such permission.
- The committee reviewed the action of the 1995 Conference that resulted in the inclusion in the *Final Report* of proposed floor actions that the Conference voted not to consider and agreed that it was appropriate to include that information.
- The committee asked that consideration be given to listing online groups/meetings on A.A.'s Web Site.

TREATMENT FACILITIES

- The committee reviewed and discussed the sampling survey on Treatment Facility items conducted by the chairperson and alternate chairperson of the Conference Treatment Facilities Committee, beginning with Item No. 6: Do you or your committee have any concerns that you would like to have discussed by the Conference Treatment Facilities Committee? Helpful suggestions in response to concerns were: Encouraging areas to get more districts involved in treatment facilities service work; having more treatment facilities workshops; making service calls to treatment facilities; encouraging more discussion on carrying the message into treatment facilities; emphasizing Bridging the Gap service work. *Improvement in communication is always desired, especially in the current changing treatment environment.*
- The committee discussed the future direction of the Conference Treatment Facilities Committee and referred to the 1997 Conference Treatment Facilities Committee the review of both the committee's scope and its literature to make sure that the changing landscape of treatment programs is reflected.
- The committee discussed ways to inform the Fellowship about current changes going on in the treatment field and encouraged the A.A. membership to share these changes with the Treatment Facilities desk at the General Service Office.
- The committee shared ways to get "temporary contacts" for patients at the beginning of their treatment and felt that providing "temporary contacts" or "bridging the gap" contacts should be left up to the autonomy of the Treatment Facility Committee involved. Suggestions were also made to use central/intergroup office lists, area Treatment Facilities Committee chairpersons and "bridging the gap" committees as a means for "temporary contact" service work.
- The committee considered adding material to the Treatment Facilities Workbook on making Twelfth Step calls on "wet drunks" and, although the committee recognized the importance for each of us to understand working with others, it was decided the Treatment Facilities Workbook was not the proper format for this material. The committee referred the subject of making Twelfth Step calls on "wet drunks" to the trustees' Treatment Facilities Committee for further discussion.

CONFERENCE COMMITTEE ON TRUSTEES

- No other considerations.

Committee Recommendations Which Did Not Result in Conference Advisory Actions

GRAPEVINE

- The committee recommended that the Grapevine Corporate Board and staff utilize mailing lists similar to those used by the General Service Office to disseminate information about the Grapevine.

LITERATURE

- It was recommended that the video production company be authorized to videotape a short piece of the 46th General

Service Conference session (as well as a committee meeting) for possible limited use in the video project recommended by the 45th General Service Conference, subject to proper safeguards for anonymity, with no individually identifiable faces or voices. The video project will be brought back to the General Service Conference through the trustees' Literature Committee and the 47th General Service Conference Literature Committee for Conference approval.

- It was recommended that the manuscript originally commissioned as a history book be relabeled "collected observations of Alcoholics Anonymous" and that it be placed in the Archives and made available for purchase at cost upon request after editing for anonymity and various specific concerns relating to accuracy of content and style.
- It was recommended that the "Landmarks in A.A. History" section of *A.A. Comes of Age* be returned to its original form, as published in 1957, at the next printing.

REPORT AND CHARTER

- With a clear understanding that groups listed in the directory are listed at their own request, and a directory listing does not constitute or imply approval or endorsement of any group's approach to or practice of the traditional A.A. program, the committee recommended that online A.A. groups/meetings be listed in A.A. Directories on a supplementary page at the end of the Individual Groups section under the heading "Online Groups/Meetings," and that an e-mail or equivalent URL (Universal Resource Listing) contact address be provided in place of a contact person's phone number.
- Recognizing the unique characteristics of online groups with membership in many areas throughout the U.S. and Canada and also internationally, the committee recommended that members of online groups/meetings participate in the general service structure through regular face-to-face groups meeting in one location.

Floor Actions Which Did Not Result in Conference Advisory Actions

Floor Action #1:

Propose a Conference resolution that the 46th General Service Conference recommend to the Fellowship of A.A.s of the world that the first 164 pages of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, the Preface, the Forewords, "The Doctor's Opinion," "Doctor Bob's Nightmare" and the Appendices be unchanged without approval of three quarters of groups of the world.

Floor Action #2:

Propose a Conference recommendation that the General Service Board and its subsidiary boards, A.A. World Services Inc. and The A.A. Grapevine, Inc., initiate no litigation regarding the protection of copyrights or trademarks.

Wrong Door!

In his confusion the first day, John Kane (Southern New Jersey) walked into the ladies room by mistake and ran right into Wendy Zapaniuk (Saskatchewan). Rushing out, flustered, John said: "I haven't done that since I was drinking!" Wendy, holding her sides laughing: "That's the first time sober I've been followed into a John by a John."

Additional Committee Considerations Which Did Not Result in Recommendations

Advisory Action 40 of the 1990 General Service Conference states: "Items discussed, but no action taken or recommendation made, as well as committee recommendations which are not adopted, be included in a separate section of the Final Report." Those committee recommendations which are not adopted (less than 2/3 of the total Conference votes in favor), but which received at least a simple majority of the votes, are considered "strong suggestions" of the Conference. All items, listed by committee, are as follows:

AGENDA

- The committee reviewed and accepted the revised Conference Evaluation Form which is in this year's Conference Manual.
- The committee discussed a proposal to plan Conference agendas two years in advance and decided not to accept the suggestion.
- The committee asked the staff to prepare a form for the committee to send out each September 1st to all Conference members to gather suggestions for Conference themes, presentations and workshop topics.
- The committee suggested that the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference ask their chairperson to confer with the Conference Agenda Committee chairperson and the staff member in connection with each quarterly board meeting.

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

- The committee encourages the trustees' committee efforts to combine the pamphlets "If You Are a Professional," "Alcoholics Anonymous in Your Community" and "A.A. and Employee Assistance Programs" with consideration to the following:

- 1) Brief introduction for professional groups and individuals who have contact with alcoholics.
- 2) Consider a professional presentation of items found in the A.A. Fact Sheet to provide a simple and concise overview of Alcoholics Anonymous and how we can be helpful as a resource for professionals.

- 3) Incorporate the theme "A.A. as a Resource" so it can be used in a variety of presentations. (Professionals, Community Agencies, employee Assistance Programs, etc.)

- 4) The C.P.C. Conference Committee maintains that this will eliminate the duplication and redundancy that currently exists in the above mentioned pamphlets.

- The committee suggested the following changes be made to the service piece "Information on Alcoholics Anonymous":

- 1) Retitle the section "The Nonalcoholic Addict" on page 2 to "Singleness of Purpose and

Problems Other Than Alcohol," and replace the first paragraph with the following text:

"Alcoholism and drug addiction are often referred to as 'substance abuse' or 'chemical dependency.' Alcoholics and non-alcoholics are, therefore, sometimes introduced to A.A. and encouraged to attend A.A. meetings. Anyone may attend open A.A. meetings. But only those with a *drinking* problem may attend *closed* meetings or become A.A. members. People with problems other than alcoholism are eligible for A.A. membership *only* if they have a drinking problem."

- 2) In Item 14 under "What A.A. does not do" add (following "court officials") the words "social agencies, employers, etc."

- 3) Revise existing "treatment facility" titles to "facilities and institutions."

- The committee suggested that the pamphlet "The A.A. Group" be added to the list of A.A. Conference-approved literature in the pamphlet "If You Are a Professional."
- The committee reviewed the contents of the C.P.C. Kit and Workbook and found the contents to be sufficient.
- The committee discussed ways to improve communication between A.A. and the professional community by encouraging A.A. members to become active on C.P.C. committees and in sponsorship of professionals.
- The committee suggested that the trustees' C.P.C. Committee continue its discussion on the use of the A.A. Web Site as a C.P.C. tool.

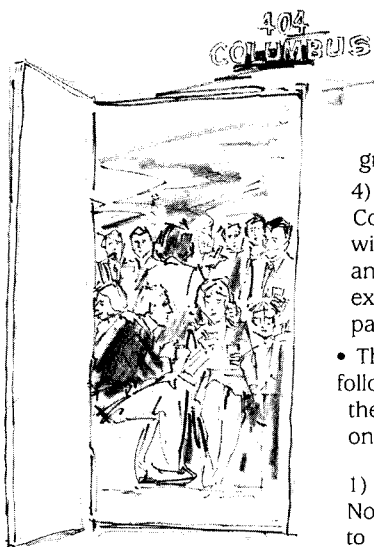
CORRECTIONAL FACILITIES

- The committee reviewed the proposed additions to the Correctional Facilities Workbook on youth detention centers and short-term facilities and referred them back, with suggestions, to the trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities to be further developed and brought back for consideration by the 1998 Conference Committee on Correctional Facilities.
- The committee reviewed the Correctional Facilities Workbook and suggested adding the pamphlet, "Twelve Steps Illustrated," to the Correctional Facilities Workbook's Literature Guide under "For Inmates (easy-to-read)" and "For Professional Staff," at the next printing.
- The committee discussed adding A.A. groups that meet in correctional facilities to the mailing list of the newsletter *Sharing From Behind the Walls*, and concluded that distribution of this newsletter to correctional facilities groups was a matter of area autonomy.
- The committee reviewed the remaining suggestions forwarded from the trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities and suggested the following:

- 1) The trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities undertake a review of the current A.A. correctional facilities literature, and that Correctional Facilities chairs be asked the following questions:

- a) Is the present A.A. corrections literature meeting the service needs of the Fellowship?
- b) What A.A. literature is reaching correctional professionals and their facilities and treatment programs?
- c) Is there a demonstrated need for any additional corrections literature?

This report is to be brought back to the 1998 Conference Committee on Correctional Facilities for review.



- 2) An informational letter from the General Service Office to wardens be developed and brought back to the 1998 Conference Committee on Correctional Facilities, along with projected costs of production and mailing.
- The committee reviewed the additional suggestions of the trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities, and concluded that these suggestions did not fall within the scope of the Conference Committee on Correctional Facilities.

FINANCE

- The committee reviewed the current Self-Support pamphlet and suggested that the Publications Department review the page numbering of the current pamphlet since the numbering for the first few pages are inconsistent in pamphlets sampled.
- The committee discussed the Birthday Envelope Plan and considered the following ways of raising the Fellowship's consciousness: Communicate Birthday Envelope Plan information to delegates at the General Service Conference; give each delegate Birthday envelopes to distribute in their areas; include information about the Birthday Envelope Plan along with several contribution envelopes in New Group Handbooks, and in quarterly contribution letters.

GRAPEVINE

- The committee discussed several suggestions for related items for production in 1999 and forwarded to the Grapevine Corporate Board for development two sets of tapes on the topics of: a) Carrying the Message; and b) Emotional Sobriety.

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/REGIONAL FORUMS

- The committee reviewed a draft of a Composition, Scope and Procedure for this secondary committee and accepted it unanimously with minor revisions.
- It was suggested that consideration be given to including the delegate chairperson of this committee or a member of the committee in future site-selection trips.

LITERATURE

- The committee considered the request to remove the word "never" from page 14, line 14, of the section, "What does a sponsor do?" in the pamphlet "Questions and Answers on Sponsorship," and saw no need for change.
- The committee reviewed the background material on confidentiality and suggested that the material not be produced.

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

- The committee considered a request to change the cutoff date for submitting Conference agenda items and determined that no change was necessary.
- The committee discussed additional background material on Conference agenda items and emphasized the importance of sending requested background material by February 15th of each year.
- The committee discussed the policy and role of observers at the General Service Conference, who are welcome and encouraged to observe, subject to the approval of the General Service Conference.

- The committee reviewed the responses regarding the forming of a Conference Archives Committee and felt there was no need.
- The Policy/Admissions Committee reviewed and discussed the scope of the Conference Committees and encouraged each Conference Committee to inventory itself.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

- The committee requested that the trustees' P.I. Committee report back to the 1998 Conference P.I. Committee on their study of updating, where necessary, all television and radio P.S.A.s including cultural references, availability in French and Spanish as well as formats compatible with current technology.
- The committee agreed to add "electronic media" to Section 1. of the current Scope of this committee as follows:
 - "1) Create greater understanding of the Fellowship of A.A. by carrying the message through:
 - a) public media
 - b) electronic media
 - c) public information meetings
 - d) speaking to community groups"
- The committee discussed the 1996 reports on A.A. Web Site activity. The committee applauded the creation of the A.A. Web Site. The committee requested a cumulative monthly reporting of accesses beyond the A.A. Web Site Home Page.
- The committee reviewed the report on C.P.C., C.F., P.I. and T.F. Service Kits and Workbooks and, in order to create consistency in language, the committee agreed to define this material as "P.I. Service Kits and Workbooks."
- The committee reviewed the contents of the Public Information Service Kit and Workbook and agreed to the following changes:
 - 1) Add a List of Contents to the Public Information Service Kit.
- At the next printing of the P.I. Workbook:
 - 1) Add an explanation regarding the 1996 Membership Survey to the section entitled "Background on Triennial A.A. Membership Survey." This explanation will be consistent with text in the 1996 Membership Survey pamphlet.
 - 2) Add a section entitled "Suggested Public Information Committee Goals" based on sharing from a district Public Information committee.
 - 3) Add the following explanation to the title page:

"The A.A. workbooks are compiled from the practical experience of A.A. members in the various service areas. They also reflect guidance given through the Twelve Traditions and the General Service Conference (U.S. & Canada)."

REPORT AND CHARTER

- The committee unanimously agreed that there was no need to footnote the "Introduction" to the *Twelve Concepts for World Service* because the A.A. World Services Board holds the copy-

When the printer delivered the blueprint of this *Report* to the Publications department the label on the envelope read: "Contents: Blueprint for text of *1997 Final Solution*."

rights in trust on behalf of the General Service Board, U.S. and Canada, and has the right of decision in such matters.

- The committee considered at length a suggestion to eliminate the last names of G.S.R.s and group contacts from the confidential A.A. directories, publishing only the first name and first initial of the last name of those members, and agreed that full names of general service representatives and group contacts may continue to be used in confidential A.A. directories. The committee requests that the General Service Office continue to exercise discretion by distributing A.A. confidential directories within the Fellowship only, and that each A.A. member respect the anonymity of members listed in the directories.
- The committee discussed the request that the General Service Office extend the delay in processing "Alcoholics Anonymous New Group Forms" from 30 days to 60 days and agreed that there was not sufficient need to extend the delay beyond 30 days.

TREATMENT FACILITIES

- After reviewing the material collected by the trustees' Committee on Treatment Facilities regarding changes in the treatment field, the committee thanked the trustees' Committee for its efforts and encouraged them to continue to monitor changes.
- The committee discussed the increasing need for direct contacts with alcoholics in the wide variety of treatment modalities and encourages area committees to assist districts in developing locally-sensitive methods of bridging the gap to Alcoholics Anonymous.
- The committee encourages the trustees' Committee to continue their efforts to share information with others involved in bridging the gap for alcoholics into our Fellowship.
- The committee discussed efforts in their home areas to address the need for helping newer A.A. members feel comfortable in carrying the message to alcoholics reaching our doors and suggested we encourage local sharing with regional correspondents at the General Service Office and the Fellowship through Box 4-5-9, the Grapevine and other vehicles.
- The committee discussed the 1996 reports on A.A. Web Site activity and agreed to forward the following suggestions to A.A. World Services, Inc. for consideration: that tracking methods continue to be developed and e-mail addresses be added to the screens.
- The committee reviewed the letter to treatment professionals and appreciates the fresh approach.

TRUSTEES

- After reviewing the committee's Composition, Scope and Procedure, the committee suggested the following statement under Scope to reflect actual practice:

"The committee reviews resumes of appointed committee members recommended to serve on trustees' committees, i.e., Public Information, Cooperation With the Professional Community, Treatment Facilities, Correctional Facilities, and Literature."

Committee Recommendations Which Did Not Result in Conference Advisory Actions

FINANCE

- It was recommended that the *General Service Board Policy* that states: "Whenever a discount or subsidy is that which would be offered to any other organization of similar size requiring a purchased service or product of similar character and magnitude, i.e., convention rates at hotels, it may be accepted. Whenever a

discount or subsidy is partly or in total offered because we are Alcoholics Anonymous, it must be declined." Be changed to:

"Whenever a discount is that which would be offered to any other organization of similar size requiring a purchased service or product of similar character and magnitude, e.g., convention rates at hotels, it may be accepted. Whenever a discount is partly or in total offered because we are Alcoholics Anonymous, it must be declined. Alcoholics Anonymous may not accept any money from outside sources to defray expenses."

- It was recommended that there be a reaffirmation of the 1981 Conference Advisory Action - "All future events, such as the International Convention, not be planned to operate on a deficit basis, and it was also recommended that all future events of this type be self-supporting" as this is still a prudent policy.

LITERATURE

- It was recommended that the suggested changes to the *Living Sober* booklet be approved with some modifications. **(Tabled)**

PUBLIC INFORMATION

- It was recommended that the following language be added to the back cover and List of Contents of the Public Information Service Kit and to the back cover of the Public Information Workbook:

"This service material is approved by the Conference Public Information Committee."

TREATMENT FACILITIES

- It was recommended that the Treatment Facilities Workbook and the Treatment Facilities Handbook be Conference-approved literature rather than service material.

Floor Actions Which Did Not Result in Conference Advisory Actions

Floor Action #1:

It was recommended that when fiscally prudent, A.A.W.S. Publishing ought to place as a high priority goal, the audio-taping in English, and the audio-taping in Spanish of current A.A. (book) printed literature. **(Failed)**

Floor Action #2:

It was recommended that the following changes to the *Living Sober* booklet be approved:

- Page 55, after the ninth full paragraph: (footnote) "A.A. World Services publishes a pamphlet titled *The A.A. Member — Medications and Other Drugs*. Many members who must take medications for medical conditions have found its suggestions very helpful. The pamphlet is A.A. General Service Conference-approved literature. It may also be helpful to give this pamphlet to our personal physicians to assist them in increasing their knowledge of the nature of our illness, alcoholism."

- Page 4, second paragraph: Remove the sentence: "We have also found that we have to stay away from mind-changing drugs." **(Failed)**

Floor Action #3:

It is recommended that last names of G.S.R.s and group contacts be eliminated from the confidential A.A. directories and that only the first name and first initial of the last name of those members be listed. **(Not Considered)**

Additional Committee Considerations

(Items discussed but no action taken or recommendation made.)

AGENDA

- The committee reviewed the Conference Evaluation Form and agreed that the questions remain the same for the 49th General Service Conference Evaluation Form.
- The committee considered the Composition, Scope and Procedure and agreed to revise the sections on Composition and Scope to better reflect current practice, and to also update the language in the Procedure section.
- The committee asked the staff secretary to prepare a form to be sent out each September 1st to all Conference members to gather suggestions for the Conference theme, presentations and workshop topics.

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

- The committee reviewed the draft for a pamphlet developed to replace the existing pamphlet "If You Are a Professional" and agreed there is no need for the new material at this time.
- The committee reviewed the C.P.C. Kit and requested the suggested addition to the C.P.C. Workbook regarding working with students of professional schools be implemented at the next printing.
- The committee encourages A.A. members to bring students of professional schools to their open A.A. meetings.
- The committee discussed C.P.C. participation in the development of future Membership Surveys, and agreed to take no action at this time.

CORRECTIONAL FACILITIES:

- The committee suggests that a new section, entitled "Carrying the Message into Youth Detention Centers and Short-Term Facilities," be added to the contents section of the Correctional Facilities Workbook and that the new section follow the section "How to do Correctional Facilities Work."
- The committee reviewed the trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities' report on literature review and saw no need for action at this time.
- The committee suggested that an informational letter from the General Service Office to correctional professionals be further developed as a one-page document and brought back to the 1999 Conference Committee on Correctional Facilities, along with projected costs of production and distribution.
- The committee considered a suggestion that the Correctional Facilities Workbook be designated as service material rather than A.A. Conference-approved literature and decided it should remain A. A. Conference-approved.

FINANCE

- The committee unanimously suggested that Birthday Plan envelopes continue to be sent to delegates annually.

- The committee unanimously suggested G.S.O. develop a method for measuring the use of Birthday envelopes and report the results to the delegates.

- The committee had a wide ranging discussion of the principle of Self-Support, with special emphasis on how the topic relates to the Conference theme: "Our Twelfth Step Work."

Much of the discussion revolved around the importance of increasing participation of individuals and groups in all levels of service. Contributions are but one form of participation that make it possible for one alcoholic to carry the message to another. The committee unanimously agreed that delegates can play a key role in increasing self-support by:

- a) Promoting the Birthday Plan, and
- b) Emphasizing Twelfth Step work made possible by contributions; for example, the work we do to provide translations of A.A. literature in foreign languages that then reach populations that have never before heard the A.A. message of recovery and hope.

The committee recognizes that Self-Support and the spiritual principle of sacrifice on which it is based must be continually communicated.

- The committee reviewed the action taken by the 1997 General Service Conference concerning the board policy that states:

Whenever a discount or subsidy is that which would be offered to any other organization of similar size requiring a purchased service or product of similar character and magnitude, i.e., convention rates at hotels, it may be accepted. Whenever a discount or subsidy is partly or in total offered because we are Alcoholics Anonymous, it must be declined.

The 1997 General Service Conference voted not to change this policy. With substantial unanimity, the committee felt there was no need to reconsider this decision.

GRAPEVINE

- The committee considered several suggestions for related items for production in the year 2000 and forwarded to the Grapevine Corporate Board their suggestion that one item be developed: a soft-cover anthology, tentatively called *AA Around the World*, comprised of Grapevine articles.
- The committee also wished to suggest to the Grapevine Corporate Board that an anthology of letters previously published in the Grapevine be considered for publication at a future date.

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/REGIONAL FORUMS

- The committee discussed suggestions for future Regional Forums and encouraged the trustees' Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums to consider the possibility of having more frequent and accessible Forums within a region.

LITERATURE

- The committee suggested that the service piece developed to accompany the video *Your A.A. General Service Office, the Grapevine and the General Service Structure* be available as a separate item.
- The committee considered a request from an area that the six-point definition of an A.A. group be added to "The A.A. Group" pamphlet, replacing the section from Warrant Six added by the

1997 General Service Conference, and concurred with the trustees' Literature Committee's conclusion that "The A.A. Group" pamphlet remain as is.

- The committee considered a request for Conference approval of a pamphlet submitted by an area, "The Twelfth Step Call: A Brief Guide," and applauded the intent and effort put into the development of this material, but took no action on this item. The consensus of the committee was that this was a local service piece, and that A.A. members should be encouraged to do Twelfth Step work through sponsorship, workshops, and the chapter, "Working With Others," in the Big Book.

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

- The Conference Policy/Admissions Committee did their inventory and felt the committee is serving a vital purpose in accordance with its scope.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

- The committee discussed the 1997 and current reports on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web Site activity and acknowledged the effectiveness of the A.A. Web Site as a valuable Public Information tool in carrying the message and providing opportunities for local Twelfth Step work.
- The committee reviewed the contents of the Public Information Kit and Workbook and suggested that the trustees' Public Information Committee thoroughly review the contents of the A.A. Fact File.

REPORT AND CHARTER

- The committee discussed a review of the *A.A. Service Manual*, undertaken by the Publications Department of the General Service Office, suggested a number of editorial changes and requested that a completed second draft be prepared for consideration by the 1999 Conference Report and Charter Committee.
- The committee considered a proposal to change the format or to discontinue the group directories for the U.S. and Canada. The committee felt the directories should be continued and that there should be no changes in the format at this time.
- The committee considered a request to list an on-line intergroup as an intergroup on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web Site. The committee took no action, reaffirming Advisory Action #32 of the 1997 General Service Conference that "intergroups serving on-line meetings be listed adjacent to on-line A.A. meetings in the section on International Correspondence." The committee felt that on-line intergroups have been placed in the appropriate place in the directories.

TREATMENT FACILITIES

- The committee discussed creating a list of suggested goals for Treatment Facilities committees and requested that the committee secretary distribute a preliminary list of suggested goals for Treatment Facilities committees to all delegates and Treatment Facilities committee chairpeople on G.S.O.'s mailing list.
- The committee discussed Area Temporary Contact/Bridging the Gap efforts and shared on a wide range of experience and suggested that this experience be included in a future edition of *Box 4-5-9* and be added to the Treatment Facilities Workbook.

- The committee discussed Treatment Facilities Activity Reports from the Treatment Facilities coordinator to all Treatment Facilities committee chairpeople and asked that these reports also continue to be sent to area delegates. The committee requested that the committee secretary distribute the G.S.O. mailing list of Treatment Facilities committee chairpeople to all area delegates for their information, updating and review.

- The committee discussed the results of the November 1997 request to Treatment Facilities committees for sharing on carrying the message into psychiatric/mental health facilities or state hospitals. The committee noted that these responses represented a wide variety of personal experience and the responses give a sense of what's happening across the United States and Canada. The committee discussed the continuing need to concentrate on this kind of sharing and exchange of information. These responses show committees at different levels of service experience. The responses appear to be an accurate inventory of the strengths and weaknesses in carrying the message into psychiatric/mental health facilities or state hospitals.

- The committee requested that the summary of responses to the November 1997 Treatment Facilities Questionnaire be condensed and rewritten for the Treatment Facilities Workbook and that this revised summary of responses be presented to the 1999 Conference Treatment Facilities Committee for their review.

- The committee discussed the 1997 Policy/Admissions Committee's suggestion that each Conference committee inventory itself. As a result of this discussion and after a second review of this committee's Composition, Scope and Procedure, the committee agreed to revise the second paragraph of the Scope, "The committee will review all aspects of service to A.A. groups in treatment facilities and make recommendations for changes and/or improvements" to read, "The committee will review all aspects of service to A.A. groups/meetings in treatment facilities and other noncorrectional institutional environments and make recommendations for changes and/or improvements."

The committee also agreed that discussion of their agenda items covered all aspects of this committee's inventory.

- The committee reviewed and accepted the Treatment Facilities Workbook (three-ring binder) and Treatment Facilities Handbook with minor changes.
- The committee requested that a questionnaire be circulated to all delegates and Treatment Facilities committee chairpeople to request sharing on carrying the message into noncorrectional youth facilities and that a summary of responses be reviewed by the trustees' Treatment Facilities Committee and the 1999 Conference Treatment Facilities Committee.
- The committee suggested that the trustees' Treatment Facilities Committee consider developing a Treatment Facilities tabletop display for use by local Treatment Facilities committees.

TRUSTEES

- The committee strongly suggested that the trustees' Nominating Committee remove the following diversity statement from the four vacancy announcement letters for regional trustee, trustee-at-large, Class A trustee and appointed committee member:

Note: At its August 1997 meeting, the trustees' Nominating Committee expressed overall concern that, as a Fellowship, we need to be mindful of attracting women and people of color to serve the Fellowship when vacancies occur, recognizing that diversity is a key factor in the unity of the Fellowship.



While the committee recognizes the Fellowship's need to attract the most diverse and qualified trusted servants in the service structure to serve Alcoholics Anonymous, enumerating diversity in announcing vacancies is not within the spirit of A.A. unity.

- In taking the committee's inventory, it was felt that under the Composition section of the Composition, Scope and Procedure document, an attempt should be made to ensure that regions with small numbers of delegates avoid duplication on Conference committee assignments.

Under the Scope section of its Composition, Scope and Procedure, the committee expressed a desire to continue to review resumes of appointed committee members but questioned the purpose of the review.

The committee found the Procedure section of its Composition, Scope and Procedure to be acceptable as written.

- The committee discussed the demands of time and energy required to serve as a regional trustee and felt that this topic needed ongoing discussion. The committee noted with appreciation that the board was looking into restructuring the board weekends.

- With regard to future growth of the Conference, the committee thanked the trustees' Nominating Committee for their work on developing the process for requesting new delegate areas and regional realignment. This had been recommended by the trustees' Nominating Committee as follows:

- 1) After January 1, 1999, requests for new delegate areas be evaluated on an individual basis, taking into consideration conditions within both the requesting area and Alcoholics Anonymous (U.S./Canada).

- 2) The possible need for regional realignment be evaluated by following the existing "Suggested Guidelines for Changing Regional Boundaries" and that regional trustees should work together as a group to further discuss the process.

- The committee encouraged the trustees' Nominating Committee to continue to examine the role of appointed committee

members on trustees' committees. The committee would like to receive feedback for future committee discussions.

Committee Recommendations Which Did Not Result in Conference Advisory Actions

LITERATURE

- That changes related to updating language in *Living Sober* be made.
- That changes related to medical and/or health information in *Living Sober* be made.
- That changes related to A.A.'s singleness of purpose in *Living Sober* be made.
- That the following insert be added to the booklet *Living Sober*, Chapter 29, "Different Kinds of A.A. Meetings" page 81, and placed after the text on Step Meetings:

"Cyberspace." With the increasing availability of the Internet, some of our members are having meetings in "cyberspace." Many of these members use this new medium to supplement their regular meetings, and some, due to either physical isolation or disability, cannot make regular meetings and find this new way of sharing to be an essential part of their sobriety.

Floor Actions Which Did Not Result in Conference Advisory Actions

Floor Action #1:

That the General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc. return the \$150,000 transportation subsidy received from the city of San Diego for the 1995 International Convention. **(Conference voted not to consider)**

Floor Action #2:

That the entire book *Living Sober* be sent to a subcommittee for evaluation and possible revision. **(Not adopted)**

Floor Action #3:

That group contributions to the General Service Office be included in the directories, i.e., Eastern, Western and Canadian. **(Conference voted not to consider)**

Tanya Every (Hawaii) and husband David (GV director) celebrated their 14th wedding anniversary Conference week—he gave her a jade ring and they sat together at lunch.

Additional Committee Considerations

(Items discussed but no action taken or recommendation made.)

AGENDA

- The committee reviewed the Conference Evaluation Form and agreed that the questions remain the same for the 50th General Service Conference Evaluation Form.
- The committee asked the staff secretary to prepare a letter and form to be sent out annually in early September to all Conference members to gather suggestions for the Conference theme, presentations and workshop topic.

ARCHIVES

- The committee reviewed the proposed draft of a Composition, Scope and Procedure of the Conference Archives Committee and accepted it with suggested amendments.

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

- The committee considered a request to change the designation of the C.P.C. Kit and Workbook from service material to Conference-approved literature and took no action. It was the sense of the committee that, as service material, the Kit and Workbook could be updated as often as shared experience indicates, with the understanding that the Kit and Workbook are reviewed annually by the Conference Committee.
- The committee reviewed the text added to six C.P.C. pamphlets by the 1997 General Service Conference under the title "Singleness of Purpose and Problems Other Than Alcohol" and took no action because they could not reach substantial unanimity.
- The committee reviewed a drawing of a proposed new panel for the current C.P.C. Exhibit to replace the "Our Beginnings" panel and supported the spirit of the panel change.
- Following a thorough review of the C.P.C. Kit, the committee made a minor change. The committee encouraged local C.P.C. committees to utilize both the shared experience of others involved in C.P.C. work and the C.P.C. Workbook.

CORRECTIONAL FACILITIES

- The committee reviewed a draft of a one-page informational letter to wardens and correctional professionals and agreed that, with minor editorial changes, the letter be distributed biannually to wardens and correctional professionals throughout the United States and Canada.
- The committee considered additions/revisions to the pamphlet "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell" and suggested that the Publications Department prepare a draft of "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell" for review by the 2000 Conference Committee on Correctional Facilities that will include:
 - 1) New graphics that do more to depict hope
 - 2) An easier-to-read format
 - 3) "Clyde's" story
 - 4) New stories depicting A.A. members with long-term sobriety while incarcerated, in addition to all current stories.

FINANCE

- The committee unanimously recognizes that the acceptance of discounts or subsidies in the form of cash causes discomfort to some members of our Fellowship. The committee suggests that any future negotiations regarding International Convention discounts or subsidies be carried out with this in mind.
- In expectation of continuing discussion of Self-Support, the committee invites areas to share their experience in Self-Support with the committee.
- After broad discussion on Self-Support, we unanimously encourage the use of our existing communication tools, such as the video "Your A.A. General Service Office, the Grapevine, and the General Service Structure." The committee noted the use of visual aids is very helpful in generating interest in service pieces and correspondence, such as the quarterly mailing, and suggests they be used.

GRAPEVINE

- The committee considered several suggestions for related items for production in 2001 and forwarded to the Grapevine Corporate Board its suggestion that the Grapevine produce a soft-cover anthology of letters selected from those published in the magazine from 1944 to the present.
- The committee liked the idea of an audio form of the monthly magazine produced by the Grapevine, and asked the Grapevine staff to determine the level of interest in the Fellowship and bring back a report to the Conference Committee on the Grapevine in the year 2000.
- The committee discussed the request to establish a committee to review and approve all articles prior to publication in the Grapevine, and determined that the current process for the selection of articles works well.
- The committee would like to encourage areas to purchase Grapevine and La Viña subscriptions and back issues for direct placement in treatment facilities and correctional facilities.
- Being mindful of the demonstrated effectiveness of La Viña and the need for it expressed by the Hispanic community, and considering its spiritual benefits and benefits as a Twelfth Step tool, the committee wishes to express strong support for its continued publication.

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/REGIONAL FORUMS

- The committee discussed ways to encourage interest in Regional and Special Forums and suggested that delegates get districts involved, especially the host district where a Forum is held; encourage new people to go to Forums and to submit topics of interest for presentations and workshops; distribute Forum flyers and place Forum information in area, district, central office and intergroup newsletters. Suggest that Forums have more flexibility and open scheduling of the agenda; questions on the Forum floor need more direct answers. Special Forums are working well and have brought areas and districts together. The committee looks forward to a great year ahead with four Regional and two Special Forums planned in Altoona, Pennsylvania; San Juan, Puerto Rico; Sheridan, Wyoming; Ann Arbor, Michigan; Window Rock, Arizona; and Lubbock, Texas.
- The committee suggested that area/state/provincial convention committees be lovingly requested to consider not planning conventions six weeks before or after the 2000 International Convention, since attendance at local events during this time might be adversely affected. As local committees are planning

events up to three years prior to the event, it is suggested that the committee discuss this request at least three years prior to the 2005 International Convention.

- The committee discussed proposed revisions to current Guidelines and Procedures for International Conventions Site Selection and requested that G.S.O. management and the trustees' Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums prepare revised Guidelines and Procedures for International Conventions Site Selection based on experience from the 2005 site selection and that these revised Guidelines and Procedures be presented for review by the 2000 Conference Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums.

- The committee requested that the trustees' Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums implement an inventory on International Conventions similar to the 1999 Regional Forums inventory and forward an Inventory Report for discussion to the 2000 Conference Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums.

LITERATURE

- The committee strongly suggested that no index be included in any Fourth Edition Big Book.
- The committee discussed with appreciation the proposal for an A.A. history book and agreed that there were ample existing resources on A.A. history and that there was no compelling need to develop this project.
- Expressing substantial concerns about unity and inclusivity in the A.A. Fellowship, the committee strongly suggested that the trustees' Literature Committee, through the General Service Office, distribute a questionnaire soliciting input from all Conference areas on whether there is a need for the continued development of "special interest" literature in a society that has many faces in one Fellowship.

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

- The Conference Policy/Admissions Committee considered a proposal that all Secondary Conference Committees be composed of nine voting members without regard for representation from every region and agreed that it is reasonable to have nine voting members on secondary committees with an attempt to have a balanced regional representation, with the exception of the Conference Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums which should continue to be composed of eight delegates (one from each region) because of the importance of having every region represented when the committee is involved with site selection for an International Convention.
- The committee considered a proposal that all Secondary Conference Committees meet jointly with the corresponding trustees' committees and then meet separately to discuss agenda items and make recommendations reached by majority vote (if any) and saw no reason to change the current practice of meeting jointly with the corresponding trustees' committee with the



understanding that, although trustee committee members are present, only members of the Conference Committees vote on recommendations to the Conference as a whole.

- Although the committee recognized the importance of bridging the gap between treatment and correctional facilities and the A.A. group, the committee saw no need for a Conference Bridging the Gap Committee at this time. The committee expressed confidence that the trustees' and Conference Committees on Treatment and Correctional Facilities will do everything possible to enhance interest in this activity at the area and district level. It was also noted that the needs of Bridging the Gap Committees are being met by the Treatment Facilities and Correctional Facilities assignments at G.S.O.

- The committee discussed possible future needs of the Conference in terms of combining or reassigning committee functions and agreed that this may need closer attention in the years to come.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

- The committee reviewed the trustees' Public Information Committee's report on the A.A. Fact File and approved all of the suggested minor editorial revisions.
- The committee discussed anonymity at the public level on the Internet and suggested that area delegates explain at the local level that "electronic media" is implicit in the last phrase of the Eleventh Tradition and that areas be encouraged to discuss anonymity at the public level of the Internet. The committee further suggested that the trustees' Committee on Public Information review P.I. literature to add "Internet" or "electronic media" where collective experience refers to press, radio, films and TV, and requested that the trustees' P.I. Committee report back to the 2000 Conference P.I. Committee.
- The committee discussed the 1998 and current report on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site activity. The committee applauded the effectiveness of the A.A. Web site as an adequate and valuable public information tool in carrying the message and providing opportunities for local Twelfth Step work.
- The committee reviewed the contents of the Public Information Kit and Workbook and suggested that the Public Information pamphlet "Where Do I Go From Here?" be included in the contents of the P.I. Kit.

REPORT AND CHARTER

- The committee considered suggestions for changes to the revised manuscript of *The A.A. Service Manual* offered by Conference members after April 1, and decided that since they came in after a deadline set for the committee's review, they should go through the committee process by being offered for the agenda of the 2000 Report and Charter Committee.
- The committee considered a proposal to add a footnote to Warranty Five, page 72, *Twelve Concepts for World Service*, 1998-99 edition, stating that Alcoholics Anonymous will continue to oppose unauthorized use of its registered trademarks. The committee unanimously agreed the footnote should not be added, agreeing with the 1997 Report and Charter Committee that it was not necessary to footnote the Warranty because the right of decision in such matters rests with the A.A. World Services Board on behalf of the General Service Board, U.S. and Canada.
- The committee discussed a proposal that G.S.O. print all listed groups in its directories unless a group chooses not to be included. It was decided not to suggest the change because it was felt the present policy of requiring a phone number in directory listings agrees with a 1977 Conference Advisory Action which states, "Only full names and phone numbers that may be used for Twelfth Step referral and meeting information from any source be published. This will be clearly indicated on the group information sheet."

TREATMENT FACILITIES

- The committee reviewed the condensed summary of responses to the November 1997 Treatment Facilities Questionnaire requesting sharing on carrying the message into psychiatric/mental health facilities or state hospitals. The committee suggested that a section on "Carrying the Message into Psychiatric/Mental Health Facilities or State Hospitals" be added to the Treatment Facilities Handbook.
- The committee discussed both the condensed and unedited summary of responses to the June 1998 Treatment Facilities Questionnaire requesting sharing on carrying the message into non-correctional youth facilities. The committee suggested that a section on "Carrying the Message Into Non-Correctional Youth Facilities" be added to the Treatment Facilities Handbook.
- The committee discussed Bridging the Gap/Temporary Contact efforts. As a result of their discussions, the committee emphasized the importance of continued attention to this most valuable Twelfth-Step work.
- The committee reviewed the contents of the Treatment Facilities Workbook and Treatment Facilities Handbook:
 - 1) The committee discussed the title of the 1998 Conference Treatment Facilities Committee's list of "Suggested Goals for Treatment Facilities Committees." The committee suggested that this section be retitled "Some Suggested Activities for Treatment Facilities Committees."
 - 2) The committee reviewed the revised text in the section entitled "Fellowships Similar to A.A." in the Treatment Facilities Handbook and welcomed the simplified version.
- The committee considered a request to change the designation of the Treatment Facilities Kit and Handbook from service material to Conference-approved literature and took no action. The committee unanimously agreed that as service material, the Kit and Handbook may be updated as often as our shared experience indicates, with the understanding that the Kit and Handbook are reviewed annually by the Conference Committee.

TRUSTEES

- The committee discussed adding the following statement to the vacancy announcement letters for appointed committee member, Class A trustee, regional trustee, and trustee-at-large/U.S. or Canada:

"In seeking applicants for all vacancies in Alcoholics Anonymous, the Fellowship is committed to creating a large applicant file of qualified persons which reflects the inclusiveness and diversity of A.A. itself."

The committee was unanimous that the statement was reflective of A.A. principles but felt uncomfortable with the word "diversity." The committee suggested that the trustees' Nominating Committee review the statement again to determine if any such statement is necessary, or if it could be improved, and report back to the Conference Committee on Trustees in April 2000.

- The committee reviewed the role of appointed committee members and recognized they are a great resource to trustees' committees, providing a richness of experience and expertise to the committees on which they serve. The committee felt that appointed committee members should continue to be members of A.A. and thanked currently-serving appointed committee members for their service to the Fellowship.
- The committee expressed appreciation to the chairman of the General Service Board for communicating that five of seven Class A trustees will be rotating off the board in the years 2000-2001, and understands that the chairman may feel the need to exercise his option to extend the term of one or more Class A trustees in order to maintain continuity on the board.

FLOOR ACTIONS WHICH DID NOT RESULT IN CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTIONS

Floor Action #2:

- That the 49th General Service Conference direct the trustees' Literature Committee to evaluate the Conference Literature Committee's "strong suggestion" to distribute a questionnaire soliciting input from all Conference areas on whether there is a need for the continued development of "special interest" literature in a society that has many faces in one Fellowship. In this evaluation, the trustees' Literature Committee should weigh out the benefits of such a questionnaire and determine if such a questionnaire would in fact, give us a group conscience. They should report back to the Conference Literature Committee. **(Not approved)**

Floor Action #3:

- That the General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc., return the \$250,000 cash incentive received from the city of San Diego for the 1995 International Convention. **(Not approved)**

Floor Action #4:

- That the General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc., refrain from accepting the \$100,000 cash incentive from the city of Minneapolis for the 2000 International Convention. **(Not approved)**

Mickey Hardesty's (Utah) area gave him a going away present of a Mickey Mouse hand puppet—to use in response to roll call and to remind him of Rule 62: Don't take yourself too seriously.

Additional Committee Considerations

(Items discussed but no action taken or recommendation made.)

AGENDA

- The committee reviewed the Conference Evaluation Form and agreed that the headings remain the same for the 51st General Service Conference Evaluation Form. The committee suggested that the Conference Evaluation Form be printed on brightly colored paper and placed in the front of the Conference Manual, and that frequent announcements to fill out the form and hand it in be made throughout the Conference week.
- The committee discussed the Spanish Translations and Remote Communities meetings that were held prior to the 50th General Service Conference and suggested that a Presentation/Discussion topic on Spanish Translations be included on the agenda of the 51st General Service Conference.
- The committee asked the staff secretary to prepare a letter and form to be sent out annually in August to all Conference members to gather suggestions for the Conference theme, presentations and workshop topic.

ARCHIVES¹

- The committee reviewed the Composition, Scope and Procedure and made a minor change.
- The existing Archives policy on anonymity was reviewed and discussed at length. The committee was satisfied that the trustees' committee's discussion on this topic significantly reflected the views of the Fellowship and accepted the trustees' committee's assurance that the topic would continue to receive the attention it deserves.
- A progress report was presented on the Archives Kit. The committee members expressed their appreciation for the ideas and suggestions they received from a number of areas. Several Area Archives Handbooks were consulted for this work. The committee was pleased with the suggested contents of the draft. Since the Kit format provides flexibility that allows for updates and potential additions, the committee encouraged the trustees' Archives Committee to complete and make the new Kit available as soon as possible.
- The committee discussed the roles of area archivists, archives chairs, and collectors and suggested that the new Archives Kit include a discussion of these roles.
- After brief discussion regarding an archives service piece pamphlet the sense of meeting was to encourage the trustees' Archives Committee to continue development.

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

- The committee discussed ways of providing A.A. information to professionals and made the following suggestions:

The committee agreed with the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities' consensus that one-on-one sharing was a more successful way than providing A.A. literature alone in helping professionals feel competent in working with those afflicted with alcoholism.

The committee suggested that Information on Alcoholics Anonymous (F-2) along with profession-specific literature be used to supplement one-on-one contact with professionals.

The committee suggested that A.A. members offer to accompany professionals to open A.A. meetings as a way of sharing hope with the professional community.

- The committee reviewed contents of the C.P.C. Kit and Workbook and made the following suggestions:

That the sentence on page 10 of the C.P.C. Workbook which reads, "There are no requirements for A.A. membership" be deleted.

That the initial paragraph on page 18 of the C.P.C. Workbook, under the heading Basic Guidelines on C.P.C. Presentations, be changed to read, "Here are two suggested formats for presentations."

CORRECTIONAL FACILITIES

- The committee considered a request to change the designation of the Correctional Facilities Kit and Workbook from Conference-approved literature to service material and took no action.

FINANCE

- The committee discussed the 1988 Advisory Action #2 concerning using literature prices as the primary mechanism to adjust the Reserve Fund and requests the trustees' Finance Committee to prepare examples of a floating cap plan for the 2001 Conference Finance Committee. This may include such items as historical data, average number of months of operating expenses covered by the Prudent Reserve over a period of years, methods used to monitor the Reserve Fund, and any other items the trustees' Finance Committee deems appropriate. This is requested to help study alternatives to price reductions which apparently sends a mixed message to the Fellowship.
- The committee discussed increasing the delegate fees, and determined no change be made at this time, but in the spirit of self-support encourages areas to make a contribution, over and above the suggested figure, if possible, to defray the average cost per delegate.
- After a discussion the committee noted the use of visual aids is very helpful in generating interest in service pieces and correspondence, such as the quarterly mailing, and suggests they continue to be used. Also, members are encouraged to use tools such as Birthday Plan, Memoriam Contributions and Gratitude Month.
- In expectation of continuing discussion of Self-Support, the committee invites areas to share their experience in Self-Support with the committee.

GRAPEVINE

- The committee reviewed the five-year history of La Viña. Being mindful of the demonstrated effectiveness of La Viña and the strong support for it expressed by the A.A. membership as a whole, and considering its spiritual benefits as a Twelfth Step tool, the committee wishes to express strong support for its continued publication.

- The committee discussed the advisability of producing the Grapevine magazine on tape and decided this is not a viable project because of the high cost and lack of expressed need.
- The committee discussed returning the About Alcoholism section (the "gray pages") to the Grapevine and felt that no action was necessary. The committee saw no need or desire in the Fellowship for the section. Information from the alcoholism field does not promote A.A.'s primary purpose and is readily available elsewhere.
- The committee considered several suggestions for related items for production in the year 2002 or later, and forwarded to the Grapevine Corporate Board its suggestion that the Grapevine produce a booklet on spiritual experience and a booklet on emotional sobriety.
- The committee considered a suggestion that a service position of Grapevine Subscription Chairperson be adopted by A.A. groups in the U.S. and Canada and concluded that there was no need for such a position.

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/ REGIONAL FORUMS¹:

- After considerable discussion, the committee accepted the proposed draft Guidelines and Procedures for 2010 International Convention Site Selection with one minor revision. These draft Guidelines and Procedures were forwarded to this committee by the trustees' Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums.
- The committee discussed a progress report on the International Conventions Inventory requested by the 1999 Conference Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums. The committee requests that all Conference members encourage their areas to discuss the need and purpose of International Conventions and to submit written reports of these discussions to the trustees' Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums. The committee noted that this International Conventions Inventory is a general inventory of all International Conventions and not specifically the 2000 International Convention.
- The committee reviewed and accepted the proposed distribution plan and text for the 2000 International Convention Questionnaire.
- The committee reviewed and discussed the 2000 International Convention Budget.

LITERATURE

- The committee reviewed the trustees' Literature Committee's progress report on the development of a pamphlet for

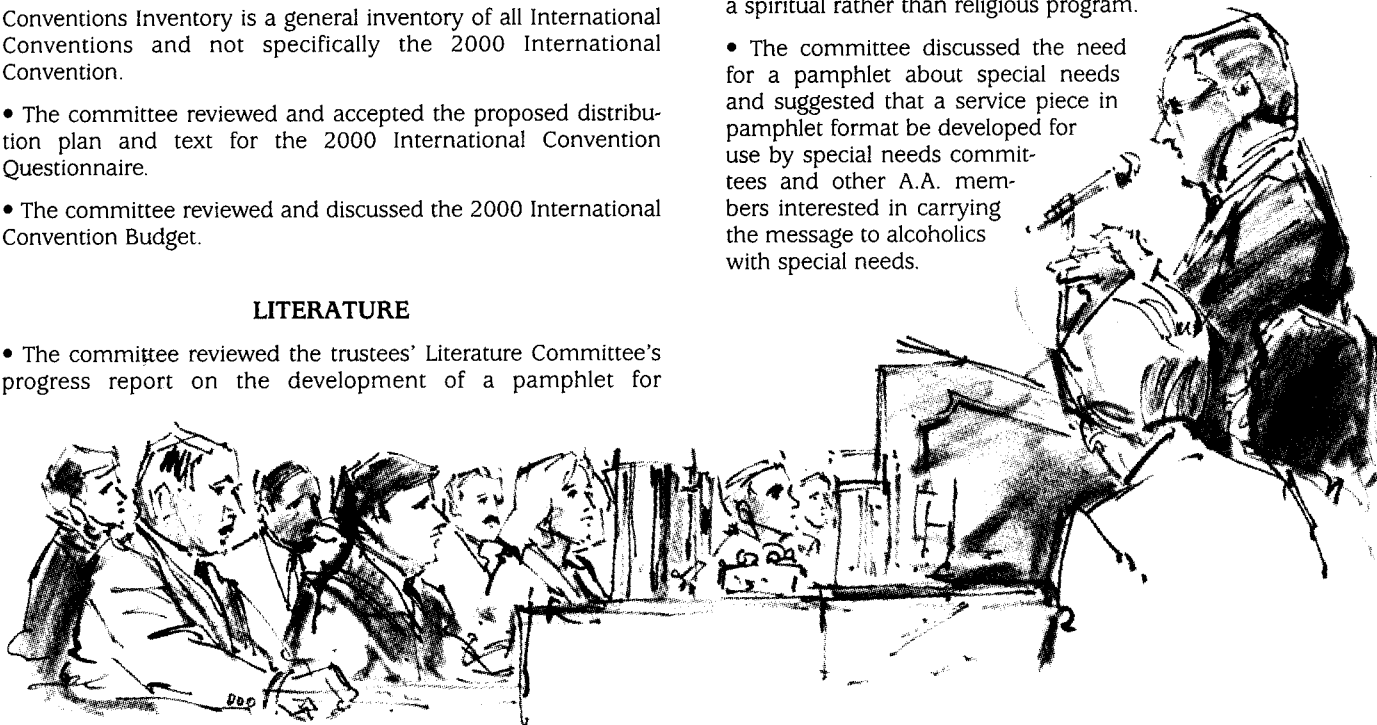
Black/African American alcoholics, expressed appreciation for the wide net cast to obtain stories and looks forward to reviewing a draft of the proposed pamphlet at the 2001 General Service Conference.

- The committee reviewed the trustees' Literature Committee's progress report on a pamphlet for older alcoholics to replace "Time to Start Living," expressed appreciation for the wide net cast to obtain stories and looks forward to reviewing a draft of the proposed pamphlet at the 2001 General Service Conference.
- The committee suggested that the pamphlet for older alcoholics to replace "Time to Start Living" be available in both standard size print and large print and that the latter be formatted to fit the literature racks used by most groups.
- The committee also suggested that the A.A.W.S. Board consider one price for both the standard type print and large print versions of the pamphlet for older alcoholics to replace "Time to Start Living."
- The committee appreciates the work of the delegates who responded to the special interest literature questionnaire and agreed that the results were inconclusive in terms of answering the question about whether there is a need for the continued development of special interest literature asked by the 1999 Conference Literature Committee for the following reasons:

- 1) The nature of the questions.
- 2) The timing of the survey.
- 3) Only 35 % of the delegates/delegate areas responded.

As a result of reviewing responses, it was noted that some of the special interest literature needs to be updated.

- The committee discussed the need for a pamphlet for the non-believer or a pamphlet explaining that A.A. is a spiritual rather than a religious program and could not reach consensus regarding the need. If the trustees' Literature Committee proceeds to develop a pamphlet, it was suggested that the focus be on A.A. as a spiritual rather than religious program.
- The committee discussed the need for a pamphlet about special needs and suggested that a service piece in pamphlet format be developed for use by special needs committees and other A.A. members interested in carrying the message to alcoholics with special needs.



POLICY/ADMISSIONS

- The committee reviewed the Composition, Scope and Procedure and agreed to revise the "Composition" to reflect current procedures for Conference committee assignments.
- The request for an additional delegate area by Southern California Area 05 was considered and the committee took no action because they were unable to reach consensus.
- The committee strongly suggested that the 2001 Conference Policy/Admissions Committee consider revising the "Application for Additional Delegate Area" in order to ensure that adequate information is provided for evaluating future applications.
- The committee suggested that the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference consider a workshop on "Future Growth of the Conference" during the 2001 General Service Conference.
- The committee suggested that the 2001 Conference Policy/Admissions Committee consider developing guidelines for the use of personal computers by Conference members during the General Service Conference.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

- The committee reviewed the inclusion of text emphasizing Anonymity at the Level of the Internet in Public Information service material and welcomed the addition of this most valuable information.
- The committee considered the suggestion to remove Question #4 — regarding race, and decided to leave the question in the survey. The committee determined that the question is helpful to the Fellowship in discovering the degree of diversity and make-up of the membership, determining trends in diversity and ascertaining the need for future out-reach to groups where the numbers are smaller than the national averages.
- The committee suggested that the G.S.O. staff member serving as "special needs" liaison consider gathering local experience on the accessibility of A.A. meetings to members with "special needs." The committee further suggested that "special needs" information be added to the G.S.O. A.A. Web site.
- The committee requested that in preparing the 2004 Membership Survey Questionnaire consideration be given to the following suggestions:

Question 3 — Marital Status

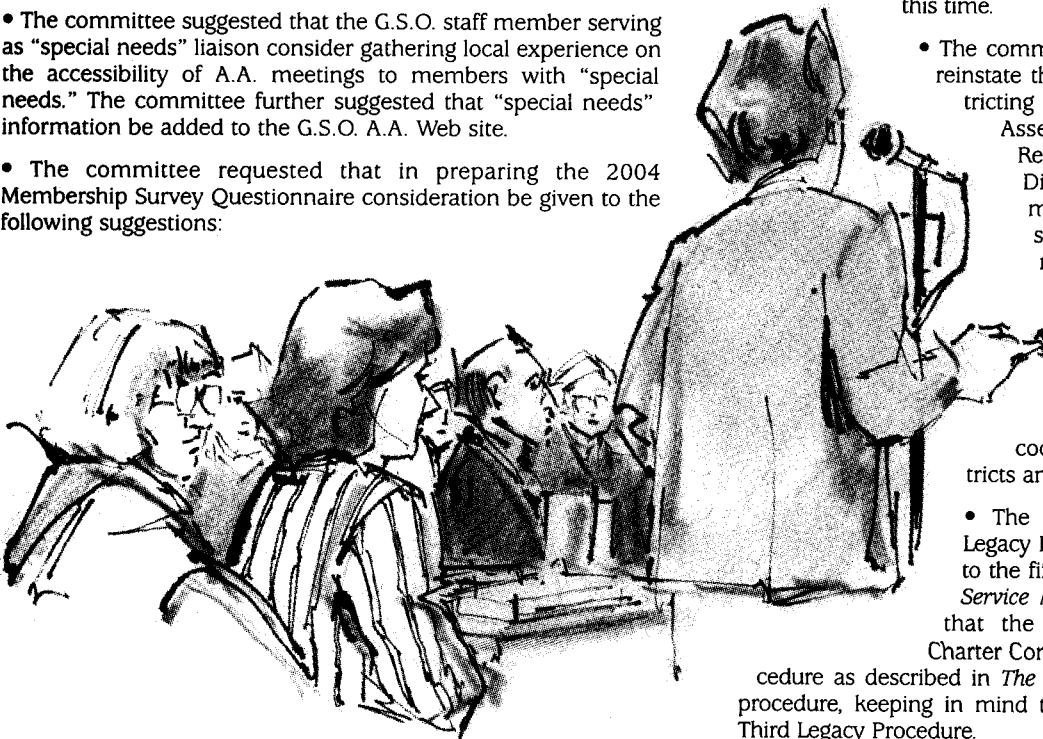
- Add a choice for those members who live in a domestic partnership, yet who are not married.

Question 12 — Employment Status

- Examine the list of choices to determine if the current listing offers those with a skilled trade a clear choice.
- The committee reviewed the 1999 and current reports on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site activity and were encouraged by the growing effectiveness of this most valuable P.I. vehicle. The effectiveness the G.S.O. A.A. Web site's continued role in providing opportunities for local Twelfth Step work was underlined.
- The committee reviewed the contents of the Public Information Kit and Workbook and suggested that a sheet highlighting Public Information audiovisual materials be added to the Public Information Kit.
- The committee discussed the trustees' Report on the Posthumous Anonymity of the Co-founders and suggested that the trustees' Public Information Committee continue its discussion of the issue of our co-founders' anonymity and develop a coherent policy to be forwarded to the 2001 Conference Committee on Public Information for their consideration, in the hope that wider sharing on this issue will clarify this matter. The committee also requested that, pending a final policy resolution of this question, the G.S.O. Public Information Coordinator continue to make Conference-approved material available to the media.

REPORT AND CHARTER

- The committee discussed the suggestion to reinstate the section "How I got interested in General Service" to Chapter Six: "The Delegate" and agreed that in order to maintain the continuity of the 1999-2000 *The A.A. Service Manual*, that adding "Personal Views" from a previous edition manual was not desirable at this time.
- The committee discussed the suggestion to reinstate the sentence "The proposed redistricting should be approved by the area Assembly" in the section on Redistricting in Chapter Three: "The District and the DCM" and unanimously agreed that the sentence should not be reinstated. The committee felt that adding such a sentence was not consistent with the autonomy reflected in the Fourth Tradition and agreed that the section adequately stressed the importance of good communication and cooperation amongst groups, districts and areas.
- The committee discussed the Third Legacy Procedure specifically in reference to the fifth ballot as described in *The A.A. Service Manual*. The committee suggests that the 2001 Conference Report and Charter Committee review the fifth ballot procedure as described in *The A.A. Service Manual* to clarify the procedure, keeping in mind the 1984 Advisory Action on the Third Legacy Procedure.



TREATMENT FACILITIES

- The committee discussed the Treatment Facilities Kit. The committee considered whether additional pamphlets might be helpful for those doing this service work, and concluded that the Kit contained complete information for local Treatment Facilities committees.

- The committee members shared about the Bridging the Gap/Temporary Contact efforts in their areas. A variety of contact methods were discussed, and it was noted that A.A. contacts are particularly important for clients in short-term facilities.

Concern was expressed about the inconsistency in Bridging the Gap/Temporary Contact efforts throughout the United States and Canada. The committee stressed that efforts to help alcoholics coming out of Treatment Facilities are vital whether done by committees named Hospitals and Institutions, Treatment Facilities, or Bridging the Gap/Temporary Contact.

- Several committee members shared specific ways that local Treatment Facilities committees have obtained finances to purchase A.A. literature, including budgeting funds to purchase literature for Treatment Facilities committees, a "pink can" set out at meetings to collect spare change designated specifically for literature, and local service events.

- The committee requested that the Treatment Facilities staff person collect sharing from areas on formats used for institutional meetings for the purpose of possible inclusion in Treatment Facilities materials.

TRUSTEES

- The committee discussed at length the proposal that the selection of a regional trustee be made by delegates of the region only and unanimously agreed that no change be made to the current procedures at this time.

COMMITTEE RECOMMENDATIONS WHICH DID NOT RESULT IN CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTIONS

CORRECTIONAL FACILITIES

- The Correctional Facilities Kit be designated as service material, and that the contents of the Correctional Facilities Kit not be changed prior to review by the Conference Correctional Facilities Committee; however, literature catalogs, A.A. guidelines, Box 4-5-9, and service material contained in the kit would be the current versions.

FINANCE

- To adjust the General Service Board's Reserve Fund, the trustees continue the policy to consider other projects and ways of carry



ing the message such as, additional free literature, foreign translations, and increased discounts before adjusting selling prices. The committee felt this was necessary to clarify trustees' options during the budget process.

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/ REGIONAL FORUMS'

- The time frame for the 2010 International Convention be expanded from July 4th weekend, 2010 to May 1 through September 15, 2010. Expanding the time frame provides flexibility to the bidding cities.

LITERATURE

- Prior to being asked to vote approval of the Fourth Edition of *Alcoholics Anonymous*, all Conference members be given the titles and a brief synopsis of both the new stories and those stories carried forward from the Third Edition. The synopsis of the stories will be similar to the brief descriptions found in the table of contents of the Third Edition.

FLOOR ACTIONS WHICH DID NOT RESULT IN CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTIONS

- That the Grapevine not move forward with a Web site message board, forum, or other online meeting format until this issue can be fully discussed by the 51st General Service Conference and go through the committee and Conference process. **(Not approved)**

- That in selection of regional trustees, two-thirds of the voters be the delegates from the region involved and one-third be divided between the Conference Committee on Trustees and the Trustees' Nominating Committee. **(Not approved)**

- That all work on the Black/African American pamphlet cease as it does not promote unity or our common welfare. **(Conference voted not to consider)**

(Note: Two Floor Actions from "Delegates Only Meeting" were withdrawn.)

Additional Committee Considerations

(Items discussed but no action taken or recommendation made.)

AGENDA

- At the joint meeting the trustees' Committee on the Conference and the Conference Agenda Committee discussed the idea of having a more flexible agenda for 2002 in case additional topics of concern come up during the year. The Conference Agenda Committee decided to submit two presentation/discussion topics and one workshop topic in order to allow room for additional presentations or reports, if necessary.
- The committee discussed the format of the A.A. meeting following the opening dinner of the General Service Conference and made no changes.
- The committee discussed the Conference Evaluation Form and suggested changing the heading of Section #4 to Conference Committee Reports and copying the form onto a brighter color in 2002. It was further suggested that the Conference Evaluation Form be kept in the front of the Conference Manual and that announcements be made throughout the Conference week to fill out the form.

ARCHIVES¹

- The committee reviewed the Composition, Scope and Procedure and added the following Procedure: "To review the available archives literature."
- The committee reviewed the newly developed Archives Workbook and expressed their appreciation for the work done by the trustees' Archives Committee. Members of the committees also expressed their appreciation to the General Service Office Publications Department for their help to make the item available by this year's Conference.
- The committee considered a request to produce a pamphlet about how archives carry the message of Alcoholics Anonymous and encouraged the trustees' Archives Committee to develop a service piece about how archives carry the message of Alcoholics Anonymous.



COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

- The committee suggested that the word "dental" appear only once in the third sentence of paragraph three (3) in the service piece, "Working with Students Attending Professional Schools" (F-106).
- The committee suggested that the paragraph on page 31 of the C.P.C. Workbook beginning with, "These publications are all listed..." be changed to read, "there are also catalogs for Special Needs and Grapevine materials."
- The committee suggested that the sentence following the heading "Basic Guidelines for C.P.C. Presentations," at the bottom of page 16 in the C.P.C. Workbook, be changed to read: "Here are two *suggested* formats for presentations..." which reflects a suggestion by the 2000 Conference Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community.
- The committee suggested that Item F-64, the postal subscription card for *About A.A.*, be added to the contents of the C.P.C. Kit and that item numbers appear with all items listed on the C.P.C. Kit Contents (M-41) sheet.
- The committee forwarded to the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities a suggestion that the "Singleness of Purpose" statement outlined in the 1997 Advisory Action be moved to a more prominent place in the C.P.C. pamphlets: "Alcoholics Anonymous in Your Community," "Is There an Alcoholic in the Workplace?," "A.A. as a Resource for the Health Care Professional," "How A.A. Members Cooperate With Professionals," "If You Are a Professional," and "Members of the Clergy Ask About Alcoholics Anonymous." The committee asked that the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities forward ideas and suggestions to the 2002 Conference Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community. (Note: The "Singleness of Purpose" statement reads: "Alcoholism and drug addiction are often referred to as 'substance abuse' or 'chemical dependency.' Alcoholics and nonalcoholics are, therefore, sometimes introduced to A.A. and encouraged to attend A.A. meetings. Anyone may attend open A.A. meetings. But only those with a *drinking* problem may attend closed meetings or become A.A. members. People with problems other than alcoholism are eligible for A.A. membership *only* if they have a drinking problem.")

CORRECTIONAL FACILITIES

- The committee reviewed the service piece to accompany the video "Carrying the Message Behind These Walls" and suggested that the following information be included in the section "Take a Meeting into or Share at a Correctional Facility":
 - 1 Sharing that may help to alleviate fears regarding security in a correctional facility.
 - 2 A reference to the fact that previous incarceration is not required to share practical, sober A.A. experience in a correctional facility.
- The committee agreed that the service piece to accompany the video "Carrying the Message Behind These Walls" should

¹ Secondary committee



be added to the Correctional Facilities Kit and placed in the service files at the General Service Office.

- The committee reviewed the contents of the Correctional Facilities Kit and Workbook. Since the Workbook reflects the practical experiences of A.A. members in various service areas, the committee agreed that any future sharing or experience should be forwarded to the Correctional Facilities staff secretary in order for the information in the Workbook to be current.
- The committee discussed various ways to carry the message into youth detention centers and short-term facilities and emphasized the importance of working closely with C.P.C. and P.I. committees to provide information to those professionals who specialize in this type of work. The committee noted there is a need for younger A.A.s to share their experience, strength and hope at these facilities and suggested that increased efforts should be made to communicate this need through young people's groups in Alcoholics Anonymous.
- The committee agreed that communication between local A.A. committees is the key to more effective Bridging the Gap, Prerelease and Temporary Contact efforts.
- The committee shared experience on the value of participating in activities, such as Funshops, area luncheons and service symposiums that facilitate better communication between local service committees that carry the A.A. message to the alcoholic, wherever he or she may be.

FINANCE

- In expectation of continuing discussions of using literature price reductions as the primary mechanism in adjusting the relationship of the Reserve Fund, the committee invites areas to share their views.
- The committee discussed how areas separate and account for local convention activities, including ongoing convention funds. As the input did not create a clear group conscience, we request additional sharing from the Fellowship concerning their convention accounting and reporting practices as they may apply to the International Convention. The committee offered the following points for discussion:

Essentially, the General Service Board has held Convention funds "in trust." They have been held in the Reserve Fund. These funds, deposited with or withdrawn from the Reserve Fund, have impacted the balance of the Fund for the Ample Prudent Reserve calculation.

It has been suggested that if we were to establish an ongoing Convention Fund (which would be essentially the monetary results of the International Conventions held to date), it would be more in keeping with the practices of many parts of the Fellowship.

Balances left in the Fund after a Convention would then be used to help fund the next Convention, instead of having the operating corporation (A.A.W.S.) do so. Currently we are expending funds for two future Conventions and it is conceivable that we may be working three Conventions out at some point.

A suggested minimum "fund balance" could be determined and then the remainder might be used to help defray the registration fee of the next event.

- The committee discussed an area's suggestion "that the 2001 Conference appoint an ad hoc Ways and Means committee to discuss and present to the 2002 Conference their ideas and suggestions on how our General Service Office may become fully self-supporting through A.A. member and group contributions" and felt it was not necessary at this time.
- The committee discussed self-support using tools such as workshops, visual aids, reporting on where the money goes when passing the basket, there is no contribution too small, and the need to communicate and educate.

GRAPEVINE

- The committee considered several suggestions for related items for production in the year 2003 or later, and forwarded to the Grapevine Corporate Board its suggestion that the Grapevine produce a softcover anthology of articles that would be helpful to newcomers and which have been previously published in the magazine.



- The committee discussed the need for an announcement card about the A.A. Grapevine that could be distributed to A.A. groups and read at meetings and concluded that there was no need to produce such a card at this time. Understanding the importance of raising awareness of the Grapevine in A.A. groups, the committee suggested that information about subscribing to the magazine be included in some of G.S.O.'s regularly scheduled mailings to listed groups and area committees and in some of the Kits and Workbooks offered by G.S.O.

- The committee discussed the suggestion that the A.A. Grapevine, Inc., refrain from sponsoring or hosting online meetings, including but not limited to real-time meetings, e-mail meetings, bulletin boards, and forums and, after careful consideration, decided that no action was necessary.

- The committee encouraged the A.A. Grapevine, Inc., to approach the use of any real-time online format with caution.

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/ REGIONAL FORUMS¹

- The committee reviewed the trustees' report on the general International Conventions Inventory and agreed there was a good response from the Fellowship, and that, as indicated in the trustees' report, there was an overall positive feeling about A.A. International Conventions; that these events fulfill their purpose; should be self-supporting and should continue. The committee agreed that if a "general International Conventions Inventory" is done in future, a single inventory questionnaire be sent out mid-way between Conventions.

Note: *Introductory Text:* Trustees' Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums Report on the General International Convention Inventory dated January 27, 2001:

The 1999 Conference Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums requested that the trustees' Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums implement a general inventory on International Conventions. The trustees' committee presented an interim report to the 2000 Conference Committee and is responsible for presenting a final report to the 2001 Conference Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums.

On June 9, 2000, the International Conventions Coordinator mailed to all Conference members a request for sharing on the general subject of International Conventions with responses due January 1, 2001. Delegates were asked for only one response per area. Two sample questionnaires were enclosed with the mailing.

Of the ninety-three delegate areas, forty areas returned completed questionnaires yielding a 43 % response rate.

- The committee discussed ways to encourage interest in Regional and Special Forums and agreed that thorough communication to the Fellowship by areas, districts and the General Service Office was key to generating interest in Forums. Ideas shared on helping to encourage interest in Forums included:

Early organization of a host committee.

Development of flyers that clearly describe what a Forum is in addition to where and when.

Pre-Forum informational sessions with D.C.M.s and G.S.R.s so they are better able to describe what a Forum is to members.

Early gathering of suggested presentation/workshop topics from area members.

Early mailing by the General Service Office of Preliminary Forum Agenda.

- The committee gratefully expressed their thanks and appreciation to the 2000 Minneapolis International Convention Host Committee for their extraordinary enthusiasm, and hard work in helping to make the Convention a successful and joyous celebration of Alcoholics Anonymous.

LITERATURE

- The committee discussed four different proposals to change the Fourth Edition of the Big Book Conference distribution process and took no action. The committee based this decision on the 1999 Conference Advisory Action which reads, "Based on precedent in regard to previous editions of the book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, the A.A. history book, and *Daily Reflections*, any draft copy of the Fourth Edition of *Alcoholics Anonymous* be considered a work-in-progress, and as such, is confidential; the operating principle being that any story material brought forward to the Conference Literature Committee will be done on a 'for-their-eyes-only' basis adhering to the principle of the 'right of decision,' and not brought forward for any other general distribution until publication."

- In order for the Fellowship to have equal access to information about the 24 new stories and the 16 stories brought forward from the Third Edition of the Big Book and also to give the General Service Office Publications Department adequate time to collect releases from the authors of the new stories, the committee agreed that the personal story section of the Fourth Edition of the Big Book remain confidential until publication. The General Service Office will contact all current and previous subcommittee, trustees' and Conference Literature Committee members after this Conference to request that any material in their possession

¹ Secondary committee

pertaining to the Fourth Edition of the Big Book be returned to the General Service Office. The draft manuscripts of the 1,222 stories originally submitted for consideration for the Fourth Edition Big Book have been held in trust by all involved. This is a customary request to protect the confidentiality of all stories submitted by A.A. members.

- In order to give the General Service Office Publications Department adequate time to collect releases from the authors of the stories in the pamphlets "Can A.A. Help Me Too? — Black/African Americans Share Their Stories" and "A.A. for the Older Alcoholic — Never Too Late," the committee agreed that these pamphlets remain confidential until publication.

- The committee discussed the trustees' Literature Committee's proposal for a new pamphlet that includes a variety of spiritual experience and took no action. The committee suggested that the trustees' Literature Committee consider adding to or clarifying existing pamphlets such as "This Is A.A." and "A Newcomer Asks" to address a variety of individual interpretations and individual experience of spirituality in Alcoholics Anonymous.

The committee suggested that the trustees' P.I. and C.P.C. Committees consider addressing in their literature that A.A. is not allied with any religion.

- The committee discussed the request "that in the future no draft copy of any literature be submitted for approval by the General Service Conference without all Conference members having the opportunity to review that literature" and saw no need for any action.

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

- The committee reviewed their Composition, Scope and Procedure and agreed to correct paragraph 2 of the "Scope" describing the Admissions function to read, "Is responsible for reviewing all requests for admission to the Annual Meeting of the General Service Conference."

- The "Application for Additional Delegate Area" was reviewed and the committee agreed on a number of changes to be included in a draft that will be distributed to committee members after the Conference for additional suggestions. A final draft of the "Application for Additional Delegate Area" will be forwarded to the 2002 Conference Policy/Admissions Committee for consideration and implementation.

- The committee agreed on some basic guidelines for the use of Conference members' portable computers during the General Service Conference, if or when a Conference agrees that use of portable computers is appropriate. The basic guidelines will be passed on to the trustees' Committee on the Conference with the request that consideration be given to a trial use of portable computers during the 2002 General Service Conference, if the Conference agrees. The committee also requests that the trustees' Committee on the Conference gather information on costs related to use of portable computers during a General Service Conference.

- The committee reviewed the trustees' Nominating Committee's recommendation on Bill W.'s "Memorandum on New Delegates" regarding future growth of the General Service Conference. The committee strongly suggested that the General Service Board gather input from all trustees and delegate areas on current problems within the General Service Conference structure, as well as possible solutions. The General Service Board is

asked to share a progress report and background with the 2002 Conference Policy/Admissions Committee by February 15, 2002.

- The committee discussed a request to consider the use of electronic voting systems during the General Service Conference, and agreed to request that the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference explore the spiritual, practical and financial implications of using electronic voting systems during a General Service Conference. The committee requested that the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference report their findings by February 15, 2002 to the 2002 Conference Policy/Admissions Committee for further consideration.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

- The committee considered a request that a television Public Service Announcement specific to the Holiday Season be produced. Based on a report that indicated that there is less available air-time and increased competition for broadcasting P.S.A.s during this period of the year, the committee felt that it might be more cost effective to look at radio and print vehicles for this Holiday Season concept. The committee suggested that the trustees' Public Information Committee examine these options and report back to the 2002 Conference Public Information Committee.

- The committee discussed the concept of utilizing centralized distribution, tracking and evaluation of future P.S.A.s, in addition to the work of local committees and found that the concept was worth pursuing. The committee requested that the trustees' Public Information Committee present a complete proposal, including detailed cost estimates and a more precise explanation of the potential benefits to the 2002 Conference Public Information Committee for their consideration.

- The committee discussed the trustees' Public Information Committee's idea of formulating a long range development plan for future P.S.A.s and requested that the trustees' Public Information Committee develop a detailed plan including cost estimates to be forwarded to the 2002 Conference Public Information Committee for their consideration.

- The committee discussed the draft of the proposed trustees' Public Information Committee's policy on the co-founders' posthumous anonymity and expressed appreciation for the sensitivity which the committee demonstrated and the practical manner in which this policy can guide the General Service Office in dealing with the media concerning our co-founders' anonymity.

- The committee reviewed the 2000 and current reports on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site activity and were encouraged by the growing effectiveness of this most valuable P.I. vehicle. Members of the committee emphasized the increasing use of area web sites in communicating local A.A. information to the general public and the Fellowship.

- The committee reviewed the contents of the Public Information Kit and Workbook and noted that changes approved by the 2000 General Service Conference concerning Anonymity at the Level of the Internet had been implemented in several pamphlets and that the remainder of the changes are on schedule to be implemented.

- The committee expressed appreciation for the presence of the two observers from the German General Service Office during their deliberations.

REPORT AND CHARTER

- The committee discussed the suggestion to clarify the procedures for redistricting by adding wording to the effect that "When redistricting, approval of the groups within each district involved is essential and the proposed redistricting plan should be approved by the area assembly" on Pages S30-S31 of *The A.A. Service Manual*, in section titled Redistricting, and took no action. The committee agreed that the current wording on Page S31 reflects the spirit of the Twelve Traditions and is not in conflict with areas that have guidelines.

- The committee discussed the suggestion to reinstate the group structure chart in *The A.A. Service Manual*, Chapter Two: The Group and Its G.S.R. and concluded that because the chapter includes the following sentence, "The pamphlet 'The A.A. Group' provides extensive information on group organization and opportunities for service," and "The A.A. Group" pamphlet includes the group structure chart, it is not necessary to reinstate the group chart in *The A.A. Service Manual*.

- The committee considered the suggestion to restore Appendix A "Original Conference Charter - 1955," Appendix B "1955 Resolution" and Appendix C "Current Conference Charter" to the front of the manual to reflect its placement as it was in the 1999 *A.A. Service Manual*, and reinstate the section titled "What is the Conference Plan" to its original placement as in the 1999 *Service Manual* and took no action.

- The committee discussed the suggestion to change the sentence on Page S63, under #3 "A resume of the candidate, covering professional, business, and A.A. service qualifications...." to read "A resume of the candidate, covering A.A. service, business and professional qualifications...." and unanimously agreed to take no action as all aspects are considered important regardless of the order placed in the text, and changing the order might indicate a priority of qualifications.

- The committee suggested deleting the first sentence in Paragraph #3 on Page S63 under the title "Trustees-at-Large" and replace with "Each trustee-at-large is requested to attend Regional Forums in both the U.S. and Canada. If schedules permit, each trustee-at-large could attend one Regional Forum in each of the eight North American regions over the course of their four-year term."

- The committee considered the suggestion to add a footnote to Page 61 of the *A.A. Service Manual* or to expand the scope of the existing footnote #9, under Concept XI, to reflect current practices and concluded that given the complexity of laws affecting the workplace today, this item be referred to the A.A.W.S. Board for consultation with legal counsel.

- The committee considered the suggestion that a column be added to the group listings in A.A. Directories showing the date group information was last updated and took no action. The committee agreed that adding the last update would not provide better information to the Fellowship.

TREATMENT FACILITIES

- The committee reviewed collected sharing on formats used for institutional meetings, and considered the two-paragraph state-



ment "Why We Are Here" proposed for inclusion in the Treatment Facilities Kit. After thorough discussion, the sense of the meeting was that there is no need to include this statement as this information is included in the A.A. Preamble and other materials. Many local committees have already developed their own method of presenting this information.

- The committee shared about the activities of local Treatment Facilities Committees, and stressed the importance of ongoing cooperation and communication with the staff of each facility.

The committee also focused on using A.A. literature in carrying the message into short-term and outpatient facilities, where it may not be practical to bring in meetings, with particular emphasis on providing local meeting directories and subscriptions for the A.A. Grapevine and La Viña.

- The committee discussed Bridging the Gap/Temporary Contact efforts in their areas, and stressed its importance for alcoholics in making the successful transition from a treatment facility to sobriety in A.A. Many areas have developed effective procedures for implementing Bridging the Gap/Temporary Contact programs. Bridging the Gap/Temporary Contact workshops have explained this service to local members and helped them become involved. Often working together, area and district service committees and intergroup/central offices have extended the hand of A.A. through Bridging the Gap/Temporary Contact efforts.

- The committee considered ways treatment facilities committees can help when it comes to individuals referred to A.A. who focus on problems other than alcohol at A.A. meetings. Committee members shared the experience with this topic in their areas. Some solutions discussed included: continual sharing about our A.A. Traditions with treatment facilities staff, workshops on what A.A. does and does not do, and use of A.A. literature, especially the pamphlet, "Problems Other Than Alcohol." The committee shared that at meetings, individual A.A. members can provide loving but firm one-on-one sharing and sponsorship to newcomers.

- The committee forwarded numerous suggestions for additions and changes to the Treatment Facilities Kit and Workbook to the trustees' committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities for consideration.

TRUSTEES

- The committee suggested that the trustees' Nominating Committee's *Composition, Scope and Procedure* be included as background material for the members of the Conference Committee on Trustees.

FLOOR ACTION WHICH DID NOT RESULT IN CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTION

- That the proposed draft of the posthumous anonymity policy be made available to this Conference to review and vote on as a general policy of this Fellowship.

Additional Committee Considerations

(Items discussed but no action taken or recommendation made.)

AGENDA

- The committee suggested the wording on page 4 of the Conference Evaluation Form, which reads "no signature needed," be changed to "signature optional" with an additional check-off box for individuals wishing to be contacted.

ARCHIVES¹

- The committee discussed the suggested changes received from an area and took no action. The committee requested the trustees' Archives Committee to consider those suggestions in future reprints of the Workbook. All areas are encouraged to continue reviewing the Archives Workbook and submit suggestions for future revisions.
- The committee reviewed "The A.A. Archives" service piece that was newly developed by the trustees' Archives Committee. The service piece will be available for wider distribution immediately after the General Service Conference.

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

- The committee was in agreement with the trustees' Committee report to keep the "singleness of purpose" statement in existing C.P.C. pamphlets as is. The committee suggested the following:

Continue to publish articles in *About A.A.* and *Box 4-5-9* on A.A.'s singleness of purpose, emphasizing Tradition Three, "The only requirement for A.A. membership is a desire to stop drinking";

Encourage C.P.C. committees to communicate the importance of A.A.'s singleness of purpose to professionals;

Continue to review the C.P.C. Workbook and Kit to be sure there is sufficient information in each on our singleness of purpose.

- The committee considered the idea of a service piece on "Singleness of Purpose is A.A.'s Strength," similar to the Summer 2001 issue of *About A.A.*, and did not feel there was a need at this time for a service piece.

(Note: The "Singleness of Purpose" statement reads: "Alcoholism and drug addiction are often referred to as 'substance abuse' or 'chemical dependency.' Alcoholics and nonalcoholics are, therefore, sometimes introduced to A.A. and encouraged to attend A.A. meetings. Anyone may attend open A.A. meetings. But only those with a drinking problem may attend closed meetings or become A.A. members. People with problems other than alcoholism are eligible for A.A. membership only if they have a drinking problem.")

- The committee reviewed and accepted the trustees'

Committee report regarding addressing in C.P.C. literature that A.A. is not allied with any religion and suggested that the Fellowship:

Consider different modes of communicating what is meant by "spirituality" in A.A. during workshops, sharing sessions, Regional and Special Forums; and, in communications with professionals, utilize C.P.C. pamphlets as well as *About A.A.*

Continue looking for ways to improve cooperation with staff in treatment centers, who may have misgivings about A.A. as a resource for their clients.

- The committee considered a request that the soft-cover C.P.C. Workbook be changed from service material to A.A. General Service Conference-approved literature and agreed with the 1997 Conference Advisory Action that the C.P.C. Workbook continue to be designated as service material.
- A request for the development of a Conference-approved pamphlet similar to the flyer "So the Court Sent You to A.A. and You Hate the Idea" was discussed at length by the Conference C.P.C. Committee. The committee expressed appreciation for the idea and forwarded the request to the trustees Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities Committee for further review.
- The committee reviewed the contents of the C.P.C. Kit and Workbook and made the following suggestions:

On page 7, add "at" to the sentence to read "Let's take a look at some of our A.A. Traditions and their relationship to cooperation with the professional community."

On page 18, put a comma after nursing and delete the word "and" to read, "Most of the information that follows concerns working with medical students, but the same ideas may be used with students in such other areas as social work, law, nursing, dentistry, pharmacy, education, law enforcement and theology."

On page 5 of the pamphlet "Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings" change "Should P" to "Should I?"

In the Service Piece, "Working With Students Attending Professional Schools," change the section "Working with Medical Students" to "Working With Medical and Other Professional Schools Students."

CORRECTIONAL FACILITIES

- The committee unanimously requested that the trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities consider publishing the Correctional Facilities Kit and Workbook in a three-ring binder format and that a progress report be sent as background to the 2003 Conference Correctional Facilities committee for consideration.
- The committee requested that a statement of purpose be developed by the trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities for use as an introduction to the Correctional Facilities Workbook/Kit, and sent as background to the 2003 Conference Correctional Facilities committee for consideration.

¹ Members of this committee serve on this as a secondary committee assignment.

- The committee requested that the trustees' Correctional Facilities Committee develop a statement on A.A.'s Singleness of Purpose to be added to the Correctional Facilities Workbook after review by the 2003 Conference Committee on Correctional Facilities.

(Note: A "Singleness of Purpose" statement currently in several pamphlets reads: "Alcoholism and drug addiction are often referred to as 'substance abuse' or 'chemical

dependency.' Alcoholics and nonalcoholics are, therefore, sometimes introduced to A.A. and encouraged to attend A.A. meetings. Anyone may attend open A.A. meetings. But only those with a drinking problem may attend closed meetings or become A.A. members. People with problems other than alcoholism are eligible for A.A. membership only if they have a drinking problem." The committee suggested that references to "a drinking problem" be changed to "a desire to stop drinking," as reflected in our Third Tradition.)

- The committee suggested that the video "Carrying the Message Behind These Walls" be included with welcome letters and other material sent to incoming Area Correctional Facilities, Hospitals & Institutions and Bridging The Gap committee chairpersons.

- The committee suggested that the Publications Department consider reformatting the cover of "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell" at the next printing so that the title is fully visible when the pamphlet is folded and placed in literature racks.

- The committee suggested that the Corrections Correspondence Service pamphlet (F-26) be listed in catalogs of our A.A. Conference-approved Literature and Other Service Material. The committee remarked on the importance of sharing about this service in assemblies, Forums and other A.A. events. It was noted that sharing of personal experience with this service would encourage more members to participate.

- The committee unanimously requested that the trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities consider distributing the newsletter *Sharing From Behind The Walls* to A.A. groups in Correctional Facilities. Additionally, the committee suggested that the Publications Department consider reformatting the newsletter *Sharing From Behind The Walls* in an easy-to-read type, and forward the results as background to the 2003 Conference Correctional Facilities committee for consideration.

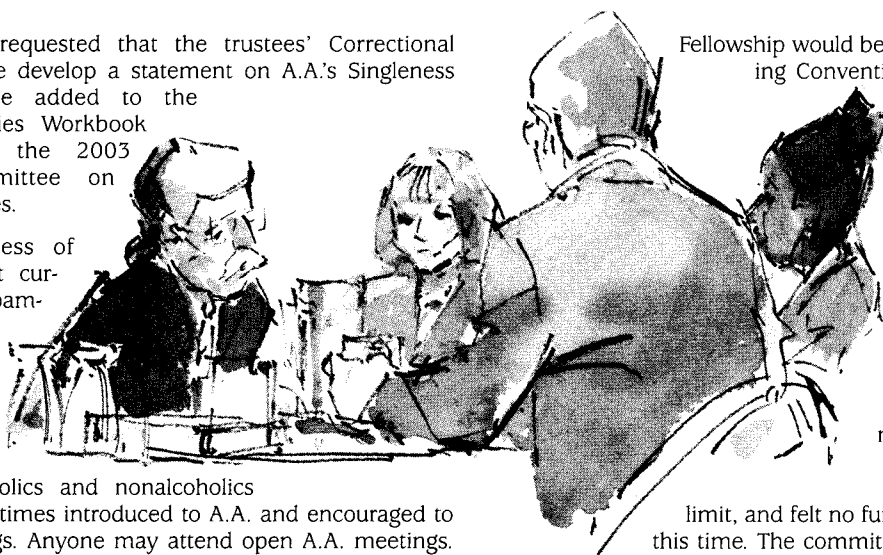
- The committee discussed various ways that A.A. information is presented to staff in Correctional Facilities.

FINANCE

- The committee reviewed input from the Fellowship on local Convention reporting matters.

After a broad discussion, the committee felt that reporting matters are not a policy level issue but a matter of Professional accounting.

The committee felt that by reporting International Convention activities in a separate column on the financial statements the



Fellowship would be better informed about ongoing Convention activities, and urges that such reporting be implemented as soon as practicable.

- The committee discussed information received as a result of the 2001 Conference Finance Committee's request for additional sharing on the philosophy of using literature price reductions as the primary mechanism in adjusting the relationship of the Reserve Fund balance to its upper

limit, and felt no further action was necessary at this time. The committee realized that the Floating Cap Plan allows for orderly management of the Reserve Fund, which does not preclude literature price reductions.

- The committee encourages preparation and periodic distribution of a simplified description of the purposes and necessity of G.S.O.'s Reserve Fund (for example in *Box 4-5-9*).

The committee also encourages frequent explanation and communication of services G.S.O. provides to and on behalf of the Fellowship.

GRAPEVINE

- The committee considered several suggestions for related items for production and forwarded to the Grapevine Corporate Board the following items for development: 1) Declaration of Responsibility signs in English and (when feasible) in Spanish and in French, with a facsimile of the art that appears in the Grapevine; 2) *Best of Grapevine* CDs; and 3) a Spanish-language CD.

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/REGIONAL FORUMS'

- The committee discussed ways to encourage interest in Regional and Special Forums and suggested that host committee contacts and delegates of host areas increase their efforts to provide information about Forums; utilize G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site for on-line registration, generate enthusiasm by visiting groups and emphasize the need for volunteers to participate in host committees.

The committee expressed interest in the possibility of having more frequent and accessible Regional/Special Forums.

- The committee discussed and reviewed the 2015 International Convention Site-selection Procedures.

LITERATURE

- The committee noted the following information that was reported at the April 21, 2002 joint meeting with the trustees' Literature Committee:

Addition of one story "The Fearful One" to Anthology for a total of 56 stories.

Title suggestions from the trustees' Literature Committee and the G.S.O. editor for the anthology project.



A report from the G.S.O. editor on the editing deletion of the ninth paragraph of the story "Freedom from Bondage" which was included in the Third Edition of the Big Book and which was deleted from the Fourth Edition to create a page count in the Fourth Edition similar to the page count of the Third Edition.

Taking into consideration previous Conference Advisory Actions addressing the historical context of Bill Wilson's writings, the committee requested that the trustees' Literature Committee consider adding a statement to the Foreword of the *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* explaining the historical context of Bill's writings and report back to the 2003 Conference Literature Committee.

- The committee reviewed the complimentary service material "Concepts Checklist" (F-91) which was revised January 2002 and thanked the subcommittee of the trustees' Literature Committee for their service in completing this revision.
- The committee considered at length the request for a new edition of the Spanish Big Book and took no action as a widely expressed need was not exhibited at this time.
- The committee considered the request to add a quote from Concept Nine to the pamphlet "Questions and Answers on Sponsorship" and took no action. The committee agreed that this addition was not necessary.
- After careful consideration of the request to restore "The Doctor's Opinion" to page 1 as published in the First Edition of the Big Book from 1939 to 1955 in future printings of the Big Book, the committee agreed to take no action.
- The committee reviewed the January 15, 2002 summary of responses received by the General Service Office to the Fourth Edition of the Big Book and was grateful for all sharing received in response to the publication of the Fourth Edition.

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

- The committee strongly suggested that when an area submits an "Application for Additional Delegate Area," a special meeting at the Conference of the Policy/Admissions Committee be held so that any delegate submitting an application can respond to questions of the committee for clarification.
- The committee reviewed and discussed the report given by the General Service Board's Ad Hoc Committee on the General Service Structure and agreed to distribute the Ad Hoc

Committee's Progress Report and the summary of responses to the 2001 Ad Hoc Committee's Questionnaire to all Conference members.

- The committee suggested that Final Agenda Items and background material be distributed to Conference members requesting them in time to be received by February 15th.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

- The committee suggested that television public service announcement inventory items #TV-14 ("Male" and "Information") and #TV-28 ("BG's Advice" and "High/Low Bottom") be removed from inventory. Inventory items #TV-14 and #TV-28 have the lowest circulation of all current P.S.A.s.
- The committee reviewed the need for producing a radio or print public service announcement specific to the holiday season, and agreed that it is not necessary to produce a Conference-approved radio or print public service announcement specific to the holiday season.
- The committee reviewed the contents of the Public Information Kit and Workbook. They considered a request that the soft-cover Public Information Workbook be changed from service material to A.A. General Service Conference-approved Literature and agreed that the Workbook serves its purpose as service material, noting that the Public Information Kit and Workbook are reviewed by the Conference P.I. Committee each year.
- The committee agreed to add a third "suggested newspaper announcement" with the language, "If you want to drink that's your business. If you want to stop, we can help." on page 40 of the Public Information Workbook at its next printing.
- The committee requested that any changes to be implemented to the Public Information Kit or Workbook be communicated in the activity updates from the P.I. staff member. (Note: Activity updates are sent to all Public Information committee chairs two to three times per year and are copied to all area delegates.)
- The committee reviewed with appreciation the report of the trustees' Public Information Committee on religion and spirituality in P.I. literature. They agreed that, where appropriate, P.I. literature adequately addresses A.A.'s not being a religious organization, noting the change made to the service piece, "Information on Alcoholics Anonymous," and agreed that no further action was necessary.

- Committee members reviewed the 2001 report on G.S.O.'s Web site activity and discussed Web sites as a Public Information tool.

REPORT AND CHARTER

- The committee discussed the suggestion to reinstate the diagram "Service Structure Inside the A.A. Group" as it appeared in the 1998-1999 edition of *The A.A. Service Manual* on page S49 in Chapter II "The General Service Representative and The Group" and took no action.
- The committee suggested that the trustees' Literature Committee consider revising the chart "Service Structure Inside The A.A. Group" on page 24 in "The A.A. Group" pamphlet to better reflect the current structure of a typical A.A. Group.
- The committee suggested that the Publications Department complete the revision of the "Regional Map of U.S. & Canada" to replace the existing regional map on page S62 in *The A.A. Service Manual*.
- The committee agreed that the updated charts "General Service Office of Alcoholics Anonymous and A.A. World Services, Inc." and the "Grapevine Corporate Board" replace the existing charts on page S72 and S80 in *The A.A. Service Manual* to accurately reflect the current structure of G.S.O. and A.A.W.S., Inc., and the Grapevine Corporate Board.
- The committee agreed that the proofs of updates to Chapter Eleven "The General Service Office," and to Chapter Twelve "The A.A. Grapevine" in *The A.A. Service Manual* will be mailed to the committee for review following the 52nd General Service Conference.
- The committee discussed the *Final Conference Report* and appreciated the anecdotal inserts and sketches included in the *Final Conference Report*.
- The committee suggested that the trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee consider adding the average cost of services per member to the annual "Contributions from Groups by Delegate Area" report in the *Final Conference Report*.

TREATMENT FACILITIES

- The committee considered a request that the soft-cover Treatment Facilities Workbook be changed from service material to A.A. General Service Conference-approved literature, and unanimously agreed that the Treatment Facilities Workbook continue to be designated as service material.
- The committee unanimously agreed to the request that the Treatment Facilities Kit and Workbook be combined in a 3-ring binder format; and, requests that the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities examine all options to accomplish that purpose, and provide a progress report as background to the 2003 Conference Committee on Treatment Facilities for consideration.

TRUSTEES

- The committee reviewed the resumes and approved, as eligible for election, all candidates for Pacific and Eastern Canada regional trustees.
- It was the consensus of the committee that the A.A. Fellowship be asked to look for and encourage qualified and willing nonal-

coholic "friends of A.A." to serve as Class A trustees. It was also noted that the identification of potential applicants should be an ongoing process, rather than occurring only when there is a scheduled vacancy.

RECOMMENDATIONS THAT DID NOT RESULT IN A CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTION

CORRECTIONAL FACILITIES

- The Correctional Facilities Workbook be changed to A.A. General Service Conference-approved literature.

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

- An electronic voting system be given a two-year experimental trial at the Fifty-third and Fifty-fourth General Service Conferences at a cost of approximately \$5,000 a year, keeping in mind the spiritual, practical and financial considerations outlined in the 2002 report by the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference, and that an evaluation on the overall effectiveness of this system be submitted by the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference to the 2004 Conference Policy Admissions Committee by February 15, 2004.
- All literature being considered as "General Service Conference-approved literature" be made available for review by all General Service Conference members prior to debate on the Conference floor.

FLOOR ACTION WHICH DID NOT RESULT IN CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTION

- If and when a new Spanish-language Big Book is produced by A.A.W.S., an appeal be made to the Fellowship for stories originally written in Spanish by Spanish-speaking members of Alcoholics Anonymous for possible inclusion.
- It is recommended that an ad-hoc committee be formed to evaluate options for the review of material proposed for General Service Conference approval by Conference members, and report its findings to the 2003 General Service Conference Policy/Admissions Committee. The ad hoc committee shall be comprised of the general manager, trustees, G.S.O. staff and delegates appointed by the General Service Board chair.
- The Twelve Concepts of Alcoholics Anonymous be produced in a window shade display format similar to the M-14 "Twelve Steps" window shade display and a parchment format similar to the M-3 Twelve Steps parchment, for sale and distribution to our Fellowship.
- Reconsider the request to restore "The Doctor's Opinion" to Page 1 as published in the First Edition of the Big Book from 1939-1955 in future printings of the Big Book.
- Request that A.A.W.S. consider printing an 8 ½" by 11" poster of the Twelve Concepts.
- A statement be added to the letter sent convention bureau contacts, before they submit their bids, from the chairperson of the trustees' International Conventions Committee, expressing the thought: that in keeping with our Tradition of Self-Support, Alcoholics Anonymous does not accept cash subsidies.

members in attendance. This year we held six regional pre-Conferences throughout our area so the groups could have the opportunity to be more involved in the Conference topics and so I could be better prepared for the Conference. We have roughly 400 to 500 members attending these regional pre-Conferences each year. Our area is currently looking into how to fund interpreters for Spanish members and the hearing impaired at our area assemblies and other events. We have formed an area Web site, which will be coming this summer. And we have been working on a revision of our area history book, "Our Stories Disclosed" and the updated book will contain information from about 600 of our groups. — *Eddie Harris*

West Virginia: Area 73 has approximately 300 groups in 16 districts. We have an assembly each spring and fall, which is offered to every district to host in a regular rotation. In the summer we have an area-wide convention that is also on a rotation. The cooperation among the districts is successful, and all districts are active. Our area elections use the Third Legacy procedure. Any one who has served on our area committee is eligible to offer themselves for any of the area committee positions. The chair positions of P.I., C.P.C., Corrections, Hospital and Treatment, Grapevine and Literature are nominated by their district. Our delegate always visits the districts to give a report after each Conference. We have an 800 phone number in all the state directories, which receives around 250 calls per month, mostly people looking for a meeting but occasionally an alcoholic reaching out. Our Web site allows a person to look up a meeting anywhere in the state or check for upcoming events. Area 73 is currently struggling with problems like: keeping personalities out of A.A. service work; sloth and procrastination; ego and self-centeredness. I believe it was this way when Area 73 was formed and I believe it will be this way 100 years from now. I believe there will be an Area 73 one hundred years from now because I believe in alcoholism and I believe in God and I believe that we are progressing in Area 73. Come by sometime and trudge the road with us. God bless you all. — *Jerry Moore*.

Wisconsin (Southern): Area 75 has 950 active groups served by 32 districts. District 10 is an at-large district that serves all Spanish-speaking groups. We have our own translation equipment. We hold two agenda planning meetings and two pre-Conference assemblies per year. An annual delegates workshop is held to create a balanced "informed group conscience" to carry to the General Service Conference. Past delegates continue to provide a "traveling G.S.R. school" for anyone that requests it. They also hold a G.S.R. school at the first agenda planning meeting of each year. Southern Wisconsin actively carries the A.A. message into correctional facilities, utilizing our "Rainbow Can" donations to purchase Conference-approved A.A. literature and our "Count on Us" program to provide hundreds of Grapevine subscriptions for the inside meetings. We, along with Area 74 (Northern Wisconsin and the UP of Michigan), hold an annual Corrections conference to coordinate BTG and volunteer efforts between Area 74 and Area 75. Our Third Annual Unity Conference will be held in July. This joint effort focuses on sharing information between Areas 74 and 75, with the ongoing theme of "Recovery, Unity and Service." This conference is held in addition to our long-standing Area 75 spring and fall conferences. Our alternate delegate is now funded to attend the Delegates/Past Delegates Conference. Our P.I. chairperson launched our Web site this year. My personal goals for this rotation are to bring the "dark districts" back into our service structure and to help the groups provide accurate information to G.S.O. to update our directories. — *Jo McLaughlin*

Additional Committee Considerations

(Items discussed but no action taken or recommendation made.)

AGENDA

- The committee reviewed the General Service Conference Evaluation Form and suggested that the question under the category "Pre-Conference" which reads, "Was the advance material and preparation from G.S.O. adequate and timely, () Yes () No" be replaced with the following two questions:

a) Was the advance material and preparation from G.S.O. adequate?
() Yes () No

b) Was the advance material and preparation from G.S.O. timely?
() Yes () No

- The committee also suggested that the parenthetical explanation "(e.g. schedule of Conference activities, meals, hotel accommodations, the trip to G.S.O., etc.)" be added to the sentence for item 7, which would then read:

"If you have suggestions for improving the Conference (e.g., schedule of Conference activities, meals, hotel accommodations, the trip to G.S.O., etc.), please list them here:"

ARCHIVES¹

- The committee reviewed the updates suggested by the trustees' Archives Committee to be included in the next reprint of the Archives Workbook and suggested that the trustees' Archives Committee consider additional items in the "Mission Statement" and in the "Calendar of Holdings" of the Workbook.

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

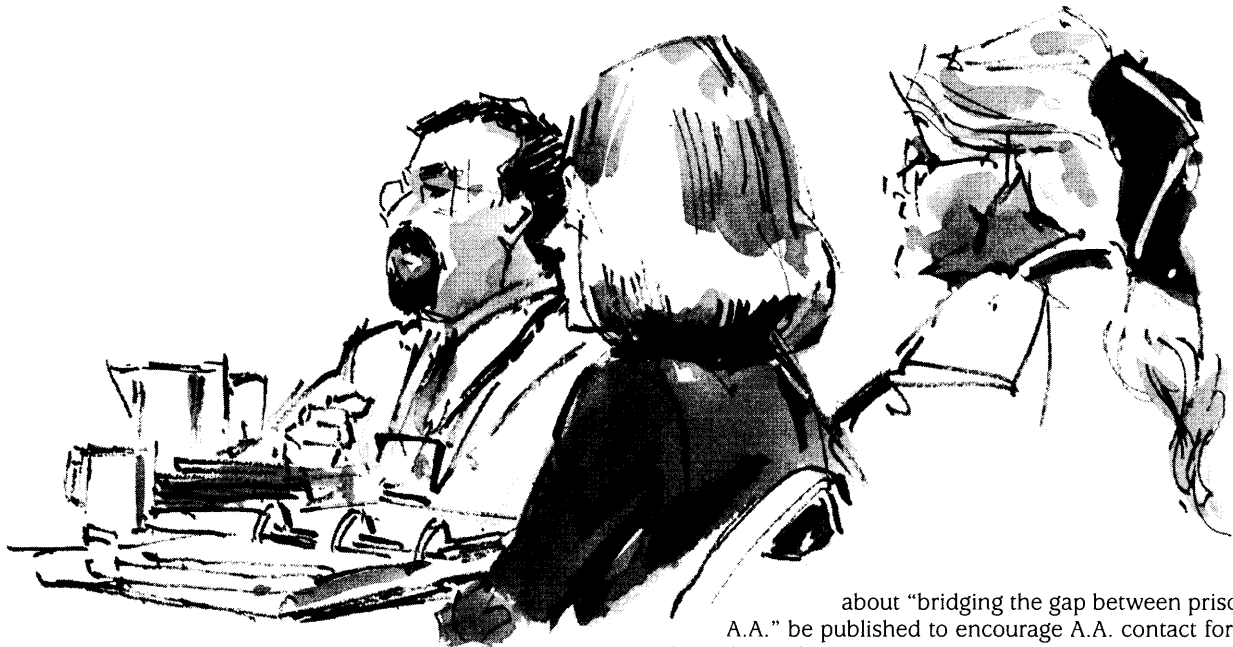
- The committee reviewed the report from the trustees' Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities Committee regarding new C.P.C. displays, and thanked the trustees' committee and the Publications Department for developing new tabletop displays for A.A. exhibits at national professional conferences.

The committee requested that the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities consider providing delegate areas with equal opportunities to obtain the current C.P.C. displays, once the new displays are available.

- The committee considered the request that the Workbook (service material) be reviewed annually by the Conference Committee; that changes to the workbook be approved by the trustees' committee; that any changes to the workbook be reported annually to the Conference Committee, and distributed as background material, and reaffirmed the sense of the 1999 C.P.C. committee that "...as service material the Kit and Workbook could be updated as often as shared experience indicates, with the understanding that the Kit and Workbook are reviewed annually by the Conference Committee."

- The committee discussed ways of reaching a wider variety of professionals, and suggested that we: 1) continue to reach out

¹Members serve on this committee as a secondary committee assignment.



about "bridging the gap between prisons and A.A." be published to encourage A.A. contact for newly-released members, and took no action.

to nursing and medical schools; 2) consider assigning an A.A. "sponsor" to professionals or students who come to A.A. meetings, sitting with them and helping them understand the meeting as it progresses; 3) make more frequent use of "Information on Alcoholics Anonymous;" 4) carry the message through calls or personal contacts to professionals, in addition to mailings; 5) cooperate with other service committees to reach professionals in all fields.

- The committee requested that the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities reconsider development of a Conference-approved pamphlet similar to the local flyers entitled "So the Court Sent You to A.A. and You Hate the Idea," and that the committee's secretary seek wider input from the delegate areas on the need for such a pamphlet.

- The committee requested that the secretary convey their concerns regarding certain editorial corrections to the pamphlet "Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings" to the secretary to the trustees' and Conference Public Information Committees.

CORRECTIONAL FACILITIES

- The committee accepted with appreciation the trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities' suggestion to combine the Correctional Facilities Kit and Workbook in a single three-ring binder format with the suggested title of "Correctional Facilities Kit;" and that the Workbook also be available as a separate item.

- The committee unanimously suggested that the pamphlet "Twelve Traditions Illustrated" (P-43) be added to the Correctional Facilities Kit.

- The committee reviewed the draft statement of purpose developed by the trustees' Committee for inclusion in the Correctional Facilities Workbook, and took no action.

- The committee reviewed the draft statement on A.A.'s singleness of purpose for inclusion in the Correctional Facilities Workbook, and requested that this topic be considered by the 2004 Conference Committee on Correctional Facilities because the statement on A.A.'s singleness of purpose is under review by another 2003 Conference committee.

- The committee also considered a request that a pamphlet

- The committee requested that the trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities gather examples of local A.A. pre-release brochures and/or forms and develop generic samples to be considered by the 2004 Conference Committee on Correctional Facilities for possible inclusion in the Correctional Facilities Workbook.

FINANCE

- The committee reviewed the Composition, Scope and Procedure of the Committee and amended item 1 under the Scope to read "Reviews the A.A. World Services/General Service Board budget and financial reports" (it had read only the A.A. World Services budget).

- The committee reviewed the reporting of International Convention accounting on the 2002 financial statements and looked favorably on the balance sheet treatment (a separate column for an International Convention Fund). However, it felt that the footnote listing all prior conventions with profits and losses was too detailed. The committee indicated an abbreviated footnote was more appropriate, for example:

Amounts shown as prepaid expenses in the Convention Fund on the Balance Sheet represent funds paid in advance for future conventions. These costs include such items as site selection costs, deposits on facilities, and professional management expenses. Following established Policy, funds not needed for current operations reside in the Reserve Fund.

- The committee reviewed the draft of the "Simplified Reserve Fund" document forwarded by the trustees' Finance Committee.

- The committee then reviewed the current A.A. Finance Guidelines as well as the current version of *The A.A. Service Manual*, and felt those descriptions better fulfilled the intent of last year's committee for a simplified description of the Reserve Fund.

- The committee also suggested that the document forwarded by the trustees' Finance Committee be available if a request for more detailed information is requested by a member of the Fellowship.

- After considerable discussion on the topic of self-support, the committee feels that sponsorship is the key. The committee urges the delegates to discuss financial responsibility within their areas.

GRAPEVINE

- The committee considered several suggestions for Grapevine items to be produced in the year 2004 or later and unanimously agreed to forward to the Grapevine Corporate Board the following items to be developed: Victor E. posters in English, French, and Spanish, celebrating the A.A. Grapevine's 60th anniversary, and a Spanish-language edition of *The Best of Bill*.

- By a substantial majority, the committee agreed to forward to the Grapevine Corporate Board suggestions that the following items be developed: French, Spanish, and English-language editions of a pocket-sized soft-cover collection of Grapevine stories focusing on A.A.'s Responsibility Declaration, titled *I Am Responsible*; and a new Spanish-language audio CD of stories previously published in La Viña.

- The committee expressed deep concern about information from the Grapevine Board received during the committee meeting that the board had failed to observe the 1993 Conference Advisory Action stating: "The Grapevine Corporate Board not actively pursue the placement of Grapevine materials for resale in commercial (non-A.A.) outlets."

Following lengthy discussion, the committee strongly suggests that the Grapevine Corporate Board:

1. Establish a one-year moratorium on initiating the sale of Grapevine items, including the Grapevine magazine, to any enterprise not identified as an A.A. entity.
2. Outline the sequence of events, meetings and decisions, as well as the rationale, that led to the Grapevine magazine being sold through an enterprise not identified as an A.A. entity.
3. Provide a full report on the history of the 1993 Advisory Action, including the concerns that led to that Action, as well as the meaning and intent of that Action.
4. Provide to the committee an interim report on the three points above no later than September 30, 2003, followed by a final report to be sent as background to the 2004 Conference Committee on the Grapevine.

- The committee also strongly suggests that the Grapevine Corporate Board carefully review Conference Advisory Actions prior to implementing a practice or policy.

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/REGIONAL FORUMS¹

- The committee discussed data collecting of personal information of A.A. members who attend conventions and strongly suggested that, in order to protect A.A.'s principle of anonymity, G.S.O. direct hotels contracted for Regional Forums and International Conventions not to use the list of A.A. hotel guests in conjunction with the words "Alcoholics Anonymous" or "A.A." for any mailing lists including outside marketing campaigns.

- The committee discussed ways to improve and encourage interest in Regional and Special Forums and suggested:

Continue providing simultaneous translations into Spanish and/or French to increase participation of Spanish- and French-speaking A.A. members.

Have presentations at Forums in Spanish and French as well as English.

Seek better ways to encourage members, groups, districts and areas in organizing various means of transportation to Regional/Special Forums.

Encourage attendees to share their Forum experience more widely with other members, (e.g. articles in local newsletters, reports at group conscience or business meetings, etc.).

LITERATURE

- The committee encourages full Conference discussion of the A.A. World Services Board's "intent to place the Fourth Edition of the Big Book on the G.S.O. Web site."

- After lengthy discussion, the committee considered the request to edit the following Fourth Edition Big Book stories to restore their Third Edition Big Book content: "The Housewife Who Drank At Home," "Me An Alcoholic?," "Another Chance" and "Freedom From Bondage," and agreed to accept the Fourth Edition Big Book editorial changes and agreed to take no action.

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

- The committee discussed the request to form a secondary General Service Conference Committee to review all aspects of G.S.O. Internet usage and make recommendations for additions, changes and/or improvements, and agreed there was no widely expressed need for such a committee.

- The committee discussed the request to establish an ad hoc committee of trustees, delegates and staff to outline the means and criteria for examining material submitted for Conference approval and took no action.

- The committee discussed the request to form a Conference Committee on Special Needs and agreed that Special Needs in the Fellowship are currently being met by the existing services provided by A.A. World Services and the General Service Office.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

- The committee reviewed the contents of the Public Information Kit and Workbook. They suggested that the pamphlets "Is A.A. for Me?" and "A.A. for the Older Alcoholic" be added to the Kit.

- The committee also considered the request that the Workbook (service material) be reviewed annually by the Conference Committee; that changes to the Workbook be approved by the trustees' committee; that any changes to the Workbook be reported annually to the Conference Committee, and distributed as background material and took no action.

- The committee reviewed with appreciation the information on centralized distribution, tracking and evaluation of the "Reach Out" P.S.A.

- The committee requested that a copy of the updated version of the Compilation Video of PSAs (VS-28) be mailed to all area P.I. Committee chairs.

- The committee suggested that television public service announcement inventory item #TV-17 ("Female" and "Information") be removed from inventory. Inventory item #TV-17 has the lowest circulation of all current P.S.A.s.

¹Members serve on this committee as a secondary committee assignment.

REPORT AND CHARTER

- The committee considered that Chapter Two: The Group and Its G.S.R. on page S23 be returned to the text on pages S45-49 in the 1991-1992 Edition of *The A.A. Service Manual* that includes the sections "How Elected," "What is an A.A. Group," "How the A.A. Group Fits into the Structure of the Fellowship," "The A.A. Group – the Final Voice of the Fellowship," "Why Do We Need Service Entities Other Than the A.A. Group," "How Much Organization Should an A.A. Group Have?" and "The Home Group," and took no action.
- The committee reviewed the updated chart of the A.A. Grapevine, Inc. to replace the chart on page S80 and other editorial updates to include language on the Grapevine Representative (GvR), La Viña Representative (RLV) and La Viña.
- The committee considered the request that the trustees conduct an audit of all reported Conference Advisory Actions to ensure that they have been and will be reported accurately and took no action.
- The committee discussed the purpose and usefulness of the Eastern and Western, Canada A.A. Directories, and International A.A. Directory and agreed that the directories continue to be useful and serve the Fellowship.

TREATMENT FACILITIES

- The committee expressed appreciation for the work of the trustees' Committee and the Publications Department on combining the Treatment Facilities Workbook and Kit, and unanimously requested that:

The Treatment Facilities Workbook and Kit be available as a single unit in a 3-ring binder, with the suggested title "Treatment Facilities Kit";

The reformatted soft-cover Treatment Facilities Workbook, bound in 8 ½ X 11 format and 3-hole punched be included in the Kit; and, that the reformatted Workbook also be available as a separate item.

- The committee requested that the combined Treatment Facilities Kit continue to be reviewed annually by the Conference Committee on Treatment Facilities, the trustees' Committee review changes in content, and the Conference Committee continue to be advised of any changes.
- The committee also reviewed the contents of the reformatted Treatment Facilities Kit, and suggested streamlining the divider tabs, as well as reducing the pamphlets and service material to be included.

TRUSTEES

- The committee reviewed the resumes and approved, as eligible for election, all candidates for Northeast and Southwest regional trustees and for trustee-at-large/Canada.
- The committee discussed various ways to encourage qualified and willing nonalcoholic "friends of the Fellowship" to serve as Class A trustees, including posting vacancy announcements in area, district and intergroup newsletters, as well as on local A.A. Web sites. The committee also suggested that A.A. members work closely with potential candidates to provide information about Alcoholics Anonymous and the role and responsibilities of Class A trustees.

- The committee reviewed a request that the Conference examine the role and responsibilities of regional trustees, and develop a means for their selection to provide substantially more input from the areas within a given region. Following a lengthy discussion on the roles and responsibilities of regional trustees, the committee unanimously agreed that no changes to the current procedures be made.

RECOMMENDATIONS THAT DID NOT RESULT IN A CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTION

CORRECTIONAL FACILITIES

- That changes to the Correctional Facilities Workbook/Kit shall be reported annually to the Conference Committee on Correctional Facilities and distributed as background material. The Correctional Facilities Workbook/Kit will continue to be reviewed annually by the Conference Committee.

LITERATURE

- That the following changes to "The A.A. Group" pamphlet be approved:

1. On page 23, in the section "*What trusted servants (officers) do we need?*", the word "jobs" in the first sentence of the first paragraph be replaced with the word "service" and the word "jobs" in the first sentence of the third paragraph be replaced with "service positions."

2. The sentence "See the chart of *suggested group officers*," which introduces the Group Service Structure Chart on page 24 be replaced by the sentence "The chart below offers possibilities for service at the group level."

3. The sentence "Some groups have positions that do not appear on this chart such as greeter, archivist, special needs representative and liaison to meeting facility" be added immediately after the chart on page 24.

4. The reference to "Archives Representative" be deleted in the Group Service Structure Chart on page 24.

- That the Third Edition Big Book punctuation in "Doctor Bob's Nightmare" be restored based on the 1995 Conference Advisory Action: "The first 164 pages of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, the Preface, the Forewords, "The Doctor's Opinion," "Doctor Bob's Nightmare" and the Appendices remain as is."

REPORT AND CHARTER

- To add the words "and a sponsor" to the sentence of the second bullet under the section titled "Qualifications" in Chapter Two: The Group and Its G.S.R. in *The A.A. Service Manual* to read: "Usually, prospective G.S.R.s have at least two years of continuous sobriety and a sponsor."

Jutta Matthews (Alabama/NW Florida), on the Conference Grapevine Committee, brought special necklaces, sporting bunches of grapes, for each member of the committee.

group conscience and pass on that legacy through sponsorship. Our service people are well educated in the writings of A.A. and Bill W. We cross all boundaries and ethnic lines, and proudly look to our two linguistic districts that prosper and provide the message to our large Hispanic population. Area 92 is coming of age and Unity is our standard. We are proud to be one of two areas that host the Pacific NW Conference, started by a suggestion of Bill's in 1948, and to be a member of the Pacific Region where PRAASA is such a great service experience. We will be there when and if any hand reaches for help, and we will be there as a part of A.A. as a whole. — *Mike McMurtrie*

Wisconsin (Northern)/Upper Peninsula Michigan: Area 74 has over 600 groups divided among 24 districts in the northern half of Wisconsin and most of the Upper Peninsula of Michigan. We have two assemblies and two conferences annually, and a Unity Conference, shared with Area 75. We have a new format for our area committee to meet at least four times per year. Prior to the Conference, we have a delegate's workshop where our committees make recommendations to the assembly, who in turn make recommendations for the delegate to New York. Sharing sessions happen quite often during the year and many good ideas are brought forth. The Northern half of Wisconsin and the UP of Michigan have traveling speaker meetings monthly, which are sponsored by districts. At these events G.S.R.s have a sharing session and sometimes corrections sharing also. Fellowship, recovery, unity, and service prevail at these monthly speaker meetings. Our area archivist is diligently preserving our history. Our corrections committee is in the process of developing a better "bridging the gap" system, as is our treatment facilities committee. We are striving to carry the message of happiness, joy, and freedom to the still-suffering alcoholic. The theme for this year's Conference is "Our Singleness of Purpose—The Cornerstone of A.A." and the Spirit of the Twelve Steps, Twelve Traditions, and The Twelve Concepts for World Services to observe this shall guide Area 74. — *Torvin Theisen*

Wyoming: Area 76 has 108 registered groups and spans 97,914 square miles in 12 districts, with approximately 1,950 members. We hold two business assemblies each year, in March and mid-August. Assemblies are rotated to various small communities to involve as many as possible. We also hold two area conventions each year, rotating between larger cities. This March we hosted the West-Central Regional A.A. Service Conference, which comes to our area once every eight years, in Cheyenne. Our members also enjoy campouts, jamborees, and other get-togethers to celebrate sobriety. They take meetings to our prisons in Rawlins and Lusk, our honor farms and local jails on a monthly and weekly basis. We have a full-time archivist, who is preserving Wyoming A.A. history. They are currently transferring many of our audio archives to CD format. *The Tributary*, the area newsletter, is published four times per year. We currently updated our area Web site to provide meeting lists from our 12 districts. Wyoming members are as rugged as the wilderness we live in, but also have technology at our fingertips. Our members are helping other alcoholics get and stay sober through their meetings and Twelfth Step calls without so much as one complaint. We continually see growth, sometimes quickly, sometimes slowly. These members give of themselves freely, honoring our primary purpose everywhere they are asked. I am honored to be a part of such a wonderful, loving, and caring group of A.A. members. Come on out and see us some time, the coffee's always on, arms open, and in some cases during our cold and wintry nights, willing to be there just for you. We'd be quite glad to see ya! — *Don Myers*

¹Members of this committee serve on this as a secondary committee assignment.

Additional Committee Considerations

(Items discussed but no action taken or recommendation made.)

AGENDA

- The committee reviewed the Conference Evaluation Form and suggested that the trustees' Conference Committee review the rating scale to offer a broader choice of responses.

ARCHIVES¹

- The committee reviewed the contents of the Archives Workbook and suggested including a bibliography of A.A.W.S. and Grapevine publications of historic interest.
- The committee asked the trustees to review and clarify how the "Ownership of Material" statement in the Workbook relates to material collected at the G.S.O. Archives.
- The committee reviewed the "Guidelines for Collecting Oral Histories" and expressed their appreciation to the trustees' Archives Committee for developing the document. The revised Guidelines will replace the oral history section currently included in the Archives Workbook.
- The committee expressed their appreciation For the revised editorial vision and reformatted design of *Markings, Your Archives Interchange* newsletter. The committee asked the trustees' committee to explore possibilities for wider distribution of the newsletter along with the related costs involved.

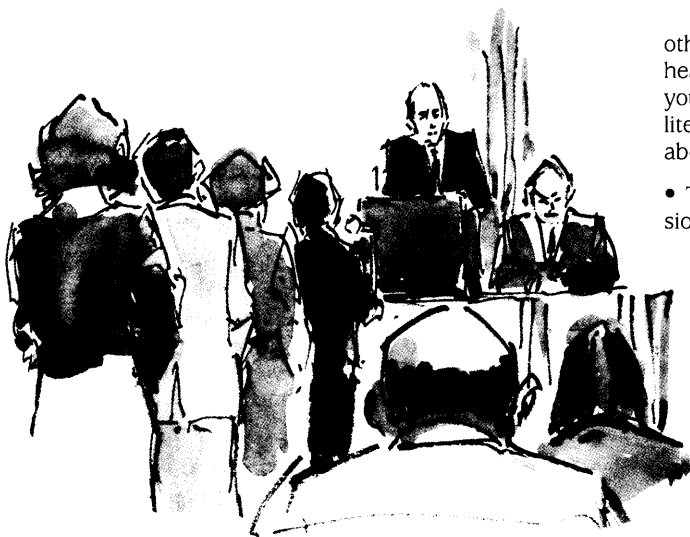
COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

- The committee reviewed the contents of the Cooperation With the Professional Community Kit and Workbook and made several suggestions:
 1. The list of C.P.C. pamphlets and videos on page 30 denote which ones are available in English, French and Spanish.
 2. The Kit and Workbook be made consistent in English, French and Spanish, noting that in order to do this it would be necessary for some materials to be translated.
 3. That the pamphlet "The Twelve Traditions Illustrated" be included in the Kit.
 4. That a section titled "Singleness of Purpose" be added to the Workbook. It would read:

"This statement of 'Singleness of Purpose' has been added to pamphlets intended to share information about A.A. with professionals:

Some professionals refer to alcoholism and drug addiction as 'substance abuse' or 'chemical dependency.' Nonalcoholics are, therefore, sometimes introduced to A.A. and encouraged to attend A.A. meetings. Anyone may attend *open* A.A. meetings, but only those with a *drinking* problem may attend *closed* meetings.

This is in keeping with the long form of A.A.'s Third and Fifth Traditions:



Third Tradition—Our membership ought to include all who suffer from alcoholism. Hence we may refuse none who wish to recover. Nor ought A.A. membership ever depend upon money or conformity. Any two or three alcoholics gathered together for sobriety may call themselves an A.A. group, provided that, as a group, they have no other affiliation.

Fifth Tradition—Each Alcoholics Anonymous group ought to be a spiritual entity *having but one primary purpose* — that of carrying its message to the alcoholic who still suffers.”

5. That the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities gather sharing for possible inclusion in the Workbook on ways that C.P.C. committees approach professionals, such as contacting professional associations, to add to the existing sharing regarding sending letters.

- The committee discussed ways C.P.C. committees can help when it comes to individuals referred to A.A. who focus on problems other than alcohol at A.A. meetings, and agreed that the following are useful suggestions:

1. Spending time one-on-one with professionals.
2. Making use of available A.A. literature.
3. Asking local professional friends of A.A. and utilizing A.A.s employed in professional fields to participate in C.P.C. work.
4. Informing professionals about the difference between open and closed A.A. meetings and encouraging them to refer people to open meetings.
5. Working with professionals to coordinate orientation meetings for people referred to A.A.
6. Sharing information about twelve step groups that focus on problems other than alcoholism.
7. Making sure that all A.A. members, not only those doing C.P.C. work, are familiar with all A.A.'s Traditions.

- The committee shared local experience and emphasized the benefits of Cooperation With the Professional Community, Correctional Facilities, Public Information, and Treatment Facilities committees cooperating and working together to carry the message.

- The committee discussed ways of reaching a wider variety of professionals, including lawyers, police officers, counselors and

others involved in the social welfare system, educators, mental health professionals, as well as professionals who interact with young people. They encouraged local committee sharing about literature that may be useful in informing legal professionals about A.A.

- The committee also noted the importance of contacting professionals who serve those who speak other languages.

- The committee requested that the trustees' committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/ Treatment Facilities review the inclusion of the name of a Class A trustee in the service piece "Information on Alcoholics Anonymous."

- The committee requested that the Cooperation With the Professional Community Kit and Workbook be made available in a three-ring binder format similar to the Correctional Facilities and Treatment Facilities Kits.

CORRECTIONAL FACILITIES

- The committee supports the proposed name change from "trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities" to "trustees' Committee on Corrections."

- The committee accepted with appreciation the trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities' progress report on the revision of *A.A. in Prison: Inmate to Inmate* and looks forward to receiving a draft manuscript at the 2005 General Service Conference.

- The committee selected and reformatted generic prerelease brochures from the samples forwarded by the trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities and requested that they be included in both the Correctional Facilities Workbook and under a new tab in the Correctional Facilities Kit.

- The committee strongly suggested that the trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities present a report to the 2005 Conference Committee on Correctional Facilities on the feasibility and cost of producing and distributing a video featuring someone highly credible in the corrections field introducing A.A. to correctional personnel.

- The committee unanimously requested that the trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities continue to gather and review additional sharing from area delegates and Correctional Committee, Cooperation With the Professional Community, and Bridging the Gap area chairs on the topic of introducing A.A. into training programs for correctional personnel, and that they use this information to write guidelines to present to the 2005 Conference Committee on Correctional Facilities for the development of workshops and training sessions on introducing A.A. to correctional personnel.

FINANCE

- The committee spent considerable time discussing sponsorship and the spiritual aspects of voluntary contributions. We agreed that membership and support of a home group is the fundamental cornerstone of A.A. Participation centered at the home group will support our primary purpose to carry the message to the alcoholic who still suffers.

- The committee requests that the trustees' Finance Committee review the level of delegate area participation (delegate fees and area contributions) to the General Service Conference forwarding this information to the 2005 Conference Finance Committee.



GRAPEVINE

- The committee reviewed the draft of the A.A. Grapevine Workbook and suggested certain editorial changes be made prior to publication.

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/REGIONAL FORUMS'

- The committee discussed ways to encourage interest in Regional and Special Forums and suggested:

1. That information regarding Regional and Special Forums emphasize that Forums can benefit *all* A.A. members and not just those members involved in general service.
2. That a small souvenir might be provided as memento of the Forum for all attendees.
3. That information regarding Regional and Special Forums be mailed earlier.
4. That areas with web sites consider linking to the General Service Office Web site in order to provide members in the area with easier access to information about Regional and Special Forums.

LITERATURE

- After lengthy discussion, the committee requested that the Publications Department rewrite the draft introduction to be added to the front matter of the *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, as recommended by the 2003 General Service Conference, taking into consideration suggestions from the committee, and present it to the 2005 Conference Literature Committee following review by the trustees' Literature Committee.
- The committee considered the suggestion that the trustees' Literature Committee develop comic books for the new and younger members in the Fellowship, and took no action.

- The committee considered the request to develop a booklet for teenagers, similar to the booklets *Living Sober, Came to Believe*, and *A.A. in Prison: Inmate to Inmate*, and took no action.

- The committee considered the request to restore punctuation in "Dr. Bob's Nightmare" in the Fourth Edition as it appears in the Third Edition of the Big Book and after lengthy discussion and with unified consensus, agreed to take no action.

- The committee reviewed the draft manuscript of a new comic book format pamphlet to replace the pamphlet "It Happened to Alice!" and requested that the Publications Department present a storyboard draft to the 2005 Conference Literature Committee for consideration following review by the trustees' Literature Committee. The committee made some suggestions for changes to the sample manuscript.

- The committee reviewed and accepted the trustees' Literature Committee progress report on the comprehensive review of "The A.A. Group" pamphlet recommended by the 2003 General Service Conference. The committee noted that the deadline for suggestions to changes in the pamphlet was January 2004. A draft manuscript of the revised pamphlet will be presented to the 2005 Conference Literature Committee for review.

- The committee considered the request to develop a separate and specific intergroup/central office pamphlet and took no action. The committee suggested that "The A.A. Group" pamphlet include a definition of intergroup/central offices in the section "The A.A. group's relations with others in the community" on page 33 to be taken from the "A.A. Guidelines on Central or Intergroup Offices."

- The committee considered the requested revisions to the pamphlet "Your A.A. General Service Office" pertaining to the A.A. Grapevine and La Viña and requested that the trustees' Literature Committee, in consultation with the A.A. Grapevine Corporate Board, review the section titled "The A.A. Grapevine" for revisions to reflect current practices and accuracy, and present a revised draft of the section to the 2005 Conference Literature Committee.

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

- The committee requested that the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference consider changing the reference to "personal digital assistants" to "*personal digital assistants (PDAs) with a keyboard requiring power*" in Section Definitions I. of the "Guidelines for PC Users at the General Service Conference."

- The committee requested that the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference consider forwarding a recommendation to the 2005 Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions regarding the broader use of self-powered personal digital assistants (PDAs) and/or similar electronic devices with no attachments for note taking at the General Service Conference.

- The committee concurred with the A.A.W.S. Board's report indicating that the use of a CD format is the most practical method of electronically distributing Conference background material. The committee requested that the current statement of confidentiality be prominently displayed in the proposed CD format. If the CD format becomes available, the committee requested that Conference members be offered the option of receiving the General Service Conference Final Agendas and all corresponding background materials in either CD format and/or paper format.

- In response to a request from the A.A.W.S. Board, the committee encourages full Conference input on the ramifications

of electronic distribution of Conference agendas and background material.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

- The committee viewed the proposed television Public Service Announcement (P.S.A.) — “Living in Chaos” — developed by the trustees’ Public Information Committee, expressed deep appreciation for the concept and the diversity portrayed, and asked that the first segment be re-filmed and the amended version of “Living in Chaos” be forwarded to the 2005 Conference P. I. Committee.
- The committee considered centralized distribution, tracking and evaluation of the proposed television P.S.A. — “Living in Chaos” — at a cost not to exceed \$30,000, in addition to the work of local P.I. committees and, as there will be no new P.S.A. this year, the committee took no action.
- The committee reviewed with appreciation the information on centralized distribution, tracking and evaluation of the “We Know What It’s Like” Public Service Announcement.
- The committee requested that all Conference Areas review whether and how Alcoholics Anonymous is listed in the white pages of local phone books.
- The committee requested that the trustees’ Public Information Committee submit a report to the 2005 Conference Committee on Public Information which includes feasibility, costs and timelines for updating/replacing the two videos “A.A. — Rap With Us” and “Young People in A.A.”
- The committee requested that the trustees’ Public Information Committee review the radio Public Service Announcement, “Teenager,” spot number 6 on item #R-10, and report back to the 2005 Conference Committee on Public Information regarding the sentence “I started drinking and taking pills” in relation to the spirit of our singleness of purpose.
- The committee reviewed contents of the Public Information Kit and Workbook.

REPORT AND CHARTER

- The committee reviewed proposed editorial changes to *The A.A. Service Manual* with appreciation, and forwarded suggestions to the Publications Department for their consideration. The committee also requested that the Publications Department consider reviewing the format and quality of the current *Service Manual*.
- The committee discussed a suggestion that the *Conference Final Report* be mailed in English, French and Spanish at the same time and took no action.
- The committee discussed the purpose and usefulness of the Eastern and Western United States, Canada and International A.A. Directories, and agreed with the 2003 Report and Charter Conference Committee that the directories continue to be useful and serve the Fellowship.

TREATMENT FACILITIES

- The committee expressed appreciation for the new three-ring binder Treatment Facilities Kit format.
- The committee reviewed the Treatment Facilities Workbook and Kit and requested that the Singleness of Purpose Statement

currently used in six Cooperation With the Professional Community pamphlets be included in the Treatment Facilities Workbook, and that the Fall/Winter 2002 and Fall 2003 issues of *About A.A.* be included in the Treatment Facilities Kit.

- The committee requested that the A.A.W.S. Board review the price of the Treatment Facilities Kit.
- The committee discussed Treatment Facilities area and district committee service work at homeless shelters, halfway houses, outpatient treatment programs, and nursing homes. Committee sharing indicated that in some areas Special Needs or Cooperation With the Professional Community Committees contact nursing home personnel; in other areas, Treatment Facilities Committees perform this valuable service work.
- The committee discussed Bridging the Gap activities, which also reflected a wide range of experience. The committee discovered that in some areas the Treatment Facilities Committee and Correctional Facilities Committee do their own Bridging the Gap work and in other areas a separate Bridging the Gap committee has this responsibility.
- The committee requested that the Treatment Facilities staff person request further shared experience on the scope of Treatment Facilities Committee activities from areas, districts, and intergroups/central offices in the U.S. and Canada.
- The committee discussed ways of carrying A.A.’s message of singleness of purpose, which includes mailing letters and making visits to treatment facilities professionals, and conducting workshops for A.A. members and professionals on what A.A. is and is not.

TRUSTEES

- The committee reviewed its Composition, Scope and Procedure and changed the wording of item #2 under the “Scope” section to read as follows:

“The committee reviews the resumes of all newly-nominated Class A and Class B trustees of The General Service Board and nontrustee directors of the corporate boards (A.A.W.S. and The A.A. Grapevine). The committee reviews the slates of members and officers of The General Service Board and the slates of corporate board directors, before the Conference meeting, and expresses disapproval, if any.”
- The committee reviewed the resumes and approved, as eligible for election, all candidates for West Central and Western Canada regional trustees.

FLOOR ACTIONS WHICH DID NOT RESULT IN CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTION

- That the trustees’ Committee on Correctional Facilities continue to gather and review additional sharing from area delegates and Correctional Committee, Cooperation With the Professional Community and Bridging the Gap Area chairs on the topic of introducing A.A. into *educational* programs for correctional personnel, and that they use this information to write guidelines to present to the 2005 Conference Committee on Correctional Facilities for the development of workshops and *education* sessions on introducing A.A. to correctional personnel.
- That the A.A. Grapevine Corporate Board produce a collection of stories for young people, drawn from previous issues of the A.A. Grapevine magazine, similar to “Spiritual Awakenings.”

Virginia: Area 71 has 45 districts with approximately 1,200 groups. We have two assemblies a year and 11 active committees, plus seven special assignments: We had one district fold a year ago, so the Growth Committee is working with those groups to restart or join surrounding districts. We are trying to get inactive groups to get involved. D.C.M.s and G.S.R.s and other member are attending these groups to see why they need to be represented. At present Growth is also gathering inventory questions so we can again look at our area. The last inventory, about 6-7 years ago, revealed lack of communication. I want to thank all for allowing me to serve. — *Gail Lee*

Washington (Western): Area 72 has over 1,400 registered groups in 40 districts, including one area-wide Hispanic district. We hold three area committee quarterlies plus one annual assembly. Five pre-Conference regional meetings are used to inform the groups about the Conference agenda items, and our April quarterly will invite the G.S.R.s to share their group conscience on the agenda items. We hold 4-6 regional preassemblies to inform the groups on our assembly agenda items. The 2004 assembly approved the establishment of an Accessibility Committee. We will also host the 2006 Pacific Region Forum in Seattle on June 23-25. The Greater Seattle area is served by three intergroups and the balance of the area has central offices. The districts are busy with treatment, corrections and jail meetings. Group level involvement is encouraged. I thank you for this opportunity to serve such a great Fellowship. — *Dick Donahue*

West Virginia: Area 73 has approximately 300 groups in 17 districts. We have an assembly in the spring and fall in addition to two yearly agenda meetings. At our assemblies, we usually have 100% district representation. We have an active committee system that insures that the message is being carried effectively to the professional, the public, behind the walls, and to alcoholics in treatment or hospitalized. We have a statewide 800 telephone number that can be utilized by the newcomer for an A.A. contact or a meeting. A.A. is alive and well in Area 73 and I am humbled and honored to serve as delegate. Whether you are passing through our area on business or for pleasure, please look us up. We would love to have you join us. May God bless and keep you until then. — *Alan Siebel*

Wisconsin (Southern): Area 75 has over 900 registered groups and 32 districts. We hold two agenda planning meetings and two pre-Conference assemblies, and two additional assemblies. Two annual conferences are also organized in cooperation with Area 74 A.A. members. We also have a Corrections Conference and the Unity Conference. One special event for 2004 was a Spanish Sharing Session. Our Corrections committee funds A.A. literature for the facilities through our Rainbow Can project, and provides many Grapevine and La Viña subscriptions to inmates through our Count On Us program. C.P.C.'s big event for 2004 was the national meeting of Drug Court Professionals held in Milwaukee last summer. We now have an archivist, and an archives chairperson, and are in search of space to store our expanding collection. We face the ongoing challenge of introducing more members to the joy of general service. One helpful tool is our G.S.R. school, which travels on request to districts throughout the area. With God's help, we will continue to fulfill our spiritual responsibility to carry the A.A. message to those who still suffer. — *Nancy Gusner*

Additional Committee Considerations

(Items discussed but no action taken or recommendation made.)

AGENDA

- The committee reviewed the Conference Evaluation form and suggested that a heading be added to section #7 on page 5 regarding improving next year's Conference.

ARCHIVES¹

- The committee reviewed the contents of the Archives Workbook and suggested adding a reference to the G.S.O. Archives Web site under the "Reference Information and Resources" section of the workbook.
- The trustees provided updates to the Conference committee on the following ongoing projects: preparations for the International Convention, Ownership of Material, the current status of the audio preservation, and distribution increase of *Markings* newsletter.

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

- The committee reviewed shared experience on ways local committees approach professionals in addition to writing letters.
- The committee discussed the need for a pamphlet directed to the criminal justice system and requested that the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities review current C.P.C. literature to see whether it provides easily accessible information on singleness of purpose, open and closed meetings, proof of attendance at meetings, anonymity and how to contact A.A. locally, and report to the 2006 Conference Committee on C.P.C.
- The committee considered a request to create a video for professionals. They asked that trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities consider the cost and feasibility of producing short video segments directed to professionals in the employment/human relations, legal/criminal justice, and medical fields that could be streamed on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site.

The committee shared that PowerPoint® presentations offer a simple and inexpensive way to provide A.A. information to professionals. They noted that locally produced examples of such presentations are currently available from the C.P.C. desk at G.S.O. They requested that the C.P.C. staff member gather additional samples that might be combined into a service piece and included in the C.P.C. Kit.

- The committee reviewed the new three-ring binder format of the Cooperation With the Professional Community Kit and asked that the following be included in the C.P.C. Workbook: a guide letter to the legal community, a note suggesting that C.P.C. committees contact the C.P.C. desk for samples of locally developed C.P.C. pieces, and the suggestion that some committees have found a list of local open meetings helpful in doing C.P.C. work.
- The committee considered ways that members share information about A.A. one-on-one with professionals, for possible inclusion in C.P.C. material. They felt that additional information on



how committees can encourage individuals to work with the professionals in their lives should be included in the C.P.C. Workbook, along with lists of literature appropriate to approaching various professionals. This information would note that examples of how some areas have done this are available from G.S.O.

- The committee requested that the section "Guidelines for A.A. Sponsors" on page 15 of the C.P.C. Workbook be rewritten using terms such as building or developing relationships with professionals. They agreed that the word "sponsorship" may be confusing to A.A. members and professionals in describing their relationship.

- The committee requested that a list of professions that have been approached by local committees be gathered for possible inclusion in the C.P.C. Kit.

- The committee requested that the C.P.C. staff person gather sharing, for possible inclusion in the C.P.C. Kit, on ways that C.P.C. committees have solved the challenges of rotation in A.A., ensuring that the committee works without breaks in continuity.

- The committee noted that the following have been helpful in doing C.P.C. work:

Approaching professionals in twos; as in Twelfth-Step work, bring a newcomer.

Creating calling cards with C.P.C. committee contact information.

Finding A.A. members with appropriate professional or recovery experience to do C.P.C. work.

Remembering that A.A. is a valuable resource to professionals.

CORRECTIONAL FACILITIES

- The committee requests that the font size in the pamphlet "A Message to Correctional Professionals" be increased to be consistent with other Conference-approved pamphlets for professionals.

- The committee reviewed with appreciation the draft service piece on "Guidelines for the Development of Workshops Introducing A.A. in Training Programs for Correctional Personnel" and suggested that the trustees' Committee on Corrections continue to develop the piece. The committee requested that the draft be addressed to training programs for corrections personnel, rather than being limited to training academies; that a

revised draft be circulated to Correctional Facilities, Hospitals and Institutions, and Bridging the Gap area committee chairs for additional sharing; and that the trustees' Committee report back to the 2006 Conference Committee on Corrections.

FINANCE

- The Conference Finance Committee requests that the trustees' Finance Committee develop a "draft finance card" to be used by the groups similar in concept to the "Blue Card" that can explain that in addition to group expenses all levels of service require money to carry the message to the still-suffering alcoholic. This may include a discussion on the spiritual principles of self-support as described on pages 5 and 6 in the pamphlet "Self-Support: Where Money and Spirituality Mix," and the April 1956 A.A. Grapevine article "More Than Donuts."

- The committee discussed a request to include information on how to obtain a tax ID number in the "Self-Support: Where Money and Spirituality Mix" pamphlet and took no action as the information is currently available in other literature.

GRAPEVINE

- The committee agreed to forward to the Grapevine Corporate Board the request that a collection of A.A. Grapevine stories for young people be produced in the year 2006 or later.

- The committee agreed to forward to the Grapevine Corporate Board the suggestion that an audio compact disc of La Viña stories on Steps Seven through Twelve be produced in the year 2006 or later.

- The committee reviewed the contents of the Grapevine Workbook and suggested that certain editorial changes be made prior to reprinting.

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/ REGIONAL FORUMS'

- The committee discussed the 2005 International Convention and heard updates from the 2005 International Convention coordinator and our professional convention consultant, Gregg Talley.

- The committee discussed ways to encourage interest in Regional and Special Forums and suggested the following:

That groups, districts, and areas develop flyers using the information regarding Regional and Special Forums posted on the web by the General Service Office.

That members consider organizing bus/van trips to Forums.

That more members, particularly sponsors and trusted servants in each region, personally encourage and invite new members to attend Forums with them.

- The committee discussed the concept of restructuring and/or increasing Forums (Regional/Special) and requested that the trustees' Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums prepare a report on this topic for the 2006 Conference Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums.

LITERATURE

- The committee reviewed with appreciation the revised draft manuscript of the pamphlet "Too Young?" and requested that the Publications Department rewrite the manuscript taking into consideration suggestions from the committee and present the rewritten manuscript to the 2006 Conference Literature Committee following review by the trustees' Literature Committee.
- The committee reviewed the draft manuscript developed to replace the pamphlet "It Happened to Alice!" and requested that the Publications Department rewrite the manuscript taking into consideration suggestions from the committee and present the rewritten manuscript to the 2006 Conference Literature Committee following review by the trustees' Literature Committee.
- The committee considered the request to develop a publication oriented toward and addressing the concerns of A.A. members with long-term sobriety and took no action.
- The committee considered the request to revise the table of contents in *Living Sober* by creating "unity," "service," and "recovery" sections and by including a subtitle under chapter titles and took no action.

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

- The committee accepted with appreciation the report from the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference regarding the use of laptop computers at the General Service Conference.
- The committee discussed regional structure and realignment and requested that the General Service Board furnish a report to the 2006 Conference Policy/Admissions Committee on the feasibility of more balanced composition/structure of regions.
- The committee considered a request that a second Conference Committee on Literature be formed and unanimously agreed to take no action.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

- The committee considered the 2004 annual report from the trustees' Committee on Public Information regarding G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site, as requested by the 2004 General Service Conference, and expressed their appreciation for the comprehensiveness of the report.
- The committee reviewed with appreciation the information on centralized redistribution, tracking and evaluation of the "We Know What It's Like" Public Service Announcement (P.S.A.).

- The committee suggested adding additional clarification to the category "Introduction to A.A." on the Membership Survey pamphlet to indicate that "the total responses may add up to more than 100 %."
- The committee reviewed the contents of the Public Information Kit and Workbook.

REPORT AND CHARTER

- The committee reviewed proposed editorial changes to *The A.A. Service Manual* with appreciation, and selected several items to be brought back with additional background for review by the 2006 Conference Committee on Report and Charter.
- The committee reviewed the *Final Conference Report* and noted with appreciation the timely distribution of the *2004 Final Conference Report* to the General Service Conference Areas. The committee also considered cost reduction efforts involving the *Final Conference Report* and suggested they be primarily focused on the format and not affect the content.
- The committee considered placement of a central office serving Native North American People in the A.A. directories and took no action.

TREATMENT FACILITIES

- The committee reviewed the results of the 2004 Treatment Facilities Committee Survey and noted that in many areas, inpatient treatment services have decreased and outpatient services have increased; and, many local Treatment Facilities Committees bring A.A. meetings into other institutions such as nursing homes, halfway houses and homeless shelters.
- The committee requested that a summary of the survey results be prepared and that relevant shared experience from the summary be added to the Treatment Facilities Workbook. The revised text will be presented to the 2006 Conference Committee on Treatment Facilities. The committee reviewed the contents of the Treatment Facilities Kit and Workbook and made no additional changes.
- Though A.A. experience with the treatment field has undergone considerable change during the past decade, the committee felt that there is still a strong need for the A.A. message to be brought to treatment professionals and to the alcoholic in treatment settings. The committee discussed the importance of strong Treatment Facilities area chairs.
- In light of A.A.'s recent experience with changes in the treatment field, the committee requested that the 2006 Conference Committee on Treatment Facilities reconsider both the scope and name of the Conference Committee on Treatment Facilities.
- The committee considered the request that the "Singleness of Purpose" statement currently used in six Cooperation With the Professional Community pamphlets be added to the pamphlet "A.A. in Treatment Facilities," and took no action.
- Noting that a variety of A.A. literature exists for Treatment Facilities Committees, the committee requested that the Publications Department add an Additional Resources section to the last page of the pamphlet "A.A. in Treatment Facilities."

¹Members of this committee serve on this as a secondary committee assignment.

TRUSTEES

- The committee reviewed the resumes and approved, as eligible for election, all candidates for East Central and Southeast regional trustee and for trustee-at-large/U.S.
- The committee discussed at length the suggestion, "That an appointed committee member not be eligible as a regional trustee or nontrustee director candidate until one year after his or her last service as an appointed committee member," and took no action.
- The committee suggested that the first sentence of the "Composition" section of its Composition, Scope and Procedure, which currently states, "There are not more than nine voting members of this committee and a non-voting secretary," be corrected to read as follows: "There are at least nine voting members of this committee and a non-voting secretary."

NOTE: A 1979 Conference Advisory Action recommended that "The Conference Committee on Trustees always have at least nine members so that there will always be enough to constitute one-half of the committee votes in regional elections."

- The committee reviewed the selection process for adding new members to the 2004 Conference Committee on Trustees and noted that, at that time, only three Panel 54 delegates were selected, creating a committee of eight members. Also, the committee noted that, in order to restore the committee to at least nine members, as outlined in the committee's composition, during the 2005 selection process, six Panel 55 delegates were selected. The committee strongly suggests that four Panel 56 delegates be selected during the selection process for the 2006 Conference Committee on Trustees and that five Panel 57 delegates be selected during the selection process for the 2007 Conference Committee on Trustees, thus restoring the committee to its designated composition.

NOTE: The current "Composition" section of the Composition, Scope and Procedure of the Conference Committee on Trustees states the following: "The members of the committee will include: Not more than five delegates from the previous year's panel (they continue to serve on this committee for their second year), and not more than five delegates from the current year's panel."

RECOMMENDATIONS THAT DID NOT RESULT IN A CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTION

CORRECTIONS

- The committee recommended that the draft manuscript of *A.A. in Prison: Inmate to Inmate* that includes revisions suggested by the committee be approved and that the Publications Department maintain editorial responsibilities such as:

Cover and jacket design	Illustrations
Jacket copy	Title page
Preface, if any	Contents page

FLOOR ACTIONS THAT DID NOT RESULT IN CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTION

- That the "Singleness of Purpose" statement currently used in six Cooperation With the Professional Community pamphlets, as well as in the Conference Committee on Corrections pamphlet "A Message to Correctional Professionals" (and their workbook) be added to the pamphlet "A.A. in Treatment Facilities" plus the Treatment Facilities Workbook. **(Not approved)**
- "Alcoholism is a disease that ignores sexual preference" be changed to "Alcoholism is a disease that ignores sexual preference (orientation)" on page 10 in the pamphlet "A.A. and the Gay/Lesbian Alcoholic." **(Not approved)**
- That any further "editorial changes" to *The A.A. Service Manual* be included as background material sent to all delegates. **(Not approved)**
- The updated "Alcoholics Anonymous 2004 Membership Survey" pamphlet be approved with the addition of the following new question/category:
Sexual Orientation: Homosexual Heterosexual.
(Conference voted not to consider)
- The title of *A.A. in Prison: Inmate to Inmate* be changed to "A.A. member to A.A. member." The stories be focused on A.A. members who found sobriety inside the walls and continued sobriety on the outside. **(Conference voted not to consider)**
- That the title of the pamphlet "Questions and Answers on Sponsorship" be changed to "Questions and Answers on Recovery and Service Sponsorship." **(Conference voted not to consider)**
- That the A.A. directories include the listing of a central office serving Native North American people. **(Conference voted not to consider)**



pendence, but, as alcoholics, must not be isolated lest we wither and die. A major concern is filling area, district and group service positions and keeping them filled. Service work kept me connected during some rough times, and I pray that others find this to be true for them as we trudge the Road of Happy Destiny. My gratitude to Area 70 for allowing me to be of service. — *Becky Collette*

Washington State East: Area 92 has 467 groups in 24 districts. We have groups and districts in southeast British Columbia, Eastern Washington, north Idaho, parts of western Montana and two Spanish-speaking groups in Oregon. We have three nongeographic linguistic districts that serve Spanish-speaking members. One of our challenges now is to develop a translation committee, which was created in 2002. We are also seeing the development of special needs committees and Young People in A.A. groups. We are celebrating our 10th year as a new delegate area in 2006. We are gaining a broader base of past trusted servants as each panel rotates and makes themselves available to share their experience. Service to my home group, Area 92 and A.A. as whole has changed my life. Thank you for allowing me to serve and participate in this great Conference. — *Dave McCallum*

Wisconsin (Northern)/Upper Peninsula Michigan: Area 74 has over 630 groups in 24 districts. Our area committee has been given a more active role in serving the groups, and meets more frequently than in the past. We have also found that area assembly meetings have become much more productive. In conjunction and cooperation with Area 75 (Southern Wisconsin), our Unity Conference, or state convention, was started in 2001. Its purpose is to provide an annual forum for Areas 74 and 75 members of A.A., Al-Anon and Alateen to share experience on the Three Legacies. Currently we are looking at restructuring our conference, changing dates, site parameters, etc., to encourage more attendance and participation. We hosted the 2005 East Central Regional Forum in Houghton, Michigan last fall and really put "a face" on the General Service Office for many of those in attendance. Area 74 had our first trustee, Bob Mayer, elected from among our ranks last year. I am thoroughly enjoying serving as delegate and look forward to our journey together. — *Jeff Campbell*

Wyoming: Area 76 is made up of 12 districts, with approximately 70 active A.A. groups. We hold two business assemblies and two conventions each year. Our committees include Treatment Facilities, which coordinates our Bridging the Gap program and Corrections where A.A. meetings are organized to be taken into the Wyoming State Penitentiaries. Others carry the A.A. message through Literature, the Grapevine and A.A. pamphlets and publications. The committee system is working well, with excellent participation by A.A. members from around the state. Our area conventions, in the spring and fall, are primarily social occasions. Our newsletter, *The Tributary*, announces upcoming area events such as campouts and jamborees which A.A. members and their friends enjoy in Wyoming's great outdoors. Our Web site can be reached through links with www.aa.org or at www.area76wyaa.org. Wyoming has many small towns but most have an A.A. group or a meeting where visitors are always welcome. There are not as many A.A. members to help with all of the service work and each individual's contribution is important. We are grateful for our sobriety and the Grace of a power greater than ourselves and show our gratitude through service and carrying the A.A. message of recovery to the alcoholic who still suffers. — *Pat Milligan*

Additional Committee Considerations

(Items discussed but no action taken or recommendation made.)

AGENDA

- The committee reviewed the Conference Evaluation form and suggested that the section on laptop usage be modified in light of the 2004 Advisory Action allowing use of personal computers at the General Service Conference.

ARCHIVES¹

- The committee reviewed the contents of the Archives Workbook, including the revised "Ownership of Material" statement and revised "Deed of Gift" form. The committee requested that the trustees' Archives Committee review a legal opinion of the revised sample "Deed of Gift" form before inclusion in the next printing of the Archives Workbook
- The committee considered annually reviewing a list to be compiled by G.S.O.'s archivist of proposed archival recordings (format to be determined by A.A.W.S.) to be produced for sale by A.A.W.S. so that the Conference might provide guidance prior to production. The committee requested that the trustees' Archives Committee develop oversight procedures for the boards and Conference Archives Committee for possible production and distribution of selected archival recordings, and that the proposed procedures, along with a sample descriptive list of archival recordings, be brought to the 2007 Conference Committee on Archives for their consideration.

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

- The committee noted that the following points may be helpful in developing the three video segments directed to professionals:
 - Describe how professionals can use A.A. as a resource, including utilizing G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site and local A.A. Web sites, requesting presentations from local C.P.C. committees, and connecting alcoholics to local A.A. service committees.
 - Utilize Class As or other nonalcoholic friends of A.A. in the videos to share their experiences of cooperating with A.A.
 - Include footage from A.A. Conference-approved videos and other sources to make these videos more dynamic and interesting to professionals, as appropriate.
 - Exercise care to ensure that the videos attract rather than promote.
 - Make videos available in DVD and other formats to be used by local C.P.C. committees for presentations and at exhibits at professional conferences.
- The committee discussed participation of local C.P.C. committees at exhibits at local professional conferences, emphasizing the role of local A.A. committees as a resource for professionals who come into contact with alcoholics.
- The committee discussed the practice of inviting professionals to local A.A. events (e.g., C.P.C. luncheons, events targeted to spe-

¹Members of this committee serve on this as a secondary committee assignment.

cific professions, and A.A. conventions, conferences and round-ups), and agreed that these are valuable ways to cooperate with professionals.

- The committee requested that the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities develop sample presentations for possible inclusion in the C.P.C. Kit, and report back to the 2007 Conference Committee on C.P.C.
- The committee reviewed the C.P.C. Kit and Workbook and asked staff to gather sharing from local C.P.C. committees pertaining to attractive design of A.A. booths at professional conferences and effective training methods for booth volunteers, for possible inclusion in the C.P.C. Workbook.
- The committee discussed how important it is to bring a spirit of enthusiasm and fun to local C.P.C. committee service so that more A.A. members may be attracted to C.P.C. service.

CORRECTIONS

- The committee reviewed the Kit and Workbook and noted that some local committees prefer the term "Bridging the Gap" when referring to pre-release contacts and asked that acknowledgment of this local custom be included in the Workbook.
- The committee suggested that the Correctional Facilities Kit and the Correctional Facilities Workbook be retitled "Corrections Kit" and "Corrections Workbook" and that this terminology be reflected in Corrections service material where appropriate.

FINANCE

- The committee discussed the draft "Finance Card" and thanked the trustees' Finance Committee for its work. The committee asks the trustees' Committee to consider the following suggested short language for use on the card:

"The Seventh Tradition states that Alcoholics Anonymous is self-supporting through our own contributions. The contributions help cover the group's expenses. But the Seventh Tradition is more than simply paying for rent and other group expenses. It is both a privilege and responsibility of both the groups and individual members to insure that our organization, at every level including group, intergroup/central office, local services, district, area, and the General Service Office, remain forever self-supporting and free of outside influences that might divert us from our primary purpose.

"The monetary amount of our contribution is secondary to the spiritual connection that joins us in unity with our groups around the world."

- The committee discussed a request from an area regarding removing pie charts and a request from another area regarding adding additional pie charts to the pamphlet "Self-Support: Where Money and Spirituality Mix" and took no action.
- The committee discussed requests to eliminate the discounts on volume purchases of A.A.W.S. literature and took no action.

GRAPEVINE

- The committee reviewed the contents of the A.A. Grapevine Workbook and made no changes.

- The committee urged the A.A. Grapevine Board to produce a Spanish translation of the A.A. Grapevine Workbook as soon as financially possible.

- The committee agreed to forward to the A.A. Grapevine Board the suggestion that the A.A. Grapevine produce an anthology of La Viña stories in the year 2007 or later.

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/ REGIONAL FORUMS¹

- The committee noted the development and addition of registration flyers to the Regional Forums section of G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site in response to a suggestion from the 2005 committee.
- The committee accepted the Report on Restructuring and/or Increasing Regional/Special Forums from the trustees' International Conventions/Regional Forums Committee and asked that the trustees' committee consider the following suggestions:
 - Add the topic "Regional/Special Forums" to the A.A. Grapevine's i-Say Forum.
 - Add articles regarding personal Forum experience to future issues of *Box 4-5-9*.
 - Implement a subscription process for ordering Final Forum Reports.
 - Distribute a summary of past Conference committee suggestions on ways to encourage interest in Regional and Special Forums to local Forum host committee contacts.
- The committee accepted the reporting on the 2005 International Convention, and acknowledged the work of our convention consultant in helping coordinate a successful event. The committee noted that the financial results of the Convention showed a loss of \$39,039, less than one percent under budget.
- Gratitude was expressed for the extranet broadcast of the opening Flag Ceremony, and committee members encouraged further exploration of this type of access to future International Conventions. The committee also discussed how special needs challenges are handled at International Conventions, and briefly reviewed the site selection process for International Conventions.

LITERATURE

- The committee suggested that the word "largely" be added, when appropriate, to references in A.A. World Services service material concerning any changes to the first 164 pages of the Big Book.
- The committee discussed a request to develop an intergroup/central offices pamphlet and took no action. The committee acknowledged that in many areas, intergroup/central offices have a vital role in carrying the A.A. message; however, they felt that there appears to be sufficient information available about intergroup/central offices in A.A. Conference-approved literature and service material. As the structure and function of intergroup/central offices vary throughout the United States and Canada, it was the consensus of the committee that, where a need may exist for an intergroup/central offices pamphlet, it can be best addressed locally.
- The committee considered a request to develop an A.A. history book covering the years 1955-2000, and reviewed the history of the agenda item, which included past financial expenditures, and following a lengthy discussion on the logistics of going forward, the committee agreed to take no action.

¹Members of this committee serve on this as a secondary committee assignment.

- The committee considered developing a pamphlet concerning Alcoholics Anonymous, religion and spirituality. After a thorough discussion, the committee felt that there are already numerous references to this subject in the existing A.A. Conference-approved literature, and took no action.

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

- The committee discussed the request that the Conference be mindful of balancing the number of odd and even panel delegates when decisions are made that affect delegate rotation and took no action.
- The committee accepted the report from the General Service Board on the feasibility of more balanced composition/structure of regions and, after lengthy discussion, took no action. The committee agreed with the conclusion in the board's report that it is feasible to change regional boundaries and that the procedures are included in the "Suggested Guidelines for Changing Regional Boundaries" accepted by the 1996 General Service Conference.
- The committee acknowledges the magnitude of the current General Service Board's Ad Hoc "Regional Composition and Structure Inventory Committee" project, which was defined by the General Service Board chairperson following the 2005 General Service Conference and involves extensive review of background material. The committee requested that the General Service Board forward a final report to the 2007 Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions for review.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

- The committee reviewed the 2005 annual report from the trustees' Committee on Public Information regarding G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site and noted the new and improved redesigned Web site. The committee also encourages a continued sensitivity to individuals with special needs in future design and development of G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site.
- The committee reviewed information on centralized distribution, tracking and evaluation of the P.S.A. "Living in Chaos."
- The committee discussed how to get more area delegates involved in the distribution and collection of the 2007 A.A. Membership Survey Questionnaires and suggested that a presentation on the relevance and the process of the survey be included as part of the General Service Conference agenda in the years in which the survey is scheduled.
- The committee considered a request to add the categories "Sober between 11-20 years" and "Sober more than 20 years" to the "Length of Sobriety" section in the "2007 A.A. Membership Survey" pamphlet and took no action. The committee noted that "length of sobriety" categories are not part of the survey questionnaire, and that the categories are developed from data extracted from the question, "I had my last drink in ____" on the survey questionnaire. The committee agreed that, although no action was necessary at this time, additional length of sobriety categories may be considered by the trustees' and Conference P.I. Committees that would review the next survey and "A.A. Membership Survey" pamphlet.
- The committee considered the request to add a "Sexual

Orientation" category to the 2007 A.A. Membership Survey Questionnaire and took no action.

- The committee suggested that the trustees' Committee on Public Information review the wording in the "A.A. Membership Survey Questionnaire" for consistency with the wording used in the "A.A. Membership Survey" pamphlet. The committee noted the desirability of including a term that would better describe the "Native American" option under Question 4: "Race." The committee also suggested that option K: "Transportation (equipment operator)" of Question 12: "What is the nature of your employment status now?" be clarified or better defined.
- The committee reviewed a request that the list of early symptoms derived from outside literature on page 17, item #19, in the pamphlet "Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings," be replaced with a list derived from A.A. literature and took no action. The committee suggested that the trustees' Committee on Public Information make a thorough review of the pamphlet, "Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings" and that a report of their findings be forwarded to the 2007 Conference Committee on Public Information for consideration.
- The committee reviewed the P.I. Kit and Workbook.

REPORT AND CHARTER

- The committee reviewed a list of proposed editorial changes to *The A.A. Service Manual* and forwarded suggestions to the Publications Department.
- The committee discussed the discrepancy between the Conference Charter and *The A.A. Service Manual* regarding panel rotation of district committee members (D.C.M.s) and took no action.
- The committee considered a request to include a description of the duties of a district committee member chairperson (D.C.M.C.) on page S30 of *The A.A. Service Manual* and requested that a list of duties be developed and brought back to the 2007 Conference Committee on Report and Charter for review.
- The committee considered a request to insert into *The A.A. Service Manual* an inverted triangle graphic similar to the one found in "The Twelve Concepts for World Service Illustrated" pamphlet and took no action.



- The committee considered a request to revise page S28 of *The A.A. Service Manual* to more accurately reflect the number of groups in a metropolitan district and requested that a description be developed and brought back to the 2007 Conference Committee on Report and Charter for review.

- The committee reviewed the *Final Conference Report* and noted the timeliness of the distribution process.

- The committee considered a suggestion to restore *The Twelve Concepts for World Service* by Bill W. to its original form as published in 1962 and requested that the Publications Department restore *The Twelve Concepts for World Service* to its original form keeping in mind the 1985 Conference Advisory Action and all subsequent Advisory Actions regarding *The Twelve Concepts for World Service*.

- The committee considered a request to attach an explanatory letter regarding the appropriate use of the A.A. Directories and requested that the statement on the front cover of each A.A. Directory regarding "appropriate use" be made more prominent.

TREATMENT FACILITIES

- The committee discussed the name of the "Conference Committee on Treatment Facilities" and took no action.

- The committee requested that the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities gather additional sharing from the Fellowship regarding use of the video *Hope: Alcoholics Anonymous* by those A.A. members carrying the message into treatment facilities and other noncorrectional environments.

- The committee requested that the A.A.W.S. Board consider the development of a pilot electronic bulletin board on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site for those bringing the A.A. message to treatment facilities and other noncorrectional environments.

- The committee reviewed the revisions and additions to the Treatment Facilities Workbook forwarded from the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities. These revisions and additions were based upon the shared experience received from local treatment facilities committees in response to a questionnaire sent to areas, districts and intergroup/central offices in 2004.

TRUSTEES

- The committee reviewed the resumes and approved, as eligible for election, all candidates for Pacific and Eastern Canada regional trustee.

- The committee discussed the report from the trustees' Committee on Nominating on the efficacy of the "Diversity Statement" currently being used in vacancy letters, and agreed that the current wording of the statement continues to convey the idea of an inclusive and diverse Fellowship. The current wording is:

"In seeking applications for all vacancies in Alcoholics Anonymous, the Fellowship is committed to creating a large applicant file of qualified persons which reflects the inclusiveness and diversity of A.A. itself."

The committee felt the impact of the statement may be

improved by positioning it closer to the beginning of relevant vacancy announcement letters.

- The committee discussed the option of having a Class B trustee serve as chairperson of the General Service Board, and requested that additional relevant background be gathered and reported to the 2007 Conference Committee on Trustees, to include specific questions raised by the 2006 Conference Committee on Trustees.

The committee also suggests that all delegates consider discussing this topic in their areas and forward any responses to the trustees' Committee on Nominating by October 2006.

RECOMMENDATIONS THAT DID NOT RESULT IN A CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTION

FINANCE

- The committee recommended that the current small-order freight charge policy be replaced with a policy of charging shipping on all orders, which seems to be more in keeping with the spirit of treating everyone equally.

FLOOR ACTIONS THAT DID NOT RESULT IN CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTIONS

- It is recommended that an intergroup/central offices pamphlet be developed and a draft copy or progress report be brought to the 2007 General Service Conference. **(Conference voted not to consider)**

- That the title of *A.A. In Prison: Inmate to Inmate* be changed to *A.A. Member to A.A. Member Behind the Walls*. **(Not Approved)**

- To make available the talk by Bill W. given at Amy's presentation to anyone at this Conference through e-mail or CD by anyone requesting. **(Not Approved)**

- That under the section "Domestic Status" in the 2007 A.A. Membership Survey Questionnaire, we add the option of "Domestic Partner." **(Conference voted not to consider)**



Additional Committee Considerations

Advisory Action 40 of the 1990 General Service Conference states: "Items discussed, but no action taken or recommendation made, as well as committee recommendations which are not adopted, be included in a separate section of the *Final Report*." All items, listed by committee, are as follows:

AGENDA

- The committee reviewed the General Service Conference Evaluation Form. In response to a request for sharing from the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference on the question of participation by service category, the committee agreed that the question remain on the Evaluation Questionnaire. While the responses from the question may not affect the planning of future Conferences, it was felt that the publication of the responses in the Evaluation Summary provides an opportunity for Conference members to check their own participation, and may open communication with others on how they viewed this topic.

ARCHIVES¹

- The committee accepted the "Sound and Video Access Policies" and expressed gratitude for the hard work in developing this General Service Board policy clarifying procedures and limitations for accessing the archival recordings of the General Service Office Archives.
- The committee reviewed the contents of the Archives Workbook and accepted the revisions.
- The committee requested that the trustees' Archives Committee consider developing new format(s) for the Archives Workbook. Suggestions included a 3-ring binder and/or a CD format, from which pages and forms could easily be updated, copied, downloaded, and/or printed.
- The committee suggested that the trustees' Archives Committee consider developing language for the Archives Workbook and/or a service piece that would help foster awareness of copyright issues in local, district, and area archives projects.
- The committee forwarded to the 2008 Policy/Admissions Committee a request to consider that the Conference Archives Committee be established as a permanent Conference committee.

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

- The committee reviewed the "Progress Report on Video Segments Directed to Professionals" from the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities, and viewed a preliminary clip of the C.P.C. video directed to medical professionals. The committee offered several suggestions to the Publications Director and video production vendor regarding script pacing, content, content security, and the general direction of the video.

The video segments directed to professionals in the employment/human relations, legal/criminal justice, and medical fields will be brought back to the 2008 Conference Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community.

¹Members of this committee serve on this as a secondary committee assignment.

- The committee reviewed the C.P.C. Kit and Workbook, and suggested two minor changes to the C.P.C. Workbook, which will be forwarded to the Publications Department.

- The committee recognized that local C.P.C. committees could benefit from easier access to the C.P.C. Workbook, and suggested that placement of the C.P.C. Workbook on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site be considered by A.A. World Services, Inc.

- The committee agreed that sending letters introducing A.A. and supplying A.A. literature to professionals are valuable C.P.C. service projects. The committee stressed the importance of one-on-one contact with professionals, noting that personal contact with professionals is essential to effective C.P.C. service.

- The committee recognized the value of utilizing professionals who are friends of A.A. at local A.A. events with the goal of stimulating interest in C.P.C. service. This approach can generate enthusiasm in the Fellowship for C.P.C. service, and enthusiasm is a critical component of effectively reaching professionals.

CORRECTIONS

- The committee reviewed the Corrections Workbook and suggested one change and one correction to the service piece "A.A. Corrections Prerelease Contact Information" (F-162), which will be forwarded to the Publications Department.

- The committee discussed various ways to stimulate corrections Twelfth Step work; these included:

- Utilizing the video *Carrying The Message Behind these Walls* more effectively.
- Creating Power Point presentations about A.A. corrections service including photos and discussion topics.
- Hosting A.A. round-ups inside correctional facilities similar to those previously shared about in *Box 4-5-9*.
- Mentioning in G.S.O.'s welcome letter to Corrections chairs that G.S.O. staff collects sharing on local corrections workshops and events.
- Sending sharing on local corrections workshops and events to G.S.O.
- Discussing ideas in areas and districts regarding ways to collect money to purchase literature for local correctional facilities.
- Including local corrections events on area Web sites.
- Introducing someone to corrections service by bringing them to corrections events and/or A.A. meetings on the inside.
- Listing Corrections chairs with G.S.O. so they receive useful corrections-related material and communications.
- Sharing about corrections service experience with excitement and enthusiasm.
- Encouraging ex-inmate A.A. members to participate in corrections service.
- Creating calendar of corrections events around U.S. and Canada.

FINANCE

- The committee suggests that the phrase "G.S.R. travel expenses to attend service functions" be added to A.A. service material

where appropriate when describing expenses in need of support.

- The committee discussed a request to "Develop a communication plan for the purpose of increasing the level of group participation and self-support within the Conference structure" and after considerable discussion took no action.
- The committee discussed a request to eliminate volume discounts on literature orders and agreed with the A.A.W.S. practice of allowing volume discounts on literature orders.
- The committee discussed a request to incorporate shipping costs into literature pricing, and agreed that the A.A.W.S. practice of shipping charges is appropriate.

GRAPEVINE

- The committee agreed to forward to the A.A. Grapevine Board the suggestion that the A.A. Grapevine produce in the year 2008 or later:
 - a collection of Grapevine stories by people with 40 or more years of sobriety, and;
 - a book of classic cartoons and jokes from the A.A. Grapevine.
- The committee reviewed the contents of the A.A. Grapevine Workbook and suggested that the sample presentation in Appendix IV be updated.
- The committee encouraged the Grapevine to explore less expensive formats for production of the workbook.
- The committee again urged the A.A. Grapevine Board to produce a Spanish translation of the A.A. Grapevine workbook as soon as financially possible.

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/ REGIONAL FORUMS'

- The committee discussed the site-selection procedures for the 2020 International Convention. The committee noted that selecting an International Convention site twelve years out prevents us from having to compete for sites and yet allows us to have enough information about the site city to make a good decision.
- The committee discussed the concept and details of Local Forums as approved by the General Service Board. It was noted that the new Local Forums format specifies that some expense, such as site rental, will be the responsibility of the Local Forum organizing committee. The diversity of the purpose of Local Forums was emphasized. In addition to large gatherings, there can be smaller gatherings to present Forum and local service information to selected A.A. communities and to respond to specific needs of these communities.

There were questions about Local Forums attendance by a General Service Board trustee and a member from either the General Service or the Grapevine Office. Starting July 2008 there will be an annual inventory of the new Forum schedule by the trustees' Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums to review Forum experience with the new Forum schedule and to respond to any questions about implementation of the Forum schedule.

- The committee discussed the following ways to encourage interest in Forums:

- Emphasize the importance of A.A. members talking to A.A. members about Forums.
- Use translators to communicate Forum information.
- Emphasize that it is more effective if local delegates, districts, groups and A.A. members take responsibility for providing information about Forums rather than relying on the General Service Office's mailing of registration forms.
- Encourage use of G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site to find Forum registration forms, Forum information and hotel information.
- Encourage A.A. members to use G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site as a source for Forum Final Reports to find out what happened at past Forums and what Forums are like.
- Be an example of an enthusiastic Forum attendee.
- Emphasize interesting things you can learn at a Forum such as "Where does A.A.'s money go?"; "Do you want to get to know your literature?"
- Include Forum registration forms with catalogs in literature orders sent to central offices and intergroups.

LITERATURE

- The committee reviewed the trustees' Literature Committee progress report on revisions to the "A.A. for the Native North American" pamphlet and expressed appreciation that the story submission deadline was extended until June 30, 2007 to provide a greater opportunity for Native North American A.A. members to share their stories. The committee looks forward to reviewing a draft of the revised pamphlet at the 2008 General Service Conference.
- The committee discussed at length requests to develop an intergroup/central office pamphlet and took no action. As the structure and function of intergroup/central offices vary greatly throughout the United States and Canada, it was the consensus of the committee that, where a need may exist for an intergroup/central office pamphlet, it can be addressed locally.

The committee also felt that sufficient information is available about intergroup/central offices in existing A.A. Conference-approved literature and service material, including "The A.A. Group" pamphlet, *The A.A. Service Manual*, and A.A. Guidelines on Central and Intergroup Offices.

- The committee considered a request to produce a pamphlet to replace the discontinued "Letter to a Woman Alcoholic" and took no action.

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

- The committee accepted the final report from the General Service Board Ad Hoc Regional Composition and Structure Inventory Committee and expressed appreciation regarding the complexity of the issues that were discussed at length by the Board's Ad Hoc Committee.

The committee requested that the General Service Board provide a summary of the board's discussions on the inventory questions for board consideration that were listed in the final report, which pertain to regional composition and structure and, if completed, forward the summary to the 2008 Conference Committee on Policy Admissions.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

- The committee reviewed the 2006 Annual Report from the trustees' Committee on Public Information regarding G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site and noted the detailed information provided and the thoughtful consideration given to all items involving the G.S.O. A.A. Web site.
- The committee reviewed information on centralized distribution, tracking and evaluation of the Public Service Announcement "Testimonials."
- The committee reviewed the contents of the Public Information Kit and Workbook and suggested that the language in the Workbook be revised to reflect current Conference Advisory Actions and experience regarding how to handle anonymity breaks by A.A. members at the public level.

REPORT AND CHARTER

- The committee reviewed a list of duties of a district committee member chairperson (D.C.M.C.) and requested that a "service piece" be developed for inclusion in the D.C.M. Kit.
- The committee considered a recommendation from the General Service Board that the following text be added to Chapter Nine in *The A.A. Service Manual* where appropriate:

"The intent of forming regions was to create a vehicle by which regional trustees could be added to the General Service Board and a way to provide a cross section of people who would serve A.A. as a whole—not in a representative capacity. To allow for a balanced rotation, elections of regional trustees are staggered in order that there may be a relatively even flow of new trustees coming onto the board. It was not until 1962 that the formal naming of regions occurred and a redistribution; and, soon afterwards the formation of new regions."

and took no action.

- The committee considered a recommendation from the General Service Board that the sentence, "Regional trustees bring to the board's discussions a regional point of view and experience that is invaluable," in Chapter Nine: The General Service Board, p. S62 in *The A.A. Service Manual*, 2006-2007 Edition, be replaced so that the section reads:

"While no trustee can be said to "represent" a geographical section—all trustees represent only the Fellowship as a whole—regional trustees bring to the board's discussions a diversity of A.A. experience that is invaluable."

and took no action.

- The committee considered a suggestion to include the committee scope from each Conference Committee Composition Scope and Procedure document in the Standing Committee section in the Chapter on Conference Committees and took no action.
- The committee considered and accepted a suggestion that the first sentence in the last paragraph of the preface to *Twelve Concepts of World Service*, which reads: "A 'short form' of the Concepts was prepared by the 1974 General Service Conference for inclusion in *The A.A. Service Manual*," be corrected to read as follows:

"A 'short form' of the Concepts was recommended by the 1974 General Service Conference for inclusion in *The A.A. Service Manual*."

- The committee considered a suggestion that the section on "Past Delegates," in *The A.A. Service Manual*, be moved from pages S43-44 and inserted, as amended, in Chapter Six, p. S47, after the discussion on "The Alternate" and took no action.
- The committee considered a suggestion that the terms L.C.M. (Local Committee Member) and D.C.M.C. (District Committee Member Chairperson) be added to the glossary on pages S18-19, and took no action. The committee requested that the Publications Department place a reference to D.C.M.C. in the Index.
- The committee considered a request to have A.A.W.S. discontinue publishing regional directories (Canada, Western U.S., and Eastern U.S.) and took no action.
- The committee considered a suggestion that the second to the last full sentence under Qualifications (page S29) in *The A.A. Service Manual* be amended to read: "A D.C.M. should have enough sobriety, generally four or five years" and took no action.
- The committee considered a suggestion to add to the A.A. Directories (Canada, Western U.S., and Eastern U.S.) a separate subsection within the section "INTERNATIONAL CORRESPONDENCE MEETINGS" for listing "Online Intergroups" that request to be listed, and that online Intergroups thus listed provide an e-mail and/or Web site address to be included in the directories and took no action.
- The committee reviewed the *Final Conference Report* and suggested that the publications department consider increasing the font size for future publications. The committee also wished to convey its thanks and appreciation for the artist's continued excellence in providing high quality illustrations to be included in the *Final Conference Report*.

TREATMENT FACILITIES

- The committee suggested that the DVD *Hope: Alcoholics Anonymous* be inserted in the complimentary Treatment Facilities Kit sent to each new Treatment Facilities area committee chair.
- The committee requested that the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities gather sharing from the Fellowship on how to stimulate interest in Treatment Facilities Twelfth Step work. This sharing is to include information such as:
 - Service material that has been locally produced.
 - Reports on events that have been held.
 - Examples of how sponsorship has proven to be an effective tool.

The committee is particularly interested in having samples of existing local service information available as background material to assist the 2008 Conference Committee on Treatment Facilities' discussion on the possible development of Conference-approved literature and/or service material to stimulate A.A. members' interest in Treatment Facilities Twelfth Step work.

- The committee forwarded to the A.A. Grapevine Corporate Board a suggestion that it consider producing a special section in the A.A. Grapevine and La Viña once a year on Treatment Facilities Twelfth Step work.
- The committee discussed the need for more input from the Fellowship in the area of carrying out our Twelfth Step responsi-

bility regarding Treatment Facilities service. Based on a lack of agenda items, the committee discussed the possibility of merging with another Conference committee, and concluded that the Conference Committee on Treatment Facilities is still viable.

TRUSTEES

- The committee reviewed the résumés and approved, as eligible for election, all candidates for Northeast and Southwest regional trustees and for trustee-at-large/Canada.
- The committee reviewed with approval the résumé of Terrance M. Bedient to serve as a consultant on the trustees' Finance & Budgetary Committee commencing with the July 2007 committee meeting.
- The committee accepted with appreciation the "Appeal to the General Service Conference" dated April 11, 2007 concerning the decision made in the January 2007 executive session of the General Service Board not to begin a search for a new general manager of the General Service Office.

In keeping with the importance of the principle of assuring us that the minority opinion will be heard, as outlined in Concept V, the Conference Committee on Trustees requests that this "Appeal to the General Service Conference" be given a full hearing at the next scheduled executive session of the General Service Board.

In addition, the committee requested that the trustees' Committee on Nominating review Procedure No. 9 of their Composition, Scope and Procedures—"Guidelines for Hiring the General Manager, G.S.O."—and clarify the language which refers to the length of service for that position. The committee requested that the trustees' Committee on Nominating forward a final report to the 2008 Conference Committee on Trustees.

RECOMMENDATIONS THAT DID NOT RESULT IN A CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTION

REPORT AND CHARTER

- The committee recommended that the first sentence of the first paragraph in the "The Area Assembly" section of Chapter Four in *The A.A. Service Manual* which reads: "Any meeting of area G.S.R.s, and the area committee (see Chapter Five) is an assembly," be changed to read as follows:

"Any meeting of area G.S.R.s, D.C.M.s and the area committee (see Chapter Five) is an assembly."

TRUSTEES

- The committee recommended that the existing sentence pertaining to regional trustees in the Bylaws of the General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc., be amended to read.

"Class B regional trustees are expected to contribute their time basically during the four periods of the year, viz., each three-day period ending on the day of each quarterly meeting of the trustees of the General Service Board, and, in addition, *to provide the Board their views and opinions regarding policy matters based on Fellowship-wide experience.*"

Note: As it exists in *The A.A. Service Manual, 2006-2007 Edition*, p. S110, that sentence reads:

"Class B regional trustees are expected to contribute their time basically during the four periods of the years, viz., each three-day period ending on the day of each quarterly meeting of the trustees of the General Service Board, and, in addition, *to advise the Board with respect to regional views and opinions regarding policy matters.*"

FLOOR ACTIONS THAT DID NOT RESULT IN CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTIONS

- The background material on the "Appeal to the General Service Conference" dated April 11, 2007 and reviewed by the Conference Committee on Trustees, be provided to all members of the 57th General Service Conference. (**Conference voted not to consider**)
- That the hospital scene appearing in the corrections video, previously approved, be deleted. (**Not Approved**)
- That the information media presentation introducing A.A. to training academies and in-service training for corrections personnel be edited to include at least one mention and display of our magazines, *The A.A. Grapevine* and *La Viña*, together with French and Spanish A.A. books and pamphlets. (**Not Approved**)
- That a pamphlet on intergroup/central offices be developed and that a draft copy or a progress report be brought back to the 2008 Conference Committee on Literature. (**Conference voted not to consider**)



Additional Committee Considerations

Advisory Action 40 of the 1990 General Service Conference states: "Items discussed, but no action taken or recommendation made, as well as committee recommendations which are not adopted, be included in a separate section of the *Final Report*." All items, listed by committee, are as follows:

AGENDA

- The committee reviewed the General Service Conference Evaluation Form, and suggested that the trustees' Committee on the Conference consider adding a category evaluating the individual Conference members' committee experience and a category to allow Conference members to rate their overall Conference experience, to the Evaluation Form.

ARCHIVES¹

- The committee reviewed the contents of the Archives Workbook, and accepted the revisions and proposed format changes, including the new language intended to foster awareness of copyright issues, with minor edits.
- The committee requested that the G.S.O. Archives' "Statements of Policy" related to accessing the Archives, as well as the "Sound and Video Access Policies," be added to the next printing of the Archives Workbook.
- The committee discussed various ideas for creatively making A.A.'s archives and history more readily available to the Fellowship in the future; these included:
 - Exploring ways to convey the experience of visiting G.S.O. and the Archives, for those who have not yet visited New York.
 - Continuing the development (currently in progress) of an extensive, illustrated timeline of A.A.'s history, for the Archives portal of G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site.
 - Placing the Archives' policies in a more prominent area of the Archives portal of G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site.

- Clarifying those services and materials that the Archives Department makes available to A.A. members and others.

- Including frequently asked questions and answers about A.A.'s archives and history to the Archives portal of G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site.

- Welcoming sharing and experience from Area and District Archives Committees for inclusion in the workbook and *Markings: Your Archives Interchange*.

- Submitting insightful articles to *Box 4-5-9*, or the A.A. Grapevine, that express the significance of archives and history to a wider audience.

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

- The committee reviewed the video segments directed to professionals in the employment/human relations field to be streamed on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site. The committee made suggestions to the Publications department for changes to the video segment and requested that a revised draft be brought back to the 2009 Conference Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community for review. (Changes not to exceed \$10,000.00)
- The committee requested that the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities discuss further possible projects directed toward legal/criminal justice system professionals.

CORRECTIONS

- The committee reviewed the contents of the Corrections Kit and Workbook and made the following suggestions:
 - That a copy of the annual corrections issue of the Grapevine and La Vina magazines be made available in the Kits, along with a brief list of suggestions about how the magazines may be useful for carrying the message behind the walls. The list of suggestions could include, but is not limited to: mention of the availability of boxes of back issues for a discounted



¹Members of this committee serve on this as a secondary committee assignment.

price with the appropriate information about contacting the Grapevine for ordering; the fact that only the July issue is available in stitched version, and that many facilities may not accept issues with staples; and mention of the option for local service opportunities for "stitching parties" to increase the chance of the magazines being allowed into facilities.

- That the Grapevine and La Vina magazines be added to the list of Kit Contents, with a mention of the "timelessness" of issues.
- That in future reprints of the Corrections Workbook, add the above suggestions for use of the magazines to the section on "Ideas to Stimulate Corrections Twelfth Step Work Within A.A." (see pages 6 & 7 of the 2008 Workbook)
- That a copy of the D.V.D. "A.A. in Correctional Facilities" be included in the Corrections Kit.
- The committee reviewed the service piece "Corrections A.A. Group Handbook" and made the following suggestions:
 - That when the service piece "Corrections A.A. Group Handbook" (CF-36) is updated, the "A.A. Correctional Facility Group Information Change Form" and the "Suggestions for Leading Beginners Meetings" be added.
 - That the list of contents of the service material included in, "Corrections A.A. Group Handbook," (CF-36) along with the list of materials included in the package sent with the Handbook, and a cover page explaining the development, current use, and possible use of the handbook, be included in the section of the Corrections Kit called "Other."
- That the trustees' Committee on Corrections consider development of a CD which would contain the contents of "Corrections A.A. Group Handbook" (CF-36) in English, Spanish and French, along with other materials mentioned above—the list of materials included in the package sent with the Handbook and a cover page explaining the development, current use, and possible use of the handbook—to be sent to A.A. members upon request, for reproduction by correctional facilities A.A. meetings and groups.

FINANCE

- The committee discussed a request that a Finance Kit be developed to assist group, intergroup/central offices, district and area service workers in carrying the message of our shared responsibility for the Seventh Tradition. Recognizing the need for increased awareness, the committee suggested that A.A.W.S. consider:
 - Updating/reformatting the Self-Support Packet (FV-19) to include the Finance Guidelines (MG-15).
 - Adding the information that is included in the Self-Support Packet (FV-19) to the G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site.
 - That the Self-Support Packet (FV-19) be sent to incoming area treasurers.
 - Add the Self-Support Packet (FV-19) to the Conference-approved Literature Catalog.

GRAPEVINE

- The committee reviewed the contents of the A.A. Grapevine Workbook and agreed that no changes were needed at this time.

• The committee discussed the staff report addressing the 2007 Additional Consideration to "explore less expensive formats for the production of the A.A. Grapevine Workbook" and requested that the Grapevine:

- Produce a portable GvR (Grapevine Representative) Handbook similar to the recently revised RLV (La Viña Representative) Handbook in size and format for ease of use by the GvR network and for cost containment.
- Update and revise the A.A. Grapevine History booklet.
- Continue to offer the current A.A. Grapevine Workbook as a free download at the Grapevine Web site.
- The committee agreed to forward to the A.A. Grapevine Board the suggestion that the A.A. Grapevine produce in the year 2009, or later, two CDs of stories from La Viña on Traditions One—Twelve.
- The committee reconsidered the 2007 General Service Conference Committee Advisory Action recommending that "the Grapevine and La Viña include a section on the medical, legal and social aspects of alcoholism, with an appropriate disclaimer" and took no action.
- The committee discussed the Grapevine's legacy of self-support and encouraged the A.A. Grapevine, Inc. to uphold that legacy.
- To increase use of the Grapevine and La Vina and awareness of their roles in A.A. today, the committee made several suggestions, including the following:
 - That delegates challenge each of their areas to increase circulation of the Grapevine by at least 100 subscriptions and circulation of La Viña by as much as possible.
 - That groups buy bulk subscriptions or 50-Packs of back issues for distribution in treatment facilities, correctional facilities, and other institutions.
 - That districts buy subscriptions for local libraries.
 - That GvR/RLVs use laptops to take subscriptions at A.A. events.
 - That delegates and Area Grapevine/La Viña chairs exchange information about successful efforts to increase awareness of A.A.'s magazines.
 - That groups put copies of the magazines in grocery stores, laundromats, and other public places where they might help alcoholics,
 - That groups hold Grapevine or La Viña meetings.

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/REGIONAL FORUMS¹

- The committee discussed ways to encourage interest in Regional and Local Forums and suggested:
 - That to increase local participation, areas where a Regional Forum is scheduled begin early in the year asking districts to consider not scheduling district functions that would conflict with the Forum dates.
 - That Local Forums be held in conjunction with State Conventions, and other nonservice A.A. events.
 - That information about Local Forums be mailed to all delegates again this year.

¹Members of this committee serve on this as a secondary committee assignment.



- That information about Local Forums be communicated to intergroups and central offices.
- That areas consider extending one day service events into two day events with the inclusion of a Local Forum.

LITERATURE

- The committee reviewed the selected unedited stories and the draft introduction for the revised pamphlet "A.A. for the Native North American," and suggested some changes. The committee looks forward to reviewing a draft of the revised pamphlet—taking into consideration the committee's suggestions—at the 2009 Conference Literature Committee meeting.
- The committee accepted the progress report from the Publications Department on the revision of the pamphlet "The A.A. Member—Medications and Other Drugs," and looks forward to reviewing a draft of the revised "The A.A. Member—Medications and Other Drugs" at the 2009 Conference Literature Committee meeting.
- The committee considered a request to reinstate the pamphlet "Letter to a Woman Alcoholic" and took no action.
- The committee reviewed the Composition, Scope and Procedure of the Conference Committee on Literature and made changes to clarify that the scope of the committee pertains to "recovery" literature.

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

- The committee considered a proposal that the current secondary Conference Archives Committee be established as a standing Conference Committee and took no action.
- The committee noted that the General Service Board, in response to an additional consideration from the 2007 Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions, will forward a summary of their discussion of the inventory questions which pertain to regional composition and structure to the 2009 Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

- The committee suggested that the proposed 2009 television public service announcement be at least partially directed to older alcoholics, and that previously shot P.S.A. footage be used wherever possible (**Note:** The recommendation to produce a television public service announcement in 2009 failed on the Conference floor).
- The committee reviewed the 2007 Annual Report from the trustees' Committee on Public Information regarding G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site and noted the detailed information provided and the thoughtful consideration given to all items involving the Web site.
- The committee reviewed information on centralized distribution, tracking and evaluation of the 2007 television public service announcement "A Force of Nature."
- The committee reviewed the trustees' Public Information Committee's Progress Report on the A.A. Videos for Young People Project, and expressed continued enthusiasm for the project.
- The committee reviewed the contents of the Public Information Kit and Workbook and suggested that the new A.A. Guidelines on the Internet be included in the P.I. Kit.

REPORT AND CHARTER

- The committee considered a suggestion to place a glossary of terms used in *The A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts for World Service* after the text of *The A.A. Service Manual* and directly preceding the index and took no action.

TREATMENT FACILITIES

- The committee discussed a proposal that the pamphlet, "Bridging the Gap" (BTG), be rewritten to reflect that the BTG program is used in both Treatment Facilities and Corrections service work and took no action.
- The committee discussed the possible development of Conference-approved literature and/or service material to stimulate A.A. members' interest in Treatment Facilities Twelfth Step work and took no action. The committee agreed that current

Conference-approved literature and service material serves the needs of those involved in Treatment Facilities Twelfth Step work.

- The committee reviewed the Treatment Facilities Kit and Workbook and requested that the following pamphlets be included in the Treatment Facilities Kit: "This is A.A." (P-1), "Message to Teenagers" (F-9), "The A.A. Group" (P-16), and "Question and Answers on Sponsorship" (P-15).

- In addition, the committee discussed the use of the tab labeled, "Local Experience" in the Treatment Facilities Kit. After lengthy sharing, the committee agreed that the appropriate use of the tab is best determined locally.

- The committee discussed the need for more input from the Fellowship in the area of carrying out our Twelfth Step responsibility and agreed that Treatment Facilities' Twelfth Step work is changing. Based on a lack of agenda items, the committee discussed the possibility of merging with another Conference committee, and concluded that the Conference Committee on Treatment Facilities is still viable.

TRUSTEES

- The committee reviewed the resumes and approved, as eligible for election, all Class B trustee candidates for the West Central and Western Canada Regions.

- The committee discussed a request to revisit the 2007 General Service Conference Advisory Action to consider all eligible Class A and Class B trustees when selecting the chairperson of the General Service Board and took no action.

- The committee took no action on the recommendation from the General Service Board that the following language from paragraph three, page 4 of the Bylaws be amended so that it applies only to **Class B regional trustees**:

"...However, when the vacancy being filled is that of a Class B **regional** trustee, the maximum term of service of such successor member trustee shall be limited to that number of one-year terms which will result in the term of service of the successor member trustee ending at the same time as the term of the replaced member trustee would have ended if no vacancy had occurred and the replaced member trustee had served four consecutive one-year terms."

- The committee took no action on the recommendation from the General Service Board that the following language from paragraph two, page 4 of the General Service Bylaws be amended so that it applies to **Class B regional trustees**:

"In the event that any member trustee shall resign, die, retire, be removed, become disqualified, or shall be otherwise unable to serve, the trustees may, at any regular or special meeting of the Board of Trustees, elect a new member trustee to fill such vacancy, or, alternatively, permit such a vacancy to continue until the next annual meeting of the members of the General Service Board. A third alternative, with respect to Class B **regional** member trustee vacancies occasioned by resignation, death, retirement, removal or disqualification, is to permit the vacancy to remain unfilled for the remainder of the four-year commitment, and to allow regional coverage to be provided by the trustee-at-large or the regional trustee from an adjacent region, unless a region decides that a new regional member trustee should be elected."

- In response to a recommendation from an area steering committee, the committee asked the trustees' Committee on Nominating to:

- amend the General Service Board Bylaws so that a Class B regional trustee elected to a partial term as the result of a resignation, death, retirement, removal or disqualification of a Class B regional trustee may stand for an additional full term of service subsequent to filling the term of service of the replaced member trustee.

- consider comparable amendments to the General Service Board Bylaws regarding an unexpected vacancy of a Class B trustee-at-large.

- forward the amended General Service Board Bylaws to the 2009 Conference Committee on Trustees for approval.

RECOMMENDATIONS THAT DID NOT RESULT IN A CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTION

LITERATURE

- The committee recommended that the pamphlet "44 Questions" be retitled "Questions and Answers about the A.A. Program of Recovery from Alcoholism."

PUBLIC INFORMATION

- The committee recommended that a new television public service announcement be developed for review by the 2009 Conference Committee on Public Information, at a cost not to exceed \$45,000, and that no current television public service announcements be retired at this time.

- The committee recommended that the following section on posthumous anonymity be included in the pamphlet "Understanding Anonymity" on page 9, before the Anonymity at the media level section:

Posthumous anonymity

Q. In general, what is the feeling of the Fellowship in regards to posthumous anonymity?

A. In 1988 the General Service Conference recommended that: The 1971 Conference Advisory Action be reaffirmed: "A.A. members generally think it unwise to break the anonymity of a member even after his death, but in each situation the final decision must rest with the family."

Q. Why do obituaries sometimes state that the deceased was a member of Alcoholics Anonymous?

A. There are many reasons why this could occur. Family members and funeral directors sometimes write the obituaries and are not aware of A.A.'s Traditions. On the other hand, the deceased person's A.A. membership may have been revealed due to a conscious decision made beforehand by the A.A. member, or it may have been a conscious decision made by the family.

A.A. members may wish to make their personal wishes on this matter known to their families ahead of time.

Q. What about posthumous anonymity in regard to our co-founders?

A. Co-founder Bill W's obituary, with photography, appeared on the front page of the *New York Times* on January 26, 1971. Following are excerpts from the obituary:

Mr. Wilson gave permission to break his A.A. anonymity upon his death in a signed statement in 1966. The role of Dr. Robert Holbrook Smith as the other founder of the worldwide fellowship was disclosed publicly when the Akron, Ohio, surgeon died of cancer in 1950 after 15 years of uninterrupted sobriety.

In fathering the doctrine that members should not reveal their A.A. affiliation at the public level, Bill W. had explained that anonymity isn't just something to save us from alcoholic shame and stigma; its deeper purpose is to keep those fool egos of ours from running hog wild after money and fame at A.A.'s expense.

REPORT AND CHARTER

- The committee recommended that an anonymity protected version of the *Final Report* of the Annual Meeting of the General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous be posted on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site to begin with the 2008 *Final Report*. This version will not include names and also will not include the final three (3) sections; Conference Committees, Trustees Committees, and Conference members.

TRUSTEES

- The committee recommended that, in order to further clarify the language regarding the length of service of the general manager, G.S.O., the trustees' Committee on Nominating:

- a) Consider replacing paragraph three of Nominating Procedure No. 9 approved by the General Service Board on February 4, 2008 which reads:

"The general manager serves at the pleasure of the Board without an employment contract and as an at-will employee. While there is no term of office as such, most recently, applicants have been asked for a commitment of five to seven years. It has been generally recognized that it is in the best interest of the Board and the individual to agree on the probable length of service in this position."

with the following language:

"The general manager serves at the pleasure of the Board without an employment contract and as an at-will employee. While there is no term of office as such, it is in the best interest of the Board and the individual to agree on a maximum length of employment for this position at the time of hire."

- b) Forward a report on their deliberations to the 2009 Conference Committee on Trustees.

The 58th General Service Conference now holds the record as the longest Conference in its 58 years. Scheduled to adjourn at 5:00 p.m. Friday afternoon it did not end until 12:40 a.m. Saturday morning. A lot of theatre and baseball tickets were put on hold — permanently.

FLOOR ACTIONS THAT DID NOT RESULT IN A CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTION

- To amend the 1959 Conference Advisory Action to display the Puerto Rican Flag along with the United States and Canadian Flags, to also include the British, Bahamian, and Dutch Flags, which are presented at the General Service Conference as part of Area 15. **(Not Approved)**
- That the trustees' Conference Committee develop policies and process for the selection of Conference agenda items, the selection of background material for these items, and present these to the 2009 Conference for review. **(Not Approved)**
- Request that the trustees' Committee on Nominating and the Conference Trustees Committee replace the word "good" with "geographical" preceding Cross Section in Nominating Procedure #9. **(Conference voted not to consider)**
- Background material for the Conference Agenda Committee shall include a list of proposed agenda items that were tabled or upon which no action was taken and an explanation of why each proposal was tabled or no action was taken. **(Not Approved)**
- To have the Conference revisit the 2007 General Service Conference Advisory Action to consider all eligible Class A and Class B trustees when selecting the chairperson of the General Service Board. **(Recommended to Committee)**
- To consider only all eligible Class A trustees when selecting the chairperson of the General Service Board. **(Recommended to Committee)**
- That the secondary Conference Committee on Archives be established as a standing Conference Committee. **(Recommended to Committee)**
- That all pending and future Conference-approved audio visual projects, i.e. P.S.A.s, informational videos, etc., include the end line of: "Look us up. Check your phone book, newspaper or aa.org." **(Conference voted not to consider)**
- That item F of the Public Information's Committee agenda, regarding a section on posthumous anonymity being added to "Understanding Anonymity," be returned to the trustees' Committee on Public Information for consideration at the General Service Conference in 2009. **(Conference voted not to consider)**
- Consider a request to change the title of the pamphlet "44 Questions" to "Frequently Asked Questions About A.A." **(Recommended to Committee)**
- Reinstate the pamphlet "Letter to a Woman Alcoholic." **(Conference voted not to consider)**
- That the trustees' Committee on Literature develop a pamphlet titled "A.A. for the First Nation" with first nation stories included. **(Recommended to Committee)**
- The Conference proposes that the trustees' Committee on Public Information conduct an assessment of how A.A. could best utilize new media platforms for Public Information purposes and report its findings to the 2009 Conference Committee on Public Information. **(Recommended to Committee)**
- That the Grapevine and La Viña discontinue the Alcoholism at Large Pages on the medical, legal and social aspects of alcoholism. **(Not Approved)**

Washington (Western): Area 72 has over 1,200 groups spread throughout 41 districts, two of which are Spanish-linguistic districts representing our 24 Spanish groups. We also have a fairly good-sized community of deaf alcoholics who are now participating in service, and rumor has it the Russians are coming. To surmount these language hurdles, while maintaining even a semblance of financial sanity, is currently one of the most pressing challenges. To date we have found the written word to be one of the most cost-effective methods of bridging this divide. We are working to complete a Spanish version of all the information on our Area Web site and, on a quarterly basis, have been creating a Spanish translation of our area's monthly newsletter. Area business is transacted in three area committee quarterlies, which also set the agenda items for our annual assembly in October. Attendance at our last assembly was over 750 registered attendees and a rocking 50% of the groups were represented. I am grateful and honored to serve as this Area's 31st delegate to the General Service Conference.—*Dave Tully*

West Virginia: Area 73 is the entire state of West Virginia with groups from the bordering states of Ohio, Kentucky, Virginia, Maryland and Pennsylvania. The A.A. Fellowship in Area 73 began in March 1942, when three gentlemen from Charleston registered their group; 67 years later we have 517 meetings and 432 groups in 16 districts. Carrying the message to the alcoholic who still suffers remains the priority of our area. Our Spring and Fall service assemblies are hosted on a rotation basis. Our State Convention, held each summer, is a weekend highlighted by speakers from both A.A. and Al-Anon. Members of the Fellowship keep the doors open, the coffee pot on and their hands extended to those who reach out for help. We remain grateful to the Fellowship and God's amazing grace for our sobriety that has made the unofficial slogan of the State of West Virginia a realization for many suffering alcoholics... "Mountaineers are always free."—*Kathy O'Shea*

Wisconsin (Southern): Area 75 has 31 districts, plus one Spanish-language district-at-large, and 999 active groups. Our area is served by five central/intergroup offices. We have one dark district. In 2010 we will be transitioning to a single area conference per year. We hold four other assemblies per year and a Delegate's Workshop in March. Many districts are hosting more workshops and open meeting events with growing effectiveness. A new "A.A. at the VA Mini-Conference" is a ground-breaking effort at cooperation between us and a large VA Medical Center (and treatment facility). Area 75 has a reformed Milwaukee County Corrections Committee, some new Special Needs efforts, and some active C.P.C. and P.I. initiatives. A challenge is to be sure we are carrying A.A.'s message, not our own opinions, in matters like service, sponsorship, self-support, and singleness of purpose at all levels.—*Stu Elwing*

Additional Committee Considerations

Advisory Action 40 of the 1990 General Service Conference states: "Items discussed, but no action taken or recommendation made, as well as committee recommendations which are not adopted, be included in a separate section of the Final Report." All items, listed by committee, are as follows:

AGENDA

- The committee reviewed the General Service Conference Evaluation Form and made no changes.

ARCHIVES*

- The Conference Committee on Archives wishes to emphasize the importance of G.S.O.'s A.A. Archives as precious to all members of our Fellowship and wishes to express concern over staffing levels at G.S.O.'s A.A. Archives.
- The committee reviewed the Archives Workbook and expressed satisfaction with the contents.
- The committee discussed the following ideas to make A.A.'s archives and history more readily available to the Fellowship:
 - The committee requested that the trustees' Archives Committee create a report to be forwarded to the 2010 Conference Archives Committee on the feasibility of developing a format (e.g., PowerPoint® presentation) for a self-guided tour of G.S.O.'s A.A. Archives to convey the experience of visiting G.S.O. and the Archives, for those who have not yet visited the General Service Office in New York.
 - The committee requested that the trustees' Archives Committee consider a suggestion to add a daily historical reference to G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site to create interest and enthusiasm for A.A.'s history and archival collection.
 - The committee received a report from the Senior Archivist on archival activities since the last Conference in response to suggestions from the 2008 Conference Committee on various ideas for creatively making A.A.'s archives and history readily available to the Fellowship.

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

- The committee suggested that the voiceover of the text regarding anonymity and singleness of purpose in the C.P.C. video segments directed to professionals in the legal/criminal justice and medical fields currently streamed on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site be consistent with the C.P.C. video segment directed to professionals in the employment/human relations field.
- The committee suggested that the C.P.C. video segments directed to professionals in the legal/criminal justice, medical and employment/human relations fields be added in DVD format to the C.P.C. Kit and made available for purchase.
- The committee reviewed the current C.P.C. Kit and Workbook and suggested that appropriate references to the A.A. Grapevine in the C.P.C. Workbook be updated to include La Viña and La Vigne.
- The committee discussed specific possible uses of the A.A. Grapevine, La Viña and La Vigne in C.P.C. endeavors and suggested



*Members of this committee serve on this as a secondary committee assignment.

that the following helpful ideas for C.P.C. committee members be added to the C.P.C. Workbook:

- A.A. groups, individuals or committees participate in "Adopt a Professional" efforts and take a single issue to, or purchase a subscription for the professional.
- "Lose a Grapevine" by leaving an issue behind in a professional's office.
- Consider inviting A.A. Grapevine reps to participate in local C.P.C. presentations and exhibits.
- The committee requested that the staff and trustees consider creating a survey-style follow up letter to be completed by the professional after a C.P.C. contact to assess the effectiveness of the C.P.C. effort. This letter could address items such as the effectiveness of A.A. literature (including the A.A. Grapevine, La Viña and La Vigne), C.P.C. presentations and contact by A.A. members. This letter would be included in the Guide Letter Section of the C.P.C. Workbook.

CORRECTIONS

- The committee reviewed the contents of the Corrections Kit and Workbook and made the following suggestions:
 - That the list of contents be corrected to indicate that both the Corrections Correspondence Service flyer for the outside A.A. member (F-26) and the Corrections Correspondence request form for inmates (CCS-2) are included in the Kit.
 - That the Spanish-language and the French-language Corrections Kit contents be updated to match as closely as possible the English-language Kit. The committee heard a report from the Publications director that *A.A. in Prison: Inmate to Inmate* will be completed in Spanish by fall of 2009, and the DVD *A.A. in Correctional Facilities* will be available in a compilation of all three languages by the end of 2009.
 - That a copy of the booklet *A.A. in Prison: Inmate to Inmate* (in the appropriate language) be included in the Kits.
 - That the list of Corrections Kit Contents be placed on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site in the Corrections 'bucket' with the appropriate links to each service piece, pamphlet or book, where available.
- The committee considered alternatives to a biennial mailing to corrections professionals, and made the following suggestions:

- That the automatic biennial mailing begun by an additional committee consideration of the Conference Committee on Corrections in 1999 be suspended indefinitely.
- That the American Correctional Association Directory of Adult and Juvenile Correctional Departments, Institutions, Agencies and Probation and Parole continue to be purchased on a biennial basis and the contact information therein be sent to the relevant area corrections committee chair.
- The committee discussed issues that may be involved in A.A. members complying with the rules of correctional facilities, such as signing 'sponsorship agreements' or legally binding documents, and requested sharing from the A.A. Fellowship regarding this topic to be gathered by the staff member and the trustees' Committee on Corrections and that this sharing be sent to the 2010 Conference Committee on Corrections.

FINANCE

- The committee acknowledges that roughly half of all the A.A. groups contributing is not enough to support our services, yet agreed that funding services through voluntary contributions is our ideal. The committee affirms the General Service Board Policy previously adopted which reads as follows: "Self-Support of the World Services of Alcoholics Anonymous: The A.A. spiritual principle of self-support enables us to pursue our primary purpose of carrying the message to the still-suffering alcoholic with a shared sense of responsibility for our lifesaving work and without interference or financial dependence on outsiders. From our Fellowship's earliest days, the expenses of the General Service Office, and the world services provided by it, have exceeded the amount derived from contributions of A.A. groups and members. As a result, providing these needed services has necessarily been supported in part by income from the sale of A.A. literature. It is the policy of the General Service Board that income from literature sales should only be in amounts required to allow continued provision of vitally needed services and maintenance of a prudent reserve fund. We hope that the day will come when A.A. groups and members, through their contributions, will be able to fund fully the services provided by the General Service Office. If that is achieved, revenues from literature sales will only be needed in amounts necessary to cover the actual costs associated with literature production and to maintain a prudent reserve fund."
- The committee discussed a request to produce a Seventh Tradition poster and took no action. The committee felt that while visual aids are frequently helpful, it did not feel that there was a need for a



"Conference-approved" Seventh Tradition poster, but hoped that local areas might create visual aids that could be shared with others.

GRAPEVINE

- The committee discussed the contents of the A.A. Grapevine Workbook and noted that the new portable GvR Handbook requested by the 2008 Conference Committee on the A.A. Grapevine is scheduled for publication.

The committee also requested that the current A.A. Grapevine Workbook, *A Guide to the A.A. Grapevine*, continue to be posted on the A.A. Grapevine Web site as a free download.

The committee suggested that the location and description of the Workbook/Guide be reviewed to improve visibility and accessibility on the Web site.

- The committee considered a request that "the 2007 Conference Advisory Action recommending that 'the A.A. Grapevine and La Viña include a section on the medical, legal, and social aspects of alcoholism, with an appropriate disclaimer' be rescinded" and after lengthy and thoughtful discussion took no action.

- The committee requested that the disclaimer in the section on medical, legal and social aspects of alcoholism in the A.A. Grapevine (Alcoholism at Large) be placed more prominently and distinctively and that the language of the disclaimer in the A.A. Grapevine and La Viña be reviewed for both clarity and consistency.

- The committee considered a request that the 2004 Conference Advisory Action—"To allow the widest distribution of the A.A. Grapevine and La Viña to all purchasers, while guarding against affiliations with any outside enterprise, a) subscriptions to the A.A. Grapevine and La Viña magazines be issued only by A.A. Grapevine, Inc., or by A.A. trusted servants directly; and b) the A.A. Grapevine, Inc., adopt standardized sales practices and pricing structures for all purchasers. Note: This recommendation is to clarify the 1993 Advisory Action stating that the Grapevine Corporate Board not actively pursue the placement of Grapevine materials for resale in commercial (non-A.A.) outlets."—be rescinded and took no action. The committee noted that rescinding the 2004 Advisory Action would not have an impact on the 2009 subscription price.

- The committee supported the spirit of communication between the Grapevine Board and Conference members, as recommended in 1987 and reaffirmed in 1988 that: "The Grapevine staff be responsible for communicating updated information to the delegates at appropriate intervals regarding editorial, circulation/fulfillment, and financial matters."

- The committee expressed concerns regarding several changes and decisions made by the A.A. Grapevine office and Board in the last year, concerning items produced by A.A. Grapevine, Inc. The committee requested that the A.A. Grapevine Board review the history of Advisory Actions pertaining to the relationship between the A.A. Grapevine Board, A.A. Grapevine office and the



Conference Committee, on the decision-making process of matters that affect the Fellowship (i.e. pricing, redesign, name change and promotional items) and forward a report to the 60th General Service Conference Committee on the A.A. Grapevine for their review.

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/REGIONAL FORUMS*

- The committee requested that the trustees' Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums consider ways that the broadcast of the 2010 International Convention Opening Flag Ceremony could be made more widely available than was the 2005 broadcast.

- The committee discussed the site-selection process for the 2020 International Convention, and requested that the trustees' Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums conduct a review and inventory of the site-selection process for International Conventions and prepare a report for the 2010 Conference Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums.

- The committee discussed ways to encourage interest in Regional and Local Forums, including:

- Be enthusiastic in announcing the Forum in advance, and reporting on it afterwards.
- Write an article about the Forum for a local newsletter or Web site.
- Participation is key—get people involved in the planning of the Forum, as greeters, hospitality, registration, etc.
- Encourage all segments of the Fellowship to attend, including those who speak other languages.
- Seek ways to prevent conflicts with other local events, such as sharing weekend A.A. event schedules through a central office or intergroup.
- Let members know that Local Forums can be requested by any A.A. entity; the request does not need to come through the general service structure.
- Overcome challenges of the cost of attending Forums by encouraging members to ride together and share rooms; some areas have rented buses for members to travel together.

*Members of this committee serve on this as a secondary committee assignment.

LITERATURE

- The committee considered the request to publish a book of stories from members living in remote communities and took no action. The committee noted that there was no widely expressed need.
- The committee considered the request to develop a second volume of *Daily Reflections* and took no action.

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

- The committee reviewed the "General Service Board Summary of Responses to Inventory Questions Pertaining to Regional Composition and Structure" and expressed their gratitude to the General Service Board for their thorough discussion of the inventory questions.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

- The committee reviewed the 2008 Annual Report from the trustees' Committee on Public Information regarding G.S.O.'s A.A. Web Site.
- The committee considered the request to add the text "Provide initial motivation" to the section "What A.A. Does Not Do" in the flyer "A.A. at a Glance," and took no action. The committee requested that the trustees' Public Information Committee consider placing the full text of the section "What A.A. Does Not Do," from the service piece "Information on Alcoholics Anonymous," into the "What A.A. Does Not Do" section of the "A.A. at a Glance" flyer.
- The committee considered the request to develop a generic A.A. poster or posters for places such as hospitals, places of employment, doctors' offices, etc., and took no action. The committee noted that there is no widely expressed need for this item at this time and that experience with posters will be gained should the wall poster for young people become available.
- The committee reviewed current A.A. television public service announcements for relevance and usefulness, and suggested that no current television public service announcements be retired.
- The committee reviewed information on centralized distribution, tracking and evaluation of the 2008 A.A. television public service announcement "I Thought."
- The committee requested that the script be included in the packaging of the "Combination Radio P.S.A.s on CD."
- The committee requested that the trustees' Public Information Committee consider distribution options in addition to DVD for the A.A. Videos for Young People, e.g., placement on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site.
- The committee requested that the A.A. Videos for Young People Project continue, and that video submissions be encouraged from young people in the Fellowship, especially from Spanish-speaking members.
- The committee requested that the trustees' Public Information Committee consider the purpose, usefulness, frequency and methodology of the A.A. Membership Survey.
- The committee requested that the trustees' Public Information Committee develop text on the importance of not breaking the anonymity of living A.A. members in memorial announcements when one of our Fellowship dies. This text, intended for inclusion in the pamphlet "Understanding Anonymity," is requested to be

brought back to the 2010 Conference Committee on Public Information.

- The committee briefly discussed the use of the A.A. Grapevine and La Viña in Public Information endeavors.
- The committee reviewed the contents of the Public Information Kit and Workbook and requested that the pamphlets "Too Young?" and "A.A. for the Older Alcoholic—Never Too Late" be included.

REPORT AND CHARTER

- The committee received a locally developed G.S.R. Preamble and decided not to include it in *The A.A. Service Manual Combined With Twelve Concepts for World Service*. The committee recognized that the G.S.R. Preamble is not broadly utilized within the Fellowship and the ideals expressed already exist in G.S.R. Material.
- Editorial responsibilities of the Publications Department of the General Service Office regarding *The A.A. Service Manual Combined With Twelve Concepts for World Service* will be limited to the following:
 - Update financial and publication data that changes on an annual basis.
 - Revise dates that require periodic updating.
 - Correct typographical and spelling errors.
 - Maintain an accurate index and cross references.
- The committee reviewed a request from the A.A.W.S. Board to add text regarding the desirability of business or professional background for regional and at-large trustees to the section of *The A.A. Service Manual Combined With Twelve Concepts for World Service* on "Qualifications of an Effective Trustee" found on p. S63. The committee strongly believes that placing such limitations on those who are willing to serve might prevent the selection of the most qualified candidate.
- The committee considered a suggestion to insert the page reference "(see page S63)" in the section on Regional Trustees found on page S65 and decided it was not needed.
- The committee reviewed suggested revisions to Chapters 10 and 12 of *The A.A. Service Manual Combined With Twelve Concepts for World Service* submitted by the A.A. Grapevine Board. The Committee suggested that the A.A. Grapevine Board forward revisions of Chapters 10 and 12 to the 2010 Conference Committee on Report & Charter and:
 - Use the current version (2009-2010) of Chapters 10 and 12 as the basic text.
 - Include any new charts necessary to the text.
 - Provide reasons for the proposed revisions.

The committee also suggested that the A.A. Grapevine Board may wish to retain accurate historical information currently in *The A.A. Service Manual Combined With Twelve Concepts for World Service*.

- The committee is forwarding a request to clarify language regarding nominating a regional trustee candidate in the same year when nominating a trustee-at-large candidate to the 2010 Conference Committee on Trustees, as the request includes reference to the 1985 Conference Committee on Trustees Advisory Action, "no area shall submit an individual as candidate for both regional trustee and trustee-at-large U.S./Canada in the same year."

The committee noted inconsistencies in the current *A.A. Service Manual*, the current Conference Charter, and the 1985 Conference Advisory Action.

- The committee reviewed a list of proposed editorial changes to *The A.A. Service Manual Combined With Twelve Concepts for World Service* and forwarded them to the Publications Department.
- The committee reviewed a list of proposed editorial changes to *The A.A. Directories* and forwarded them to the Publications Department.
- The committee agreed to review the rough draft of the *Final Conference Report* and the tear sheets of *The A.A. Service Manual Combined With Twelve Concepts for World Service* with careful attention to accuracy and completeness of reporting. The committee agreed to return corrections or suggestions to the G.S.O. within 21 days of receipt.

TREATMENT

- The committee considered a proposal to include additional information on carrying A.A.'s message to treatment facilities with out-patient programs. The committee requested that the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities consider developing a section on carrying the A.A. message into out-patient treatment settings, using shared experience, for inclusion in the Treatment Facilities Workbook and the A.A. Guidelines on Treatment Facilities.

In addition, the committee suggested that staff continue to gather shared area experience regarding carrying the A.A. message into out-patient treatment settings and that the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities continue to explore ways to carry the A.A. message to treatment professionals and patients in out-patient settings.

- The committee discussed possible uses of the A.A. Grapevine and La Viña in Treatment Facilities endeavors and suggested that the A.A. Grapevine consider developing an annual treatment facilities issue similar to its annual Corrections issue. In addition, it was suggested that if a new treatment facilities issue is published that it be placed in the Treatment Facilities Kit.

It was also suggested that groups be encouraged to adopt a treatment facility or center for the purpose of providing subscriptions and/or back issues of the A.A. Grapevine.

- Upon review of the Treatment Facilities Kit and Workbook, the committee suggested that an A.A. Grapevine as well as the DVD *Hope: Alcoholics Anonymous*, be included in the kit.

It was also suggested that a one-page insert containing suggested uses/examples of the "Local Experiences" tab be added to the Treatment Facilities Kit.

TRUSTEES

- The committee reviewed the résumés and approved, as eligible for election, all candidates for East Central and Southeast regional trustee and for trustee-at-large/U.S.
- The committee thoroughly reviewed and unanimously accepted, with one correction noted, the report from the trustees' Committee on Nominating pertaining to the 2008 Additional Committee Consideration regarding Class B regional trustee and trustee-at-large successor terms in the event of an unexpected vacancy.

RECOMMENDATIONS THAT DID NOT RESULT IN CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTIONS

LITERATURE

- The committee recommended that the revised draft pamphlet "The A.A. Member—Medications and Other Drugs" be approved.
- The committee recommended updating the existing video/DVD, "Your A.A. General Service Office, the Grapevine, and the General Service Structure" and adding one episode on G.S.R. and one episode on D.C.M. to the video/DVD. The committee looks forward to reviewing a progress report or a revised video/DVD at the 2010 Conference. [Note: The approximate cost is \$64,000]
- The committee recommended that the trustees' Committee on Literature develop a questionnaire to gather input from the Fellowship on whether there is a need to develop Conference-approved literature that focuses on the topics of spirituality, and agnostics or atheists/nonbelievers in A.A., and that a report which includes a summary of the results from the responses to the questionnaire be presented to the 2010 Conference Committee on Literature.

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

- The committee recommended that as part of a procedure for the submission of minority appeals to the General Service Conference, minority appeals be presented directly to the General Service Conference without being reviewed, vetted or approved by any committee of either the Trustees or the Conference.

FLOOR ACTIONS THAT DID NOT RESULT IN CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTIONS

- Recommend that a thorough inventory of the charter be made a standing agenda item for the Conference Committee on Report and Charter. (**Conference voted not to consider**)
- Request a floor action with a needs assessment for Special Needs literature that includes scope, content and cost of such literature by trustees' Committee on Literature. (**Conference voted not to consider**)
- That the price increases proposed by Alcoholics Anonymous World Services in a letter dated March 20, 2009 be withdrawn and the current pricing structure be maintained. (**Not Approved**)
- To develop a uniform Conference-approved policy regarding full-face photography of actors or subjects appearing in our General Service Conference-approved videos/public service announcements/graphic arts projects before any new projects are placed in production. (**Not Approved**)
- The Kindle project/contract with Amazon.com be suspended immediately and a detailed review be conducted by the trustees' Literature Committee on the scope, substance, format, and pricing arrangements. This report is to be forwarded to the 2010 Conference Committee on Literature. (**Not Approved**)
- Do a voice over in the video "Hope – Alcoholics Anonymous" to change the discussion of the Traditions as "by-laws" to "guidelines" or some related term. (**Not Approved**)

Additional Committee Considerations

Advisory Action 40 of the 1990 General Service Conference states: "Items discussed, but no action taken or recommendation made, as well as committee recommendations which are not adopted, be included in a separate section of the Final Report." All items, listed by committee, are as follows:

AGENDA

- The committee reviewed the General Service Conference Evaluation Form with appreciation and made the following suggestions:

- Continue the daily color coding of the Evaluation Form.
- Add the date to each page.
- Bold Presentation Topics and Report Headings.

ARCHIVES¹

- The committee reviewed the contents of the Archives Workbook and accepted the revisions, including a minor change to the Photocopying Policy and new language to the section "What to Collect?," intended to provide more detailed information on the development of collection procedures for local use.

- The committee requested that the section "Role of the Archives Committee" in the Archives Workbook be revised to include:

- Suggested archives committees activities, to encourage interest in, and understanding of, the role and benefit of archives committees at the local level, for example: archives workshops, traveling exhibits, presentations and seeking out historical material from longtime A.A. members.
- Information for archives committees on how to implement, establish and support local archives.

- The committee accepted the report from the trustees' Archives Committee on the Feasibility of Developing a Self-guided Tour of G.S.O.'s Archives. The report included information from the archivist on the new Digital Archives Exhibit, which will be launched on the Archives portal of G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site.

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

- The committee reviewed the C.P.C. Kit and Workbook and made the following suggestions:

- The trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities/Special Needs-Accessibilities gather sharing from the Fellowship on the need to develop a sample format for one-on-one C.P.C. contact with professionals for inclusion in the C.P.C. Workbook.
- The first bullet on page 14 in the C.P.C. Workbook, be revised to read: "Consider showing videos such as the C.P.C. video 'A.A. Cooperation With the Professional Community,' 'Hope: Alcoholics Anonymous,' 'A.A. Videos for Young People,' at this point, or other videos appropriate for the audience."
- The trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities/Special Needs-Accessibilities explore including in the C.P.C. Kit and Workbook a service piece with Class A trustees' shared experiences em-

phasizing the value found in the continued use of the A.A. Grapevine, La Viña and La Vigne.

- The trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities/Special Needs-Accessibilities explore including in the C.P.C. Kit and Workbook a sample letter which reinforces the value to professionals of the A.A. Grapevine, La Viña and La Vigne as well as providing information on how the recipient may subscribe to the A.A. Grapevine, La Viña and La Vigne.

- The committee requested that the committee secretary and trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities/Special Needs-Accessibilities consider creating a process by which professionals attending national C.P.C. exhibits can request follow up contact with local C.P.C. committees.

- The committee requested that the committee secretary and trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities/Special Needs-Accessibilities consider adding to the *About A.A.* postal card a question to allow professionals to request follow-up contact with local C.P.C. committees.

- The committee requested that the committee secretary and trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities/Special Needs-Accessibilities discuss developing a method by which appropriate C.P.C. pamphlets and other materials may be consolidated on cost effective digital media such as CD and DVD in order to be distributed to professionals.

CORRECTIONS

- The committee reviewed with appreciation the progress report from the trustees' Committee on Corrections on revising the pamphlet "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell." The committee expressed its sincere thanks for the work already done on this revision, and encouraged the trustees' committee to consider the following criteria when updating photos, as per the 2009 Advisory Action:

- photos reflecting the principle of attraction.
- photos that convey the varieties of age, ethnicity, gender, culture and beliefs that our Fellowship so richly enjoys.
- visual aspects other than photos (i.e., graphics, illustrations, etc.).

- The committee reviewed with appreciation the progress report from the trustees' Committee on Corrections on signing sponsorship agreements and legally binding documents and requested that the staff member continue to gather sharing on local solutions A.A. members may use to resolve perceived differences between facility rules/regulations and what A.A. is and is not.

- The committee reviewed changes to the Corrections Workbook and Corrections Guidelines forwarded by the trustees' Committee on Corrections and requested that applicable changes reflect updated language in Conference-approved literature.

- The committee discussed discrepancies in the contents of the French language Corrections Workbook and suggested that the trustees' Committee on Corrections undertake an inventory of the contents of the Corrections Workbook in all three languages, and take appropriate steps to ensure consistency of content in these publications.

The committee also suggested that "missing" sections be translated as soon as possible and be made available as addendums until current inventory is depleted.

- The committee discussed at length the importance of having the Composition, Scope and Procedure for a particular Conference committee available in French or Spanish for any Conference committee member whose native language is not English.

FINANCE

- The committee reviewed and discussed input from the Fellowship concerning the 2009 Conference Advisory Action that the trustees' Finance Committee gather input from the Fellowship on the following: (1) If we continue to use literature profits to fund services, should there be a limit? (2) If there is a limit how do we continue to pay for services if there is a shortfall in contributions? The committee recognized that the majority of the sharing of the Fellowship was not in favor of a limit. The committee does not recommend that a specific limit should be placed on the use of literature profits to fund services. From all input gathered, the committee found that the Fellowship agrees with the trustees' policy on self-support which was affirmed at the 2009 Conference:

Self-Support of the World Services of Alcoholics Anonymous

The A.A. spiritual principle of self-support enables us to pursue our primary purpose of carrying the message to the still-suffering alcoholic with a shared sense of responsibility for our lifesaving work and without interference or financial dependence on outsiders. From our Fellowship's earliest days, the expenses of the General Service Office, and the world services provided by it, have exceeded the amount derived from contributions of A.A. groups and members. As a result, providing these needed services has necessarily been supported in part by income from the sale of A.A. literature. It is the policy of the General Service Board that income from literature sales should only be in amounts required to allow continued provision of vitally needed services and maintenance of a Prudent Reserve Fund. We hope that the day will come when A.A. groups and members, through their contributions, will be able to fund fully the services provided by the General Service Office. If that is achieved, revenues from literature sales will only be needed in amounts necessary to cover the actual costs associated with literature production and to maintain a Prudent Reserve Fund.

- The committee believes that more effective communication to the Fellowship as a whole is key to achieving this ideal and the committee has made recommendations to that end.
- The committee discussed additional ways to communicate with the Fellowship about Self-Support and forwards the following list of items to the 2011 Conference Finance Committee for further discussion:
 - 1) Birthday Plan.
 - 2) Seventh Tradition Pamphlet.
 - 3) Box 4-5-9 or Grapevine Articles.
 - 4) Finance Workbook/Tool Kit.
 - 5) Report Costs of Services to Members.
 - 6) Discuss Effects of Inflation.
 - 7) Add Additional Financial Information to the Web site.

GRAPEVINE

- The committee reviewed the A.A. Grapevine Board's History of Advisory Actions Report pertaining to the relationship between the A.A. Grapevine Board, A.A. Grapevine office and the Conference Committee on the A.A. Grapevine with appreciation and encourages this ongoing partnership and the continuation of the quarterly Conference Committee calls with the board and office, along with all of the board's recommendations in the Report, especially the board's recommendation for an annual report to the Conference Committee on the A.A. Grapevine.
- The committee reviewed the contents of the A.A. Grapevine Workbook and suggested that electronic updates be made to outdated material, while still preserving a digital version of the historic document, and these updates should be brought to the 2012 Conference Committee on the A.A. Grapevine.
- The committee discussed at length and agreed to forward to the A.A. Grapevine Corporate Board the suggestion that the A.A. Grapevine produce in the year 2011 or later:
 - Step by Step (working title): A collection of A.A. Grapevine stories on the Steps.
 - The Sponsorship Book (working title): A collection of stories on sponsorship.
 - Staying Sober Through Adversity (working title): A collection about handling the rough patches in sobriety.

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/ REGIONAL FORUMS¹

- The committee heard reports on the upcoming International Convention:
 - Over 37,000 people have registered for the Convention so far. About half of those have prepurchased the souvenir edition of *Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age* and the Special Issue of the Grapevine magazine.
 - Preparations are in place for the anonymity-protected broadcast of the Friday night Flag Ceremony. Invitations have already been sent to many of the flag bearers who were selected at random from registered A.A. members from each country.
 - For the second time, registration for an International Convention was made available online. While paper communications continue in order to make sure everyone has access to International Convention information, a large percentage of our attendees registered and made housing reservations online.
 - Notices are being included in Convention materials and meeting formats to emphasize A.A.'s anonymity Traditions to attendees.
 - Efforts are being made to insure that attendees are prepared for the Convention experience, and understand the challenges of weather and of getting around very large facilities.
- The committee reviewed the report from the trustees' committee on the site-selection procedure for International Conventions, and expressed gratitude for the trustees' committee's willingness to continue to review and improve the process.
- The committee discussed ways to encourage interest in Forums and attract first-time attendees and suggested the following:
 - Create local flyers to carry the message about future Forums in the region.

¹Members of this committee serve on this as a secondary committee assignment.

- Utilize electronic communication from the areas to the Fellowship.
- Share about the Forum Orientation for first-time Forum attendees.
- Encourage members to bring others, such as sponsees, along to Forums.
- Coordinate fun "road trips" to Forums—"Fill the car; bring them all!"
- Share the Forum experience with others and with enthusiasm.
- Attraction, attraction, attraction!

LITERATURE

- The committee considered a request to define the editorial responsibility of G.S.O.'s Publications Department and took no action. The committee expressed appreciation for the request, noting the concern for Conference-approved literature and for the Conference process, and agreed that current practices followed by G.S.O.'s Publications Department are appropriate.
- The committee considered a request that the video, "Your General Service Office, the Grapevine and the General Service Structure" be revised and updated and took no action. The committee noted that there was no widely expressed need for a new video and that the information in the video was still relevant and useful in describing the A.A. service structure.
- The committee considered a request to develop a book on the history of "early pioneer women in A.A." and took no action. The committee expressed appreciation for the request but considered that there was not a widely expressed need for a Conference-approved book on the history of early pioneer women in A.A.

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

No additional committee considerations.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

- The committee agreed to forward to the 2011 Conference Committee on the Agenda a request to hold a future General Service Conference on the theme "Anonymity in a Digital Age."
- The committee reviewed the 2009 Annual Report from the trustees' Public Information Committee regarding G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site, noted that the Web site seemed to be very well managed, and appreciated that numerous steps previously required to get an item placed on the Web site have been streamlined.
- The committee suggested that particular consideration be given to developing a more effective distribution of Spanish and French language public service announcements to Spanish and French language stations, including exploring possible assignment of telecaster numbers to older public service announcements in Canada.
- The committee reviewed all of the current A.A. TV public service announcements and agreed with the report of the trustees' Public Information Committee that found them all to be relevant and useful.
- The committee assessed the need for a new A.A. TV public service announcement and agreed with the report of the

trustees' Public Information Committee that none was needed at this time. However, the committee recognized the need to have a public service announcement tracked and distributed on a yearly basis.

The committee requested that the trustees' Public Information Committee consider developing a plan to redistribute and track an older A.A. T.V. public service announcement in the years when a new public service announcement is not being distributed.

- The committee suggested that the trustees' Public Information Committee replace the "What A.A. Does Not Do" section of the service piece "Information on Alcoholics Anonymous" with the revised "What A.A. Does Not Do" section of "A.A. at a Glance."
- The committee requested that the trustees' Public Information Committee develop draft text on the topic of anonymity in a digital age for the Conference-approved pamphlet "Understanding Anonymity" for review by the 2011 Conference Committee on Public Information.
- The committee requested that the trustees' Public Information Committee develop an answer to the question "What should I tell my loved ones about protecting the anonymity of the A.A. members they may meet?" for inclusion in the Conference-approved pamphlet "Understanding Anonymity" as a new second question and answer in the section "Some questions and answers about anonymity/personal anonymity" on page 7. The draft text will be brought back to the 2011 Conference Committee on Public Information.
- The committee suggested that delegates utilize a variety of means, such as workshops, newsletters, panels, delegate reports, area Web sites, etc., to stimulate A.A. members' discussion on how to maintain anonymity on online media, such as social networking sites.
- The committee discussed the "A.A. Guideline on the Internet" and suggested that it be more prominently placed on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site.
- The committee expressed gratitude for the obvious time and commitment on the part of the trustees' Public Information Committee to the A.A. Videos for Young People Project and agreed with the trustees' suggestions that:
 - Use and distribution of videos from the A.A. Videos for Young People Project, including those already approved by the Conference, will be at the discretion of the trustees' Public Information Committee.
 - The trustees' Public Information Committee may group similar items, stream individual or multiple items on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site, create DVD compilations, and produce video loops for use at C.P.C. events.
 - All video submissions that are not used in their entirety, with permission, will be kept on file at G.S.O. and may be edited for inclusion in future young people's video projects.
- The committee enthusiastically encourages continuation of the A.A. Videos for Young People Project. They suggested that the A.A. Videos for Young People Project submission form be listed periodically in the A.A. Grapevine, La Viña, and La Vigne.
- The committee reviewed the contents of the Public Information Kit and Workbook and suggested that an issue of the A.A. Grapevine, La Viña, or La Vigne be added to the contents of the kit.

REPORT AND CHARTER

- The committee reviewed a report from the Publications Department outlining the General Service Office process for timely and accurate preparation and publication of *The A.A. Service Manual* 2010-2011 Edition, and suggested two changes to the process.
- In keeping with the 2009 Advisory Action that the A.A. Grapevine Board annually review *The A.A. Service Manual* and forward necessary updates to the Conference Committee on Report and Charter, the committee reviewed with appreciation the updates from the A.A. Grapevine Board for *The A.A. Service Manual* and suggested some revisions.
- In keeping with the 2009 Advisory Action that the A.A.W.S. Board annually review *The A.A. Service Manual* and forward necessary updates to the Conference Committee on Report and Charter, the committee reviewed with appreciation the updates from the A.A.W.S. Board for *The A.A. Service Manual* and suggested some revisions.
- In keeping with the 2009 Advisory Action that the General Service Board annually review *The A.A. Service Manual* and forward necessary updates to the Conference Committee on Report and Charter, the committee reviewed with appreciation the updates from the General Service Board for *The A.A. Service Manual* and suggested some revisions.
- The committee reviewed the list of editorial updates from the Publications Department for *The A.A. Service Manual* and added additional updates.
- The committee agreed to add the sentence, "The Report and Charter Committee has reviewed and accepted these changes." to the note on the bottom of the page in *The A.A. Service Manual* that lists annual changes to the Manual (currently on page S123, 2009-2010 Edition).
- The committee considered a request to (a) publish and distribute *The A.A. Service Manual* every other year and in years not produced, distribute a supplement of changes, and (b) publish the A.A. directories (Canada, Eastern U.S. and Western U.S.) in alternate years when the *Service Manual* is not published and took no action. The committee noted the importance of publishing *The A.A. Service Manual* annually and that it be as current and accurate as possible.
- The committee considered a request that *The A.A. Service Manual* "be reprinted only as necessary and consider publishing every three to five years with changes being sent as inserts to existing manuals," and took no action.
- The committee considered a request to gather sharing from the Fellowship concerning the general nature of *The A.A. Service Manual* and took no action. The committee agreed that there was no widely expressed need for this sharing.
- The committee agreed to add the text "(see Chapter Eleven)" in the paragraph under the heading *Tools Available from G.S.O.* in Chapter One in *The A.A. Service Manual* so that the sentence reads: "They are designed to show groups the kind of help that is offered to groups everywhere by G.S.O., and thus get more people interested in service activity (see Chapter Eleven)."
- The committee considered a request to place *Additional Committee Considerations, Recommendations That Did Not Result in Advisory Actions and Floor Actions That Did Not Result in Advisory Actions* following the Advisory Actions in the Conference *Final Report*, and took no action. The committee agreed that the current placement in the *Final Report* continues to work well.

TREATMENT FACILITIES/ SPECIAL NEEDS-ACCESSIBILITIES

- The committee reviewed and accepted the progress report from the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities/Special Needs-Accessibilities regarding the proposed Special Needs recovery pamphlet and requested that:
 - In the first paragraph, second sentence under the proposed introduction "Do You Have a Drinking Problem?" other language be considered that is more special needs focused.
 - In all aspects of pamphlet development, the use of language that is inclusive of a wide variety of special needs be continued.
- The committee considered a suggestion to change the name of "Treatment Facilities" Committee to "Treatment" Committee and took no action. The committee requested that the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities/Special Needs-Accessibilities forward to the 2011 Conference Committee on Treatment Facilities/Special Needs-Accessibilities background which would include details regarding the impact of such a name change on, among other things: titles of relevant A.A. literature; contents of relevant A.A. literature; and the focus of A.A. service committee work.
- The committee considered two locally created Bridging the Gap forms (one for treatment clients and one for A.A. members willing to serve as temporary contacts) and requested that the trustees develop and include sample forms in the Treatment Facilities Workbook, taking into consideration exemplars from other local committees.
- Upon review of the Treatment Facilities Kit and Workbook, the committee suggested that the following changes/additions be made where fiscally feasible:
 - The DVD *Hope: Alcoholics Anonymous* be added in a hole-punched vinyl sleeve instead of in the current jewel box casing.
 - The Young People's videos be included in the Kit as a suggested tool for use with young people in treatment.
 - That suggestions for use of the two DVDs and the A.A. Grapevine be included in the Kit.
 - That changes be made in the Treatment Facilities Workbook to reflect that the A.A. message is carried to alcoholics in a wide variety of treatment settings, including outpatient settings.
- Upon review of the Special Needs Kit and Workbook, the committee suggested that:
 - The Kit be incorporated in a three-ring binder instead of the current pocket folder to achieve parity with other service Kits.
 - Shared experience with carrying the A.A. message to those with less visible challenges, such as illiteracy, autism, etc., be gathered and added to the Special Needs Workbook when feasible.

TRUSTEES

- The committee agreed to forward to the 2011 Conference Committee on Report and Charter a request to clarify language and resolve inconsistencies in *The A.A. Service Manual* regarding nominating a regional trustee and a trustee-at-large candidate in

the same year. They reviewed Conference Advisory Actions regarding this matter and suggested the following language, which reflects the policy decisions in those actions.

On page S65 of the 2009-2010 Edition of *The A.A. Service Manual* in the Regional Trustee Elections Procedures replace:

"2. Two Conference Actions should be kept in mind. In 1977, the Conference recommended that a delegate not be eligible as a trustee candidate until one year after his or her last Conference. And in 1983, it was recommended that 'no area shall submit an individual as candidate for both regional trustee and trustee-at-large U.S./Canada in the same year.'"

With:

"2. Prior Conferences have recommended that no area submit the same person as a candidate for both regional trustee and trustee-at-large/U.S. or Canada at the same Conference. Also, a General Service Conference delegate is not eligible as a trustee candidate until one year after his or her last Conference."

On page S67 of the 2009-2010 Edition of *The A.A. Service Manual* in the Trustees-at-Large Election Procedure replace:

"In the areas, the same procedure used in selecting a regional trustee candidate is followed. No area should submit the same name for regional and at-large trustee in the same year."

With:

"Prior Conferences have recommended that no area submit the same person as a candidate for both regional trustee and trustee-at-large/U.S. or Canada at the same Conference. Also, a General Service Conference delegate is not eligible as a trustee candidate until one year after his or her last Conference."

Note: When these changes are made to *The A.A. Service Manual* the committee would ask that the trustees' Committee on Nominating consider using similar language in Procedure No. 11 "Procedure For Electing Regional Trustee Candidates in the U.S. and Canada" and No. 12 "Procedures For Electing A Candidate For trustee-at-large/U.S. or Canada."

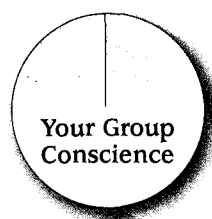
- The committee reviewed the resumes and approved, as eligible for election, all candidates for Pacific and Eastern Canada regional trustee.
- The committee reviewed their Composition, Scope and Procedure and updated the reference to "Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities" found in their Scope to "Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities/Special Needs-Accessibilities."
- At present, in two regions (Southeast and East Central) the elections of regional and at-large trustee occur in the same year. Since no area can submit the same person as candidate for regional and at-large trustee in the same year, the committee feels that A.A. members in the two regions do not have the same opportunity for participation in our service structure as they do in the other six regions. In six of the regions the same person has the opportunity to stand for both regional and at-large trustee every four years. In the other two regions the same person has only the opportunity to stand for one of these two trustee positions every four years. Therefore, the committee requests that the trustees' Committee on Nominating explore benefits and liabilities of allowing the same person to be submitted as candidate for both regional trustee and trustee-at-large at the same Conference.

- The committee discussed unplanned regional trustee vacancies that are left unfilled. The committee requested that the trustees' Committee on Nominating explore the impact on the boards (General Service Board, A.A. World Services Board and the A.A. Grapevine Board) if a change in regional trustee rotation were to occur, and to bring a report to the 2011 Conference Committee on Trustees.
- The committee discussed unplanned Class A and general service trustee vacancies that are left unfilled. The committee requested that the trustees' Committee on Nominating explore the impact on the boards (General Service Board, A.A. World Services Board and the A.A. Grapevine Board) when such vacancies occur and bring a report to the 2011 Conference Committee on Trustees.

RECOMMENDATIONS THAT DID NOT RESULT IN CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTIONS

FINANCE

- The committee considered a request to replace the "pie chart" on page 12 with text in the pamphlet "Self-Support: Where Money and Spirituality Mix" and recommended the following changes:
- "AND" be replaced with "OR" between the pie charts that start on page 12 and an additional "OR" added after the second pie chart.
- Replace the Q & A on page 13 with the text "Each group is autonomous and its informed conscience should determine the contribution amounts to the following entities: District, Area, G.S.O. and Intergroup/Central Office, if one services your locality" and insert an additional blank pie chart afterwards.



District	_____ %
Area	_____ %
G.S.O.	_____ %
Intergroup/Central Office	_____ %
Other	_____ %
Other	_____ %

See Floor Action #3

LITERATURE

- The committee recommended that the revised pamphlet "The A.A. Member-Medications and Other Drugs" be approved. (See Floor Action #2)

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

- The committee recommended that the following procedure for the submission of Concept V minority appeals to the General Service Conference be established noting that staffs, committees, corporate boards or trustees, as referenced on page 22 of *The A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts for World Service*, are entitled to submit a minority appeal to the Conference (the Committee on Policy/Admissions agreed that "committees" as stated in the first paragraph of Concept V refers to trustees committees):

- 1) Historically, a minority appeal to the General Service Conference has been very rare. It is hoped that an individual entitled under Concept V to make an appeal would exhaust every avenue offered within the General Service Conference structure prior to making a minority appeal to the General Service Conference.
- 2) The minority should announce to the chair of the General Service Board, the General Service Conference delegate chair and to the General Service Office Conference coordinator that it intends to present an appeal under Concept V to the General Service Conference.
- 3) Minority appeals are to be submitted in writing 30 days prior to the General Service Conference. However, appeals may be received up to the beginning of the General Service Conference Opening Session, but, the closer to the Conference a minority appeal submission is made the more difficult it is for the General Service Office to process the background and for Conference members to fairly appraise the material. Appeals submitted later than the 30 day deadline run the risk of the matter not being heard.
- 4) The individual entitled to make an appeal under Concept V should be mindful of the logistical and practical limitations involved with organizing and distributing the written appeal if it were to be submitted after the 30 day minimum deadline prior to the General Service Conference.
- 5) All Conference members will be given notice of the minority's decision to file an appeal.
- 6) The Concept V appeal and any background should be sent to the G.S.O. Conference coordinator for distribution as soon as possible prior to the 30 day deadline. The G.S.O. Conference coordinator will be responsible for seeing that the written minority appeal, including the minority report and its documentation, are physically made available to the Conference. G.S.O. will distribute the minority report and background to all Conference members within ten business days after their receipt if feasible.
- 7) If there is a defined majority, it would be appropriate to have the majority's side presented at the General Service Conference, along with the appeal, so that all sides would be fairly represented. Both minority and majority should have material available. If the minority does not provide all of its material prior to the 30 day deadline, it will be difficult for the majority to prepare its response.
- 8) In order to acquaint the Conference members with the substance of the appeal, the minority appeal will be presented immediately following the portion of the Opening Session referred to as the "Mechanics of the Conference."
- 9) The submitter will have ten minutes to present their appeal.
- 10) After the submitter has presented their appeal, the Conference will vote to determine whether the Conference debates the minority appeal or not. It would take a simple majority vote to debate the appeal.
- 11) Should the Conference vote to debate the appeal, the appeal

will be debated after all Conference committee reports have been heard, at which time, if there is a defined majority, a designated representative of the majority will be allowed ten minutes to present the majority position.

- 12) Whether or not the appeal is debated, all Concept V minority appeals will be printed in full in the *Final Conference Report* omitting the background material. **(See Floor Action #1)**

REPORT AND CHARTER

- The committee recommended that the A.A. Directories (Canada, Western U.S., and Eastern U.S.) be published annually and that the General Service Office continue exploring other methods of providing the information in the directories.
- The committee recommended that areas may choose to opt-out of the 30-day pending period to complete processing of new groups.

FLOOR ACTIONS THAT DID NOT RESULT IN CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTIONS

- Propose that the A.A. General Service Board develop an A.A. Guideline relating to "YPAA," to be presented to the 2011 General Service Conference. **(Conference voted not to consider)**
- Future Conference-approved videos will carry both an audio and visual disclaimer that state the following:

"Protection of the anonymity of A.A. members is a fundamental principle of Alcoholics Anonymous. In this production, no member of Alcoholics Anonymous appears in full face or otherwise identifiable." **(Not Approved)**
- Recommend that a policy be created that does not allow full faces of members or actors portraying A.A. members or potential A.A. members in Conference-approved visual media. **(Conference voted not to consider)**
- The video "Hope: Alcoholics Anonymous" be withdrawn from distribution until the policy of showing full faces of actors who are portraying A.A. members in Conference-approved visual media is resolved. **(Conference voted not to consider)**
- Publishing *La Viña* as a bimonthly, perfect-bound, black & white, 68 page issue at an additional estimated cost of \$21,400 per year beginning in 2011, followed by a year of review and assessment in 2012. The results of this review and assessment will be brought to the 2013 Conference Committee on the Grapevine. **(Not Approved)**
- That the board of directors of the Grapevine and A.A.W.S. be directed to combine the catalogs from Grapevine and A.A.W.S. into one catalog. **(Conference voted not to consider)**
- A delegate area may opt out of the 30-day pending period to complete processing of new groups on either a group by group or annual basis by either the delegate or delegate's appointee notifying the Records Department of the General Service Office. **(Conference voted not to consider)**

■ **Additional Committee Considerations**

Advisory Action 40 of the 1990 General Service Conference states: "Items discussed, but no action taken or recommendation made, as well as committee recommendations which are not adopted, be included in a separate section of the Final Report." All items, listed by committee, are as follows:

AGENDA

- The committee discussed a request from the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference to consider reducing the number of presentation/discussion topics planned for the 2012 General Service Conference and agreed to reduce the number of presentation/discussion topics to two for the 2012 General Service Conference.
- The committee considered a request that the trustee's Committee on the Conference meet annually with the Conference Committee on Agenda to address matters concerning the Conference agenda. Following a lengthy discussion, the committee requested that the trustees' Committee on Conference meet/confer with the Conference Committee on Agenda prior to the winter Quarterly Board meeting to address matters concerning the Conference week agenda.

ARCHIVES¹

- The committee reviewed the contents of the Archives Workbook and accepted the revisions, including a minor change to the Research Application Form and a new section, "Tools and Suggested Activities For Archives Committees," which will provide sharing and suggestions for Archives committees.
- The committee requested that the G.S.O. Archivist solicit new material and stories for the "Shared Experiences" section of the Archives Workbook, by contacting area archivists and area Archives Committee chairs via a memorandum, with a copy to area delegates, so that this section can be updated in a future printing of the Workbook. The committee also requested that the "Shared Experiences" section be updated every five years.
- The committee requested that the trustees' Archives Committee develop an informational piece on basic archival preservation procedures intended to provide guidance to local archivists responsible for maintaining the physical and intellectual integrity of the collection.

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

- The committee agreed that the concept of combining the A.A. Cooperation With the Professional Community DVD with a compilation of C.P.C. literature would be very useful in C.P.C. service work. The committee requested the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities/Special Needs-Accessibilities explore replacing the current A.A. Cooperation With the Professional Community DVD with a new DVD compilation that includes the following existing material:
 - Table of contents
 - Introduction letter that includes references to aa.org and the resources available for professionals on the Web site

- "If You are a Professional ..."
- Information on Alcoholics Anonymous
- "A.A. Membership Survey"
- "Alcoholics Anonymous in Your Community"
- *About A.A.* — Newsletter for Professional (3-4 selected issues)
- "Is A.A. for Me?"
- A.A. Cooperation With the Professional Community videos

The committee requested that the trustees bring back a report and draft product to the 2012 Conference Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community.

- The committee discussed a draft sample letter to professionals on how they might use the A.A. Grapevine, La Viña and La Vigne and took no action.
- The committee reviewed a draft service piece regarding use of the A.A. Grapevine and La Viña in C.P.C. endeavors and suggested including the piece in the C.P.C. Kit with minor edits suggested by the committee.
- The committee reviewed the C.P.C. Kit and Workbook and made the following suggestions:
 - That a list of goals and project suggestions for C.P.C. committees be added to the C.P.C. Workbook.
 - The committee reviewed the Fellowship sharing on formats for one-on-one contact with professionals. The committee requested that a summary of shared experience from C.P.C. committees and professionals for one-on-one C.P.C. contact with professionals be included in the C.P.C. Workbook.
 - The committee suggested adding two bullets on page 20 of the C.P.C. Workbook regarding suggested elements in C.P.C. letters:
 - Invitation to accompany professionals or students to open A.A. meetings.
 - Invitation to present on what A.A. is and is not.

CORRECTIONS

- The committee reviewed the progress report from the trustees' Committee on Corrections on revising the pamphlet "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell." The committee particularly agreed with the suggestion already forwarded to the Publications Department to include content in the draft revision that would appeal to the young incarcerated alcoholic. The committee looks forward to seeing a full draft of the revised pamphlet at the 2012 General Service Conference, and encourages the Publications Department to consider a more standard pamphlet-sized format, if feasible, while still preserving the elements of the existing easy-to-read format.
- The committee discussed the possible need for a comprehensive survey of A.A. program activities in Correctional Facilities similar to the one conducted in 1990, and requested the trustees' Committee on Corrections explore the need for such a survey and report back to the 2012 Conference Committee on Corrections.
- The committee reviewed the Kit and Workbook and forwarded a list of suggestions to the trustees' Committee on Corrections regarding content. The committee requested that a process be established for updating the Workbook at each printing, which will ensure accurate references to items such as page numbers, A.A. publications, current terminology and statistical information. The committee also suggested that new Corrections chairs be informed that new A.A. material may be available that is not yet reflected in the current catalogue.

FINANCE

- The committee reviewed the Seventh Tradition stories received to date and encouraged that the collection process continue. The committee suggests that the trustees or office can use any stories received to date if the occasion arises.
- The committee discussed a request that the trustees' Finance Committee develop a Finance Workbook and felt a workbook was not necessary at this time as there is a wealth of information currently available.
- The committee discussed a request that the trustees' Finance Committee convert the Self-Support packet F-19 to a comprehensive Self-Support Kit. The committee requested that the trustees' Finance Committee develop a draft Self-Support Kit to be brought back to the 2012 Conference Finance Committee for review. The kit would include, but not be limited to:

- M-21 *I Am Responsible* wallet card
- M-23 *Final Conference Report* (current year)
- MG-15 A.A. Guidelines on Finance
- P-16 "The A.A. Group" pamphlet
- P-43 "Twelve Traditions Illustrated"
- P-44 "A.A.'s Legacy of Service"
- MS-20 Traditions Checklist from the A.A. Grapevine
- F-42 Self-Support Green Card
- FR-2 A.A. Group Contribution Envelope
- FR-5 A.A. Birthday Contribution Envelope & Birthday Plan Cover letter
- FV-19 Self-Support Packet — with updated flyers
- SMF-176 Services Provided by G.S.O./A.A.W.S.

- The Conference Finance Committee requests that the trustees' Finance Committee prepare a simple document of Self-Support/Financial Talking Points to be used by the Fellowship, made available on G.S.O.'s Web site, in the G.S.R. and D.C.M. packets, and in the Self-Support Kit.

GRAPEVINE

- The committee considered permitting A.A. Grapevine, Inc., to accept contributions, limited to the same General Service Board contribution policy, to be used for operation expenses with excess funds continuing to be forwarded to the Reserve Fund and agreed to take no action. The committee noted that the current financial structure is appropriate.
- The committee reviewed the contents of the A.A. Grapevine Workbook with appreciation.
- The committee discussed at length and agreed to forward to the A.A. Grapevine Corporate Board the suggestion that the A.A. Grapevine produce in the year 2012 or later:
 - Working the Program (working title)
A collection of AA Grapevine stories on recovery from alcoholism
 - Happy, Joyous, and Free (working title)
A collection of AA Grapevine stories reflecting experience, strength, hope and humor
 - Young and New to AA (working title)
A collection about getting sober young from those who have done it

- In order to adhere to our spiritual principle of self-support, the Conference Committee on the A.A. Grapevine suggests that the A.A. Grapevine Board only propose balanced operating budgets to the General Service Board.

- A single issue of Grapevine, La Viña and/or La Vigne magazine be included, with an introductory letter that offers AAGrapevine.org information, in the GSR packet for all new G.S.R.s. Format and costs are to be determined jointly by A.A. Grapevine and A.A.W.S.
- Encourage each home group to purchase a minimum of two annual subscriptions.
- The A.A. Grapevine Board look at distribution techniques of journals similar to the Grapevine, including La Vigne, as well as other General Service structure journals.

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/ REGIONAL FORUMS¹

- The committee accepted the reporting on the 2010 International Convention and noted that the financial results of the Convention showed a profit of \$844,545.
- The committee expressed appreciation to the 2010 International Convention coordinator, Rick Walker, for coordinating a successful event celebrating A.A.'s 75th anniversary in San Antonio, Texas. Gratitude was also expressed to the volunteers of the local Host Committee.
- The committee discussed the importance of Regional Forums and how Forums foster unity, enhance communication and provide a unique opportunity for local A.A.s to meet Board members, G.S.O. and Grapevine staff and trusted servants from the region. The committee noted that in 2010, over 1,500 first time Forums attendees were welcomed at Forums.
- The committee discussed ways to encourage interest in Forums and how areas communicate about upcoming Forums. The committee noted that flyers for upcoming Forums are being sent electronically from G.S.O. to delegates and D.C.M.s, and the information is accessible through G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site. In addition to announcements in local A.A. newsletters, bulletins, at assemblies and meetings, and local distribution of Forum Flyers, some local A.A. Web sites include the Forum Flyer or hyperlink to Forum information and registration on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site.

LITERATURE

- The committee reviewed and accepted a progress report from the trustees' Literature Committee on the revision of the pamphlet "A.A. and the Armed Services." The committee expressed appreciation for the work done by the trustees and provided several suggestions for the development of the pamphlet, and asked that a draft pamphlet or report be brought to the 2012 Conference Committee on Literature for review.
- The committee reviewed the draft revisions to the *Living Sober* booklet forwarded by the trustees' Literature Committee. The committee expressed appreciation for the revisions suggested, and requested that the trustees' Literature Committee continue to review the booklet *Living Sober*, focusing on outdated language and/or practices, and provide a new revision to the 2012 Conference Committee on Literature for consideration.
- The committee considered a request to develop an item similar to the Self-support card or "green card" to help promote the use of

¹Members of this committee serve on this as a secondary committee assignment.

our literature as a Twelfth Step tool and took no action. They noted that when an item to promote the use of A.A. literature as a Twelfth Step tool is needed, the language and format of this tool is generally best decided by each A.A. service committee or entity, based on their needs and experience.

- The committee considered the request to reconsider the 2010 Conference Advisory Action that “the trustees’ Literature Committee develop literature which focuses on spirituality that includes stories from atheists and agnostics who are successfully sober in Alcoholics Anonymous,” and after thoughtful discussion agreed to take no action. The committee noted that the trustees’ Literature Committee’s report on the development of literature which focuses on spirituality clarifies that the pamphlet under development will reflect a wide range of spiritual experiences of A.A. members.
- The committee considered a request to develop a publication about the General Service Office and agreed to take no action at this time. The committee noted that Conference-approved materials describing the General Service Office are currently available.

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

- The committee noted that Donald Sheets, the former Panel 61 delegate for Area 22, Northern Indiana, resigned. In February 2011 Ron Foor was elected as the new Panel 61 delegate for Area 22. Therefore, no recommendation from the Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions was required in order to seat him as a Conference member at the 61st General Service Conference.
- The committee had lengthy discussion on a request to change the deadline for the submission of Conference Agenda items, and took no action. Acknowledging the challenge of communicating about agenda items within a short time frame, the committee noted that many delegates are taking advantage of current technology in order to facilitate timely distribution of background within their areas.
- The committee discussed a request that a formal relationship be developed between the Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions and the trustees’ Conference Committee to address matters of policy relating to the General Service Conference and took no action.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

- The committee reviewed and accepted the 2010 Annual Report from the trustees’ Public Information Committee regarding G.S.O.’s A.A. Web site.
- The committee expressed support for the trustees’ Public Information Committee development of a comprehensive media plan.
- The committee reviewed all of the current A.A. T.V. public service announcements and agreed with the trustees’ Public Information Committee’s report that found them all to be relevant and useful.
- The committee suggested that “The A.A. Fact File” be revised and updated every three years.
- The committee suggested that the trustees’ Public Information Committee explore alternative packaging of the Public Information Kit and report back to the 2012 Conference Committee on Public Information including cost information.

REPORT AND CHARTER

- The committee accepted a report from the Publications Department outlining the General Service Office process for timely and accurate preparation and publication of *The A.A. Service Manual* 2011-2012 Edition, and the 2011 General Service Conference Final Report.
- In keeping with the 2009 Advisory Action that the A.A.W.S. Board annually review *The A.A. Service Manual* and forward necessary updates to the Conference Committee on Report and Charter, the committee reviewed the updates from the A.A.W.S. Board for *The A.A. Service Manual* and suggested some revisions. The committee suggested that the A.A.W.S. Board consider adding examples to clarify what “other entities” refers to on page S74 in the last paragraph under FINANCIAL SUPPORT.
- The committee reviewed the list of editorial updates from the Publications Department for *The A.A. Service Manual* and suggested some revisions.
- The committee considered the request to change the phrase “new kid on the block” with “a first year Delegate” on page S52 under Personal Experience in section “Preparing for the Conference” in *The A.A. Service Manual* and took no action. The committee agreed that this quote from a past delegate should not be altered and it adequately expresses the sentiment.
- The committee briefly discussed the A.A. Directories and noted that there were no requests for changes to the A.A. Directories.

TREATMENT FACILITIES/ SPECIAL NEEDS-ACCESSIBILITIES

- The committee suggested that when the pamphlet for alcoholics with special needs is created, formats for alcoholics who are deaf, blind, or have learning challenges be produced as soon as fiscally possible.
- The committee requested that the term “treatment facilities” be replaced with a more appropriate reference such as “Treatment Committee,” “Treatment Committee Kit,” “A.A. Guidelines on Treatment Committees,” etc. wherever it appears in service material.
- The committee considered removing one line of dialog from the video “Hope: Alcoholics Anonymous” and took no action. The committee requested instead that the trustees’ Committee review the entire script of the video, taking into consideration concerns expressed by the Conference Committee, and return a progress report to the 2012 Conference Committee on Treatment/Special Needs-Accessibilities.
- Upon review of the Treatment Facilities Kit and Workbook, the committee:
 - Expressed appreciation for the slimmer, less fragile, DVD case to be used for the videos in the Kits in place of the current DVD casings at no additional cost.
 - Suggested that the section on “Carrying the Message Into Noncorrectional Youth Facilities” in the Workbook be reviewed by the trustees’ Committee for appropriate emphasis on the safety of the A.A. members and the youths involved.
 - Reviewed the two suggested Bridging the Gap forms, one for A.A. members requesting a temporary contact to help them connect to A.A. on the outside, and one for A.A. members willing to serve as temporary contacts, and accepted them with minor editorial changes.

- Upon review of the Special Needs Kit and Workbook, the committee:

- Hoped that there will continue to be A.A. Grapevine issues that include stories from A.A. members with special needs.
- Expressed appreciation for the recent repricing of the American Sign Language (ASL) DVDs of the books *Alcoholics Anonymous* and *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, and hopes that special needs formats will continue to be priced in accordance with their corresponding standard formats wherever fiscally possible.

TRUSTEES

- The committee requested that the trustees' Nominating Committee examine the impact of the Conference disapproving a recommended slate and bring a report back to the 2012 Conference Committee on Trustees.

RECOMMENDATIONS THAT DID NOT RESULT IN CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTIONS

GRAPEVINE

- After extensive review and discussion of the results of the surveys conducted per the 2010 Conference Advisory Action, the Committee recommended that, in order to encourage unity and to support A.A. Grapevine, Inc., the A.A. Grapevine Board establish an ad hoc committee to review and determine actionable items from the A.A. Grapevine Fellowship Sharing Report and that the ad hoc committee have a proportional representation similar to the General Service Conference and be chaired by the chair of the General Service Board.

LITERATURE

- The committee recommended that the A.A. Preamble be added to the front inside pages of the Big Book and asked that the trustees' Literature Committee provide a report that includes sample placement options, and any other consideration, to the 2012 Conference Committee on Literature for review.

REPORT AND CHARTER

- The committee discussed a request to "address and remedy the inconsistencies" between the Current Conference Charter and the Original Conference Charter—1955 as found in *The A.A. Service Manual*. The committee recommended acceptance of the un-footnoted editorial changes and updates that exist in the Current Conference Charter as found in *The A.A. Service Manual*.
- The committee recommended that the following 1988 Advisory Action be reaffirmed:

"The Conference Charter appear in its original 1955 form in future editions of *The A.A. Service Manual*, with General Service Conference Advisory Action amendments and editorial changes indicated by footnotes, followed by the current version of the Charter."

TRUSTEES

- The committee recommended that the General Service Board take action to improve communication and cooperation among all its Boards and bring a report to the 2012 Conference Committee on Trustees.

FLOOR ACTIONS THAT DID NOT RESULT IN CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTIONS

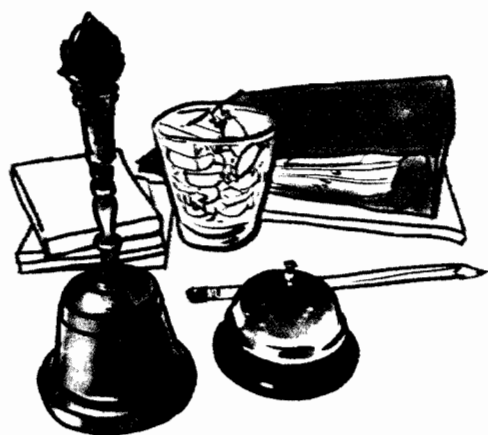
- To allow the committee secretary to have a laptop, projector and a screen in committee meetings. This would allow for real time editing of documents/ manuscripts that are agenda items. This would afford committee members to view changes as they make them to ensure the document is truly an accurate presentation of their work and enable a faster turnaround time in making the documents available to Conference members prior to presentation on the Conference floor. **(Not approved)**
- Reinstate the full slate of nine directors as constituted by the Grapevine Nominating Committee. **(Ruled out of order)**
- That the trustees' Committee on Conference not meet/confer with the Conference Committee on Agenda prior to the winter Quarterly Board Meeting until such time as an Advisory Action has been approved by the General Service Conference recommending that such a meeting/Conference occur. **(Withdrawn by submitter)**
- The "Current Conference Charter," (United States and Canada) as presented in Appendix C to *The A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts for World Service*, 2010-2011 edition, is hereby accepted as the current Conference Charter, and all changes to the original Charter contained therein are hereby ratified and confirmed. Footnotes to the Conference Charter as printed in *The A.A. Service Manual* are not part of the Conference Charter itself, and are included in *The A.A. Service Manual* for information purposes only. **(Not approved)**



all our districts, providing information and assistance to institutions and communities. I am excited, honored, and humbled to be serving Area 92 and especially, with all of you in this, the 62nd General Service Conference!—*Jeff Saunders*

Wisconsin (Northern/Upper Peninsula of Michigan): Area 74 is a mostly rural area including the Northern half of Wisconsin and most of the Upper Peninsula of Michigan. We have 24 districts and 599 registered groups covering an area of about 350 miles north to south and 475 miles east to west. Our area service structure includes our area officers and 12 standing committees. We have two standing committees for Corrections — one overseeing service for each state. Our Webmaster services are part of the Public Information Committee. Beginning in 2012 we are moving to a four-assembly structure, having two assemblies incorporated into our spring and fall Area Conferences. Conferences are now including area committee meetings and assemblies, bringing more service information to the members. We also conduct a one-day annual Corrections Conference jointly with Area 75, alternating locations between the areas each year. Area financial resources remain low in numbers of groups supporting the area service, and we are examining ways to be most effective with our funding. Approximately 31% of our area groups contribute financially to the area service structure. We have a committee in place for the 2013 East Central Regional Conference, which we will be hosting in Appleton, Wisconsin. I am proud to say we have a strong participation level of past delegates at our area service assemblies; our past delegates have a voice and vote at assemblies. With this year's rotation of district D.C.M.s and G.S.R.s we have several districts inactive at the Area business meetings. We will continue to offer support to attract greater service at the district and home group levels. I am proud and humbled to be serving our Area 74 to continue to support the future of Alcoholics Anonymous.—*Marty Laakso*

Wyoming: Area 76 covers the state of Wyoming, the least populated and 10th largest of the 50 states. Twelve districts are represented with approximately 125 groups. We hold two business assemblies (winter and summer) and two conventions (fall and spring). Locations are rotated throughout the state. In addition, local and district events occur over the year. Information is available on our Web site www.area76wyaa.org. If you come to visit us be sure to be prepared for a lot of "windshield" time. Most towns are about 100 miles apart.—*Greg Boone*



■ Additional Committee Considerations

Advisory Action 40 of the 1990 General Service Conference states: "Items discussed, but no action taken or recommendation made, as well as committee recommendations which are not adopted, be included in a separate section of the Final Report." All items, listed by committee, are as follows:

AGENDA

- The committee considered the request from the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference and agreed to reduce the number of presentation/discussion topics for the 2013 General Service Conference to allow scheduling for the 2013 Conference Inventory process approved by the 2011 G.S.C.
- The committee also noted that for the General Service Conferences in 2013, 2014 and 2015, there will be no solicitation for Workshop topics since the Conference Plan specifies that the time allotted for Conference Workshops during Conference week will be replaced with Inventory Group meetings to discuss Inventory questions.
- The committee reviewed the General Service Conference Evaluation Form and suggested that the Pre-Conference section of the Evaluation be separated from the Sunday section of the form.

ARCHIVES'

- The committee reviewed the request for changes to the Composition, Scope and Procedure of the Conference Archives Committee and took no action. It was the sense of the committee that the requested changes were not necessary.
- The committee reviewed the changes to the Archives Workbook and suggested one minor editorial change in the "Shared Experiences" section.
- The committee requested that the trustees' Archives Committee develop a new section in the Archives Workbook on digitizing archival collections intended to provide guidance to local archivists and archives committees responsible for maintaining Area or District archival collections.

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

- The committee discussed the report on replacing the current "A.A. Cooperation With the Professional Community" DVD with a new compilation DVD that includes existing material and reviewed the draft product of the replacement DVD.

The committee accepted the report and felt that a new compilation DVD was not needed for some of the following reasons:

- a. The list of suggested existing materials seemed limited and was already available on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web Site.
 - b. When communicating with professionals, it is often most helpful to have material that is specific to a particular profession.
 - c. In the contemporary, ever-changing digital age, the DVD format might not be appropriate for the distribution of information about Alcoholics Anonymous.
- The committee noted that the A.A.W.S. Board has oversight of

G.S.O.'s A.A. Web Site Redesign Committee and requested that A.A.W.S. consider dedicating a portion of the Web site to making A.A. resources easily accessible to targeted professional populations and C.P.C. Committees.

- The committee reviewed the contents of the Cooperation With the Professional Community Committee Kit and Workbook and made several suggestions:

- a. The sentence on page 15, which reads: "Open: Guests are welcome; if practical, mention that individual members are available to take a professional friend to a meeting" be changed to read "Open: Guests are welcome as observers; if practical, mention that individual members are available to take a professional friend to a meeting."
- b. The revised text in the "What A.A. Does Not Do" section in the C.P.C. pamphlets "A.A. in Your Community," "If You Are A Professional" and "Members of the Clergy ask about Alcoholics Anonymous" replace the current text in the "What A.A. Does Not Do" section on page 29 of the C.P.C. Workbook.

CORRECTIONS

- The committee reviewed the work of the trustees' Committee on Corrections with regards to the Corrections Kit and Workbook, and forwarded a list of suggested changes in the Workbook to the Publications Department.

FINANCE

- The committee suggested that a review of the delegate's fee be a standing item on the Conference Finance Committee agenda.
- The committee reviewed a proposed Self-Support Kit and agreed that the F-19 Self-Support Packet is sufficient service material and suggested adding "Services Provided by G.S.O./A.A.W.S." (SMF-176) to the Self-Support Packet.
- The committee reviewed and acknowledged the 21 Self-Support Talking Points presented in the background for use by the Fellowship and offers one additional point to be included: "What is the value of your sobriety?" The committee also suggested that they be added to the Finance Section of the Web site.
- The committee suggested the following statements be added to the back of the F-42 Self-Support green card:

What is the value of your sobriety?

- Less than 44 % of groups contribute to the General Service Board.
- Costs of Services provided by G.S.O. are \$6.32 per member per year.
- Sales of A.A. literature account for 56 % of our income.
- You can easily contribute regularly online at AA.org.
- Give till it feels good.
- The committee reviewed the information presented concerning financial projections for 2013 and 2014 and trusts that the Corporate Boards and the trustees' Finance Committee will deal with the financial issues in an appropriate manner.

The committee also expressed that increasing the awareness of the need for Fellowship contributions is the more spiritual way to address the funding issue.

GRAPEVINE

- The committee agreed with the proposal to update, proofread, and digitize the Grapevine Workbook. The revised workbook will be available on the Grapevine Web site for downloading. The workbook will no longer be printed. Note: The cost of this project is estimated to be \$5,000.

- The committee agreed to forward to the A.A. Grapevine Corporate Board the suggestion that Grapevine produce in the year 2013 or later:

1. Attitude of Gratitude (working title)
A collection of stories on the topic of gratitude previously published in Grapevine magazine and/or AAGrapevine.org.
2. Voices of Long Term Sobriety II (working title)
A collection of stories by members with 30+ years of sobriety previously published in Grapevine magazine and/or AAGrapevine.org.
3. Women's Stories in AA (working title)
Stories from women members on every topic including a special section from A.A.'s women pioneers previously published in Grapevine magazine and/or AAGrapevine.org.
4. GLBT in AA — We are all the same or Sober & Out (working title)
A collection of stories from the Gay, Lesbian, Bisexual and Transgender A.A. community previously published in Grapevine magazine and/or AAGrapevine.org.
5. Relationships in Sobriety (working title)
A collection of stories on the topic of relationships previously published in Grapevine magazine and/or AAGrapevine.org.
6. Having Fun in Sobriety (working title)
Now that you're sober you've discovered that you haven't the foggiest notion on how to have fun. What now? Stories from members having fun in sobriety from stories previously published in Grapevine magazine and/or AAGrapevine.org.
7. Daily Grapevine
365 inspirational passages as originally published in GV's thought of the day in Grapevine magazine and/or AAGrapevine.org.
8. Mid Sobriety Crisis (working title)
Not a beginner anymore and not an oldtimer? This collection of stories comes from members in the middle years (10-29) who are working the program and trudging the road to happy destiny previously published in Grapevine magazine and/or AAGrapevine.org.
9. The Best of La Viña II
Collection of Spanish language original stories (not translations) previously published in La Viña magazine.
10. AA Inside the Walls (working title)
A collection of stories from those behind bars and/or from those carrying the message to these institutions previously published in Grapevine magazine and/or AAGrapevine.org.

- The committee considered incorporating the service responsibilities and duties of the service position "Grapevine Representative" in the service responsibilities and duties of the "General Service Representative" and took no action.

- The committee requested that the AA Grapevine Board incorporate into all appropriate literature the 1962 Advisory Action that: "retiring delegates become Grapevine Representatives (GvRs) in their areas, with the objective of a GvR in each group."

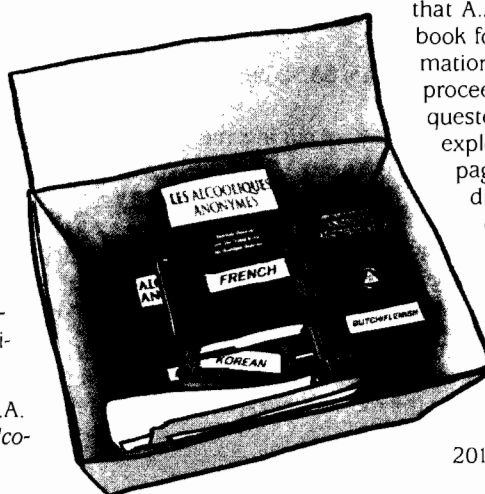
- The committee requested that groups that do not have a GvR or RLV consider incorporating these duties into the duties of the GSR.
- The committee requested that the AA Grapevine Board look into the feasibility of producing one book in ASL format.
- The committee requested that the AA Grapevine Board provide a report to the 2013 Conference Committee on the Grapevine as background, on the cost of reformatting Grapevine magazine from its current design to black/white interior, non-glossy, minimal photos and increase the font size.

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/ REGIONAL FORUMS¹

- The committee discussed and reviewed the 2025 International Convention Site-Selection Procedures.
- The committee discussed ways to encourage interest in Regional Forums and shared some experiences that have helped increase member participation in recent Regional Forums in their regions. These included:
 - Delegate and Area officers' participation helped increase interest in Regional Forums.
 - Online Regional Forum registration/information on www.aa.org is convenient and easily accessible.
 - One Area started workshops on Regional Forums at local service events to provide information and create enthusiasm.
 - One host committee extended committee membership to other Areas in the region and to members from different cities throughout their own Areas.
 - One committee member suggested including an article in the Grapevine with the Regional Forum schedule or from a member about their Regional Forum experience.
 - It helps to let members know you don't have to be in General Service to attend and enjoy a Regional Forum.
 - One Area took ownership of their Regional Forum hospitality committee to create enthusiasm and generate greater participation.
 - Talk and continue to talk about Regional Forums and explain what Regional Forums are all about.
 - When there are travel challenges look for creative/alternative ways to travel.
 - Suggest combining a trip to a Regional Forum with your vacation plans.

LITERATURE

- The committee reviewed the progress report from the trustees' Committee on Literature on the development of literature which focuses on spirituality that includes stories from atheists and agnostics who are sober in Alcoholics Anonymous. The committee forwarded to the trustees' Committee on Literature, as requested, input and suggestions, and requested a draft pamphlet or progress report be brought back to the 2013 Conference Committee on Literature.
- The committee discussed a request to add text from the dust jacket of the Third Edition of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, to the dust jacket of the Fourth Edition of the Big Book and took no action.
- The committee considered a request to add the "A.A. Preamble" to the front inside pages of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, and took no action.

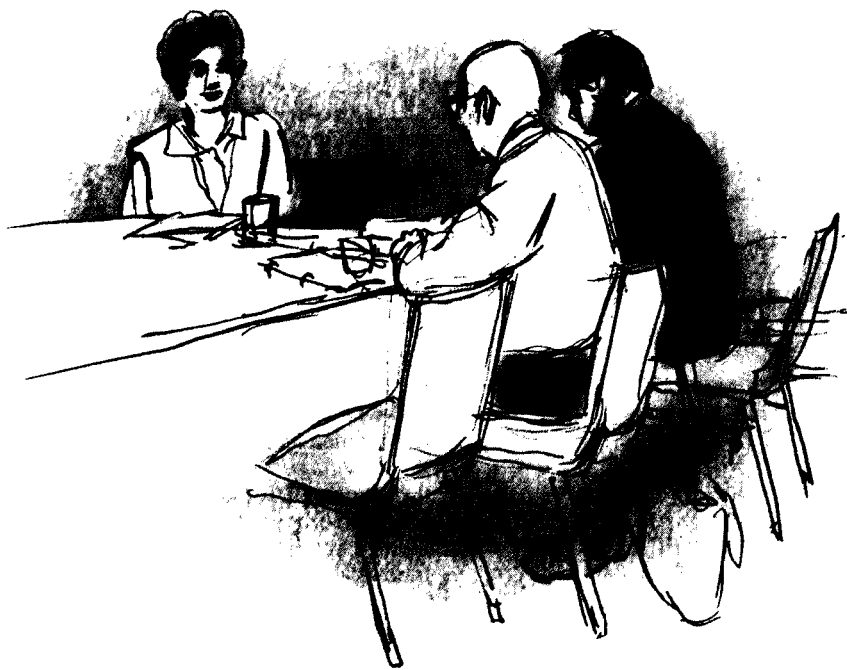


POLICY/ADMISSIONS

- The committee considered modifying the procedure for the submission of Concept V minority appeals to the General Service Conference and took no action. They agreed that the policy approved by the 2011 General Service Conference sufficiently provides a process for the "Right of Appeal" as described in Concept V — the procedure allows for a "well-heard minority" to be a "chief protection against an uninformed, misinformed, hasty or angry majority," and it makes the "best possible use of minority feeling and opinion."
- The committee requested that the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference review the role of the Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions in granting international observers admission to the General Service Conference, taking into account the concerns expressed by the Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions, and provide a report to the 2013 Conference Committee. The Conference committee agreed that their recommendation for approval of observers seems redundant, and this approval could appear to be a "rubber stamp" of the trustees' action, as cautioned against in Concept VII.
- The committee requested that the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference review the "Guidelines for Electronic Device Users at the General Service Conference" on an ongoing basis and forward any updates to the Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions for their review.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

- The committee reviewed the report of the Comprehensive Media Plan Subcommittee from the trustees' Public Information Committee, and expressed their support for the continued development of the media plan.
- Following lengthy and thoughtful discussion related to adding language referring to current media to Tradition Eleven, the committee concluded that the spirit and principle of anonymity at the public level is conveyed adequately in the Long Form of Tradition Eleven. Recognizing that suggested changes to Tradition Eleven have come to the Conference several times, the committee requested the trustees' Public Information Committee gather Area sharing on the effectiveness of the language of the Short Form of Tradition Eleven in addressing the needs of the Fellowship today and report back to the 2013 Conference Committee on Public Information.
- The committee considered favorably the suggestion from the trustees' Public Information Committee that A.A. establish a presence on Facebook for the purpose of providing information about A.A. to the public. Before proceeding, however, the committee requested that the General Service Board explore all aspects of this social media page and, if feasible within our Traditions, provide the 2013 Conference Committee on Public Information an implementation plan that addresses the implications of such a page, including sample content and estimates for implementation cost and maintenance.
- The committee reviewed the 2011 Annual Report from the trustees'



Committee on Public Information regarding G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site and noted the detailed information provided and the thoughtful consideration given to all items involving the Web site.

- The committee reviewed the information on centralized distribution, tracking and evaluation of the "My World" public service announcement.
- The committee reviewed all of the current A.A. TV public service announcements and agreed with the report of the trustees' Public Information Committee that found them all to be relevant and useful.
- The committee assessed the need for a new A.A. TV public service announcement and agreed with the report of the trustees' Public Information Committee that none was needed at this time.
- The committee considered the proposed alternative packaging for the Public Information Kit and suggested that the Publications Department continue to explore options for alternative packaging that is durable, allows for organization and containment of the kit materials.

REPORT AND CHARTER

- The committee accepted a report from the Publications Department outlining the General Service Office process for timely and accurate preparation and publication of *The A.A. Service Manual* 2012-2013 Edition, and the 2012 General Service Conference *Final Report*.
- In keeping with the 2009 Advisory Action that the A.A. Grapevine Board annually review *The A.A. Service Manual* and forward necessary updates to the Conference Committee on Report and Charter, the committee reviewed the updates from the A.A. Grapevine Board for *The A.A. Service Manual* and suggested some revisions.
- In keeping with the 2009 Advisory Action that the A.A.W.S. Board annually review *The A.A. Service Manual* and forward necessary updates to the Conference Committee on Report and Char-

ter, the committee reviewed the updates from the A.A.W.S. Board for *The A.A. Service Manual* and suggested some revisions.

- In keeping with the 2009 Advisory Action that the General Service Board annually review *The A.A. Service Manual* and forward necessary updates to the Conference Committee on Report and Charter, the committee reviewed the updates from the General Service Board for *The A.A. Service Manual*.

Note: The committee agreed to ask the General Service Board to reconsider two changes that had been forwarded by the General Service Board.

- The committee reviewed a list of proposed editorial updates for *The A.A. Service Manual* and forwarded them to the Publications Department.
- The committee considered a suggestion for revising text on "Conference Panels," on page S107, to clarify what is meant by the term "panels," and forwarded suggestions to the Publications Department with the request that draft text be brought back for consideration by the 2013 Conference Committee on Report and Charter.

- The committee considered a request to add a section on the "spirit of rotation" and forwarded suggestions to the Publications Department with the request that draft text be brought back for consideration by the 2013 Conference Committee on Report and Charter.
- The committee reviewed suggested changes to the Conference Charter that were requested from the General Service Board and took no action. The committee asked that the General Service Board reconsider the 2011 Advisory Action regarding the Conference Charter, and develop text that explicitly addresses the principles of participation, petition and appeal for consideration by the 2013 Conference Committee on Report and Charter.
- The committee briefly discussed the A.A. Directories and noted that there were no requests for changes to the A.A. Directories.
- The committee briefly discussed the General Service Conference *Final Report* and noted that there were no requests for changes to the *Final Report*.

TREATMENT/ SPECIAL NEEDS-ACCESSIBILITIES

- The committee expressed concerns about the French and Spanish translations of the video *Hope: Alcoholics Anonymous* regarding the exact translation of the direct quote read from the translated Big Books and for background distraction in the videos. The committee asked the Publications Department to review these items and report back to the 2013 Conference Committee on Treatment/Special Needs-Accessibilities.
- The committee reviewed the Treatment Committee Workbook and Kit and suggested minor editorial changes to the service piece "A.A. Temporary Contact/Bridging the Gap Request" and removed redundant information in the Kit. Following these minor changes the committee found the Workbook and Kit to be satisfactory for use by local committees.



FINANCE

- The committee reviewed the current \$3,000 dollar limit on annual individual contributions and recommended that the annual limit on contributions be increased from \$3,000 to \$5,000.
- The committee reviewed the current \$3,000 dollar limit one time bequests and recommended that the limit on one-time bequests be increased from \$3,000 to \$25,000.
- The Conference Finance Committee reviewed the background presented and past Conference actions and recommended that La Viña become self-supporting within three years beginning January 1, 2013. If La Viña has not become self-supporting by December 31, 2015, General Service Board funding will cease.

TREATMENT/SPECIAL NEEDS-ACCESSIBILITIES

- The committee reviewed the video *Hope: Alcoholics Anonymous* and recommended that one line of dialog, "Uncle Sam is not gonna come in and bail us out" be removed the next time it is reprinted at a cost of approximately \$9,000.00.
- The committee recommended that the pamphlet "A.A. for the Alcoholic With Special Needs" be expanded to include additional stories of alcoholics with mental illness collected from the Fellowship, and that the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment/Special Need-Accessibilities bring a progress report or draft pamphlet to the 2013 Conference Committee on Treatment/Special Needs-Accessibilities.

TRUSTEES

- The committee reviewed the resumes and approved, as eligible for election, all Class B Trustee candidates for the West Central and Western Canada Regions.
- The committee reviewed and accepted the report from the trustees' Committee on Nominating on the Impact of the Conference Disapproving a Recommended Slate noting that, as requested, the report solely addressed the admission of slates; the committee recognizes that the General Service Conference has additional authority related to the General Service Board not commented upon in the report.
- The committee strongly suggested that the practice of including the operating corporation board slates (A.A.W.S. and Grapevine) on the General Service Conference agenda be continued.

RECOMMENDATIONS THAT DID NOT RESULT IN CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTIONS

CORRECTIONS

- The committee recommended that the video "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell," be remade in order to accurately reflect current-day life in correctional facilities, while retaining the original message and intent consistent with A.A. Traditions, at a cost not to exceed \$75,000.

FLOOR ACTIONS THAT DID NOT RESULT IN CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTIONS

- Request to develop a pamphlet for the Alcoholic with Mental Illness. **(Withdrawn by submitter)**
- To change the question: (1) what more could be done to insure the General Service Board remains transparent and thorough in their reporting to the Fellowship concerning financial condition? 2013 Section G Question #3 **(Conference voted not to consider)**
- GSC recommends that the General Service Board form a sub-committee comprised of all stakeholders to develop a plan to address publication, distribution and finances of La Viña with the objective of self-support by 12/31/15. **(Not approved)**
- That the trustees' Committee on Literature develop a pamphlet for the alcoholic with mental illness, with a progress report to be provided to the 2013 Conference Committee on Literature with suggestions for content of the pamphlet, including breadth and scope of the pamphlet. **(Not approved)**
- That the pamphlet "A.A. and The Armed Services" include the subtitle "none left behind." **(Not approved)**
- This body form an A.A.W.S. Committee to allow this motion to be heard by a committee before coming to the floor for approval. **(Conference voted not to consider)**

■ **Additional Committee Considerations**

Advisory Action 40 of the 1990 General Service Conference states: "Items discussed, but no action taken or recommendation made, as well as committee recommendations which are not adopted, be included in a separate section of the Final Report." All items, listed by committee, are as follows:

AGENDA

- The committee reviewed the Conference Evaluation Form, along with the comments and suggestions from the trustees' Conference Committee and agreed that the form was adequate and that no changes be made at this time.

ARCHIVES¹

- The committee reviewed the Archives Workbook and expressed satisfaction with the content.

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

- The committee discussed how local C.P.C. committees are utilizing new technologies to provide information about Alcoholics Anonymous to professionals, and suggested adding information to the C.P.C. Kit and Workbook on:
 - Using PowerPoint and Webinars.
 - Providing electronic subscriptions to A.A. newsletters.
- The committee discussed ways of stimulating interest in C.P.C. service work and suggested:
 - Using mock C.P.C. presentations at service workshops.
 - Encouraging groups to elect C.P.C. chairs.
 - Bringing A.A. members along on C.P.C. presentations.
- The committee reviewed the contents of the Cooperation With the Professional Community Kit and Workbook and suggested:
 - Adding an index of past issues of *About A.A.* to the publications tab.
 - Including a copy of the A.A. Grapevine, La Viña and La Vigne in each Kit.

CORRECTIONS

- The committee requested that the trustees' Committee on Corrections continue their thorough review of all Corrections materials.
- The committee discussed how to engage A.A. members in corrections service and shared about the opportunities to highlight the current available corrections literature through local area and district Web sites.
- In discussing difficulties in engaging A.A. members in corrections service, the committee recognized that some A.A. members who have not been incarcerated may feel they have nothing to offer in corrections service. The committee requested the staff secretary work with the Publishing Department and the trustees' Committee on Corrections to incorporate text in the Corrections Workbook section "Ideas to Stimulate Corrections Twelfth Step Work Within A.A." to reassure all A.A. members that they can participate in corrections service by sharing A.A.'s basic message about getting and staying sober.
- The committee discussed available resources in support of local corrections' Twelfth Step work and suggested:

- that the committee secretary gather sharing on ways that areas fund A.A. literature for incarcerated alcoholics for an article in *Box 4-5-9* and other service materials;
- that corrections committees be encouraged to use *La Viña* as a valuable resource for Spanish-speaking A.A. meetings and members inside correctional facilities.

- The committee reviewed a sample Letter of Introduction to Correctional Facilities, a sample Correctional Facility Fact Sheet, and a sample A.A. Program Plan for Correctional Facilities, and requested that all three samples—with suggested changes—be added to the Corrections Workbook at the next printing.
- The committee suggested that in cases when the Area Corrections Committee is inactive, communications from the G.S.O. Corrections assignment requesting prerelease contacts or outside support for correctional facility A.A. meetings be forwarded to the delegate.
- The committee reviewed the Corrections Kit and Workbook, and suggested that the service piece "Suggestions for Using the A.A. Grapevine Magazine (or *La Viña*) as a Tool in Corrections Service" be updated and considered for inclusion in the Workbook.

FINANCE

- The committee reviewed the suggested area contribution for delegate expense for the Conference and felt an increase was not necessary at this time.
- The committee reviewed the Self-Support packet and suggested adding the following words to the packaging sleeve: "Information from Self-Support packet also available on the Web site aa.org" and "Please Share with Your Group."
- The committee suggested adding the following phrase to the Self-Support Green Card (F-42): "Gratitude expressed through contributions reaches the still-suffering alcoholic."
- The committee thoroughly reviewed the report on self-support from the trustees' Finance Committee and urged that the work of the Self-Support subcommittee continue.
- The committee suggested that the appropriate committee reconsider the policy concerning the General Service Conference site selection ("The responsibility for General Service Conference site selection be delegated to General Service Office management, subject to approval of the General Service Board")* and that Conference members consider the spiritual and financial aspects.

*2008 Policy/Admissions Committee

GRAPEVINE

- The committee reviewed the 2013 Grapevine Office Report on Audio Strategy and made the following requests:
 - That Grapevine communications regarding the Grapevine Audio Project specify that GV is not recording meeting speakers at A.A. events.
 - That an updated status and financial report on the project, including practices, financials, metrics and plans for the future, be provided to the 2014 Conference Committee on the Grapevine.
- The committee reviewed the results of the 2012 assessment of *La Viña* as a bimonthly, perfect bound, black and white, 68-page magazine and concluded:
 - The committee recognized that funding *La Viña* as a service, through the General Fund, is an issue affecting the overall Fellowship.

- The committee acknowledged the increase in circulation by 8.6% from January 2011 to December 2012 may be tied to the changes in format and additional content.
- The committee acknowledged that the 2012 increase in La Viña deficit results in large part from allocation of pension funding expense.
- The committee expressed concern that funding La Viña through the General Fund of the General Service Board, while A.A. Grapevine Inc. has responsibility for the production of La Viña, may suggest an imbalance between responsibility and authority.
- The committee requested that the GV board submit a proposal to the 2014 Conference Committee on the Grapevine that would significantly reduce the La Viña deficit.
- The committee considered discontinuing the requirement for the current format of the La Viña print magazine (i.e., 68 pages, perfect bound) and took no action. The committee needed more background regarding La Viña's financial history and information regarding what a new format would be.
- The committee agreed to forward to the A.A. Grapevine Corporate Board the suggestion that Grapevine produce in the year 2014 or later:
 1. Making Amends (working title)
Members share their experience about making Ninth Step amends from stories previously published in Grapevine magazine and/or AAGrapevine.org.
 2. How I Found My Higher Power (working title)
A collection of stories by AA members sharing their experience with their personal journeys with Step Two, previously published in Grapevine magazine and/or AA-Grapevine.org.
- The committee reviewed the revised workbook and approved the draft copy with the following suggestions:
 - Expand Appendix V to include all past Advisory Actions about the Grapevine.
 - Look into the feasibility of hyperlinks and a live table of contents to facilitate ease of navigation of the electronic workbook.
- The committee requested a report from the A.A. Grapevine Board on the feasibility of producing one book in American Sign Language (ASL) format.

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/ REGIONAL FORUMS¹

- The committee discussed ways to encourage interest in Regional and Local Forums and attract first time attendees and suggested:
 - Using locally created "save the date" flyers to encourage attendance and participation.
 - Emphasizing that you do not have to be involved in General Service to attend a Regional Forum.
 - Making Regional Forums more prominent on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site.
 - Continuing to include information about Regional Forums in Box 4-5-9 on a regular basis.
 - Encouraging local host committees to include food, treats and A.A. meetings as part of the hospitality.
 - Providing additional service opportunities for local A.A. members at each Forum.

LITERATURE

- The committee reviewed the draft pamphlet of "Circles of Love and Service" and offered additional suggestions for the trustees'

Literature Committee to consider. The committee looks forward to reviewing an updated draft pamphlet that includes their considerations at the 2014 Conference Committee on Literature meeting.

- The committee discussed a suggestion to add an index to *Alcoholics Anonymous* and took no action, noting that our Big Book is spiritual in nature rather than academic and that an index might discourage a full reading of the material.
- The committee thoroughly discussed a request to add the subtitle "None Left Behind" to the newly revised "A.A. and the Armed Services" pamphlet and took no action. The committee agreed that this request was fully and appropriately addressed by both the Conference Committee on Literature and Conference members at the 62nd General Service Conference.

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

- The committee discussed the report of the trustees' Committee on Conference regarding the role of the Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions in granting international observers admission to the General Service Conference. The committee agreed that no change to the current practice is necessary.
- The committee discussed the concept of combining the Conference Agenda and Conference Policy/Admissions Committees. The sense of the committee was that there was not enough information presented to express a need or benefit to combining the committees. In addition, the amount of time currently allotted for each committee's deliberation seems appropriate, and combining the committees might result in too heavy a workload for the combined committee. The committee was also dissuaded by the complications involved in merging the committees (revising the Composition, Scope and Procedures of committees; updating *The A.A. Service Manual* and other literature; additional responsibilities for staff, etc.).
- The committee noted a discrepancy between the description of the Conference Agenda Committee in *The A.A. Service Manual* and in the Conference Agenda Committee's Composition, Scope and Procedure, and suggested that the 2014 Conference Agenda Committee review the description in *The A.A. Service Manual* for consistency.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

- The committee reviewed the 2012 Annual Report from the trustees' Committee on Public Information regarding G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site and requested that as soon as possible, and independent from the Web site redesign, A.A.W.S. insure that A.A. videos on aa.org be accessible on as wide a variety of electronic devices as possible.
- The committee reviewed the report from the trustees' Public Information Committee on A.A. Video Public Service Announcements (P.S.A.s).
- The committee considered production of one or more video P.S.A.s to be produced in the calendar year 2013 using the current five "Young People's Videos" and took no action. The committee requested that the trustees' Public Information Committee define more specifically the target audience, the cost, the method of distribution appropriate to the targeted audience, and any format issues, and bring back a report to the 2014 Conference Public Information Committee.
- The committee reviewed all current A.A. video public service announcements and found them all to be relevant and useful, noting that "Living in Chaos," which the trustees' committee had suggested for retirement, continues to effectively portray the consequences of alcoholic drinking.

¹Members of this committee serve on this as a secondary committee assignment.

- The committee reviewed the interim report on the centralized distribution, tracking and evaluation of "Tengo Esperanza," the video public service announcement for the Spanish-speaking community. The committee noted the strong performance of this P.S.A. thus far, and looks forward to receiving the final report next year.
- The committee reviewed the report from the trustees' Public Information Committee on establishing a Public Information Social Media Page and agrees with the trustees' conclusion that A.A. World Services, the General Service Office, and the A.A. Grapevine and La Viña cannot establish a presence on Facebook in a manner which would be consistent with A.A. Traditions.
- The committee suggested the General Service Board encourage the trustees' committees to review existing literature that discusses how A.A. members apply the Eleventh Tradition, e.g., "Questions and Answers on Sponsorship" and "The Twelve Traditions Illustrated," and suggest updates to the literature that reflect current experience with anonymity in a digital age, with an eye towards reaffirming the importance of the Eleventh Tradition to the Fellowship.
- The committee reviewed the contents of the P.I. Kit and Workbook and suggested that:
 - The address of G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site, www.aa.org, be added to the front of the new P.I. Kit packaging.
 - The pamphlet "Members of the Clergy Ask About Alcoholics Anonymous" be included in the P.I. Kit.

REPORT AND CHARTER

- The committee accepted a report from the Publishing Department outlining the General Service Office process for timely and accurate preparation and publication of *The A.A. Service Manual* 2013-2014 Edition, and the 2013 General Service Conference *Final Report*.
- The committee reviewed the list of editorial updates from the Publishing Department for *The A.A. Service Manual* and suggested some revisions. The committee noted that one of the editorial updates regarded the description of a Conference Committee, and asked that a review of the descriptions of all Conference Committees for consistency with current Composition, Scope and Procedures be made, and any suggested editorial updates be included in the annual list to be forwarded to the 2014 Conference Committee on Report and Charter. The committee also requested that a similar review of the list in Chapter Eleven of services provided by G.S.O. be made, and any suggested editorial updates be included in that list as well.
- In keeping with the 2009 Advisory Action that the A.A.W.S. Board annually review *The A.A. Service Manual* and forward necessary updates to the Conference Committee on Report and Charter, the committee reviewed the updates from the A.A.W.S. Board for *The A.A. Service Manual* and suggested some revisions.
- The committee considered a request to add "Advisory Action" and "Additional Committee Consideration" to the Glossary of General Service Terms in *The A.A. Service Manual*, and forwarded suggestions to the Publishing Department with the request that draft text be brought back for consideration by the 2014 Conference Committee on Report and Charter.
- The committee considered a request that "the definition and Composition of an Area Assembly be modified for consistency and clarity in Chapter Four" and took no action. The committee believes the existing descriptions of Area assemblies accurately reflect the variety of autonomous practices determined by each Area's group conscience.
- The committee considered a request to revise the description of "Director (nontrustee)" in the Glossary of General Service Terms in

The A.A. Service Manual, and agreed to forward this suggestion to the General Service Board for consideration as part of the annual review of *The A.A. Service Manual*.

- The committee considered a request to update information in *The A.A. Service Manual* regarding suggested qualifications for area registrars, and forwarded suggestions to the Publishing Department with the request that draft text be brought back for consideration by the 2014 Conference Committee on Report and Charter. The committee also suggested that G.S.O. develop a new piece of service material outlining the specific abilities and resources area registrars have found helpful in assisting with the maintenance of vital information in the Fellowship New Vision database.
- In light of the recent decision not to publish regional directories this year, the committee asked the staff secretary to communicate their concerns to the A.A.W.S. Board about the still existing, albeit decreasing, need for print resources by A.A. members in rural and remote areas, and those members who may travel frequently.

TREATMENT/SPECIAL NEEDS-ACCESSIBILITIES

- The committee reviewed the report on Spanish and French translations of the video *Hope: Alcoholics Anonymous* and expressed the need for translated versions of audio visual materials to have improved sound production in the future.
- The committee reviewed the report on the DVD version of the pamphlet "A.A. For the Alcoholic with Special Needs" formatted for alcoholics who are blind, deaf or learning challenged and expressed appreciation for the availability of the item. There was a concern expressed whether a DVD in American Sign Language (ASL) and with subtitles in English serves the needs of French and Spanish language-based members.
- The committee reviewed the Treatment Committee Kit and Workbook contents and its current content.
- The committee reviewed the contents of Special Needs-Accessibilities Workbook and Kit and requested the following:
 - That the staff secretary produce a memo with the following wording suggested by the 2012 Conference Committee on Treatment/Special Needs-Accessibilities: "Committees gather local information and identify outside local resources regarding accessibility requirements and options." This memo is to be a temporary insert in the section, "Activities Suggested for Special Needs-Accessibilities Committees," of the current Special Needs-Accessibilities Workbook until the next printing of the workbook. The memo will be sent to area, district, and intergroup/central office Treatment/Special Needs-Accessibilities chairs.
 - Add the service piece, "Online Meetings/Reunions a L'Internet/Reunions del Internet" (SM F-124), to the Special Needs-Accessibilities Kit.
- The committee had a wide-ranging discussion on how Special Needs-Accessibilities committees can communicate the various ways to make meeting places accessible to all alcoholics. Topics included:
 - Start Special Needs-Accessibilities committees and hold workshops on various topics to inform members about this service area.
 - Communicate in web-based and print meeting directories which meetings are handicapped equipped, wheelchair accessible, and ASL interpreted.
 - Consider ensuring that the entire meeting experience for those with special needs is accessible-friendly, e.g. assuring that the height of literature displays or coffee dispensers are accessible to those in wheelchairs.
 - Prepare meeting greeters to identify attendees with spe-

cial needs and to help provide accommodation as best as possible.

- Provide local special needs contact information in meeting formats and event flyers.
- The committee also discussed ways that Special Needs-Accessibilities committees might help groups prepare in advance for the arrival of deaf/hard of hearing alcoholics. Topics included:
 - Provide optimal seating arrangements.
 - Use a microphone, discourage cross-talk, and ask those speaking to stand and avoid covering their faces with hand gestures.
 - When economically possible, provide ASL interpreters or seek out capable A.A. members who can sign; some areas fund ASL interpreters.
 - Communicate with the hard of hearing in attendance that seating and other accommodations can be made.
 - Encourage cooperation with local professionals serving the deaf/hard of hearing community.

TRUSTEES

- The committee reviewed their Composition, Scope and Procedure and updated the references to the trustees' committees on "Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities/Special Needs-Accessibilities" and "Correctional Facilities" found in their Scope to trustees' committees on "Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment/Special Needs-Accessibilities" and "Corrections."
- The committee reviewed the resumes and approved, as eligible for election, all Class B trustee candidates for the East Central and Southeast regional trustees and trustee-at-large/U.S.
- The committee reviewed the General Service Board's proposed plan regarding the slate of directors for the A.A.W.S. Board and the A.A. Grapevine Board and took no action. The committee did not support the proposed interlocking directorate.
- The committee noted that the General Service Board has sufficient authority to implement changes in Practices as outlined in the initiatives in the sections under the heading "Communications and Unity" and "Efficient Operations and Financial Stability" and expressed their support for those ongoing changes. It was the sense of the committee that the changes in Practices could address the concerns of the General Service Board.
- The committee requested that, before implementation, any changes proposed in the section "Governance," regarding "Non-trustee Director Service," "Eligibility of General Service Trustees" and "Eligibility of Appointed Committee Members" be brought to the Conference Committee on Trustees for review.

RECOMMENDATIONS THAT DID NOT RESULT IN CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTIONS

LITERATURE

- The committee recommended that the second paragraph on the inside front flap of the dust jacket which currently states:

At the time of the third edition, in March 1976, the worldwide membership of A.A. was estimated at 1,000,000 or more. Copies of *Alcoholics Anonymous* in circulation exceeded 1,450,000. In 1995, the General Service Conference approved the recommendation: "The first 164 pages of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, the Preface, the Forewords, 'The Doctor's Opinion,' 'Doctor Bob's Nightmare' and the Appendices remain as is."

Be replaced with the following language:

At the time of the third edition, in March 1976, the worldwide membership of A.A. was estimated at 1,000,000 or more. Copies of *Alcoholics Anonymous* in circulation exceeded 1,450,000. The basic text (pages 1 through 164) remains largely unchanged. This is the A.A. message, just as it was introduced in the 1939 edition of *Alcoholics Anonymous*, the book that gave the young fellowship its name.

NOTE: This change will also be made to all formats of the dust jacket of *Alcoholics Anonymous*.

- The committee recommended that "Nonalcoholics may attend open meetings as observers" be added to the open meeting side of the Primary Purpose (Blue) Card (F-17) in all three languages when the inventory of the English version is depleted.

The statement will read as follows:

"This Is An Open Meeting Of Alcoholics Anonymous"

"This is an open meeting of Alcoholics Anonymous. We are glad you are all here – especially newcomers. In keeping with our singleness of purpose and our Third Tradition which states that 'The only requirement for A.A. membership is a desire to stop drinking,' we ask that all who participate confine their discussion to their problems with alcohol. **Nonalcoholics may attend open meetings as observers.** (Bold text reflects addition)

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

- The committee recommended that the alternate chair of a primary committee be eligible to serve as chair of a secondary committee only if there are no other available candidates.

FLOOR ACTIONS THAT DID NOT RESULT IN CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTIONS

- The General Service Board develop a process in which the Conference can be participants in the development of its own agenda to include agenda items and present the process to the 64th General Service Conference. **(Not approved)**
- The General Service Board's proposed plan of an interlocking directorate serving the A.A.W.S. and Grapevine, shall be continued in scope and procedure as proposed to the General Service Conference. **(Conference voted not to consider)**
- To discontinue the current formatting requirements for the La Viña print magazine (i.e., 68 pages, perfect bound), in order to return the responsibility for formatting La Viña to the A.A. Grapevine Board and management. **(Not approved)**
- The commemorative 75th Anniversary Edition of the First Edition, first printing of *Alcoholics Anonymous* be published in April 2014 in Spanish and French. **(Not approved)**
- Propose that the General Service Office of Alcoholics Anonymous develop, implement, and maintain a nationwide online, searchable meeting list and locator. **(Conference voted not to consider)**
- That any vote on reorganizing our General Service Board and two service corporations be decided by 3/4 rather than 2/3 substantial unity vote as this is a matter of vital importance. **(Not approved)**

Additional Committee Considerations

Advisory Action 40 of the 1990 General Service Conference states: "Items discussed, but no action taken or recommendation made, as well as committee recommendations which are not adopted, be included in a separate section of the Final Report." All items, listed by committee, are as follows:

AGENDA

- The committee reviewed the General Service Conference Evaluation Form and made no changes. The committee discussed providing the General Service Conference Evaluation Form in a digital format and agreed that was not appropriate at this time.
- The committee reviewed and discussed their Composition, Scope and Procedure and agreed that point #3 of the current Scope, which is to consider "The Conference Agenda and where appropriate to make suggestions for improvement to the trustees' Committee on the Conference," is ambiguous. The committee requested that the trustees' Committee on the Conference explore the potential role that the Conference Committee on Agenda might play in the selection process of Agenda items in the future and provide a report to the 2015 Conference Agenda Committee.
- The committee requested that the 2015 Conference Agenda Committee be provided with a report regarding the current and historical process of Agenda item selection.

ARCHIVES¹

- The committee reviewed the Archives Workbook and suggested adding sharing of experience with regard to preservation procedures, as well as on legal considerations for Archives collections.

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

- The committee reviewed the contents of the Cooperation With the Professional Community Kit and Workbook and suggested:
 - Adding an index of past issues of *About A.A.* to the publications tab.
 - Including a copy of the A.A. Grapevine, La Viña and La Vigne in each Kit, subject to cost considerations.
 - Include a copy of the April 2010 A.A. Grapevine article entitled, "Spirituality and 'God Talk,'" by former Class A chair of the General Service Board, Ward Ewing, and a copy of the Fall 2003 *About A.A.* newsletter entitled, "The A.A. Program — Spiritual But Never 'Religious.'"
- The committee suggested that changes be made to the service piece *Information on Alcoholics Anonymous* (F-2) under the section "Proof of Attendance at A.A. Meetings" to reflect changes proposed for the pamphlet "If You Are A Professional...."

CORRECTIONS

- The committee reviewed the contents of the Corrections Kit and Workbook and suggested that the DVD, "Carrying the Message Behind These Walls" (DV-06) be included in the Corrections Kit (MV-45).
- The committee noted from the trustees' report that the number of requests from male inmates (U.S.) for Corrections Correspondence Service (C.C.S.) continues to increase at a rate significantly higher than the number of "outside" male volunteers available. The committee discussed ways to increase participation in C.C.S. including:

- Offer presentations on C.C.S. at A.A. events;
- Communicate the importance of C.C.S. to area delegates;
- Increase awareness of C.C.S. at A.A. meetings;
- Make C.C.S. information and forms more accessible at the home group;
- Use G.S.O. and Grapevine publications to encourage C.C.S. participation;
- Consider the topic of C.C.S. for presentations at Regional Forums.

FINANCE

- The committee reviewed the suggested area contribution for delegate expense for the Conference and after a lengthy discussion felt an increase was not necessary at this time.
- The committee reviewed the Self-Support packet and suggests that the following changes, as the Self-Support Card (F-42) is being updated by the A.A.W.S. Finance Committee:
 - Add the phrase "Your contributions help ensure the future of our Fellowship worldwide" in the "Some facts" section of the card.
 - Delete the phrase "Give until it feels good" under "Personal thoughts."
 - In addition to reporting the average costs per member, add the year of the costs that are quoted so the reader will know how current the information is.

GRAPEVINE

- The committee reviewed the 2014 Grapevine Office Report on Audio Strategy and requested that an updated status and financial report on the project, including practices, financials, metrics and plans for the future, be provided to the 2015 Conference Committee on the Grapevine.
- The committee reviewed the A.A. Grapevine Board's suggestion that a new business plan is required for La Viña and requested that a new business plan be developed for La Viña and be brought back to the 2015 Conference Committee on A.A. Grapevine for review.
- The committee reviewed the report from the A.A. Grapevine Board on the feasibility of producing one book in ASL format. The committee agreed with the conclusion of the report that it is not feasible at this time to produce one book in ASL format due to cost considerations and a lack of expressed need.
- The committee agreed to forward to the A.A. Grapevine Board the suggestion that Grapevine produce in the year 2015 or later:
 - The Twelve Traditions—Our Experience (working title)
Members share their experience with each of our Twelve A.A. Traditions, previously published in Grapevine magazine and/or AAGrapevine.org.
 - Cartoon Book II (working title)
A collection of cartoons by A.A. members, previously published in Grapevine magazine and/or AAGrapevine.org.
 - Special Needs (working title)
Stories by members who are wheelchair-bound, blind, deaf, ill or with other special needs. How A.A. reaches out to everyone. Previously published stories in Grapevine magazine and/or AAGrapevine.org.
 - Diversity in A.A. (working title)
A.A. members of color share their own stories of getting sober—from previously published stories in Grapevine magazine and/or AAGrapevine.org.

- The committee discussed the request to reconsider publish-

ing the “Alcoholism at Large” section of the Grapevine and took no action.

- The committee reviewed suggested changes from A.A. Grapevine Board to the pamphlet “A.A. Grapevine and La Viña: Our Meetings in Print” (P-52) and made the following suggestions:
 - Re-edit the pamphlet for consistency and grammar.
 - Use the subtitle “Our Meetings in Print and Other Media” on the cover of the pamphlet and on page 5.

The committee requested that a revised draft be presented to the 2015 Conference Committee for review.

- The committee reviewed the Grapevine Workbook.

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/ REGIONAL FORUMS¹

- The committee discussed ways to encourage interest in Regional Forums and attract first-time attendees, and some of the suggestions were:
 - Having the Forum Flyer professionally designed so that it would be attractive, perhaps could be used as a table topper;
 - Sharing ideas among areas in a region or region-to-region;
 - Encouraging those who have attended Regional Forums to share their enthusiasm about their experience — word-of-mouth sharing is really powerful;
 - Bring information about the Regional Forum to every district and area event.

LITERATURE

- The committee discussed a suggested change to the first paragraph in the section on Concept XII in the pamphlet “Twelve Concepts for World Service Illustrated” and took no action. The committee noted that the Report and Charter Committee was discussing a similar proposal.
- The committee discussed multiple suggestions for changes to the pamphlet “Questions & Answers on Sponsorship” and took no action, noting the current language in the pamphlet is adequate.
- The committee discussed a suggestion to reconsider the use of the circle and triangle as an unofficial A.A. service mark on Conference-approved Literature and, agreeing with past Conference Advisory Actions, took no action.
- The committee discussed a suggestion to create a pamphlet for alcoholics with mental illness and took no action. The committee agreed that this subject is adequately addressed in current A.A. literature.

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

- The committee discussed the 2008 Conference Advisory Action regarding responsibility for site selection of the General Service Conference and took no action. The committee considered that the current hotel site-selection process by the General Service Office management is appropriate. The committee suggested that, in the spirit of clear communication, reports describing the hotel site-selection process of all future General Service Conferences be provided to the Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions for their information.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

- The committee reviewed the 2014 Comprehensive Media Plan. Because this document will be reviewed and updated on an annual basis, the committee asked the staff secretary to forward some

suggestions to the trustees’ P.I. Committee, including the following:

- Clarification of some terminology since the plan is distributed widely to A.A. members who may be unfamiliar with media jargon.
- Adding annual review of the plan by the Conference P.I. Committee to the cover memo under “process.”
- Emphasis on items not only being “actionable” but also, whenever possible, “measurable.”

- The committee expressed strong support for the forward-looking vision of the Comprehensive Media Plan regarding seeking member-submitted content for future Public Service Announcements, similar to the model used for the Young People’s Video Project.

- The committee reviewed the 2013 Annual Report from the trustees’ Committee on Public Information regarding G.S.O.’s A.A. website. The committee requested that when ongoing website projects have made further progress than what was reflected in the distributed background, that relevant updates be communicated to the committee prior to the Conference.

- The committee expressed concern about possible inconsistencies between retiring certain P.S.A.s because of conflict with the current full-face policy, and posting video content on AA.org that may also be perceived to conflict with this policy. The committee asked that the A.A.W.S. Board consider offering the video *Hope: Alcoholics Anonymous* via a digital platform accessible by local committees, rather than displaying this content on publicly accessible pages of the AA.org website.

- The committee agreed with the assessment provided in the report from the trustees’ Public Information Committee on A.A. Video P.S.A.s regarding the P.S.A.s “I Thought,” “A Force of Nature” and “Testimonials,” including the suggestion that as new P.S.A.s are developed that these three items be retired as quickly as practical.

- The committee considered two proposed items from the report on the 2014 A.A. Membership Survey from the trustees’ Committee on Public Information regarding A.A. member awareness of services offered by G.S.O., and A.A. member awareness of the A.A. Grapevine, and took no action. The committee recognized the potential usefulness of gathering such information, but did not believe these questions fit the historical purpose of the A.A. Membership Survey.

- The committee strongly supported the idea of utilizing digital survey methods for future surveys, and looks forward to hearing from the trustees’ P.I. Committee regarding how such a transition might best be accomplished.

- The committee reviewed presurvey communications for area delegates and groups randomly selected to participate in the 2014 A.A. Membership Survey, and offered some suggestions to the staff secretary for how such communication might be most effective and helpful. The committee acknowledged that successful administration of the survey depends upon delegate participation in the process.

- In light of ongoing anonymity concerns, the committee suggested that delegates and other trusted servants utilize a variety of means, such as workshops, newsletters, panels, delegate reports, local A.A. websites, skits, presentations, etc., to stimulate A.A. members’ discussion on how to maintain anonymity at the public level. Because the ranks of our ever-changing membership exist in an ever-changing world, the committee acknowledged that such efforts truly have no end-point, and might best be incorporated as a regular part of local A.A. discussions and events. The committee asked the staff secretary to explore both direct and indirect ways of sharing these concerns, and a list of A.A. resources on anonymity, with the A.A. Fellowship. The committee also asked

¹Members of this committee serve on this as a secondary committee assignment.

the staff secretary to share the following suggestions with the 2015 International Convention coordinator for emphasis on anonymity at the International Convention via the following means:

- Pre-Convention registration and communication materials, including AA.org.
 - Hospitality suite communication and materials.
 - Consideration of an anonymity booth or similar display.
- The committee reviewed a progress report on development of a brief video on anonymity for inclusion with the Annual Letter to the Media, and expressed support for the content and purpose of such a video. The committee requested that if such a video is created that it be brought back to the 2015 Conference Committee on Public Information prior to posting or distribution. The committee recognized that this may mean delayed mailing of the Annual Letter to the Media until after the next Conference. The committee also expressed support for the idea of using both Class A and Class B trustees in the video, with the Class B trustees' anonymity carefully protected, to serve as an example of how A.A. members can share information about A.A. in the media within the spirit of our anonymity tradition.
 - The committee reviewed the contents of the P.I. Kit and Workbook, and suggested adding the following items:
 - Anonymity Online (SM F-197)
 - Anonymity Card (F-20)
 - The committee reviewed the information on centralized distribution, tracking and evaluation of the "Tengo Esperanza" public service announcement.

REPORT AND CHARTER

- The committee accepted a report from the Publishing Department outlining the General Service Office process for timely and accurate preparation and publication of *The A.A. Service Manual* 2014-2015 Edition, and the 2014 General Service Conference Final Report. The committee noted that the "Report of the 2014 General Service Conference Inventory" in the Final Report may take longer to prepare than the other front matter and asked to review the page proofs of the inventory report as soon as possible prior to publication.
- In keeping with the 2009 Advisory Action that the General Service Board, the A.A.W.S. Board and the A.A. Grapevine Board annually review *The A.A. Service Manual* and forward necessary updates to the Conference Committee on Report and Charter, the committee reviewed the updates from the General Service Board, the A.A.W.S. Board and the A.A. Grapevine Board and suggested some revisions. The committee requested the General Service Board reconsider one item that they had forwarded.
- The committee reviewed the list of editorial updates from the Publishing Department for *The A.A. Service Manual* and suggested some revisions.
- The committee considered a request to modify Article 3 of the Current Conference Charter and took no action. The committee agreed that the proposed modification was unnecessary, noting that the existing phrasing of Article 3 adequately addresses the process for making a change to Article 12 of the Charter, the Twelve Traditions of A.A., or the Twelve Steps of A.A.
- The committee reconsidered a 2013 Conference Advisory Action regarding editing Area Service Highlights in the General Service Conference Final Report and took no action. The committee agreed that the entire Final Report should continue to be professionally edited and published, and noted that they had discussed the Area Service Highlights in 2013. The committee requested that the memo to first-year delegates regarding Area Service Highlights emphasize that the Highlights may be edited for the Final Report.

- The committee considered the A.A. Directories (Canada, Eastern U.S., and Western U.S.) and requested that the General Service Office explore alternative methods of accessing and distributing the contact information contained in the A.A. Directories (Canada, Eastern U.S., and Western U.S.). The committee requested that a report be brought back to the 2015 Report and Charter Conference Committee.

TREATMENT/SPECIAL NEEDS-ACCESSIBILITIES

- The committee thoroughly considered a proposal to revise the pamphlet "Bridging the Gap" to expand its scope to include information on related corrections service activity and took no action. The committee acknowledged the desire in some areas for a generic Conference-approved pamphlet about bridging the gap. While some areas have combined corrections and treatment bridging the gap activities, they remain separate in many others. The sense of the committee was that revising the current pamphlet to include both treatment and corrections might not adequately address the variety of bridging the gap programs that areas throughout the U.S. and Canada have developed to address their specific needs. Some of these areas have developed service material tailored specifically to explain their local programs.
- The committee requested that the General Service Board consider whether there is a need to develop a Conference-approved pamphlet addressing bridging the gap activities for corrections.
- The committee reviewed the Treatment Committee Kit and Workbook and agreed that the current contents adequately serve the needs of local committees.
- The committee reviewed the Special Needs/Accessibilities Kit and Workbook and expressed appreciation for the service material that is available to assist American Sign Language interpreters. They noted that the Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions are available in this format, and requested that a service piece be developed of the Twelve Concepts for World Service for signing purposes.
- The committee noted that the first line in Gloria's Story in the pamphlet "A.A. for the Alcoholic with Special Needs" that says "I was 84 years old and 11 years sober (Although I've been in A.A. since 1962...)" might be confusing to newcomers. They requested that the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment/Special Needs-Accessibilities consider whether this language might be clarified and bring back any suggestion for revision to the 2015 Conference Committee on Treatment/Special Needs-Accessibilities.
- The committee asked that the staff member on the Treatment/Special Needs-Accessibilities assignment explore ways to provide electronic versions of the Workbooks and other materials in the Kits to committee chairs as an alternative to automatically mailing hard copies.

TRUSTEES

- The committee reviewed the resumes and approved, as eligible for election, all Class B trustee candidates for the Eastern Canada and Pacific regional trustees.

RECOMMENDATIONS THAT DID NOT RESULT IN CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTIONS

A.A. GRAPEVINE

- The committee discussed a request "to reaffirm the Right of Decision of the A.A. Grapevine Board to make formatting decisions

for the A.A. Grapevine and La Viña magazines.” The committee acknowledged that Grapevine and La Viña are valuable Twelfth-Step tools. The committee recommended that the A.A. Grapevine Board have the ability to exercise their right of decision for all formatting decisions in producing Grapevine and La Viña noting that this recommendation removes all formatting restrictions on Grapevine and La Viña.

LITERATURE

- The committee recommended removing the following text from page five in the *Living Sober* booklet:

“Many of us have come to believe that our alcoholism is an addiction to the drug alcohol; like addicts of any sort who want to maintain recovery, we have to keep away from the first dose of the drug we have become addicted to.”

NOTE: The committee agreed that the current text added to confusion regarding A.A.’s Singleness of Purpose.

- The committee recommended that “Nonalcoholics are welcome to attend open meetings as observers” be added to the end of the open meeting side of the Primary Purpose (Blue) Card (F-17) in all three languages when the inventory of the English version is depleted.

The statement will read as follows (addition in **bold**):

“This Is An Open Meeting Of Alcoholics Anonymous

This is an open meeting of Alcoholics Anonymous. We are glad you are all here — especially newcomers. In keeping with our singleness of purpose and our Third Tradition which states that “The only requirement for A.A. membership is a desire to stop drinking,” we ask that all who participate confine their discussion to their problems with alcohol. **Nonalcoholics are welcome to attend open meetings as observers.”**

(The 1987 General Service Conference made this statement available as an A.A. service piece for those groups who wish to use it.)

NOTE: The committee agreed that this item is available as a service piece for groups and is not intended to limit attendance at anniversaries or other A.A. events.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

- The committee recommended that the Anonymity Card (F-20), which currently reads:

A.A. ANONYMITY (ANNOUNCEMENT FOR READING AT MEETINGS OPEN TO THE PUBLIC)

There may be some here who are not familiar with our Tradition of personal anonymity at the public level:

“Our public relations policy is based on attraction rather than promotion; we need always maintain personal anonymity at the level of press, radio and films.”

Thus, we respectfully ask that A.A. speakers and A.A. members not be photographed, videotaped, or identified by full name on audiotapes and in published or broadcast reports of our meetings, including those reports on new media technologies such as the Internet.

The assurance of anonymity is essential in our efforts to help other problem drinkers who may wish to share our recovery program with us. And our Tradition of anonymity reminds us that “A.A. principles come before personalities.”

Be changed to read:

A.A. ANONYMITY (ANNOUNCEMENT FOR READING AT A.A. MEETINGS)

There may be some here who are not familiar with our Tradition of personal anonymity at the public level:

“Our public relations policy is based on attraction rather than promotion; we need always maintain personal anonymity at the level of press, radio and films.” **Anonymity breaks on the Internet, social media and all other forms of public communications are contrary to our Tradition of personal anonymity at the public level. When we break our anonymity at the public level, we may inadvertently break the anonymity of others, and adversely affect A.A. as a whole.**

In keeping with this spiritual principle, A.A. speakers and A.A. members ought not be photographed, video recorded, or identified by full name on audio recordings, and in published or broadcast reports of our meetings, including online resources accessible by the public.

The assurance of anonymity is essential in our efforts to help other problem drinkers who may wish to share our recovery program with us. And our Tradition of anonymity reminds us that “A.A. principles come before personalities.”

FLOOR ACTIONS THAT DID NOT RESULT IN CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTIONS

- To add a single line item to the General Fund budget for La Viña. **(Not approved)**

- The 64th General Service Conference reaffirm the right of decision of the Grapevine Board to making formatting decisions for the A.A. Grapevine and La Viña magazines noting:

- a. That right is already exercised by publication of La Viña in color and
- b. The 2010 Advisory Action recommended a beginning point in bringing La Viña on spiritual parity with the A.A. Grapevine. **(Not approved)**

- The Conference consider the use of the circle and triangle on Conference-approved literature as a historical reminder of A.A.’s Three Legacies of Recovery, Unity and Service. **(Conference voted not to consider)**

- A.A. Grapevine discontinue publishing the “Alcoholism at Large” section of The Grapevine Magazine. **(Not approved)**

- The General Service Conference recommended that literature which focuses on “Alcoholics in Recovery with Mental Health Issues” be developed. **(Not approved)**

- Proposed Anonymity Card

The A.A. principle of anonymity at the public level is one of A.A.’s oldest protections and has helped attract countless newcomers from out of the shadows and into the rooms of Alcoholics Anonymous. Therefore, anonymity breaks on the Internet, social media, and all other forms of public communications are not only contrary to our Tradition of personal anonymity at the public level, they can scare away a problem drinker reaching out for help.

In the spirit of anonymity A.A. speakers and A.A. members ought not be photographed, video recorded, or identified by full name on audio recordings, and in published or broadcast reports of our meetings including online resources accessible to the public. The assurance of anonymity is essential in our efforts to help other problem drinkers who may wish to share our recovery program with us. And our Tradition of Anonymity reminds us that A.A. principles come before personalities. **(Conference voted not to consider)**

Additional Committee Considerations

Advisory Action 40 of the 1990 General Service Conference states: "Items discussed, but no action taken or recommendation made, as well as committee recommendations which are not adopted, be included in a separate section of the Final Report." All items, listed by committee, are as follows.

AGENDA

- The committee reviewed the Conference Evaluation Form and made no changes.
- The committee discussed providing the General Service Conference Evaluation Form in an anonymous digital format, in addition to the current paper format, and requested that the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference explore this option and provide a report to the 2016 Conference Agenda Committee.
- The committee reviewed the report on the Conference Agenda Process from the trustees' Committee on the Conference. After a thorough and lengthy discussion, the committee noted that while there were several areas of progress, the report did not fully explore the potential role that the Conference Agenda Committee might play in the selection process of Agenda items in the future. Therefore the committee requested that the trustees' Committee on the Conference fully explore the potential role that the Conference Agenda Committee might play in the selection process of Agenda items in the future and provide a report to the 2016 Conference Agenda Committee.
- The committee supported the concept under consideration by the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference to make trustees' Committee background available to the delegate chairperson of their corresponding Conference committee at the quarterly board weekend prior to the Conference. The committee noted that this would increase the effectiveness of the delegate chairpersons' participation in the trustees' committee meeting.
- The committee discussed adding a review of the Conference week schedule (Conference Agenda) to the standing items on the committee agenda and took no action, noting that this is not necessary as this is included in the Conference Agenda Committee's Scope.

ARCHIVES¹

- The committee reviewed the contents of the Archives Workbook noting minor editorial changes and a new section, "Sharing on Digital Archives," which will provide sharing and suggestions for Archives committees.
- The committee discussed the "Shared Experiences" section in the Archives Workbook, which is refreshed every five years. The committee suggested including experience shared by local archivists and archives committees on where archives are housed, associated costs, access procedures, and description of contents.

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

- The committee reviewed the contents of the Cooperation With the Professional Community Kit and Workbook and made the following suggestions:
 - That changes suggested by the 2015 Cooperation With the Professional Community Conference Committee to the



Cooperation With the Professional Community Workbook be forwarded to the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment/Special Needs-Accessibilities for review and implementation.

- That the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment/Special Needs-Accessibilities review the pamphlet, "Three Talks To Medical Societies by Bill W., Co-Founder of A.A.," noting the 2015 Conference Committee's concerns related to its language, outdated information and relevance to modern day medical professionals.

The committee noted that future development of material may be needed to reflect current information about A.A. to be provided to medical professionals, perhaps utilizing past and current Class A trustees.

- That the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment/Special Needs-Accessibilities continue to read and review the selection of pamphlets included in the C.P.C. Kit, taking into consideration whether the current selection best supports the needs of C.P.C. Committees and professionals in terms of language and content, particularly in the following pamphlets:
 - Speaking At Non-A.A. Meetings
 - A Brief Guide To Alcoholics Anonymous
 - Is There an Alcoholic In the Workplace?
 - How A.A. Members Cooperate With Professionals
 - The A.A. Member—Medications and Other Drugs

CORRECTIONS

- The committee discussed the Corrections Correspondence Service (C.C.S.) and requested that the trustees' Committee on Corrections consider reviewing the effectiveness of the criteria used for linking alcoholics behind the walls with outside volunteers. One specific concern is the distance requirement for correspondents participating in the Corrections Correspondence Service (C.C.S.).
- The committee discussed ways to engage members in Corrections service and noted the helpfulness of the new service piece, "Engaging A.A. Members in Corrections Work" in this effort.
- The committee reviewed the contents of the Corrections Kit and Workbook and suggested that the prison issue of the A.A. Grapevine publication, La Viña, be included in the English-language Corrections Kit.

¹Members serve on this committee as a secondary committee assignment.



FINANCE

- The committee reviewed the suggested area contribution for delegate expense for the Conference and after a lengthy discussion, agreed an increase was not appropriate at this time.
- The committee received and discussed information from the A.A.W.S. Self-Support Committee, looked favorably on work to date and urged continuing efforts.
- The committee ran out of time and did not review the Self-Support packet, however, it noted it was reviewed in detail last year.

GRAPEVINE

- The committee reviewed the 2015 Grapevine Office Report on Audio Strategy and requested that the Grapevine office provide an updated status and financial report on the project, including practices, financials, metrics and plans for the future to the 2016 Conference Committee on the Grapevine.
- The committee reviewed the A.A. Grapevine Board's 2015 Office Report on La Viña and agreed that La Viña is published as cost effectively as possible given existing parameters and conditions. The committee agreed with the A.A. Grapevine Board's suggestion to develop and implement a communication plan that utilizes (but is not limited to) A.A. Grapevine, Inc.'s newsletters, Forum presentations, and *Box 4-5-9* to clarify to the Fellowship La Viña's unique status as a hybrid entity that is at once a service to the Fellowship and is also required to strive to become self-supporting.
- The committee encouraged the support and purchase of Subscription Gift Certificates by local service committees, groups and members as a way to carry the A.A. message. These subscriptions would be used to provide magazines to people in correctional facilities, treatment centers, nursing homes, and other facilities or locations. This work would be accomplished at the local area level.
- The committee discussed ways to increase organization-wide support for Grapevine and La Viña and suggested that:
 1. Areas champion and embrace Grapevine/La Viña as the International Journals of A.A. through consistent narrative support in all relevant presentations, reports, announcements, newsletters and letters.
 2. All A.A. entities be offered the opportunity to include a GV/ LV link (with or without images) on local/area websites.
 3. All areas participate in AAGV Inc.'s 2015 Subscription Challenge.
- The committee agreed to forward to the A.A. Grapevine Board

the suggestion that Grapevine produce in the year 2016 or later¹

- 1 Armed Forces Members' AA Stories (working title). Members who have served in the military share their experiences with getting sober or staying sober in A.A., previously published in Grapevine magazine and/or AAGrapevine.org.
- 2 Voices from Early AA (working title) A collection of stories from the earliest days of Alcoholics Anonymous and Grapevine, previously published in Grapevine magazine and/or AAGrapevine.org.

- The committee reviewed the Grapevine Workbook.

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/ REGIONAL FORUMS¹

- The committee heard reports on the upcoming 2015 International Convention:
 - Over 40,000 people have registered for the Convention so far. About half of those have prepurchased the special 2015 Convention souvenir book, *Alcoholics Anonymous: 80 Years — Happy, Joyous and Free*. The Grapevine's commemorative edition of the book, *Happy, Joyous and Free*, has also been preordered and subscriptions to the Grapevine and La Viña have been sold through the preregistration process.
 - This is the third International Convention where online registration was available. Communications have been made to insure that all attendees are prepared for the Convention experience, and understand the challenges of weather and getting around the large convention facility.
 - Preparations are in place for the anonymity-protected broadcast of the Friday night Flag Ceremony.
 - The Advance Program guide has been sent to all registrants and is available on G.S.O.'s A.A. website.
 - Notices have been included in Convention material to emphasize A.A.'s Anonymity Traditions to attendees and the *Box 4-5-9* spring issue featured the article "Anonymity and the 2015 International Convention." The Convention program also includes a new panel meeting titled "Anonymity and the Convention – I get It!"
 - The Convention APP will be launched in early May for download on mobile devices.
 - New to the International Convention will be an Anonymity Booth and a "Carry the Message" pavilion featuring booths providing information on A.A.'s Cooperation With the Professional Community, Corrections, Grapevine/La Viña, Public Information, Special Needs-Accessibilities and Treatment committee service.
- The committee discussed ways to encourage interest in Regional Forums and attract first-time attendees, and suggested:
 - That delegates and area trusted servants communicate the value of Forum participation early and often;
 - Share with the Fellowship the easy availability of one-on-one conversations with trustees, directors and staff members that can be found at the Forums;
 - Consider utilizing A.A. Conventions and other A.A. events as opportunities to share the new Regional Forum Flyers with the Fellowship;

LITERATURE

- The committee reviewed a suggestion to produce a book combining Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions with the Twelve

¹Members serve on this committee as a secondary committee assignment.

Concepts for World Service and took no action. The committee noted that the *Twelve Concepts for World Service* are suitably placed with *The A.A. Service Manual* and in a stand-alone volume.

- The committee suggested consideration of developing a service piece on A.A. as a resource for the mental health professional.
- The committee reviewed the complete text of “The A.A.W.S., Inc. Policy on Publication of Literature” and suggested that “The A.A.W.S., Inc. Policy on Publication of Literature” always be included as background for the Conference Committee on Literature.
- The committee suggested that the trustees’ Literature Committee develop a plan for the systematic review of recovery literature and bring it to the 2016 Conference Literature Committee for its review.
- The committee suggested that a white imprint area for local use be included on the back of each pamphlet as it comes up for reprint.

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

- The committee reviewed a request for a representative from the General Service Board of A.A. in the Czech Republic to attend the 65th General Service Conference as an observer. In light of a recent communication from the General Service Board of the Czech Republic that their group conscience had come to a decision not to send an observer to the 65th General Service Conference, no action was necessary.
- The committee requested that, to assist the committee in its deliberations, when background for any agenda item of the committee references specific policy, that the policy referenced be included as part of the background.
- The committee considered a request that a recording of the A.A. meeting at the opening dinner of the General Service Conference be provided to each member of the General Service Conference and took no action. The committee agreed that the A.A. talks at the Opening Dinner of the Conference are enjoyable and reflect the A.A. stories of the speakers, but are not specifically focused on A.A. service.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

- While discussing the proposed video public service announcement, “Doors,” the committee expressed their appreciation for the thinking behind attempting to use already-recorded A.A. members’ stories, as both a cost-saving measure and for the purpose of authenticity.
- The committee reviewed the 2014 Annual Report from the trustees’ Committee on Public Information regarding G.S.O.’s A.A. website. The committee appreciated the inclusion of selected website analytics and looks forward to emerging clarity of how this information might be useful to A.A.’s work of carrying the message.
- The committee discussed a brief video on anonymity produced to accompany the annual Anonymity Letter to the Media, and agreed that the video is an engaging tool for communicating with the press. The committee suggested that the Intra-Office Website Committee (I.O.W.C.) explore additional pages on the aa.org website where this video might be useful, in addition to the Press/Media page, and pass along their suggestions to the A.A.W.S. Board for consideration.
- The committee reviewed the 2015 Public Information

Comprehensive Media plan and expressed their appreciation for the report’s responsiveness to suggestions offered by the 2014 Conference Public Information Committee. The committee offered the following suggestions:

Refining existing tools.

- Considering the immediate need for guidance on the use of social media by A.A. members, the committee asked the staff secretary to share information with all P.I. committee chairs and area delegates about existing literature that offers suggestions regarding A.A. principles and the Internet. The distribution of this information should correspond with the launch of the new Anonymity Resource Page planned for the aa.org website, which promises to be a useful tool for sharing information on this vital topic with A.A. members, the media, and the general public.
- The committee also suggested that the Publishing Department develop a new section in the Public Information Workbook on the Internet and Social Media based on existing literature on the subject, with the understanding that such content may need updating as new information is gathered about online platforms.
- The committee agreed with the suggestion in the report from the trustees’ Public Information Committee on A.A. Video P.S.A.s that the Spanish video P.S.A. “Tengo Esperanza” be translated into English and French, and that the 2016 Conference Public Information Committee consider centrally distributing and tracking the new spots.

Exploring new forms/channels of presenting/distributing content.

- The committee considered favorably the suggestion that the 2015 trustees’ Public Information Committee gather information about the potential for using platforms such as Twitter, Instagram and Google+ for the purpose of providing information about A.A. to the public. The committee strongly suggested that the exploration take into consideration the still-relevant concerns regarding potential implications to our Traditions reflected in the 2012 Report of the Public Information Social Media Page Subcommittee. The committee suggested that the General Service Board explore these resources and report back to the 2016 Conference Public Information Committee with consideration of the following:
 - Specific benefits of using each resource for reaching the still-suffering alcoholic;
 - How each platform will help the public information task of providing accurate information about what A.A. is and what it is not;
 - How each platform might be utilized while still maintaining member anonymity;
 - How each platform might be utilized while avoiding the appearance of promotion and still allowing our friends to recommend us;
 - How user interaction with A.A. content on such platforms might avoid controversy, or the appearance of endorsement or affiliation;
 - Clear distinctions between (a) public information work, and (b) general communication such as fellowship among members, and interaction between members and nonmembers;
 - Information about terms of service and privacy policies;
 - Information about the use of these platforms by other Twelve Step fellowships;
 - Information about the local use of these platforms gathered from various parts of the A.A. Fellowship (e.g. delegate

areas, intergroup/central offices, YPAAs, the National A.A. Technology Workshop and G.S.O.s outside the U.S. and Canada).

- The committee discussed a suggestion that the trustees' Public Information Committee explore a project for anonymity videos produced by A.A. members for A.A. members and agreed that emerging technologies for how member-submitted content might be gathered should be explored prior to developing a proposal for such a project. The committee asked the staff secretary to forward a list of questions and concerns to the trustees' P.I. Committee, and asked that a report or draft proposal be brought back to the 2016 Conference Public Information Committee for review.
- The committee discussed how to increase A.A. member participation in local public information work, and asked the staff secretary to share a list of suggestions with the trustees' Public Information Committee and with local P.I. chairs.
- The committee reviewed the contents of the P.I. Kit and Workbook, and made the following suggestions:
 - Information about the new video on anonymity be included with information already in the Kit about annual communication with the media.
 - The committee suggested that the text on page 14 of the current P.I. Workbook be revised to reflect the current content on the F-20 Anonymity Card.
 - The committee suggested that the information on page 47 of the current P.I. Workbook regarding the G.S.O.'s A.A. website be updated to reflect the redesigned website.
 - The committee suggested that the online PDF version of the P.I. Workbook, when referencing other A.A. publications on the aa.org website, be linked digitally to those items online. The committee suggested that other service workbooks might need review for similar updates.
 - While discussing potential changes to the P.I. Kit and Workbook, the committee agreed that it would be helpful to have a way to easily identify new or updated information on the aa.org website and in printed material. The committee asked the staff secretary to share this suggestion with the A.A.W.S. Board.

REPORT AND CHARTER

- The committee accepted a report from the Publishing Department outlining the General Service Office process for timely and accurate preparation and publication of *The A.A. Service Manual 2015-2016 Edition*, and the 2015 General Service Conference *Final Report*. The committee noted that the "Report of the 2015 General Service Conference Inventory" in the Final Report may take longer to prepare than the other front matter and asked to review the page proofs of the inventory report as soon as possible prior to publication.
- The committee requested the opportunity to review the page proofs of the *Final Report of the General Service Conference Inventory* prior to publication.
- The committee reviewed a list of editorial updates from the Publishing Department for *The A.A. Service Manual* and suggested some revisions.
- In keeping with the 2009 Advisory Action that the General Service Board, the A.A.W.S. Board and the A.A. Grapevine Board annually review *The A.A. Service Manual* and forward necessary updates to the Conference Committee on Report and Charter,

the committee reviewed the updates from the General Service Board, the A.A.W.S. Board and the A.A. Grapevine Board and suggested some revisions.

- The committee considered a request to include a chart in *The A.A. Service Manual* in the section "Working with Local Intergroups and Central Offices" on pages S41-S42 and took no action. The committee noted that since local intergroups and central offices are not part of the general service structure, a chart could be misleading; and that the description of this vital service provided by these local intergroup/central offices was adequately expressed in the text.
- The committee considered the complexities involved in annual production of *The A.A. Service Manual* and requested that the General Service Office consider publishing *The A.A. Service Manual* every other year and requested that a report on alternative publishing schedules, including cost considerations, be brought back to the 2016 Conference Committee on Report and Charter.
- The committee considered the A.A. Directories (Canada, Eastern U.S., Western U.S. and International) and suggested that the section currently called "Online Meetings" be reviewed and possibly renamed "Online Meetings/Groups" to reflect the Twelfth Step work that some online groups carry out beyond the meetings.
- The committee considered the General Service Conference *Final Report* and suggested that the Publishing Department consider using a larger font to make the *Final Report* more accessible; and requested that a report from the Publishing Department on the feasibility of producing a large-print format of the General Service Conference *Final Report* including cost estimates be brought back to the 2016 Conference Committee on Report and Charter.
- The committee considered the General Service Conference *Final Report* and suggested that several items of interest be highlighted on the front cover including: "Advisory Actions," "Area Highlights," and "Presentations."

TREATMENT/SPECIAL NEEDS/ACCESSIBILITIES

- The committee supported the trustees' committee's request for the A.A.W.S. Board to consider posting contents of A.A. literature items produced in audio formats on G.S.O.'s website, aa.org.
- The committee expressed appreciation for the A.A.W.S. Publishing Department's consideration to publish a service piece of the Twelve Concepts for World Service for ASL signing purposes.
- The committee supported the efforts of the A.A.W.S. Board to explore ways to provide electronic versions of the Workbooks and other material in the Kits to committee chairs as an alternative to automatically mailing hard copies and noted the following:
 - The committee strongly encouraged that postal mailing of printed Workbooks and other material in the Kits be the primary means of delivery.
 - The committee noted that the "opt-in" measure in the welcome letter to new chairs did not reflect the intent of the 2014 Conference Committee's Consideration and resulted in incomplete data. They suggested that a survey be taken of new chairs from the "exploratory period" who did not respond to their welcome letter to attempt to better understand the effectiveness of the electronic service material and the exploratory approach in general.



- The committee reviewed the Treatment Committee Kit and Workbook and forwarded suggestions for updates to the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment/Special Needs-Accessibilities.
- The committee reviewed the Special Needs-Accessibilities Committee Kit and Workbook and forwarded suggestions for updates to the trustees' committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment/Special Needs-Accessibilities.
- The committee requested the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment/Special Needs-Accessibilities consider how to better realize the commitment to make A.A. more readily available to all and suggested:
 - Focusing on the concept of overcoming barriers in accessing, receiving, and carrying the A.A. message, rather than the limiting concept of identifying "special needs" and to consider how this change might be reflected in the trustees' committee scope.
 - Changing all references to "Special Needs-Accessibilities" to "Accessibilities," including the trustees' and Conference Committee names.
 - Revising the Special Needs-Accessibilities Workbook with a particular focus on emphasizing solutions to overcoming barriers.
 - Reorganizing the Special Needs-Accessibilities Workbook to include the following sections: 1) Accessing the A.A. Message 2) Receiving the A.A. Message 3) Carrying the A.A. Message. Each section might include shared experience for overcoming barriers.

TRUSTEES

- The committee reviewed the resumes and approved, as eligible for election, all Class B trustee candidates for the Northeast and Southwest regional trustees and the trustee-at-large/Canada.
- Reflecting on the importance of Concept XI, the committee encouraged the General Service Board and A.A. Fellowship to identify, attract and recruit in a timely manner, a diverse, competent and qualified pool of candidates to serve as Class A (non-alcoholic) trustees, Class B (alcoholic) trustees, nontrustee directors and appointed committee members on trustees' committees.

RECOMMENDATIONS THAT DID NOT RESULT IN CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTIONS

FINANCE

- The committee recommended that the maximum annual limit contributed to the General Service Board from an individual A.A. member be increased from \$3,000 to \$5,000.

LITERATURE

- The committee recommended that the draft text for the section "A.A. Grapevine, Inc." in "Inside A.A. Understanding the Fellowship and Its Services" be changed from:

A.A. Grapevine, Inc., while not a service agency, is a separate corporation with its own board, which is under the guidance of the trustees. A.A. Grapevine, Inc. is responsible for publishing the print magazines Grapevine and La Viña, the Website, books, audio and other products to carry the A.A. message to U.S., Canada and beyond.

To:

A.A. Grapevine, Inc. is a separate corporation with its own board that is under the guidance of the trustees. A.A. Grapevine, Inc. is responsible for publishing the print magazines Grapevine and La Viña, the A.A. Grapevine website, books, audio and other products to carry the A.A. message worldwide.

FLOOR ACTIONS THAT DID NOT RESULT IN CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTIONS

- During reprints of Conference-approved literature and service materials, consider adding "aa.org" wherever the General Service Office contact information, and phone numbers are listed. **(Withdrawn by submitter)**
- That Section 12 of the Bylaws of the General Service Board be amended to state "The number of member trustees constituting the entire membership shall be twenty-one, except as otherwise provided herein." **(Withdrawn by submitter)**
- That the following text be added in Chapter Six of *The A.A. Service Manual* as the final bullet point under duties: "The outgoing delegate provides G.S.O. with contact information for all incoming area officers and committee chairs." **(Not approved)**
- Produce a book combining the Twelve Steps, The Twelve Traditions and the Twelve Concepts for World Service. **(Not approved)**
- Beginning with the 2016 General Service Conference, all general session voting will be done electronically. **(Withdrawn by submitter)**
- **Rescind the previous Advisory Action that reads:**

"The trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference create a plan to translate all Conference material with a progress report given to the 2016 Conference Committee on Policy and Admissions that describes the process and costs including options using third party translators and a proposal to change agenda submission deadlines."

And replace with:

"With a target date of 2018, the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference create a plan to translate all Conference material with a progress report given to the 2016 Conference Committees on Policy and Admissions and Finance that describes the process and costs including options using third party translators and a proposal to change agenda submission deadlines." **(Not approved)**

Additional Committee Considerations

Advisory Action 40 of the 1990 General Service Conference states: "Items discussed, but no action taken or recommendation made, as well as committee recommendations which are not adopted, be included in a separate section of the Final Report." Items, listed by committee, are summarized as follows:

AGENDA

The committee discussed the importance of the General Service Conference Inventory Compendium and the Additional Recommendations/Suggestions section, encouraging all Conference members to review this section for possible actions locally, regionally and at future Conferences; after discussion of the trustees' report regarding the Conference Agenda Committee and the agenda selection process, it was agreed that the actions of the Conference Agenda Committee are matters of policy not just routine programming and that the committee name should remain the same.

ARCHIVES¹

Through area assemblies and committee meetings, archives workshops, notices in *Box 4-5-9* and *Markings*, encouragement was suggested for A.A. groups to write or update their group histories, with the suggestion that the Archives service piece "Researching Group Histories" be distributed to G.S.R.s and D.C.M.s; suggestions were made to include additional resources to the Archives Workbook at its next printing.

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

The committee considered a request to discontinue the pamphlet "Three Talks to Medical Societies by Bill W." and took no action, with the suggestion that the trustees' committee continue discussing the historical value of the pamphlet and the possibility of keeping it available to the Fellowship; ways of integrating technology into the professional exhibits were offered regarding the inclusion of digital response or QR codes for pamphlets and tabletop displays, as well as development of an audiovisual presentation for continuous screening at professional events; suggestions were made for items to be added to the C.P.C. Kit and Workbook, and the "Matrix of Individual Comments" was reviewed with the suggestion that proposed changes to material *not* under the purview of the C.P.C. committee be forwarded to the appropriate trustees' committees for appraisal.

CORRECTIONS

It was noted that an accompanying service piece in a 2014 Advisory Action for the video "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell" does not exist and so cannot be updated or revised; a suggestion was made to the trustees' Committee on Corrections to consider additional versions of the video "A

New Freedom" in varying lengths for different audiences in different settings; challenges regarding the expansion of the Corrections Correspondence Service (C.C.S.) in Canada were discussed, as were ways to attract more Spanish-speaking "outside" A.A. members to the service, while additions to the C.C.S. form (F-26) and the Corrections Kit and Workbook were suggested to the trustees' Committee on Corrections.

FINANCE

After discussion, no action was taken to increase the Suggested Delegate Area Contribution to the General Service Conference or to increase the one-time limit for individual bequests; it was suggested that G.S.O. consider additional ways, using technology, to convey the financial message contained in the flyer "The Seventh Tradition Fact Sheet" (F-203) and indicated that this item could be included in the Self-Support Packet (F-19) while removing other less effective pieces; regarding future International Conventions, it was suggested that measures be considered to assure self-support through registration activities and that the feasibility of a separate ongoing Convention Fund be considered; when dealing with items such as the World Service Meeting and related activities, it was suggested that the General Service Board consider the spiritual message of self-support in its spending priorities.

GRAPEVINE

The 2016 Grapevine Office Report on Audio Strategy was reviewed and a request made for updated information on the project to be provided to the 2017 Conference Committee on the Grapevine; suggestions were forwarded to the Grapevine board to produce books with the working titles "Stories by Atheist and Agnostic AA Members" and "Steps Four and Five" in 2017 or later; the committee reviewed the Grapevine Workbook.

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/ REGIONAL FORUMS¹

Providing more information about Regional Forums, including event details on local Area websites, suggestions to "bring a buddy" and informing members outside the Region about upcoming Forums were highlighted as ways to encourage interest and attract first time attendees; noting that the 2015 International Convention showed a loss, the committee discussed ongoing efforts by G.S.O. and the General Service Board to plan effectively for the 2020 International Convention in Detroit, Michigan, as well as recognizing positive new features from the 2015 Convention such as the Anonymity Booth and the Carry the Message Pavilion, along with the participation of over 700 A.A. members who are deaf.

LITERATURE

After discussion, no action was taken on a request to produce a plain language version of the Big Book and

¹Members serve on this committee as a secondary committee assignment.

a report from A.A.W.S. on “pagination” of Conference-approved digital texts was accepted with encouragement that A.A.W.S. continue to investigate all possible solutions; the committee reviewed progress reports from the trustees’ committee on the revision of the pamphlets “A.A. for the Woman,” “A.A. and the Gay/Lesbian Alcoholic” and the development of literature for A.A.s with mental health issues and those who sponsor them, and looks forward reviewing draft copy, revisions or progress reports on these items at the 2017 Conference; suggestions for the revised draft pamphlet “Inside A.A.: Understanding the Fellowship and Its Services” were offered to the trustees’ Literature Committee for consideration when a revised draft or progress report is brought to the 2017 Conference; it was suggested that the need for “plain-language” recovery literature be explored by the trustees’ Literature Committee.

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

The committee suggested that G.S.O. and the trustees’ committee on the General Service Conference explore ways to provide information to and encourage coordinated efforts among local translation committees regarding translation of Conference background into French and Spanish; regarding Conference observers from other fellowships, the committee took no action, noting that the General Service Conference is a closed business meeting and that A.A. freely shares its experience upon request; recognizing that current practices are sufficient and in keeping with the Conference Charter, the committee took no action on a request that all Conference members be sent the same background material with the exception

of digital media and works in progress; it was suggested that the trustees’ Committee on the General Service Conference consider developing procedures for electronic polling to be used only in matters of grave emergency that may occur between Conferences and that are in keeping with the Conference Charter.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

The committee reviewed and accepted the annual report of the trustees’ P.I. Committee on the G.S.O. and Grapevine websites, the 2016 P.I. Comprehensive Media plan, and information on the distribution, tracking and evaluation of the PSA “Doors”; it was suggested that the trustees’ P.I. Committee explore ways of providing guidance to the Fellowship on carrying the A.A. message to the general public online and in social media; the P.I. Kit and Workbook were reviewed, noting their usefulness; and the committee took no action on a request to reconsider 2011 Advisory Action 22, as the current policy on the use of full-face videos is adequate.

REPORT AND CHARTER

Reports from the Publishing department regarding preparation and publication of *The A.A. Service Manual* and General Service Conference *Final Report* were accepted along with a list of editorial updates from the Publishing department, the General Service Board and the A.A. Grapevine board for *The A.A. Service Manual*; a suggestion was made to include a definition of “Service Manual” in the Glossary of Service Terms in *The A.A. Service Manual/ Twelve Concepts for World Service*; adding text to the chart



on page S22 regarding the “Third Legacy Procedure” was suggested for consistency; the Publishing department was asked to consider using a larger font for the *Final Report* and including call-out text on the cover to highlight potential items of interest.

TREATMENT AND ACCESSIBILITIES

The committee suggested creation of an Accessibilities Checklist for the Special Needs/Accessibilities Kit that groups could use to inventory their accessibility to all alcoholics and that inclusion of the A.A. Guidelines on Carrying the Message to the Deaf Alcoholic in the Treatment Kit be reviewed.

TRUSTEES

After a review of resumes, all Class B trustee candidates for the West Central and Western Canada regions were approved as eligible; the committee discussed a report from the trustees’ Committee on Nominating regarding expanding the pool of candidates to serve the General Service Board and the Corporate Boards and encouraged consultation between the trustees’ Committee on Nominating and the General Service Board to identify the skills and backgrounds most needed for each opening; while direct questions on the candidate’s resume form regarding diverse characteristics was determined unnecessary, the committee suggested adding space to the current resume form that would allow candidates to provide additional background that might benefit the General Service Board.

Recommendations That Did Not Result In Conference Advisory Actions

FINANCE

- The committee recommended that the maximum annual limit for individual contributions to the General Service Board from A.A. members be increased from \$3,000 to \$5,000

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

- The committee recommended that background material continue to be provided in English because it is not feasible at this time to move forward with translation of Conference background into French and Spanish

Floor Actions That Did Not Result In Conference Advisory Actions

- That the trustees’ Committee on Public Information begin work on a Google-for-Nonprofit account to be used for carrying the A.A. message to the public. This request is limited to “YouTube for Nonprofit” to share video content and “Google Ad Words” which will help in search result placement. The trustees’ committee is asked to provide

a progress report to the 2017 Conference Committee on Public Information. **(Not approved)**

- That the standing agenda items on the Conference Finance Committee which read as follows:

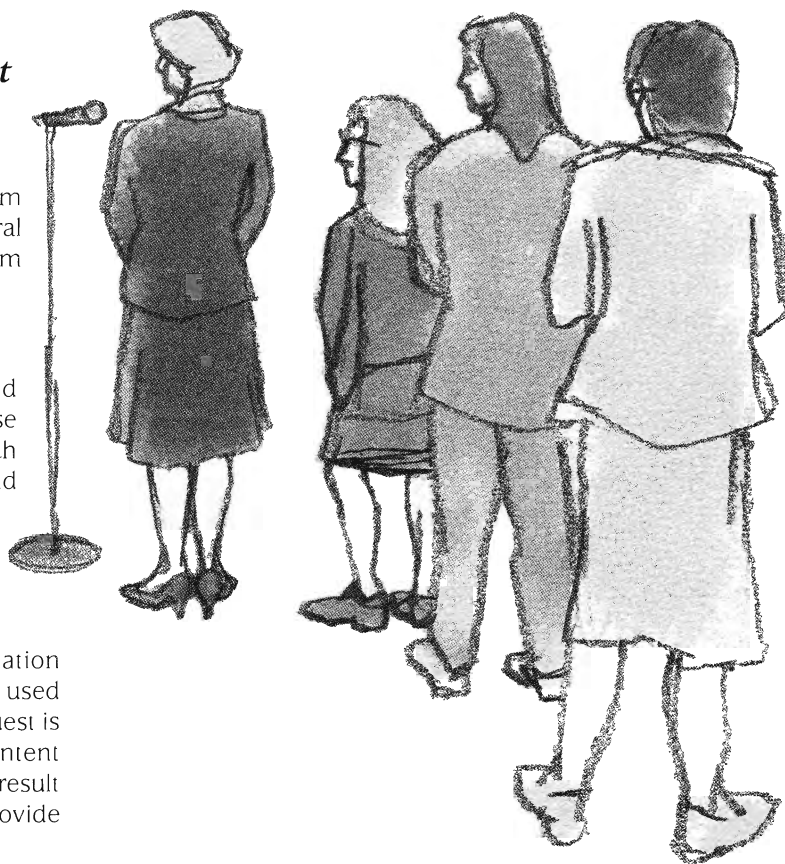
1. To review the contribution for delegate expense for the General Service Conference.
2. To approve individual bequests to the General Service Board from A.A. members.
3. To review maximum annual contribution to the General Service Board from an individual A.A. member of \$3,000.

be removed as standing items on the Conference Finance Committee agenda. **(Not approved)**

- That a subscription app for La Viña be created with the same technical components as the A.A. Grapevine app. **(Withdrawn by submitter)**

- That 2-3 hours be provided in the 67th Conference agenda to permit the Conference to consult on matters brought forward by the trustees of the General Service Board. **(Not approved)**

- That the minutes of the General Service Board meetings be posted to the General Service Conference dashboard as soon as they are approved so that all Area delegates have equal access to the minutes. **(Withdrawn by submitter)**



■ Additional Committee Considerations

Advisory Action 40 of the 1990 General Service Conference states: "Items discussed, but no action taken or recommendation made, as well as committee recommendations which are not adopted, be included in a separate section of the Final Report." Items, listed by committee, are summarized as follows:

AGENDA

The committee discussed Conference presentation/discussions and took no action to limit their number or preclude them from the 2018 Conference agenda, noting topics selected for 2018 were important for discussion at the Conference; with a low number of responses to the 2016 Conference Evaluation Form it was agreed to emphasize that all Conference members have an obligation to participate and encouraged efforts to make the form more focused and user-friendly; appreciation was noted for the additional communication and larger role for delegates in the selection of agenda items, with a request that information be gathered from 2018 Conference committee chairs and an enhanced role for delegates continue to be explored; it was requested that the grid of proposed Conference agenda items be updated to show the disposition of items by the trustees' committees and that it be posted to the dashboard as soon as possible following the January Board Weekend; no action was taken on a request to add text to the committee's Composition, Scope and Procedure regarding the option to meet by conference call prior to the Annual Meeting of the General Service Conference.

ARCHIVES*

No action was taken on a request to add text to the committee's Composition, Scope and Procedure regarding the option to meet by conference call prior to the Annual Meeting of the General Service Conference; the committee suggested refreshing the "Shared

Experiences" section of the Archives Workbook with new stories from local archivists and adding a new section to the "Archives and History" portal of the G.S.O. website to include updates from G.S.O. Archives.

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY COMMITTEE

The committee requested that the trustees' Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community/Treatment and Accessibilities continue to explore establishing a presence on LinkedIn as a tool for C.P.C. efforts and develop a full report that includes an exploration of all aspects of this social media tool and possibilities for implementation; improving communication about A.A. with professionals who come in contact with veterans and active members of the Armed Services was discussed and a number of suggestions made; no action was taken on a request to add text to the committee's Composition, Scope and Procedure regarding the option to meet by conference call prior to the Annual Meeting of the General Service Conference; the C.P.C. Kit and Workbook were reviewed, with the suggestion that the sample guide letters to various professionals be reviewed and updated to ensure that the language used is current and relevant to the professionals to whom they are addressed.

CORRECTIONS

The committee discussed raising awareness of the Corrections Correspondence Service (C.C.S.) in Canada and its benefits to both "inside" and "outside" members, making a number of suggestions and asking G.S.O. staff and the trustees' Committee on Corrections to look into additional options that could encourage broader utilization; carrying the A.A. message to incarcerated Native American/First Nations/Inuit People was discussed with agreement that local committees were best able to handle this important work, though to aid in carrying the message to this population, the committee suggested adding the pamphlet "Many Paths to Spirituality" to the Corrections Kit and the Corrections Group Handbook; the committee noted that some incarcerated French and Spanish members have difficulty with subtitles in the video "A New Freedom," and requested that A.A.W.S. make the message more accessible and consider developing a service piece to accompany the video.

FINANCE

The committee agreed that the Conference-approved level of \$5,000 for individual bequests to the General Service Board from A.A. members is an appropriate amount at this time; self-support efforts and materials were discussed with suggestions made for the Self-Support Packet, the Self-Support Card, the service piece "The A.A. Group Treasurer" and other aspects of communicating with the Fellowship about the



*Members serve on this committee as a secondary committee assignment.

spiritual message of Seventh Tradition contributions; communication about recurring contributions was discussed along with possibility of using an app to further increase carrying the message of recovery and self-support; the committee requested the trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee develop a list of Conference-approved literature where adding language regarding online and recurring contributions is appropriate and report back to the 2018 Conference Finance Committee.

GRAPEVINE

The committee discussed the spiritual value of Grapevine and La Viña in carrying the message of Alcoholics Anonymous and agreed that the magazines are important Twelfth Step tools, recognizing that Grapevine and La Viña cannot accept contributions and are self-supporting only through subscriptions and sales of books and other items; it was suggested that the Grapevine Board create a plan for outside sales of subscriptions, books and other items and report back to the 2018 Conference Committee on Grapevine; continued exploration of Instagram, Facebook and Google for Nonprofits accounts was discussed with a request for additional information and plans to be brought back to the 2018 Conference Committee on Grapevine for consideration; it was suggested that all delegates consider it a part of their responsibility to inform the Fellowship about Grapevine and La Viña as tools of sobriety, either through their own efforts or by recruiting others through email and area websites; the committee forwarded a number of suggestions to the A.A. Grapevine Board for items to be produced in the year 2018 or later and additions to the Grapevine workbook; an update on the 2017 Grapevine Office Report on Audio Strategy was requested for the 2018 Conference Committee on the Grapevine.

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/ REGIONAL FORUMS*

The committee discussed ways of encouraging interest in Regional Forums to attract first-time attendees and made a number of suggestions; the committee reviewed the 2030 International Convention Site-Selection Procedures; no action was taken to add text to the committee's Composition, Scope and Procedure regarding the option to meet by conference call prior to the Annual Meeting of the General Service Conference.

LITERATURE

The committee discussed but took no action on a request to retire the pamphlet "Too Young?"; after reviewing draft revisions or progress reports, the committee offered editorial suggestions for "Young People and A.A.," "A.A. for the Woman," "Finding Acceptance: A.A. for the LGBTQ Alcoholic" (formerly "A.A. and the Gay/Lesbian Alcoholic"), "The Twelve Traditions Illustrated," "Inside A.A.: Understanding the Fellowship and Its Services," and a pamphlet-in-progress for alcoholics with mental health issues and those who sponsor them, with the understanding that revised drafts or progress reports, where appropriate, would be brought back at the 2018 General

Service Conference; a request was made that the trustees' Public Information Committee consider adding information related to safety to the pamphlets "A Brief Guide to A.A." and "Understanding Anonymity"; the committee considered requests for the development of new literature regarding safety in A.A. and took no action, agreeing that shared experience regarding safety and A.A. would be best conveyed by revising existing literature, where appropriate, and noting that the new service piece, "Safety and A.A.: Our Common Welfare," has been found helpful in providing experience from groups and members on challenges, resources and possible solutions in situations that may involve the safety of groups or individual members; no action was taken on a request to add a section "Why A.A. groups and members should respect the rental requirements of their landlords" to the pamphlet "The A.A. Group," as it was agreed that an A.A. group's relationship with their landlord falls within the autonomy of the group.

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

The committee discussed but took no action on requests for regional service committees to bid on hosting the General Service Conference, that the Advisory Action delegating site selection for the General Service Conference to G.S.O. management be rescinded, that a "YPAA Subcommittee" be added to the service structure, and that text be added to the committee's Composition, Scope and Procedure regarding the option to meet by conference call prior to the Annual Meeting of the General Service Conference.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

The committee reviewed and accepted reports from the trustees' Public Information Committee regarding aa.org and aagrapevine.org, the Comprehensive Media Plan, and Carrying the Message Online and on Social Media, and requested that the trustees' committee continue to develop their ideas on the use of quick response (QR) codes, a video on anonymity and the Internet, and a daily text message, along with the development of service materials to address frequently asked questions regarding anonymity online and in social media, noting that the service piece "Anonymity Online" is still a valuable resource; information was reviewed and accepted on centralized distribution, tracking and evaluation of the public service announcement "I Have Hope"; suggestions were made that the trustees' Committee on Public Information continue to research the feasibility of A.A.W.S. using Google AdWords and Google Grants and bring a report to the 2018 Conference Committee on Public Information; a report from the trustees' Public Information Committee on the implementation of a Twitter account was reviewed with no action taken and continued pursuit of options for carrying the A.A. message to the public on social media was suggested; specific suggestions were offered for the pamphlet "Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings" to include revised text regarding the source of information identifying one-third of A.A. members as women and adding website information as needed; the contents of the P.I. Kit and Workbook were reviewed; no action was taken to add text to the

*Members serve on this committee as a secondary committee assignment.



committee's Composition, Scope and Procedure regarding the option to meet by conference call prior to the Annual Meeting of the General Service Conference.

REPORT AND CHARTER

The committee discussed and accepted reports outlining the General Service Office process for preparation and publication of *The A.A. Service Manual*, 2018-2020 Edition and the 2017 *Final Conference Report*; the complexities involved in biennial production of *The A.A. Service Manual* were discussed, noting that the process is still in its infancy and that substantive changes to the Service Manual can be found in the *Final Conference Report* as well as the Report and Charter Conference Committee's History and Highlights of Actions in years that a revised edition is not published; suggested revisions were offered to the proposed Service Manual updates from the General Service Board and the A.A. Grapevine Board; a plan for a revised editorial review process was requested to be brought back to the 2018 Conference Committee on Report and Charter along with suggestions on how changes to *The A.A. Service Manual* could be reported to the Fellowship in non-printing years; it was suggested that footnotes be added to *The A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts for World Service* to accurately reflect in Concept VIII the current ownership of the service corporations as presented in Footnote 3, Concept XI, and that the year A.A.W.S., Inc. and A.A. Grapevine, Inc. became membership corporations in the state of New York be added to both footnotes; no action was taken to add text to the committee's Composition, Scope and Procedure regarding the option to meet by conference call prior to the Annual Meeting of the General Service Conference.

TREATMENT AND ACCESSIBILITIES

The committee reviewed the Treatment Service Kit and made several suggestions for revisions; it was suggested that the title, menu and introduction to the DVD and CD currently titled "A.A. for the Alcoholic with Special Needs" be revised to "Accessibility for All Alcoholics," with subtitles in French and Spanish for the DVD; ways of incorporating shared experience in carrying the A.A. message to members of the Armed Services were discussed, including sharing at the pre-Conference Remote Communities meeting and translation of the pamphlet "A.A. and the Armed

Services" into French and Spanish and adding it to the Accessibilities Kit; a request was made that the General Service Office continue exploring strategies to provide more effective services to alcoholics who are veterans and active members of the Armed Services and provide a progress report to the 2018 Conference Committee on Treatment and Accessibilities; no action was taken to add text to the committee's Composition, Scope and Procedure regarding the option to meet by conference call prior to the Annual Meeting of the General Service Conference.

TRUSTEES

The committee approved as eligible for election all Class B trustee candidates and discussed the voting procedures for electing trustee-at-large/U.S. and a request to consider the need to restructure the number of regions and number of regional trustees serving on the General Service Board; a progress report was requested from the trustees' Committee on Nominating to the 2018 Conference Committee on Trustees reviewing available information on regional geographical structure, including consideration of each regional trustees' ability to effectively serve his or her areas, consideration of geographical factors and whether an equal or similar number of areas per region is desirable, as well as feasibility and cost analysis.

Recommendations Not Resulting in Conference Advisory Actions

CORRECTIONS

- The following text be added to the Composition, Scope and Procedure of the Conference Committee on Corrections:

In order to assist Conference committees in handling their workload, if a Conference committee feels it is helpful to complete the work of their committee, they are welcome to meet via conference call in the 60 days prior to the Annual Meeting of the General Service Conference. They may use the call for such things as deciding how to conduct their business, including the means of voting within the committee, reordering the items on their agenda if needed, and holding preliminary non-voting discussions on what they consider to be priority agenda items. Conference committee secretaries would be available to facilitate these meetings. **(Withdrawn by the committee)**

FINANCE

- The Conference-approved maximum annual contribution to the General Service Board from an individual A.A. member of \$3,000 be increased to \$5,000. **(Not approved)**
- The following text be added to the pamphlet "Self-Support: Where Money and Spirituality Mix": "Question: Are there limits to the amount of money an A.A. group or an A.A. event can contribute to G.S.O.? Answer: No," and include this language in all appropriate service material. **(Not approved)**

- The following text be added to the committee's Composition, Scope and Procedure:

The committee may meet by conference call in the 60 days prior to Conference for such things as deciding how to conduct their business, including the means of voting within the committee, reordering the items on their agenda if needed, and holding preliminary non-voting discussions on what they consider to be priority items. **(Withdrawn by the committee)**

GRAPEVINE

- The following text be added to the Composition, Scope and Procedure of the Conference Committee on Grapevine under procedures:

In order to assist the committee in handling its workload, the committee is welcome to meet via conference call in the 60 days prior to the Annual Meeting of the General Service Conference. They may use the call for such things as deciding how to conduct their business, including the means of voting within the committee, reordering the items on their agenda if needed, and holding preliminary non-voting discussions on what they consider to be priority agenda items. Conference committee secretaries would be available to facilitate these meetings. **(Withdrawn by the committee)**

LITERATURE

- The following text be added to the Composition, Scope and Procedure of the Conference Committee on Literature under procedures:

In order to assist the committee in handling its workload, the committee is welcome to meet via conference call in the 60 days prior to the Annual Meeting of the General Service Conference. They may use the call for such things as deciding how to conduct their business, including the means of voting within the committee, reordering the items on their agenda if needed, and holding preliminary non-voting discussions on what they consider to be priority agenda items. Conference committee secretaries would be available to facilitate these meetings. **(Withdrawn by the committee)**

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

- Option 2 in the Final Report on the Translation of Conference Background be implemented for the Spanish language only for a three-year trial period, and that an annual report from the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference be presented for review by the Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions. **(Recommitted to trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference)**
- The General Service Conference be held in New York City every other year. **(Not approved)**

PUBLIC INFORMATION

- The 2017 A.A. Membership Survey be conducted by area on a random basis as was done in the 2014 A.A. Membership Survey and requested that the trustees' Committee on Public Information review the current

A.A. Membership Survey methodology, possible methods for surveying the membership electronically and any reasonable hybrid of the two methods, and that a progress report be brought back to the 2018 Conference Committee on Public Information. **(Not approved)**

- The draft 2017 A.A. Survey Questionnaire be changed as follows:

Question 2 be changed from "Sex: ___ Male ___ Female" to "Gender Identity: ___ Male ___ Female ___ [language to include all gender nonconforming] ___ No Response" **(Recommitted to trustees' Committee on Public Information)**

TRUSTEES

- The following text be added to the Composition, Scope and Procedure of the Conference Committee on Trustees:

In order to assist Conference committees in handling their workload, if a Conference committee feels it is helpful to complete the work of their committee, they are welcome to meet via conference call in the 60 days prior to the Annual Meeting of the General Service Conference. They may use the call for such things as deciding how to conduct their business, including the means of voting within the committee, reordering the items on their agenda if needed, and holding preliminary non-voting discussions on what they consider to be priority agenda items. Conference committee secretaries would be available to facilitate these meetings. **(Withdrawn by the committee)**

Floor Actions Not Resulting in Conference Advisory Actions

- In order to reduce the current annual cost of more than \$50,000 and set an example for the Fellowship regarding our principles of rotation and financial prudence, the General Service Board develop a plan to allow no more than the immediate past chair of the General Service Board and two other emeritus trustees to attend each Board Weekend and the annual General Service Conference. **(Not approved)**
- The Conference adopt Option 1 on the translation of Conference background material into Spanish and French as it is presented in the agenda and background for Policy/Admissions. **(Withdrawn)**
- That the submission letters for proposed agenda items be placed on the Conference dashboard. **(Not approved)**
- The General Service Board develop a policy regarding limits on contributions to the board from groups and other A.A. entities, recognizing that groups and entities are autonomous in regard to both giving and accepting contributions. A draft text or progress report be brought to the appropriate committee of the 2018 General Service Conference. **(Conference declined to consider)**
- The General Service Conference of A.A. extend an invitation to the YPAA to have two of their members attend the 2018 General Service Conference as observers. **(Conference declined to consider)**

■ Committee Considerations

Advisory Action 40 of the 1990 General Service Conference states: "Items discussed, but no action taken or recommendation made, as well as committee recommendations which are not adopted, be included in a separate section of the Final Report." Listed by committee, such items are included here "in their entirety" per Advisory Action of the 2018 General Service Conference.

AGENDA

Committee Considerations:

- The committee reviewed the 2018 General Service Conference Evaluation and noted that the evaluation is now available for delegates to fill out online.
- The committee reviewed the summary of the 2017 General Service Conference evaluations. Noting the low number of respondents, the committee reiterated the obligation that Conference members have to fill out the evaluation.
- The committee reviewed the report on the Conference Agenda Process from the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference, which included the Trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference 2016 Report on the Agenda Item Selection Process.
- The committee noted that progress has been made on implementing the plan in the 2016 report. However, the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference forwarded a request to the General Service Board to continue to consider enhanced participation of area delegates in the process for selection of agenda items, and no action on this item was reported by the board.
- The committee noted that the 2016 report suggested:

Before the January board weekend, the entire Conference committee could have a conference call with the corresponding trustees' committee chair and staff secretary to review items submitted as agenda items and to talk about items still being considered by the trustees' committee. This way, Conference committee members would get a verbal report on the disposition of items submitted to the trustees' committee, and could share regarding those items. This would allow all Conference committee members to offer feedback on proposed Agenda items. Their feedback could be brought to the trustees' committee meeting as background for the discussion.

The committee noted that this has not happened and requested that the trustees' committee chairs implement this conference call portion of the plan starting in January 2019.

- After reviewing the results of the survey of Conference committee chairs about the implementation of the 2016 plan, the committee requested that this sharing be gathered from the Conference committee chairs annually and provided to the Conference Committee on Agenda.



- The committee requested the trustees' committee create a process for area delegate review of proposed agenda items that were not forwarded to a Conference committee and bring a report to the 2019 Conference Committee on Agenda.

ARCHIVES*

Committee Considerations:

- The committee discussed a request from the AA Grapevine Board to post the audio recording of the 2017 General Service Conference presentation, "AA Grapevine and La Viña" on AA Grapevine's YouTube channel and took no action for the following reasons:
 - » The request is not in accord with the current 2015 Conference Advisory Action, which states, "Audio recordings of General Service Conference final reports and audio recordings of the trustees' farewell talks given at the closing brunch be made available in accordance with Archives' policies. Access to all other General Service Conference sessions will continue to be prohibited."
 - » The presentation mentions names of A.A. members.
 - » The committee recognizes that the AA Grapevine Board might consider presenting the material at an A.A. event, such as a Regional Forum, and post the recording of this on the AA Grapevine Board's YouTube channel.

*Members serve on this committee as a secondary committee assignment.

- » The committee noted that the audience of General Service Conference presentations are Conference members only and that the focus is not the general public.
- The committee considered a request to develop a policy on distribution of audio recordings of General Service Conference presentations and took no action for similar reasons cited in the preceding committee consideration.
- The committee reviewed the Archives Workbook and made the following suggestions:
 - » In the sections “What to Collect?”, “Financing the Archives” and “Ownership of Material,” add text in the appropriate sections that distinguishes archivists from historians and collectors. In addition, add text clarifying that archivists do not appraise items for monetary value and that archives generally do not purchase items. The committee suggested that this new text also be added to the “A.A. Archives” service piece.

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

Committee Considerations:

- The committee strongly suggested that those creating the LinkedIn company page consider adding some kind of disclaimer or explanation clarifying that A.A. is not affiliated with any of the organizations that appear in promoted content on the LinkedIn company page.
- The committee suggested that the trustees’ Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community/ Treatment and Accessibilities consult with health care professionals to determine if there are issues unique to problem drinkers in the military and military veterans that would be helpful to cover in the pamphlet “A.A. as a Resource for Health Care Professionals.”
- The committee reviewed the C.P.C. Kit and Workbook and made the following suggestions:
 - » That the updated sample guide letters replace the guide letters currently in the workbook, and that utilizing the guide letters be mentioned in the “Suggested C.P.C. Committee Goals and Projects” section of the workbook.
 - » That the “Suggested C.P.C. Committee Goals and Projects” section of the workbook mention contacting military bases and veterans’ facilities.
 - » That when listing professionals in the workbook whom C.P.C. committees should approach, that list whenever possible should include professionals who come in contact with active members of the military and veterans.
 - » That the text of the pamphlet “Let’s Be Friendly with Our Friends: Friends on the Alcoholism Front” which is currently reprinted in full in the C.P.C. workbook be removed from the workbook.
 - » That the Membership Survey and the display of the

Membership Survey be encouraged for use in C.P.C. work.

- » That we continue to look for opportunities to utilize Class A Trustees in C.P.C. work.

CORRECTIONS

Committee Considerations:

- The committee discussed the request to create a pamphlet for inmates who will be released after long-term incarceration and took no action. The committee suggested that corrections service materials be revised for this purpose.
- The committee asked the trustees’ Committee on Corrections to update the service materials “A.A. Corrections Prerelease Contact Information — For A.A.s on the Inside” and “A.A. Corrections Prerelease Contact Information — For A.A.s on the Outside” with excerpts from existing literature.
- The committee suggested that the trustees’ Committee on Corrections create a letter to corrections professionals to raise awareness about prerelease and Bridging the Gap volunteers.
- The committee noted the benefits of identifying facilities with incarcerated alcoholics to effectively present A.A. to the professionals who work in these settings. This effort could inform the local Fellowship of the need for outside volunteers. The committee suggests the trustees’ Committee on Corrections create a checklist for local committees to be included in the Corrections Kit.
- The committee noted that many correctional facilities have increased their security restrictions for paper materials and suggested the trustees’ Committee on Corrections continue to work with the Publishing Department to insure access to A.A. materials for incarcerated alcoholics.
- The committee noted the progress made with producing dubbed versions of the video “A New Freedom” in Spanish and French and suggested adding this video to the Corrections Kit upon completion.
- The committee noted the progress made on the Corrections Correspondence Service (CCS) in Canada and looks forward to a progress report on this service at the 2019 General Service Conference.
- The committee noted the value of peer-to-peer communications between corrections professionals and looks forward to the creation of letters for use in Cooperation with the Professional Community (C.P.C.) and Corrections Committees.
- The committee suggested that the links displayed in the video “Carrying the Message Behind These Walls” be updated.
- The committee suggested the trustees’ Committee on Corrections discuss ways to utilize A.A. materials for incarcerated alcoholics at juvenile facilities.

FINANCE

Committee Considerations:

- The committee discussed developing a method to standardize increases to the limits on individual contributions and bequests to the General Service Board and felt that the consumer price index fluctuates by such small proportions that a change would be costly and not conducive to the Fellowship and took no action.
- The committee reviewed the Self-Support Packet and made the following suggestions to the Publishing Department:
 - » The pamphlets “Self-Support: Where Money and Spirituality Mix” and “The A.A. Group Treasurer” be consistent in print and revision coding on the back.
 - » Adding language regarding group level electronic contributions, passing the “virtual” basket, to the section Passing the Basket in the service piece “The A.A. Group Treasurer” and also be included in the pamphlet “Self-Support: Where Money and Spirituality Mix” and the Guidelines on Finance.
 - » Update illustrative material on the Seventh Tradition Fact Sheet (F-203) to reflect current pamphlet covers and website.
 - » Update birthday contribution envelopes per member/per year statistics.
- The committee had a discussion on the topic of AA Grapevine and suggested the following:
 - » That there be a greater online presence.
 - » A fact sheet on the topic of Grapevine be included in the Self-Support Packet.
 - » That the General Service Board make available issues of Grapevine for distribution purposes through G.S.O. staff assignments.
- The committee requested that when A.A.W.S. develops an A.A. app that self-support information be easily accessible. The committee also discussed having access to assignment folders containing literature relevant to the services.

GRAPEVINE

Committee Considerations

- The committee reviewed the 2018 Grapevine social media report regarding Instagram, Facebook and Google for Nonprofits and suggested that A.A. Grapevine, Inc. continue to explore a social media strategy in their forthcoming strategic plan, taking into account issues regarding anonymity, security, affiliation, outside contributions, privacy and promotion.
- The committee reviewed the audio strategy report and thanked AA Grapevine, Inc. for including it in their forthcoming strategic plan.
- The committee agreed to forward to the AA Grapevine Corporate Board the suggestion that in the year 2019 or later Grapevine produce the following items:

1. Our Twelve Steps II (working title)
Stories of experience by members about the Twelve Steps (the last Step book was in 2011).
 2. All About Grapevine Reps (working title)
Helpful and inspiring stories by A.A. members doing service with Grapevine and La Viña.
 3. Prayer & Meditation (working title)
A collection of stories by A.A. members about the many ways they practice Step Eleven.
 4. AA & Families (working title)
Stories by A.A. members that illustrate the many ways alcoholism and A.A. has touched our families.
 5. Hispanic Members Doing Service in A.A. (working title)
A collection of stories published in La Viña magazine by members getting sober and active, doing service and carrying the A.A. message.
- The committee reviewed the Grapevine Workbook and suggests that it undergo a comprehensive review and revision, and AA Grapevine, Inc. bring back a progress report to the 2019 Conference Committee on AA Grapevine.
 - The committee discussed ways groups can be kept informed about Grapevine and La Viña and suggested that all current and past delegates consider it a part of their responsibility to inform the Fellowship about Grapevine and La Viña as tools of sobriety, either through their own efforts or by recruiting others through email and area websites.



INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/ REGIONAL FORUMS*

Committee Considerations:

- The committee requested that the trustees' Committee on International Conventions/ Regional Forums review the Guidelines for Site Selection for the 2035 A.A. International Convention and explore expanding the window of dates in which the 2035 International Convention could be held.
- The committee noted that including forum attendee questionnaire summaries provided helpful information for discussions and suggested that they continue to be a part of the background for the Conference Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums.
- The committee discussed ways of encouraging interest in Regional and Local Forums and attracting first time attendees and suggested:
 - » Compiling notes from the first-timer sharing at a Forum for later distribution to encourage members to attend a future Forum.
 - » Reaching out at the local level to young people in A.A. committees, continuing with one-to-one communication and spreading the word as far as possible.
 - » Exploring sending Forum informational text blasts to members receiving La Viña text messages.
 - » Highlighting that Forums have no registration fee which might appeal to newer members to explore service at this level.

LITERATURE

Committee Considerations:

- The committee considered a request to add the A.A. Preamble and Responsibility Statement to the book *Alcoholics Anonymous* and took no action. The committee noted that the A.A. Preamble and Responsibility Statement are adequately noted in other A.A. literature.
- The committee considered a request to add an end-note to Bill W.'s story in the book *Alcoholics Anonymous* acknowledging co-founder Bob S. and took no action. The committee noted that acknowledgement of Bob S. ("Dr. Bob") as co-founder is currently mentioned in two separate places in the book *Alcoholics Anonymous*.
- The committee considered a request for the development of a new pamphlet for atheist and agnostic alcoholics and took no action. The committee agreed the recommendation that A.A.W.S. adopt/adapt the pamphlet "The 'God' Word" responded to the need expressed by atheist and agnostic members of A.A.
- The committee requested that G.S.O. Publishing Department add AA Grapevine literature to the list of A.A. Publications noted on the back page of A.A. literature, as additional resources, when appropriate. For example, the AA Grapevine publication *Voices of Women in AA* could be added to the list of publications in the

pamphlet "Experience, Strength and Hope: Women in A.A.," *Sober and Out* could be listed in the pamphlet "Experience, Strength and Hope: LGBTQ Alcoholics in A.A.," and *In Our Own Words* could be included as a resource in the pamphlet "Young People and A.A."

- The committee reviewed the trustees' Literature Committee report on "Language Related to Safety in A.A. Literature." The committee requested that the trustees' Literature Committee develop text regarding safety in A.A. to be included in *Living Sober* and the pamphlet "Questions and Answers on Sponsorship," and bring back the draft text to the 2019 Conference Committee on Literature.
- The committee reviewed draft text for the pamphlet "The Twelve Traditions Illustrated" and offered additional suggestions for the trustees' Literature Committee to consider. The committee looks forward to reviewing a progress report or revised draft pamphlet at the 2019 General Service Conference.
- The committee reviewed a progress report on the revision of the pamphlet "Too Young?" The committee looks forward to reviewing a progress report or draft revised pamphlet at the 2019 General Service Conference.
- The committee reviewed a progress report from the trustees' Literature Committee on the revision of the pamphlet "Young People and A.A." The committee looks forward to reviewing a progress report or draft revised pamphlet at the 2019 General Service Conference.
- The committee accepted the 2017 matrix of A.A. recovery literature.

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

Committee Considerations:

- The committee accepted the dates April 25-May 1, 2021 for the 71st General Service Conference since these dates do not conflict with any significant holiday or hotel availability.
- The committee reviewed the report from G.S.O.'s general manager on site selection of the General Service Conference. The committee looks forward to a progress report for review by the 2019 Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions.
- The committee reviewed the trustees' General Service Conference Committee's Report on Equitable Distribution of the Workload of Conference Committees. The committee encouraged the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference to continue reviewing options in order to create a workable plan for equitable distribution of the workload of Conference committees by combining and/or creating committees. The committee looks forward to a plan or progress report on this important process for review by the 2019 Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions.
- The committee discussed the request to develop a

*Members serve on this committee as a secondary committee assignment.

policy on the use of the Conference dashboard and suggested that the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference develop an information sheet that reflects shared experience and guidance on usage of the Conference dashboard.

- The committee discussed the question forwarded from the trustees' International Committee: "Does the U.S./Canada [service structure] have a role/responsibility in assisting the development of A.A. structures around the world through sponsoring other countries via direct invitations to observe our General Service Conference?" While wishing to remain open to requests from other country's boards/G.S.O.s, the committee agreed that the U.S./Canada service structure does not have a role/responsibility in assisting other countries *via direct invitations* to observe our General Service Conference rather than at their own request.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

Committee Considerations:

- The committee reviewed and accepted the 2017 annual report from the trustees' Public Information Committee regarding aa.org and aagrapevine.org.
- The committee reviewed and accepted the 2018 Public Information Comprehensive Media Plan and noted the importance of the trustees' continued exploration of social media and social network platforms to carry the A.A. message to the public.
- The committee reviewed and accepted the 2017 report from the trustees' Public Information Committee regarding the usefulness and relevance of video public service announcements.
- The committee reviewed the 2017 trustees' Public Information Committee Report on the use of Google AdWords and Google Grants to carry the A.A. message and requested that the trustees' Committee on Public Information continue to develop information on the use of Google AdWords and Google Grants, including information on the cost of implementing a six-month trial and the cost of a full year's implementation, and that a progress report be brought back to the 2019 Conference Committee on Public Information.
- The committee reviewed the contents of the P.I. Kit and Workbook and suggested that the information in the P.I. Workbook in the section Approaching Local Broadcast Facilities be updated to reflect changes in how G.S.O. delivers public service announcements.

REPORT AND CHARTER

Committee Considerations:

- The committee accepted a report from the Publishing Department outlining the General Service Office process for timely and accurate preparation and publication of *The A.A. Service Manual, 2018-2020 Edition* and the 2018 General Service Conference *Final Report*.
- The committee reviewed a list of editorial updates from

the Publishing Department for *The A.A. Service Manual* and accepted the updates.

- In keeping with the 2009 Advisory Action that the General Service Board, the A.A.W.S. Board and the Grapevine Board annually review *The A.A. Service Manual* and forward necessary updates to the Conference Committee on Report and Charter, the committee reviewed the updates from the General Service Board and the Grapevine Board.
- The committee considered a request to add text to *The A.A. Service Manual* regarding standing committees from "The A.A. Group" pamphlet and took no action. The committee suggested that the Publishing Department consider adding more language regarding local service committees in possible future service manual rewrites.
- The committee considered a request for changes to Chapters 2, 3 and 5 in *The A.A. Service Manual* and took no action. The committee suggested that if an extensive rewrite of the chapters is undertaken, the Publishing Department review these chapters for possible future editions of the manual.
- The committee considered a request to remove the statement from the section "Area Newsletters" in *The A.A. Service Manual*, "Any group or district of the Fellowship is free to use the circle and triangle on newsletters, meeting schedules or other A.A. material" and took no action. The committee noted that the statement as it stands is informative to those with questions concerning the circle and triangle.
- The committee considered a request to update the "Third Legacy Procedure" chart on page S22 in *The A.A. Service Manual* and suggested that the chart would be updated to correct inconsistencies.
- The committee reviewed a Publishing report with suggestions on how changes to *The A.A. Service Manual* could be made available to the Fellowship in non-printing years and took no action. The committee noted that substantive changes to *The A.A. Service Manual* can be found in the Conference *Final Report* and the Report and Charter Conference Committee's History and Highlights of Actions.
- The committee discussed the A.A. Directories and noted there were no requests for changes at this time. The committee also reviewed a memo from the G.S.O. general manager informing the committee that the A.A. Directories (Canada, Eastern U.S. and Western U.S.) would not be printed in 2018 due to the implementation of a new enterprise resource planning (ERP) system.

TREATMENT AND ACCESSIBILITIES

Committee Considerations:

- The committee requested that the staff secretary forward suggested further revisions to the pamphlet "Accessibility for All Alcoholics" to the Publishing Department for consideration.



- The committee reviewed the report “Cooperation with Armed Services Exploration Strategies” from the trustees’ Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community/Treatment and Accessibilities and suggested the following:
 - » Review existing literature and service material with a military focus to expand on the topic of accessibilities.
 - » Consider including shared experience from members on active duty as well as veterans in existing A.A. literature.
 - » Consider creating A.A. guidelines with a focus on carrying the message to those in the Armed Services.
 - » Consider whether creating a PSA as a method of carrying the message to those in the Armed Services would be effective.
 - » Consider the need for a national veteran’s workshop.
- The committee suggested that the trustees’ Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community/Treatment and Accessibilities focus on carrying the message to veterans in VA facilities, active service members stationed in local military facilities in the U.S. and Canada, and active military personnel who are deployed outside the U.S. and Canada.
- The committee suggested that the trustees’ Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community/Treatment and Accessibilities consider producing a Remote Communities Kit and Workbook.
- The committee suggested that the trustees’ Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community/Treatment and Accessibilities review literature and service material to determine if experience related to carrying the message for underserved and remote communities is included.
- The committee reviewed the summary of sharing from

A.A. members who are Deaf and Hard-of-Hearing from the trustees’ Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community/ Treatment and Accessibilities and suggested the following:

- » Continue exploring ways to meet the needs of A.A. members who are Deaf and Hard-of-Hearing.
 - » Request shared experience from A.A. members who are Deaf and Hard-of-Hearing regarding the types of technology used for participation in A.A.
 - » Review the A.A. website to determine if it is accessible to A.A. members who are Deaf and Hard-of-Hearing.
 - » Request shared experience from groups about the ways they are lowering access barriers in carrying the message to A.A. members who are Deaf and Hard-of Hearing and include sharing in existing literature and service material.
 - » Suggest AA Grapevine develop a book that includes shared experience from A.A. members who are Deaf and Hard-of-Hearing and are overcoming access barriers.
- The committee suggested that a service piece be developed to help new committee chairs in getting started in Treatment and Accessibilities service.

TRUSTEES

Committee Considerations:

- The committee reviewed the resumes and approved as eligible for election all Class B trustee candidates for Eastern Canada regional trustee and Pacific regional trustee.
- The committee thoughtfully reviewed a proposal to censure the General Service Board and after seeking extensive additional input from the general manager of G.S.O., the chair of the General Service Board, and additional General Service Board trustees, agreed to take no action. The committee recognized that the litigation regarding the Printer’s Copy Manuscript of *Alcoholics Anonymous* has caused many in the Fellowship to have strong feelings on all sides of this issue. The committee believes that the unity of Alcoholics Anonymous is the most important treasure we have as a Fellowship. The committee also recognizes that the General Service Board and the Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. Board have many legal responsibilities and must sometimes make use of the right of decision, but in the spirit of A.A. unity, the committee asks the General Service Board, A.A. World Services, Inc. and AA Grapevine, Inc. that:
 - » All major decisions made by A.A. World Services, Inc., AA Grapevine, Inc., the General Service Office or AA Grapevine management be promptly and fully reported to the General Service Board, as appropriate.
 - » If the General Service Board, the A.A. World Services Board or AA Grapevine Board needs to initiate a

legal proceeding as a plaintiff, that whenever possible, they will consult the members of the General Service Conference before starting such a proceeding, being ever mindful of A.A. unity and A.A.'s financial prudence. However, the committee understands that sometimes this might not be possible.

- The committee recognizes that the General Service Board, A.A. World Services, Inc., and AA Grapevine, Inc. could be brought into litigation by other parties and in no way wants to limit their actions required to protect these corporations.
- The committee reviewed a proposal to reorganize the A.A.W.S. and General Service Boards and took no action. The committee noted that although a reorganization was not considered necessary at this time, the committee requested that the trustees' Committee on Nominating develop procedures for a partial or complete reorganization of the General Service Board, the A.A.W.S. Board or AA Grapevine Board and that a report be brought back to the 2019 Conference Committee on Trustees, including all possible options.
- The committee expressed their appreciation for the report on the regional geographic service structure from the trustees' Committee on Nominating and the suggestion that the General Service Board discuss a possible survey of past and current regional trustees regarding their workload and ability to fulfill all their responsibilities. The committee expressed their hope that every option will be considered to allow as many A.A. members as possible the opportunity to serve on the General Service Board.

Recommendations Not Resulting in Conference Advisory Actions

TRUSTEES

- In the spirit of A.A. parity, the process for election of the trustee-at-large/U.S. be revised so that the number of delegates voting from each region be equal to the number of delegates in the smallest region, and that the voting delegates in each region be drawn by lot.

LITERATURE

- An appendix be added to the book *Alcoholics Anonymous*, reflecting recognition received from the Library of Congress.
- The trustees' Literature Committee develop text for an endnote to be placed at the end of the chapter "Working with Others" in the book *Alcoholics Anonymous* that would reflect contemporary shared experience regarding twelve-step calls and working with new prospects, as well as include helpful resources (i.e., the pamphlet "Questions and Answers on Sponsorship," and the service material "Safety in A.A.: Our Common Welfare") and bring back a progress report or draft text to the 2019 Conference Committee on Literature.
- The trustees' Literature Committee develop a new

book combining *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* with *Twelve Concepts for World Service*, and bring back a progress report or draft manuscript to the 2019 Conference Committee on Literature.

Floor Actions Not Resulting in Conference Advisory Actions

- The pamphlet "Bridging the Gap" be revised to be more inclusive, to apply to both Treatment and Corrections or possibly any alcoholic leaving any institution into the real world. **(Conference declined to consider)**
- The 68th General Service Conference lovingly advises the A.A.W.S. Board, Grapevine Board and General Service Board to refrain from the practice of litigation for the purpose of acquiring property not previously under the direct control of A.A. **(Conference declined to consider)**
- The General Service Board be censured. **(Conference declined to consider)**
- The General Service Conference affirm the delegated authority of the General Service Board and operating corporations to protect the intellectual property of Alcoholics Anonymous. **(Not approved)**
- The informational piece being created by the trustees' Committee on the Conference pertaining to the Conference dashboard include excerpts on How a Group Conscience is Obtained to reflect the integrity and collective conscience of the registered A.A. groups, including registered online groups. **(Conference declined to consider)**
- All future reorganization and censure motions go directly to the Conference Committee on Trustees, not to be reviewed by a trustees' committee. **(Withdrawn)**



■ Committee Considerations

An Advisory Action of the 1990 General Service Conference states: “Items discussed, but no action taken or recommendation made, as well as committee recommendations which are not adopted, be included in a separate section of the Final Report.” Listed by committee, such items are included here “in their entirety” per Advisory Action of the 2018 General Service Conference.



AGENDA

Committee Considerations:

- The committee discussed the report of the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference and encourages Conference committee chairs to communicate with their committee both before and after the Board weekend conference calls with their corresponding trustees' committee chairs. The committee noted that this may help to ensure all Conference committee members are fully informed.
- The committee reviewed the 2019 General Service Conference evaluation form and noted that improvements were implemented from the 68th G.S.C. Evaluation suggestions.
- The committee reviewed the summary of the 2018 General Service Conference evaluations. The committee suggests that Conference members be given the option to select the Conference Manual format and that the online version of the evaluation form be formatted such that it can be continually updated during Conference week.
- The committee reviewed the report on the Implementation and Effectiveness of the Conference Agenda Process from the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference, which included sharing from the 2019 Conference committee chairs. The com-

mittee noted that the January conference call portion of the plan was implemented and request reporting of the 2019 participant survey results to the 2020 Conference Agenda Committee.

- The committee reviewed the sharing results of the 2019 survey of Conference committee chairs.

ARCHIVES*

Committee Considerations:

- The committee reviewed the revised Archives Workbook and newly released Archives Service Piece “Archives Checklist: A quick guide for local A.A. archivists” and expressed satisfaction with the content. The committee suggested that the use of gender-specific language be avoided, when possible, in future printings of the Archives Workbook.
- The committee appreciates the work of the trustees' Committee on Archives in exploring the feasibility of including in the A.A.W.S. Literature catalog all reproductions of archival materials being distributed by the Archives department upon request. However, the committee expressed concerns about pursuing this suggestion, noting that overexposure of these items would increase the workload of the Archives staff and could trivialize the archival materials.

*Members serve on this committee as a secondary committee assignment.



CORRECTIONS

Committee Considerations:

- The committee considered a request for a review of all corrections-related literature in order to make the language more modern and inclusive and agreed to take no action. The committee noted that there was not a widely expressed need to warrant a change in the language currently used in A.A. literature for corrections. The committee also noted the absence of suitable language alternatives that could be used across all areas.
- The committee considered a request that the General Service Office establish and help maintain a database of Correctional facilities in each service area in the U.S. and Canada and the status of meetings held therein, and took no action. The committee noted the merits of the goal but considered that the diverse experiences and needs in different areas would be better served by a tool, or resource, that would help areas develop their own database tailored to their needs. The committee requested that the staff on the corrections desk ask for shared experience from A.A. members involved in corrections service for tools currently being used to create local databases with correctional facility meeting information, the status of the meetings, contacts, possible needs, and any other relevant information, and that the information be considered for a possible service piece or added to the Corrections Workbook, as appropriate.
- The committee expressed appreciation for the hard work accomplished by the trustees' Committee on

Corrections and encouraged the continued communication between the chairs of the trustees' and Conference committees on Corrections throughout the year.

- The committee reviewed the Corrections Kit and Workbook and noted that many of the pamphlets used in correction service work have staples. The committee shared that a growing number of correctional facilities will not allow materials with staples into their facilities. The committee requested that the Publishing Department give priority to pamphlets used in corrections service for publication without staples, including, but not limited to, "The Twelve Traditions Illustrated," "The Twelve Steps Illustrated," "Many Paths to Spirituality," "Is A.A. for Me?," "This Is A.A.," "Frequently Asked Questions About A.A.," "Do you think you're different?," "Too Young?" and "Women in A.A."

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

Committee Considerations:

- The committee discussed the progress on implementing a static LinkedIn page and felt that the overall goal of the 2018 Advisory Action on creating a LinkedIn page had not yet been achieved. The committee agreed that the wording suggested for the LinkedIn page did not adequately describe Alcoholics Anonymous. The presence of a LinkedIn page describing Alcoholics Anonymous would be a valuable tool to aid local C.P.C. committee work in the U.S. and Canada to inform professionals about A.A. The committee requested that the trustees' Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community/Treatment and Accessibilities revisit the plan for implementing a LinkedIn page, taking into consideration the following suggestions:
 - » Add a disclaimer explaining that the "promoted" content on the LinkedIn page is not affiliated with Alcoholics Anonymous.
 - » Include information from current A.A. literature about what A.A. does and does not do that can be useful to professionals who work with alcoholics.
 - » Add a concise description of Alcoholics Anonymous that is based on the Conference-approved literature intended for professionals that was reviewed at the October 2018 trustees' meeting.
 - » Add a link to aa.org and a link to the information for professionals' page.
 - » Add a link to the *About A.A.* newsletter.
 - » Include a schedule of C.P.C. exhibits at national level events that are coordinated through the General Service Office.
 - » Annually provide a report tracking the A.A. LinkedIn page, including visits to aa.org from the LinkedIn page for review by the Conference Committee on C.P.C.
- The committee requested that the trustees' committee review the pamphlet "A.A. in Your Community" with a focus on what professionals can expect from A.A. and

A.A. members and bring a report back to the 2020 Conference Committee on C.P.C.

- The committee reviewed the C.P.C. Kit and Workbook and noted their value to local C.P.C. committees and suggested that a section be added where local experiences can be noted.

FINANCE

Committee Considerations:

- The committee reviewed and discussed area contributions for delegate expenses for the Conference and took no action.
- The committee reviewed area contributions for delegate expenses, discussed the costs of the Conference and suggested that the trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee provide a detailed breakdown of Conference expenses be included as background when delegate expenses are reviewed every two years, beginning in 2021.
- The committee requested that additional information regarding statistical information on delegate fees and contribution limits be available as background when reviewed every two years, beginning in 2021.
- The committee reviewed and discussed the Conference-approved maximum annual contribution of \$5,000 to the General Service Board from an individual A.A. member and took no action.
- The committee reviewed the Self-Support Packet and suggested the following changes:
 - » In the Finance Guidelines mirror the language on how to make a contribution from the end of "The A.A. Group Treasurer" pamphlet.
 - » Include the regular contribution envelope in the packet.
 - » Revise the back of the Self-Support card as suggested, to reflect the following:
 - Move "What is the value of your sobriety?" under the title.
 - Move last bullet under "Some facts" to be first: "Your contributions help ensure the future of our Fellowship worldwide."
 - Rephrase the first bullet under "Some facts" to read: "Historically, less than half of all A.A. groups contribute to the General Service Office" and make it the second bullet.
 - Remove second bullet regarding "Costs of services..." from "Some facts."
 - Rephrase the third bullet under "Some facts" to read: "Gross profit from literature sales make up for the shortfall in contributions," or something similar to emphasize being more self-supporting.
 - Remove the titles "Personal thoughts" and "Some facts."
 - Include contribution information from the end of "The A.A. Group Treasurer" pamphlet.

GRAPEVINE

Committee Considerations:

- The committee considered a request to remove the Alcoholism at Large section from AA Grapevine and took no action. The committee affirmed Grapevine and La Viña's editorial freedom, as expressed in the Grapevine Charter that states: "to prepare, edit, print and publish...written material concerning generally the subject of alcoholism and related matters and dealing with various means, methods, techniques and procedures available or proposed for the treatment, relief, rehabilitation and recovery of persons suffering from or potentially subject to alcoholism."
- The committee requested that the disclaimer for the Alcoholism at Large section be printed more prominently and visibly.
- The committee agreed to forward to the AA Grapevine Corporate Board the suggestion that Grapevine produce in the year 2020 or later:
 1. The Early Days of AA (working title)
Classic stories previously published in Grapevine by members from the 1930s, '40s and '50s about what A.A. was like in its earliest days.
 2. Getting Involved in General Service (working title)
Inspiring stories previously published in Grapevine by A.A. members who have been involved in general service.
 3. Surrender and Hope (working title) (La Viña book)
Stories by Spanish-speaking A.A. members, previously published in La Viña, about how they came to surrender and join A.A. for a new life.
- The committee reviewed the progress report on the AA Grapevine Workbook revisions and looks forward to reviewing a progress report or draft at the next Conference. The committee also forwarded suggestions to the Grapevine office including expanding shared experience and how to use GV/LV as a recovery tool.
- The committee reviewed the AA Grapevine Fellowship



Survey and summary and noted the actions the Grapevine Board and staff have taken on the findings. The committee looks forward to a progress report at the next Conference on further actions taken.

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/ REGIONAL FORUMS*

Committee Considerations:

- The committee discussed ways of encouraging interest in Regional and Local Forums and attracting first time attendees and suggested:
 - » Compiling notes from the first timer sharing at a Forum for later distribution to encourage members to attend a future Forum;
 - » Consider developing a Regional Forum app;
 - » Consider developing a micro-site in addition to surface mail for distributing the Regional Forum flyers;
 - » Increase awareness at the local level, including “intentional” outreach to different populations (e.g., young people, Spanish-speaking communities, Deaf and Hard-of-Hearing);
 - » Encourage local welcome committees to create “Save the Date” flyers;
 - » Consider inviting A.A.W.S./AA Grapevine directors to “non-service” A.A. events to increase awareness of regional forums;
 - » Place information about Regional Forums in the AA Grapevine and La Viña.

LITERATURE

Committee Considerations:

- The committee reviewed the request for the development of a Fifth Edition of the book *Alcoholics Anonymous*, which would include a section of stories comprised of individuals who got sober under the age of 25 and took no action, noting that A.A. is inclusive, never exclusive. If a Fifth Edition of *Alcoholics Anonymous* is to be developed, the committee suggested that stories be gathered from as broad a cross-section of the Fellowship as possible, including from those who got sober under age 25.
- The committee reviewed the progress report on the development of a pamphlet for Spanish-speaking women and looks forward to reviewing a progress report or draft pamphlet at the 2020 General Service Conference.
- The committee reviewed the progress report on the development of a pamphlet based upon A.A.’s Three Legacies and looks forward to reviewing a progress report or draft pamphlet at the 2020 General Service Conference.
- The committee reviewed the progress report on the comprehensive update to the video “Your A.A. General Service Office, the Grapevine and the General Service Structure.” The committee looks forward to reviewing

a progress report or draft revised video at the 2020 General Service Conference.

- The committee reviewed a progress report for the pamphlet “The Twelve Traditions Illustrated” and suggested an emphasis on the importance of anonymity on social media perhaps by adding an image of the Anonymity in the Digital Age poster as well as the following text:

To quote Bill W.’s writing on page 15 from *The Language of the Heart*, “...it should be the privilege, even the right, of each individual or group to handle anonymity as they wish.” However, when dealing with social media, personal anonymity as well as the group’s anonymity may be easily compromised. We must be careful when using social media to not use full names and/or photos of A.A. members in a way that would identify them or others as A.A. members.

The committee looks forward to reviewing a progress report or revised draft pamphlet at the 2020 General Service Conference.

- The committee reviewed a progress report on the revision of the pamphlet “Too Young?” The committee looks forward to reviewing a draft revised pamphlet and/or samples of other potential formats of the pamphlet at the 2020 General Service Conference.
- The committee reviewed a progress report on the revision of the pamphlet “Young People and A.A.” The committee looks forward to reviewing a revised draft pamphlet at the 2020 General Service Conference.
- The committee reviewed a progress report for language on safety and A.A. for inclusion in the booklet *Living Sober* and the pamphlet “Questions and Answers on Sponsorship” and clarified that the language is meant to focus on safety at the group level.
- The committee suggested that the trustees’ Committee on Literature develop a Literature Committee Workbook and provide a progress report to the 2020 General Service Conference.
- The committee considered a request to add information regarding safety to the pamphlet “The A.A. Group” and took no action. The committee noted that the pamphlet already addresses safety.
- The committee discussed the draft of the proposed revision to A.A. World Services’ “Policy on Publication of Literature: Updating Pamphlets and Other A.A. Materials” and supports the proposed policy and its intended impact to support more effectively carrying the A.A. message.

In keeping with Concept Eight, which states in part, “The Trustees of the General Service Board act in two primary capacities: (a) with respect to the larger matters of overall policy and finance, they are the principle planners and administrators...” the committee expressed support for G.S.O.’s publishing professionals and their efforts working on behalf of A.A.

In keeping with Concept One, which states in part, “The final responsibility and the ultimate authority for A.A.

*Members serve on this committee as a secondary committee assignment.

world services should always reside in the collective conscience of our whole Fellowship,” the committee recognized the importance and the sensitivity of maintaining the integrity of the Conference process for developing and updating literature to best reflect A.A.’s collective experience, strength and hope.

The committee requested that the final version of the complete text of A.A. World Services’ “Policy on Publication of Literature: Updating Pamphlets and Other A.A. Materials” be included as background for future General Service Conference committees.

- The committee reviewed the matrix of A.A. recovery literature and suggested that the trustees’ Literature Committee consider an update to the pamphlet “Is A.A. for Me?” The committee noted that the pamphlet has not been updated since 1989.

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

Committee Considerations:

- In reviewing the report from G.S.O.’s general manager on site selection for the General Service Conference, the committee noted the change of dates for the 71st G.S.C. that will take place in 2021 and that it had been necessary for the general manager to move forward and contract for the hotel for the 72nd General Service Conference prior to the selection of dates by the Conference Policy/Admissions Committee.

The 71st General Service Conference will take place April 18–24, 2021 in Brooklyn, New York, and the 72nd General Service Conference will take place April 24–30, 2022 in Brooklyn, New York.

- In order to provide additional flexibility to the General Service Office management in contracting the most cost-effective and appropriate venues for the General Service Conference, the committee agreed to select three proposed dates for the 73rd and 74th General Service Conferences. The committee selected the following dates in order of preference for the 73rd General Service Conference: April 23–29, 2023; April 30–May 6, 2023 and April 16–22, 2023. The committee selected the following dates in order of preference for the 74th General Service Conference: April 14–20, 2024; April 28–May 4, 2024 and May 5–11, 2024. The committee noted that these proposed Conference dates do not conflict with any significant holidays. The committee asks that all Conference members be notified of the final dates for the 73rd and 74th General Service Conferences as soon as they are finalized by G.S.O. management.
- The committee reviewed the report from G.S.O.’s general manager on site selection of the General Service Conference and looks forward to a progress report for review by the 2020 General Service Conference.
- The committee considered a process for how a Conference committee could review, discuss, and act on proposed agenda items not forwarded to a Conference committee and appreciates the trustees’ Committee on

the General Service Conference’s work on developing a process thus far. The committee noted the inclusion of a rationale on items not forwarded that are listed on the grid of proposed agenda items. The committee requested that the trustees’ Committee on the General Service Conference continue developing the process outlined in their report and provide a report to the 2020 General Service Conference that includes more information regarding the distribution of background and the January conference call between the trustee committee chair and the corresponding Conference committee.

- The committee requested that the trustees’ Committee on the General Service Conference develop a process for approving qualified representatives from other A.A. service structures to observe the U.S. and Canada General Service Conference that allows for these observers to be presented for General Service Conference consideration prior to the General Service Conference week for review by the 2020 General Service Conference.
- The committee discussed a request to “develop a procedure to deal with special requests/agenda items” and took no action. The committee noted that Concept Three and the Conference Charter provide adequate guidance and flexibility for dealing with agenda items that are outside of the usual process.
- The committee discussed reconsidering the 1986 Advisory Action regarding a simple majority vote by the full Conference and took no action. The committee asked that implementation of this 1986 advisory action resume with the 69th General Service Conference Final Report:

If a committee recommendation does not receive the two-thirds vote required to become a Conference Advisory Action, but has a majority of votes, it automatically becomes a suggestion and will be duly noted in the Conference Report.
- The committee noted that the trustees’ General Service Conference Committee scheduled a Presentation/Discussion on the Equitable Distribution of the Workload of Conference Committees at the 69th General Service Conference. The committee looks forward to receiving a plan or progress report on this important process for review by the 2020 General Service Conference from the trustees’ Committee on the General Service Conference.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

Committee Considerations:

- The committee reviewed and accepted the 2018 annual report from the trustees’ Public Information Committee regarding aa.org and aagrapevine.org.
- The committee suggested that the A.A.W.S. Publishing Department update all A.A. pamphlet covers to prominently display the G.S.O. website “aa.org.”
- The committee also suggested that it may be helpful to include “www.aagrapevine.org” on the cover of A.A. pamphlets.

- The committee reviewed and accepted the 2018 report from the trustees' Public Information Committee on the Usefulness and Relevance of Public Service Announcements.
- The committee reviewed and accepted the information on centralized distribution, tracking and evaluation of the public service announcement "Changes."
- The committee suggested that the trustees' Committee on Public Information explore online platforms as a possible additional media outlet for future public service announcement distribution.
- The committee suggested that the "how to find A.A." section of all existing PSAs be edited to include current terminologies that describe how people search for A.A.
- The committee reviewed the contents of P.I. Kit and Workbook, and asked that the contents of P.I. Kit and Workbook continue to be updated with current and relevant information for P.I. committees.

REPORT AND CHARTER

Committee Considerations:

- The committee accepted a report from the Publishing Department outlining the General Service Office process for timely and accurate preparation and publication of *The A.A. Service Manual, 2020–2022 Edition* and the 2019 General Service Conference *Final Report*.
- The committee reviewed the progress report from the A.A.W.S. Publishing Department on the redesign of *The A.A. Service Manual* and forwarded their comments to the Publishing Department.
- The committee considered the A.A. Directories (Canada, Eastern U.S., and Western U.S.) especially in light of the new ERP system and the Meeting Guide app, and requested that the General Service Office explore alternative methods of accessing and distributing the contact information contained in the A.A. Directories (Canada, Eastern U.S., and Western U.S.). The committee requested that a report be brought back to the 2020 Report and Charter Conference Committee.
- The committee agreed with the suggestion from G.S.O. management that a new level of privacy was needed in the General Service Conference Final Report for Conference members' personal information, and that as of 2019:
 - » The roster section for Area Delegates include only each person's name, city, state or province.
 - » The bios of trustees and nontrustee directors include only each person's name, city, state or province.
 - » No email addresses for delegates, trustees or non-trustee directors will be included.

TREATMENT & ACCESSIBILITIES

Committee Considerations:

- The committee considered revising the pamphlet "Bridging the Gap Between Treatment and A.A. Through Contact Programs" to include related corrections

activities and agreed with the concept. The committee requested that the trustees' Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community/Treatment and Accessibilities consult with the trustees' Committee on Corrections to review all treatment and corrections committee literature from G.S.O. related to bridging the gap and temporary contact activities with the following in mind:

- » How treatment and corrections material can be updated for currency and inclusion;
- » How this material could be combined;
- » What material might be discontinued;
- » How the combined material might be broadened to encompass the full range of possibilities in which a temporary contact might be useful.

The committee requested that a report be brought to the 2020 Conference Treatment and Accessibilities committee.

- The committee reviewed a draft Remote Communities Kit and agreed that there is a need for this new material. The committee suggested that before the Kit is made available that a guideline or workbook be developed for inclusion. The guideline or workbook might use a locally produced current Remote Communities workbook as an example.

The committee also suggested that the guideline or workbook include a list of available material, with details, including the intended audience, and suggestions for when, why and how it might be used.

The committee forwarded a list of additional pamphlets and service material to be considered for inclusion in the Kit. The committee suggested that the trustees' committee not include paper copies of the pamphlets in the Kit but provide a list of material by category and purpose, linked to encourage digital use.

The committee noted the availability and relevance of past articles in Grapevine, *Box 4-5-9*, and *About A.A.*, and requested that the trustees' Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community/Treatment and Accessibilities and staff work with AA Grapevine to make past Remote Communities articles from Grapevine available for those involved in Remote Communities service.

- The committee reviewed the Treatment Committees Kit and Workbook and forwarded a list of suggestions to the trustees' Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community/Treatment and Accessibilities.
- The committee reviewed the Accessibilities Kit and Workbook and forwarded a list of suggestions to the trustees' Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community/Treatment and Accessibilities.

TRUSTEES

Committee Considerations:

- The committee reviewed the resumes and approved

as eligible for election all Class B trustee candidates for Northeast regional trustee, Southwest regional trustee, and trustee-at-large/Canada.

- The committee reviewed the drafted procedures for a partial or complete reorganization of the General Service Board, the A.A. World Services Board and AA Grapevine Board. The committee agreed that the procedure needed additional specificity, offered suggestions, and requested that the trustees' Committee on Nominating bring back a revised plan to the 2020 Conference Committee on Trustees.

Recommendations Not Resulting in Conference Advisory Actions

CORRECTIONS

- The Scope of the Conference Committee on Corrections, which currently reads: "The purpose of the committee will be to encourage A.A. members to assume responsibility to carry the message to alcoholics who cannot, of their own free will, seek A.A. help"

Be revised, to read:

The purpose of the committee will be to encourage A.A. members to assume responsibility to carry the message to alcoholics who cannot seek A.A. help **outside the walls.**

LITERATURE

- A draft Fifth Edition of *Alcoholics Anonymous* be developed and a progress report be brought to the 2020 Conference Literature Committee, keeping in mind the 1995 Advisory Action that:

The first 164 pages of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, the Preface, the Forewords, "The Doctor's Opinion," "Dr. Bob's Nightmare," and the Appendices remain as is.

- Text be added to the foreword of the book *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* as follows (Bold text reflects addition):

A.A.'s Twelve Steps are a group of principles, spiritual in their nature, which, if practiced as a way of life, can expel the obsession to drink and enable the sufferer to become happily and usefully whole.

A.A.'s Twelve Traditions apply to the life of the Fellowship itself. They outline the means by which A.A. maintains its unity and relates itself to the world about it, the way it lives and grows.

A.A.'s Twelve Concepts for World Service are an interpretation of A.A.'s world service structure. The Concepts provide guidelines for carrying the message to thousands of suffering alcoholics yet to come. They aim to

record the "why" of our service structure. They may be found in *The A.A. Service Manual combined with Twelve Concepts for World Service.*

- The phrase "Nonalcoholics may attend open meetings as observers" be added as the final sentence to the "Open Meeting" side of the Primary Purpose (Blue) Card. The card will read as follows (Bold text reflects addition):

THIS IS AN OPEN MEETING OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS

This is an open meeting of Alcoholics Anonymous. We are glad you are all here — especially newcomers. In keeping with our singleness of purpose and our Third Tradition which states that "The only requirement for A.A. membership is a desire to stop drinking," we ask that all who participate confine their discussion to their problems with alcohol. **Nonalcoholics may attend open meetings as observers.**

Floor Actions Not Resulting in Conference Advisory Actions

- Production of *The Language of the Heart* in Spanish as an audiobook be prioritized by AA Grapevine, Inc. and a timeline for production be reported at the 70th General Service Conference. **(Not approved)**
- The pamphlet "The 'God' Word" be added as one of the pamphlets used in Corrections service for possible publication without staples. **(Conference declined to consider)**
- In order to illustrate the importance of the committee recommendations that achieve simple majority but not substantial unanimity (i.e., a vote of two-thirds), that such "simple majority suggestions" be prominently included in the Conference *Final Report*. **(Not approved)**
- The "Alcoholism at Large" section be removed from the AA Grapevine. **(Conference declined to consider)**



It was recommended that:

The dates of the 2019 Conference be moved to the first week available to hold our Conference, May 19 – May 25, 2019.

Floor Actions

Due to concerns about the time constraint limitations regarding the amount of business that could be managed during the 70th Virtual General Service Conference, prior to the Conference the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference approved a motion to allow Floor Actions during a specified period of time at the end of the Conference and that each would be considered for a vote to decline. If the item was not declined it would automatically be forwarded to the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference for consideration.

The following items were moved forward to the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference:

- The Finance Committee expand item #2 that will be forwarded to the 71st Conference to include the proposal to revise the pie chart percentages, in order to emphasize more clearly that any percentages included in the pamphlet are only suggestions and examples, not recommendations.
- The General Service Conference consider developing a PSA about Alcoholics Anonymous geared toward minorities.
- The 70th General Service Conference approve the slate of Directors for A.A. World Services, Inc. as originally submitted:

Beau B.
Mary C.
Jimmy D.
Deborah K.
Jan L.

David N.
Greg T.
Carolyn W.
John W.

- The pamphlet "A.A. for the Black and African-American Alcoholic" be updated to include fresh stories and a new title that is respectful and inclusive.
- The slate of Directors of A.A. World Services, Inc., as submitted by the Conference Committee on Trustees, be approved.
- The launch of Google AdWords Grants by the General Service Office be halted until the 71st General Service Conference convenes and approves that launch, and that the "Ad Hoc Committee Progress Report – Google Grants and the 7th Tradition," from the trustees' Finance Committee, dated March 30, 2020, be immediately released to all members of the 70th General Service Conference.

Floor Action Declined for Consideration

- Since many agenda items from the shortened 70th Virtual General Service Conference will be forwarded to the 71st General Service Conference in 2021, the 71st General Service Conference Committee on Trustees consider the extension of the 71st General Service Conference by as many as three working days and that consideration be offered regardless of whether the 71st General Service Conference is face-to-face or held digitally.

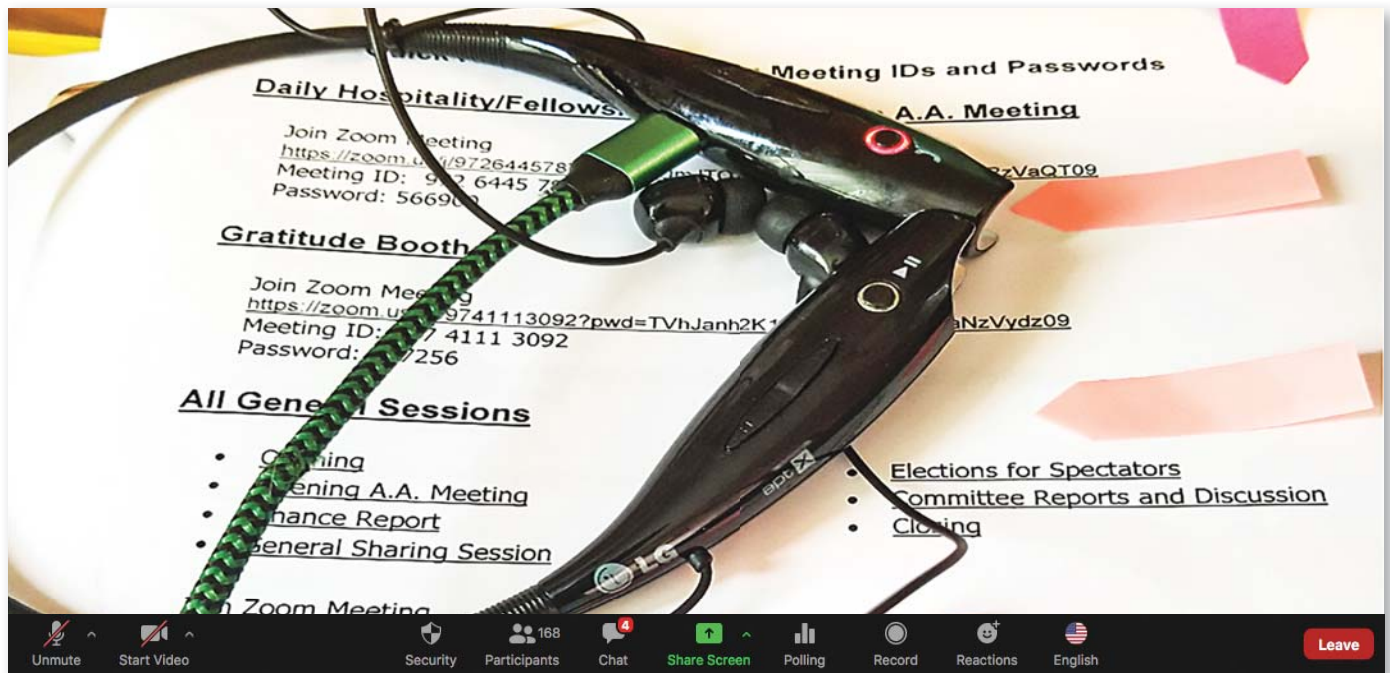
Recording

The committee recommended that the theme for the 2021 General Service Conference be: "A.A. in a Time of Change."

Unmute Start Video Security Participants 168 Chat 4 Share Screen Polling Record Reactions English Leave

■ Committee Considerations

An Advisory Action of the 1990 General Service Conference states: “Items discussed, but no action taken or recommendation made, as well as committee recommendations which are not adopted, be included in a separate section of the Final Report.” Listed by committee, such items are included here “in their entirety” per Advisory Action of the 2019 General Service Conference.



AGENDA

Committee Considerations:

There are no committee considerations from the 2020 Conference Committee on Agenda.

ARCHIVES

Committee Considerations:

- The committee considered requests to develop a book on A.A. history from 1955 through the present and, following a lengthy discussion, suggested that the trustees' Archives Committee consider possible themes, content ideas and the time period such a book might cover. The committee requested a report be brought back to the 2021 Conference Committee on Archives.

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

Committee Considerations:

- The committee discussed the request to discontinue the pamphlet “A.A. in Your Community” and took no action. The committee noted that this pamphlet is vital to local C.P.C. committee work to introduce A.A. to professionals and that the title defines A.A. as a community resource. The committee also noted that an update to the language and style is needed.
- The committee requested that the trustees' C.P.C./Treatment and Accessibilities Committee explore ways

to update content of the pamphlet “A.A. in Your Community” with a focus on modern professional settings and consider those who consume content in various formats. The committee suggested the following items regarding modern digital resources be considered such as:

- » The Meeting Guide app
- » A.A.W.S. and AAGV YouTube channels
- » A.A.W.S. LinkedIn page
- » Space to leave local contact information
- The committee requested that a progress report or a draft of “A.A. in Your Community” be brought to the 2021 Conference Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community.

CORRECTIONS

Committee Considerations:

- The committee heard a report from the A.A.W.S. publishing director on the efforts to provide digital distribution of A.A. literature into correctional facilities. It was reported that several viable options had been identified to make A.A. literature in digital formats available for alcoholics in correctional settings. The publishing director also provided an update on staple-free pamphlets and reported that the first phase of the plan to publish the most used A.A. pamphlets staple-free is already moving forward.

- The committee reviewed the Corrections Kit and Workbook and provided a list of suggestions. The committee requested that the pamphlet “The ‘God’ Word” be added to the list of contents for the Kit and suggested several changes in the Workbook to reflect current practices and resources.

FINANCE

Committee Considerations:

- The committee discussed a request to revise the pie chart percentages on page 12 of the pamphlet “Self-Support: Where Money and Spirituality Mix” and the consensus was no changes were needed and took no action as these are suggested percentages.
- The committee reviewed a report from the trustees’ Finance Ad Hoc Committee on Google Grants and the Seventh Tradition. The committee strongly suggests forwarding this report to the trustees’ Finance and Budgetary Committee and the appropriate 71st General Service Conference committee.

GRAPEVINE

Committee Considerations:

- The committee considered a request to change the language of the first sentence of the A.A. Preamble as follows: “Alcoholics Anonymous is a fellowship of people who share...” and took no action.
- The committee also discussed making suggested changes to the A.A. Preamble for gender-neutral pronouns. The committee requested that the Grapevine Board consider developing examples of generalized language options and that a progress report or draft versions be brought back to the 71st General Service Conference.
- The committee agreed to forward to the AA Grapevine Corporate Board the suggestion that Grapevine produce in the year 2021 or later:
 1. *Step Three — Turning It Over* (working title)
Previously published stories from the pages of Grapevine by A.A. members about their various experiences with Step 3.
 2. *Character Defects — Steps 6 & 7* (working title)
Previously published stories by A.A. members about their experience with Steps 6 and 7, from the pages of Grapevine.
- The committee agreed to forward to the AA Grapevine Corporate Board the suggestion that Grapevine produce the following La Viña books in the year 2021 or later:
 1. *AA and Families in Recovery* (working title)
Spanish-speaking A.A. members share experiences about how drinking affects the whole family and how A.A. helps repair them, from the pages of La Viña.
 2. *Old-timers Stories* (working title)
Long-time Spanish-speaking A.A. members share

their experience, strength and hope, from the pages of La Viña.

3. *Twelve Steps* (working title)

Spanish-speaking A.A. members share stories of experience with A.A.’s Twelve Steps, from the pages of La Viña.

- The committee discussed a request for AA Grapevine, Inc. to establish an Instagram account in line with the Twelve Traditions and encouraged them to continue with their planning. The committee suggested that the Grapevine Board provide additional information on implementation, anonymity, security, affiliation, outside contributions, privacy, and promotion, and bring a progress report back to the 71st General Service Conference.
- The committee discussed ways that AA Grapevine could get feedback on which new book topics to publish. The committee suggested an annual survey in English, Spanish and French be utilized to get input from the Fellowship.

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/ REGIONAL FORUMS

Committee Considerations:

- The committee reviewed and accepted a report from the International Convention consultants, Talley Management, outlining the steps taken prior and post cancellation of the 2020 International Convention on March 28, 2020.
- The committee discussed the use of the Lord’s Prayer for closing the Big Meetings at the International Convention and had a thoughtful and wide-ranging discussion which included:
 - » The use of the Lord’s Prayer in A.A. meetings can create controversy and support the perception of A.A. as a religious organization.
 - » Although the prayer is part of the history of A.A. and is widely used and supported in some areas, it could make some members feel excluded.
 - » The benefits of autonomy and keeping the newcomer in mind when selecting how to close A.A. meetings.
 - » The diversity of our Fellowship and the need for everyone to feel included.
 - » Consideration of surveying the Fellowship for a wider sharing regarding use of the Lord’s Prayer.
 - » Given the international nature of the International Convention, how the Lord’s Prayer is perceived in other countries.

The committee agreed that further discussion on the use of the Lord’s Prayer as a closing at the Big Meetings of the International Convention would be beneficial and suggested that the 2021 Conference Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums continue discussion at the 71st General Service Conference.

- The committee discussed ways of encouraging interest in Regional and Local Forums and attracting first-time attendees and suggested that the General Service Office consider:

- » Providing options for remote attendance.
- » Providing digital access to Regional Forum materials and presentations (including use of the Meeting Guide app or mobile app).
- » Developing service material for host committees providing shared experience on hosting a Regional Forum and stimulating participation.
- » Developing a “video invitation” from the G.S.B. chair.

Suggestions for implementation at the local area included:

- » Early and consistent communication about Regional Forums, including “What is a Regional Forum?”; no registration fee; what happens at a forum.
- » Involve members at all levels of service; do “sponsorship road trips.”
- » Use the Regional Forum video after it is released.

LITERATURE

Committee Considerations:

- The committee reviewed the progress report regarding the pamphlet “The Twelve Steps Illustrated” and requested that a progress report or draft pamphlet be brought back to the 2021 Conference Committee on Literature.
- The committee reviewed the progress report regarding the pamphlet “The Twelve Concepts Illustrated” and requested that a progress report or draft pamphlet be brought back to the 2021 Conference Literature Committee.
- The committee reviewed the progress report regarding the development of the pamphlet on A.A.’s Three Legacies and requested that a progress report or draft pamphlet be brought back to the 2021 Conference Committee on Literature.
- The committee reviewed a progress report on the revision of the pamphlet “Too Young?” The committee looks forward to reviewing a draft revised pamphlet and/or samples of other potential formats of the pamphlet at the meeting of the 2021 Conference Committee on Literature.
- The committee reviewed a progress report on the revision of the pamphlet “Young People and A.A.” The committee looks forward to reviewing a draft revised pamphlet and/or samples of other potential formats of the pamphlet at the meeting of the 2021 Conference Committee on Literature.
- The committee reviewed the progress report regarding the development of the pamphlet for Spanish-speaking women in A.A. and requested that a progress report or draft pamphlet be brought back to the 2021 Conference Committee on Literature.
- The committee considered if proposed agenda items for plain language, simplified language, accessible translations and large-print versions of the book *Alcoholics Anonymous*, as well as workbooks to help study the program of Alcoholics Anonymous, can be addressed with a common solution.

The committee requested that the trustees continue to explore this topic. The committee requested that the trustees make available to the Fellowship, as soon as possible, in Spanish, English and French, the presentation “The Big Book: Researching Issues, Possible Tools and Access (70th General Service Conference 2020),” which was presented to the committee during their May 2, 2020 agenda reduction meeting. The committee noted the importance for the Fellowship to be informed about the nature of the accessibility challenges with regard to A.A. literature.

The committee requested that a progress report be brought back to the 2021 Conference Committee on Literature.

- The committee reviewed the progress report regarding safety and A.A. to be included in *Living Sober* and “Questions and Answers on Sponsorship.” The committee requested a review of the draft language be taken with accessibility in mind as it relates to reading level. The committee requested that a progress report or draft pamphlet be brought back to the 2021 Conference Committee on Literature.
- The committee discussed a draft update of the pamphlet “The Twelve Traditions Illustrated” and noted the accessibility of the language in terms of reading level as well as the extent of work done on the current version of the update.
- The committee noted that through the process of updating this pamphlet, the final draft update is a distinct item from the original version of “The Twelve Traditions Illustrated,” addressing a different audience and serving a different purpose.
- The committee forwarded to the trustees’ Literature Committee suggestions on the draft update, which the committee considered a new piece of literature on the Twelve Traditions. The committee requested that a progress report or draft pamphlet be brought back to the 2021 Conference Committee on Literature.
- The committee discussed not retiring the existing version of the pamphlet “The Twelve Traditions Illustrated” and requested that a written description be provided by the trustees’ Literature Committee explaining how an existing version of a literature item might remain in publication after a revised, updated version has been approved, and requested that a report be brought back to the 2021 Conference Committee on Literature.
- The committee discussed the “A.A.W.S. Policy on Publication of Literature: Updating Pamphlets and Other A.A. Materials,” approved by A.A.W.S. in January 2020 and noted that concerns expressed by the 69th General Service Conference were addressed in full by the revised policy.

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

Committee Considerations:

- The committee considered a proposed process for the equitable distribution of Conference committees' workload and noted that the trustees' General Service Conference Committee made significant progress on this complex challenge and further that the proposed process selected by the committee is the appropriate option. The committee agreed that the proposed process would help ensure an equitable distribution of the Conference committees' workload and noted that the Proposed Agenda Item Submission Form would bring much needed structure and clarity to the process.

The committee requests that the trustees' General Service Conference Committee clarify the specifics of the proposed plan and bring back a more fully developed process for review by the 2021 General Service Conference. The committee agreed that more specificity is needed on the following:

- » Precisely how this proposed process will impact what will happen regarding agenda items considered at the fall and winter trustees' committees' meetings.
- » Clarity on how the proposed process will impact or change the delegate chairs' participation in the Winter Board Weekend and on the Conference Committees' January conference call to obtain feedback on proposed agenda items. The committee noted that significant progress has been made in involving delegates in the agenda item selection process and would not want to take any steps backward.
- » Creating additional primary committees as needed: develop a sample composition, scope and procedures document for an "additional primary committee."
- » Provide examples, using sample agenda items, showing how the entire process would work.

The committee looks forward to receiving a more detailed plan for this important process for review by the 2021 General Service Conference from the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

Committee Considerations:

- The committee reviewed and accepted the 2019 annual report from the trustees' Public Information Committee regarding aa.org and aagrapevine.org.
- The committee reviewed and accepted the G.S.O. Communications' Department report on the A.A.W.S. Meeting Guide app.
- The committee reviewed and accepted the 2019 trustees' Public Information report on the usefulness and effectiveness of the A.A.W.S. YouTube account.
- The committee reviewed and accepted the 2019 trustees' Public Information report on the current status

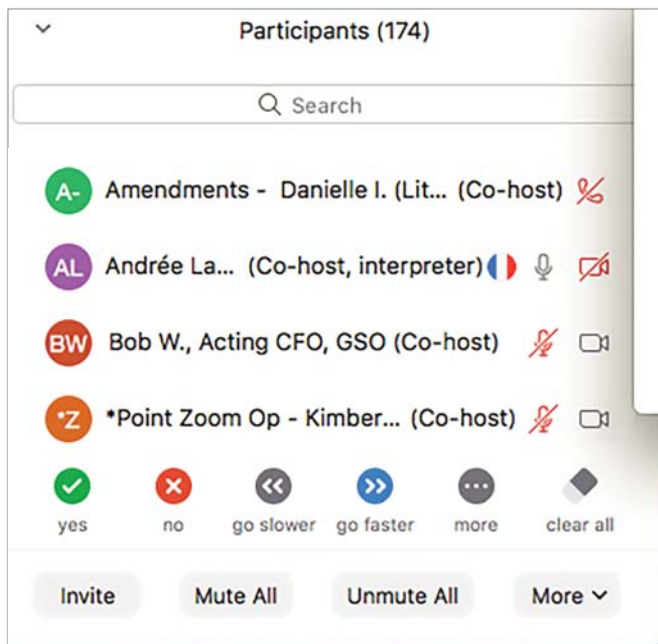
of Google AdWords/Grants and requested that a progress report be brought back to the 2021 Conference Committee on Public Information.

- The committee reviewed and accepted the report of the status of the 2020 Public Information Comprehensive Media Plan. The committee looks forward to reviewing the new architecture being developed and suggested that social media, video/audio content and accessibility to the A.A. message continue to be a priority in comprehensive media plan discussions.
- The committee reviewed and accepted a draft plan to create video shorts based on A.A. pamphlets. The committee noted the important role of short video content to carry the A.A. message and looks forward to receiving a report at the 2021 meeting of the Conference Committee on Public Information.
- The committee reviewed and accepted the 2019 report on the "Relevance and Usefulness of Video Public Service Announcements." The committee noted the recent efforts by G.S.O. to explore editing a Conference-approved PSA to remain useful for local committees reflecting "social distancing" by A.A. groups and members.
- The committee reviewed and accepted the distribution and tracking information for the video PSA "Changes." **Note:** In keeping with a 2019 Advisory Action this PSA title was updated to "Sobriety in A.A.: We made changes to stop drinking" for search engine optimization (SEO).
- The committee reviewed and accepted a report regarding the new financial reporting system for PSA media valuations.
- The committee reviewed and accepted the report on the development of two PSAs.
- The committee also expressed that in light of the recent Coronavirus pandemic it would be helpful to include information as to the many formats in which alcoholics find and carry the A.A. message. The committee looks forward to reviewing the two draft PSAs at their 2021 meeting.
- The committee reviewed a request "to create a new form of communication" to address anonymity on social media. The committee suggested that the trustees' Public Information Committee continue to discuss this request and that preliminary information be gathered before moving forward.

Information to gather:

- » Shared experience from the Fellowship on how A.A. members adhere to anonymity Traditions on various social media platforms.
- » Suggested safety and etiquette while using social media.
- » Anonymity on video meeting platforms.

While the committee recognizes that A.A. literature on anonymity is available ("Understanding Anonymity," A.A.



Guidelines on Internet, etc.) the committee noted that the content is dated and does not accurately reflect current technology or the Fellowship's experience. Specific, updated material is needed and the consideration that a video service piece to communicate this sharing might be explored. The committee requested that the trustees' Public Information Committee continue these discussions and that a progress report or draft proposal be brought back to the 2021 Conference Committee on Public Information.

- The committee discussed a request to develop a plan to create an A.A. podcast. The committee suggested that G.S.O. explore the development of a draft plan to create a G.S.O. podcast to be brought back to the 2021 Conference Committee on Public Information.

The committee suggested that information such as function, target audiences, participation, possible episode topics and an implementation plan be included.

- The committee reviewed and accepted the trustees' Public Information Committee report on the A.A. Membership Survey. The committee noted it was encouraged by some of the findings by the survey professional and asked that the trustees' Public Information Committee continue to explore this topic. The committee also suggested the exploration of a possible digital questionnaire feedback form be part of their discussions.
- The committee reviewed the contents of P.I. Kit and Workbook. The committee shared concerns on the relevancy of a print copy workbook and kit for P.I. Committees.
- The committee had the following suggestions:
 - » Explore the development of an A.A. Service Committee app.
 - » Create a new digital PDF version of the Public

Information Workbook that can be easily shared, updated by G.S.O. in a timely fashion, and edited locally to better reflect local committee work.

- » Gather broader shared experience from the Fellowship.
- » Include more sharing regarding Accessibilities in P.I. work.
- » Share a more up-to-date reflection of A.A. digital assets and how they can be applied to local P.I. work. (Example: A.A.W.S. YouTube Channel, Meeting Guide app, online video/e-radio PSA placement, QR codes, virtual A.A. meetings/events/presentations etc.)
- » Include more short content communication templates to carry the A.A. message to the public.

The committee suggested that the trustees' Public Information Committee discuss this request and that a report be brought back to the 2021 Conference Committee on Public Information on these efforts.

REPORT AND CHARTER

Committee Considerations:

- The committee accepted a report from the Publishing department outlining the General Service Office process for timely and accurate preparation and publication of the 2020 General Service Conference *Final Report*.
- The committee discussed restoring the two paragraphs with the accompanying footnote in the Concept Eleven essay of *The Twelve Concepts for World Service* that were removed by an Advisory Action of the 66th General Service Conference and took no action. The committee agreed that the footnote noting that the two paragraphs are available upon request from the G.S.O. Archives department is adequate.
- The committee reviewed the draft of *The A.A. Service Manual, 2020-2022 Edition* and noted the significant progress made toward the goals agreed upon by the 2019 Conference Committee on Report and Charter. The committee requested that an updated draft be brought back to the 2021 Conference Committee on Report and Charter. The committee will forward suggestions for the next draft to the Publishing department.

TREATMENT & ACCESSIBILITIES

Committee Considerations:

- The committee suggested that the trustees' C.P.C./T.A. committee develop a Bridging the Gap Committee Workbook and provide a progress report to the 2021 General Service Conference. The committee suggested that the shared experience included in the workbook include a list of BTG temporary contacts available from G.S.O.
- The committee reviewed the progress report "Review of Bridging the Gap Materials," and felt it met the goal of the 2019 committee consideration. The committee

suggested that rather than combine Bridging the Gap related service materials, the trustees' C.P.C./T.A. committee consider updating existing service materials to reflect the suggested language updates for currency and inclusion. The committee expressed support for use of a "Question and Answer" style in the content across the range of Bridging the Gap-related items. The committee also expressed support for the sample version of "A.A. Guidelines: Bridging the Gap/Temporary Contact Committees" included in the report.

- The committee reviewed the progress report on updating the pamphlet "A.A. for the Older Alcoholic." The committee noted that the submitted stories did not indicate a broad and diverse representation of A.A. experience and suggested a reopened call for stories based on the following experiences provided by trustees' C.P.C./Treatment and Accessibilities Committees:
 - » Ethnic, cultural and LGBTQ communities
 - » Lifestyle diversity
 - » Got sober later in life
 - » Veterans from the Vietnam War or later
 - » Hearing loss or mobility issues
 - » Online or telephone A.A. meetings
 - » Dementia or Alzheimer's mental health issues
 - » Spiritual pathways
- The committee reviewed the Treatment Committee Kit and Workbook and forwarded a list of suggestions to the trustees' C.P.C./Treatment and Accessibilities Committee.
- The committee reviewed the Accessibilities Kit and Workbook and forwarded a list of suggestions to the trustees' C.P.C./Treatment and Accessibilities Committee.

TRUSTEES

Committee Considerations:

- The committee reviewed the resumes and approved as eligible for election all Class B trustee candidates for West Central and Western Canada Regional trustee.
- The 2020 Conference Committee on Trustees reviewed the slate of directors of A.A. World Services, Inc. and A.A. Grapevine, Inc. as well as the Summary of Events re: Appeal of Proposed A.A.W.S. Board of Directors Slate submitted by the chair of the trustees' Nominating Committee, May 1, 2020, and submitted the following suggestions to the trustees' Nominating Committee:
 1. Consider amending the BYLAWS of Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. ARTICLE III, DIRECTORS to include language similar to that contained in the BYLAWS of The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc. regarding proposed new member trustees.
 2. Consider clarifying *Procedure No. 1 Grapevine and A.A.W.S. Boards Procedures for Nominating Corporate*

Board Directors, specifically point 4 "Past Delegate – not eligible until one year after rotation," to mean not eligible to apply or serve until 1 year after end of rotation as delegate.

The committee requested that a report be brought to the 2021 Conference Committee on Trustees.

- The committee recommended approval of a revised slate of directors of the A.A. World Services Corporate Board, omitting the newly proposed A.A. World Services director as ineligible due to procedural issues. The committee reconvened a second time after they received communication from the general manager requesting that the committee also remove his name from the A.A. World Services Corporate Board slate. Following thorough discussion, the committee declined to change their original recommendation.

Recommendations Not Resulting in Conference Advisory Actions

There were no such recommendations.

Recommendations Passed by Simple Majority

These recommendations passed on a simple majority vote but did not achieve the two-thirds vote to become a Conference Advisory Action.

There were no such recommendations

Floor Actions Not Resulting in Conference Advisory Actions

All 2020 Floor Actions were referred to the trustees' General Service Conference Committee for consideration (see page 53).

Agenda Items Forwarded to the 71st General Service Conference

AGENDA

1. Review the General Service Conference Evaluation Form, process and 2019 Evaluation Summary.
2. Review the 2019 January conference call participant survey results.
3. Discuss report on the Conference Agenda Process from the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference.
4. Discuss the General Service Conference schedule.

ARCHIVES

1. Review Archives Workbook.

■ Committee Considerations

An Advisory Action of the 1990 General Service Conference states: “Items discussed, but no action taken or recommendation made, as well as committee recommendations which are not adopted, be included in a separate section of the Final Report.” Listed by committee, such items are included here “in their entirety” per Advisory Action of the 2019 General Service Conference.



AGENDA

Committee Considerations:

- The committee discussed the 2020 and 2021 “Reports on the Implementation and Effectiveness of the Conference Agenda Process Including Sharing from the Conference Committee Chairs” and two years of the annual survey responses from Conference committee chairs on the effectiveness of the ongoing communication between the trustees’ committee chair or corporate board chair and their corresponding Conference committee chair. The committee noted the value of recent improvements to the Conference agenda process. The committee also suggested the following:
 - » The committee requested that the trustees’ General Service Conference Committee consider a survey suggestion to create a workbook or guideline about the role of a Conference committee chair and forwarded a list of suggestions to the trustees’ General Service Conference Committee.
 - » That the trustees’ General Service Conference Committee explore the feasibility of the three chairs of the corporate boards creating snapshot anonymity-protected videos after each quarterly board weekend, like the prerecorded board videos completed for the recent virtual General Service Conferences. These videos could include current project updates and provide details that are synchronized with but enhance the quarterly reporting that is distributed and reported out by regional trustees to delegates. Regional trustees and delegates could share such videos locally providing enhanced communication up and down the service structure.
- » The committee agreed and requested that the trustees’ General Service Conference Committee consider new ways, such as creating short videos, demonstrations, or visual workflows, to communicate the information in the opening session that describes how the Conference operates and floor actions so that all Conference members may understand them and effectively participate in the annual meeting.
- The committee reviewed the 2019 and 2020 General Service Conference evaluation form and process and made the following suggestions:
 - » That each question on the evaluation have an open comment section.
 - » That a survey like the September 2020 Conference Improvements survey be continued annually.
- The committee reviewed the summary reports of the 2019 and 2020 General Service Conference evaluations. The committee noted several repeated comments and suggested the following:
 - » Explore the feasibility of the translated Conference background being completed sooner than the cur-

rent Advisory Action deadline of the first week of March (French and Spanish).

» Consider a year-over-year statistical and comparative analysis of each evaluation category.

- The committee discussed a proposed change to the General Service Conference schedule and the method of sharing on agenda items and took no action. The proposal suggested allowing for the Conference committees to hear opinions or ideas from their areas on agenda items from delegates who are not members of the committee. The committee strongly believed we should trust the committee system and felt that the proposal did not provide benefits warranting a change.
- The committee considered a proposal suggesting the inclusion of additional avenues for A.A. members to share input on G.S.C. agenda items and took no action. The committee would like to challenge all area delegates to consider innovative ways to encourage local members to participate in the Conference process.
- The committee reviewed survey results on the 2019 January conference call that provides committee members a voice in evaluating the trustee and corporate board disposition decisions on proposed agenda items. The committee requested that this sharing be gathered annually and forwarded to the Conference Committee on Agenda. The committee asked the trustees' General Service Conference Committee to act on a survey request to include more background material on all proposed agenda items discussed at this meeting.

ARCHIVES

Committee Considerations:

- The committee reviewed the Archives Workbook and made the following suggestions regarding the section "Guidelines for Collecting Oral Histories":
 - » Include text offering suggestions on ways to conduct ASL interviews with deaf members to offer a greater diversity of sharing.
 - » In the sub-section "Sample Interview Questions," add sample questions relating to "vision for the future."
- The committee reviewed the report on "Proposed Book on A.A. History" and took no action. The committee noted that the scope of the project is too large for one volume, and that a single volume may not sufficiently cover the expanse of A.A.'s history from 1955 to present. The committee also noted that A.A.'s worldwide Fellowship is ethnically and culturally diverse and such a book might unintentionally leave out some portions of the Fellowship that are today under-reported. It was also noted that the scope and purpose of the Archives is to collect and preserve materials relevant to the history of the Fellowship and expending resources on a history book at this time would not be a prudent use of archives resources.

The committee also noted that several works on various aspects of A.A.'s history have been published by historians utilizing primary resources, including those available in the G.S.O. Archives.

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

Committee Considerations:

- The committee reviewed the C.P.C. Kit and Workbook and made the following suggestions:
 - » That the digital C.P.C. Kit be available in a format that is easily accessible on all digital devices, including desktop, laptops, tablets and smartphones.
 - » Improve the organization on the digital C.P.C. Kit content page, so it can be easily navigated and include links to all items available digitally.
 - » That a QR code connecting to the "For Professionals" page on the aa.org website be added to all appropriate materials in the C.P.C. Kit.
 - » Create a tabletop display with a QR code connecting to the "For Professionals" page on the aa.org website for use at C.P.C. exhibits.
 - » Develop a virtual C.P.C. exhibit.
 - » Update the language to service material in the C.P.C. Kit including the Workbook, C.P.C. PowerPoint presentation, and A.A. Guidelines to reflect current ways to find A.A., references to professionals, and how C.P.C. efforts are implemented in today's environment.

CORRECTIONS

Committee Considerations:

- The committee requested that the trustees' Corrections Committee review the language used in Corrections materials for Corrections professionals and explore the need for developing different language to refer to "persons in custody."
- The committee received a report from the A.A.W.S. publishing director with several viable options that had been identified to make A.A. literature in digital formats available for alcoholics in correctional settings. The committee requested that the trustees' Corrections Committee develop a service piece that will explain the digital distribution terminology to local committees who are carrying the message behind the walls, including step by step guidance on using digital materials in local correction settings.
- The committee recognized the Correction assignment's ongoing efforts to collect shared experience from members who participate in Corrections work — currently available upon request. The committee requested that the trustees' Corrections Committee actively pursue the exploration of thread-based forums and new communication models that would allow members and committees carrying the message

behind the walls to access and provide shared experience. The committee requests that a progress report be brought to the 2022 Conference Committee on Corrections.

- The committee reviewed the Corrections Kit and Workbook and asked the secretary to forward a list of changes to the trustees' Corrections Committee including using current language, correspondence samples, literature, links to A.A.W.S., Inc. and AA Grapevine digital platforms, and videos from the G.S.O. website. The committee also requested that the existing stock of Corrections Workbooks and Kits be retired once updates are completed.

FINANCE

Committee Considerations:

- The committee suggested that any updates made to the pie charts in the pamphlet, "Where Money and Spirituality Mix" be reflected on all similar service materials.
 - The committee reviewed the Conference-approved maximum annual contribution of \$5,000 to the General Service Board from an individual A.A. member and took no action. The committee noted that the maximum annual contribution was increased in 2018 and agreed the amount is appropriate as it stands.
 - The committee reviewed the Conference-approved level of \$10,000 for individual bequests to the General Service Board from A.A. members and took no action. The committee noted that the maximum annual bequest was increased in 2019 and agreed the amount is appropriate as it stands.
 - The committee reviewed the suggested area contribution for delegate expense for the Conference and took no action. The committee noted that there was a need to maintain self-support with Conference costs; however, due to the pandemic, the committee agreed that it would be appropriate to leave the amount as it stands.
 - The committee reviewed a request to reconsider the 1972 G.S.C. Advisory Action stating "G.S.O. should not accept contributions from clubs, listed or known as such, whether or not composed solely of A.A. members. Contributions are welcome from groups meeting in clubs as long as they are sent in the name of the group" and took no action. The committee noted that practices regarding clubs varied throughout the Fellowship, and that there was no widely expressed need to reconsider or change the 1972 Advisory Action.
 - The committee had a robust discussion on the mechanization of group contributions in the pamphlet "Self-Support: Where Money and Spirituality Mix" and took no action.
 - The committee reviewed the Self-Support Packet and took no action. The committee agreed that the material contained in the Self-Support packet was relevant and current.
- The committee discussed Concept XII, Warranty Two and the practice of "selling of our books at cost or less" and took no action. The committee shared experience on the varying practices within the Fellowship regarding literature sales and agreed that a change to Concept XII, Warranty Two was not necessary.
 - The committee reviewed the "Google Grants and the Seventh Tradition Report" and took no action. The committee had a wide-ranging discussion and concluded that Google Grants is a discount provided to all non-profit organizations and is not in violation of the Seventh Tradition.
 - The committee suggested updating "The A.A. Group Treasurer" and the A.A. Guidelines on Finance service materials to include information on how to financially support the AA Grapevine with the following language:

Question: Can our group make financial contributions to AA Grapevine?

Answer: No. AA Grapevine, Inc. is not set up to take contributions from groups or individuals. Groups and individual members support the Grapevine by purchasing Grapevine and La Viña magazine subscriptions and other Grapevine publications and using them in their Twelfth Step work.

To support the Grapevine and La Viña magazine contact:

www.aagrapevine.org

AA Grapevine

475 Riverside Drive, 11th Floor

New York, NY 10115

(212) 870-3018

GRAPEVINE

Committee Considerations:

- The committee reviewed the progress report on the AA Grapevine Workbook revisions and suggested adding additional information on ways to use AA Grapevine resources as Twelfth Step tools, availability of books, pricing, ways Canadian members can more easily participate, and new multimedia platforms.
- The committee reviewed the AA Grapevine Fellowship Survey and summary with appreciation and acknowledged the actions that the Grapevine Board and staff have taken as a result of the findings.
- The committee considered a request to develop an AA Grapevine pamphlet on how the AA Grapevine can be utilized to carry the A.A. message and took no action. The committee recognized the AA Grapevine workbook and other materials include information on how Grapevine and La Viña can be used to carry the message.
- The committee considered gender-neutral language options for possible changes to the A.A. Preamble and took no action. The committee felt they needed more information to make a decision.
- The committee requested that the Grapevine Board gather additional shared experience from the



Fellowship related to the topic of gender-neutral language options for the A.A. Preamble and bring back the results to the 2022 Conference Committee on Grapevine and La Viña.

- The committee agreed to forward to the AA Grapevine Board the suggestion that AA Grapevine, Inc. produce in the year 2022 or later:

1. *AA's Twelve Concepts (working title). Previously published stories from the pages of Grapevine by A.A. members about their various experiences with the Twelve Concepts.*
2. *The Home Group II (working title). Previously published stories by A.A. members about their experiences with their home groups, including stories about A.A. groups that do not meet in person. Possibly a 30th Anniversary edition of the original AA Grapevine Home Group book.*

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/ REGIONAL FORUMS

Committee Considerations:

- The committee had a thoughtful and wide-ranging discussion regarding methods of closing the Big Meetings at the International Convention, particularly the use of the Lord's Prayer and the understanding that although the prayer is part of the history of A.A. and is widely used and supported in some areas, it could make some members feel excluded and support the perception of A.A. as a religious organization. The committee also discussed possible options to the Lord's Prayer including, the Third Step Prayer, the Seventh Step Prayer and A.A.'s Declaration of Unity.

The committee agreed that it would be beneficial to gather additional shared experience from the Fellowship to make an informed decision. The com-

mittee requested that the trustees' International Conventions/Regional Forums Committee explore the preference of the Fellowship regarding methods of closing the Big Meetings at the International Convention by use of a survey through multiple communication platforms (e.g., Box 4-5-9, AA Grapevine/La Viña, etc.); and that a progress report be brought back to the 2022 Conference Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums.

- The committee discussed ways to encourage interest in Regional Forums and attract first time attendees and suggested:
 - » Consider using the meeting guide app to further convey Regional Forum information.
 - » Continue using videoconferencing technology to broadcast portions of future in-person forum programs allowing members who may not have resources or time to travel to participate.
 - » Ensure future host regions are well informed about dates, locations, programs, and ways the local membership can participate.
 - » Extend outreach materials to invite the Spanish-speaking and LGBTQ communities to attend Regional Forums.
 - » Conduct at least one presentation or workshop in Spanish and/or French at each Regional Forum.

LITERATURE

Committee Considerations:

- Regarding the "A.A.W.S. Policy on Conversion of Written Conference-approved Literature and Service Material into Video Format," the committee noted the usefulness and relevancy of video formats of

existing literature, especially items that are basic and addressing the broader aspects of A.A. The committee also noted the importance of a prioritized list of possible print to video projects being presented to the Conference for selection of projects to reflect the expressed need of the Fellowship.

- The committee expressed appreciation for the tentative plans outlined by the trustees' Literature Committee to foster expedience with moving forward on revision of the pamphlet "A.A. for the Black and African-American Alcoholic." The committee noted the importance of involving members of the community from the intended primary audience of the pamphlet in the development of the pamphlet, including providing input for a title that is respectful and inclusive of members throughout the U.S. and Canada.
- The committee noted that the draft updated version of the pamphlet "The Twelve Traditions Illustrated," pending its approval, is well-suited for an introduction to the Traditions, and the existing version is helpful for more in-depth consideration of the Traditions.
- The committee considered a request to revise the book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, by adding text from the pamphlet, "The A.A. Group... Where It All Begins," in an appendix and took no action. The committee agreed that the pamphlet content stands alone, and it is not necessary to add it to *Alcoholics Anonymous*.
- The committee considered a request to audit the first 164 pages of the book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, for necessary revisions and took no action. The committee agreed that the first 164 pages of *Alcoholics Anonymous* should remain unchanged.
- The committee reviewed a request to add a proposed addendum to a Fifth Edition foreword of the book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, at the time it is published and took no action. The committee noted that at the time of the development of a Fifth Edition book, the foreword would be written to reflect pertinent information at that time.
- The committee considered the request to add a subtitle, "How Not to Take the First Drink," to the booklet, *Living Sober*, and took no action. The committee noted that the current title is effective.
- The committee reviewed the progress report regarding the pamphlet "The Twelve Steps Illustrated" and requested that a progress report or draft pamphlet be brought back to the 2022 Conference Committee on Literature.
- The committee reviewed the progress report regarding the pamphlet "The Twelve Concepts Illustrated" and requested that a progress report or draft pamphlet be brought back to the 2022 Conference Literature Committee.
- The committee reviewed a progress report on the revision of the pamphlet "Too Young?" The committee looks forward to reviewing a draft revised pamphlet and/or samples of other potential formats of

the pamphlet at the meeting of the 2022 Conference Committee on Literature.

- The committee accepted the 2019 and 2020 matrices of A.A. recovery literature.

The committee suggested that the annual literature matrix be included as background along with a G.S.O. Publishing Workflow description and draft updates to A.A. Conference-approved literature for the agenda item related to "A.A. World Services, Inc., Policy on Publication: Keeping A.A. Literature Current."

The committee expressed appreciation for the trustees' Literature Committee and A.A.W.S. Board continuing their efforts to outline and define the process by which updates are reviewed and approved per this policy. The committee requested that a progress report be brought back to the 2022 Conference Committee on Literature.

- The committee discussed the draft language regarding safety and A.A. to be included in the booklet, *Living Sober*, and the pamphlet "Questions and Answers on Sponsorship." The committee noted that additional consideration of the accessibility of the language is needed. The committee requested that an updated draft pamphlet be brought back to the 2022 Conference Committee on Literature.
- The committee reviewed the draft update of the pamphlet "Young People and A.A." The committee expressed appreciation for the project being deferred to 2021 due to overall budget constraints and the potential video production expenses as part of the update to this item. The committee also expressed appreciation for the pamphlet's format in terms of how the shared experience, strength and hope is presented.

The committee provided additional suggestions to foster a greater diversity of stories and images of members and requested that an updated draft pamphlet and/or samples of other potential formats of the pamphlet be brought back to the 2022 Conference Committee on Literature.

- The committee reviewed the draft of the new pamphlet on A.A.'s Three Legacies. The committee expressed appreciation for the direction of the pamphlet development to date. The committee noted concern about the length of the pamphlet, the need for more relatable and accessible language, and perhaps reducing the extent to which Bill W.'s writings and A.A. history are included in its content.

The committee suggested additional revisions be considered and that an updated draft pamphlet be brought back to the 2022 Conference Committee on Literature.

- The committee considered if proposed agenda items for plain language, simplified language, accessible translations and large print versions of the book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, as well as workbooks to help study the program of Alcoholics Anonymous, can be addressed with a common solution.

- The committee suggested that the development of workbooks to help study the program of Alcoholics Anonymous, as reflected in the most current edition of the book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, be considered and that a feasibility report be brought back to the 2022 Conference Committee on Literature.
- The committee considered the request to revise the pamphlet, “The A.A. Group...Where It All Begins,” to reflect the importance of the group as a “spiritual entity” as stated in the Long Form of Tradition Five. The committee noted its extensive agenda load resulting in part from the pandemic-affected 2020 General Service Conference. Rather than rush through agenda items, the committee agreed to request that discussion on this item continue with the trustees’ Literature Committee and that consideration be made to forward the item to the 2022 Conference Committee on Literature.
- The committee considered the request to revise text highlighting service roles at the group level in the pamphlet, “The A.A. Group...Where It All Begins.” The committee noted its extensive agenda load resulting in part from the pandemic-affected 2020 General Service Conference. Rather than rush through agenda items, the committee agreed to request that discussion on this item continue with the trustees’ Literature Committee and that consideration be made to forward the item to the 2022 Conference Committee on Literature.
- The committee considered the request to update the pamphlet “A.A. for the Native North American.” The committee noted its extensive agenda load resulting in part from the pandemic-affected 2020 General Service Conference. Rather than rush through agenda items, the committee agreed to request that discussion on this item continue with the trustees’ Literature Committee and that consideration be made to forward the item to the 2022 Conference Committee on Literature.
- The committee considered the review of G.S.O. Publishing updates per the A.A.W.S. print policy for the pamphlets, “Is A.A. for You?” “Is there an Alcoholic in Your Life?” “Frequently Asked Questions about A.A.,” and “This is A.A.” The committee noted its extensive agenda load resulting in part from the pandemic-affected 2020 General Service Conference. Rather than rush through agenda items, the committee agreed to request that discussion on this item continue with the trustees’ Literature Committee and that consideration be made to forward the items to the 2022 Conference Committee on Literature.
- The committee considered the request to include a G.S.R. preamble in the pamphlet “G.S.R.: Your Group’s Link to A.A. as a Whole.” The committee noted its extensive agenda load resulting in part from the pandemic-affected 2020 General Service Conference. Rather than rush through agenda items, the committee agreed to request that discussion on this item continue with the trustees’ Literature Committee and

that consideration be made to forward the item to the 2022 Conference Committee on Literature.

- The committee considered the request to revise the pamphlet “Questions and Answers on Sponsorship” by expanding the section on “Service Sponsorship” and retitling the pamphlet to include service sponsorship. The committee agreed that these revisions might be helpful. The committee noted its extensive agenda load resulting in part from the pandemic-affected 2020 General Service Conference. Rather than rush through agenda items, the committee agreed to request that discussion on this item continue with the trustees’ Literature Committee and that consideration be made to forward the item to the 2022 Conference Committee on Literature.

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

Committee Considerations:

- The committee reviewed the G.S.O. general manager’s report regarding General Service Conference site selection. The committee agreed with the overall goal of a reduction or containment of total Conference costs, the suitability of sleeping rooms and meeting rooms, and an improvement in the convenience and cost of transportation to and from airports. The committee requested that future reports include more details on specific sites considered.
- The committee reviewed the dates for the 2025 General Service Conference. In order to provide additional flexibility to the General Service Office management in contracting the most cost effective and appropriate venues for the General Service Conference, the committee selected the following dates for the 75th General Service Conference in order of preference: May 4 – May 10, 2025; April 27 – May 3, 2025; May 11 – May 17, 2025. The committee noted that these proposed Conference dates are the best choices because they do not conflict with any significant holidays. The committee requested that all Conference members be notified of the final dates for the 75th General Service Conference as soon as the dates are finalized by G.S.O. management.
- The committee considered a request that a procedure be drafted for appealing a ruling by a General Service Conference chair and took no action. The committee noted that processes such as calling for a point of order are available, and that guidance related to handling appeals is provided in the Twelve Concepts.
- The committee requested that the trustees’ General Service Conference Committee consider revising the “Process for Approving Observers to the Conference” to enable the Policy and Admissions Committee to approve routine requests for admission from General Service structures outside the U.S. and Canada without requiring a Conference Advisory Action.
- The committee reviewed the “Report on Translation and Interpretation of General Service Conference

Material” and agreed that great progress has been made. Noting that we are consistently under budget, the committee encouraged use of the full budget if it could mean the translated background would be available earlier. The committee encouraged gathering shared experience from the Fellowship on the five questions at the end of the report. The committee agreed that making Conference background more concise would serve the Fellowship as a whole.

- The committee reviewed the report on the Conference Committee Assignment Application implemented for the 2020 Committee Selection process. The committee agreed the app provided absolute randomization while saving time and reducing human error. The committee looks forward to its continued evolution.
- The committee requested that the trustees’ General Service Conference Committee continue to explore a process for a Conference committee to review, discuss, and act on a proposed agenda item.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

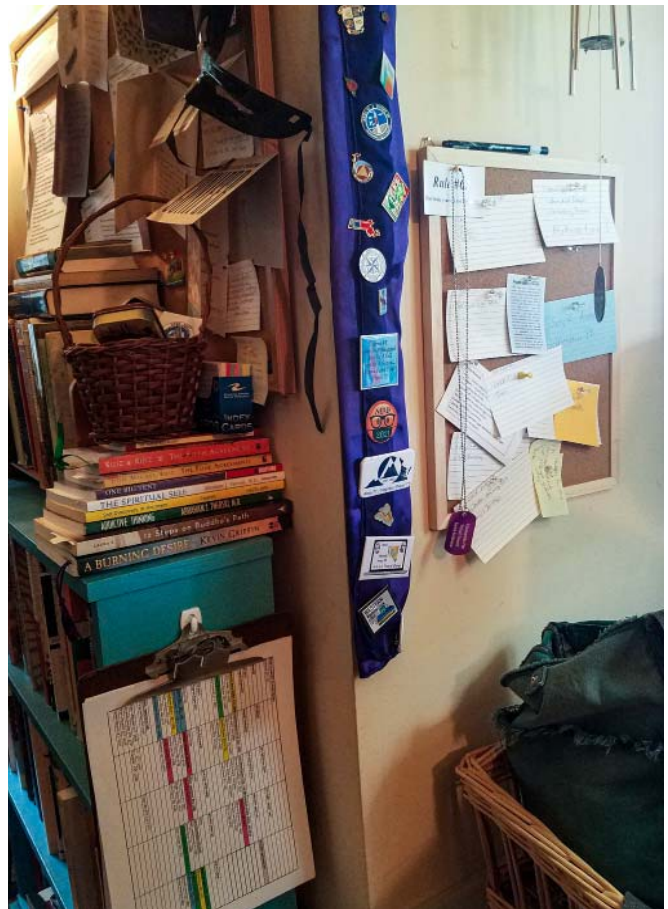
Committee Considerations:

- The committee reviewed and accepted the 2020 annual report from the trustees’ Public Information Committee regarding aa.org and aagrapevine.org.
- The committee reviewed and accepted the 2020 trustees’ Public Information Committee report on the Google Ads performance and requested that a progress report be brought back to the 2022 Conference Committee on Public Information. The committee encouraged G.S.O. to develop an annual project calendar relating to Google Ads.

The committee also supported suggestions provided to them from a report from the G.S.O. senior digital communications analyst and Public Information ACM.

Suggestions include:

- » Creation of more and diverse content. (This is a dynamic environment; a plan of monthly changes is the best use of the tool.)
- » Create two new ad sets with different conversion goals and similar language.
- » Consider setting half the new ads to clicks and half to conversions for comparison.
- » Create one new campaign with multiple ad sets for the professional community.
- » Improve use of the keyword planner and add appropriate keywords in a regular cadence.
- The committee reviewed and accepted the report on the status of the 2021 draft Public Information Comprehensive Media Plan (CMP). The committee expressed support for the vision and architecture. The committee noted the new architecture is in keeping with today’s communications standards and requested that the full plan be brought back to the 2022 Conference Committee on Public Information and that



the full plan be available to all Conference members to distribute to their areas.

The committee also suggested that the content of the CMP be expanded to include a deeper understanding of targeted audiences within A.A. relating to all genders and reaching potential members.

- The committee reviewed and accepted the 2020 report on the “Relevance and Usefulness of Video Public Service Announcements.” The committee found the current Conference-approved PSAs to be relevant and useful.
- The committee discussed the trustees’ Public Information Committee “Survey Methodology Working Group on the Triennial A.A. Membership Survey” report. The committee reviewed and accepted the report and felt satisfied that the current methodology sampling of the survey is sound.

The committee also discussed the suggestion that the 2021 A.A. Membership Survey be conducted and took no action. The committee expressed concerns on the timing of the survey being distributed to the Fellowship considering the status of many groups, attendance, and possible interrupted local communications relating to the distribution of the questionnaire.

The committee also expressed concerns about the A.A. Membership Survey in pamphlet form being used as an “outward” facing Public Information pamphlet to

inform the public, professionals, and potential members about A.A. and believes that the function of the data collected might be better used to inform Twelfth Step efforts for groups and service committees rather than a Public Information tool.

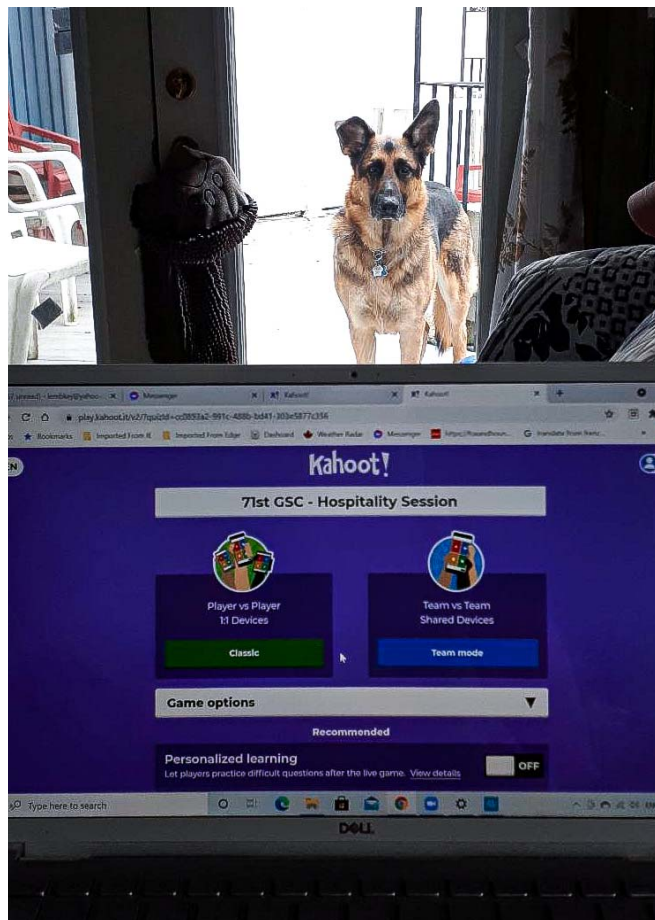
The committee suggested that the trustees' Public Information Committee:

- » Conduct a more in-depth review of the content, language, and function in the questionnaire;
 - » Discuss the function and target audience of the pamphlet;
 - » Produce a training video for delegates and G.S.R.s on data collection, purpose and methods to enhance consistency and engagement.
- The committee discussed service materials and resources for Public Information committees and suggested that a PowerPoint be developed for the purpose of providing shared experience on “how to” present about A.A. at non-A.A. events.
 - The committee discussed the trustees' Public Information Committee review of P.I. pamphlets. The committee encouraged the trustees' Public Information Committee to continue their review of the P.I. pamphlets/service materials and requested that a comprehensive report be brought back to the 2022 Conference Committee on Public Information including suggestions and input related to which P.I. pamphlets/materials may need revision, editorial updates, new formats or possible retirement to make room for improved public information messaging tools.
 - The committee requested that G.S.O. Publishing conduct editorial updates to the pamphlet “Understanding Anonymity” to reflect current technology terminologies and service resources.
 - The committee discussed the content and format of the P.I. Kit and Workbook. The committee noted the memo regarding recent A.A.W.S. Board discussions on the possible development of an A.A. service app and new digital PDF version of the workbook. The committee encourages G.S.O. to move away from a “print-first” approach to publishing so that service material and resources on aa.org might be updated more quickly and efficiently with the most up to date resources for local committees.

REPORT AND CHARTER

Committee Considerations:

- The committee accepted a report from the Publishing department outlining the General Service Office process for timely and accurate preparation and publication of the 2021 General Service Conference *Final Report*.
- The committee discussed the General Service Conference *Final Report*. The committee noted the decline in the distribution of print copies and, while aware of the need to make the print version accessible, encour-



aged the use of the digital anonymity-protected version and suggested the Conference coordinator note these points in pre-Conference documents.

- As part of its discussion on A.A. Directories (Canada, Eastern U.S. and Western U.S.), the committee noted the value of “A.A. Near You,” a searchable local resource on aa.org. The committee also agreed on the importance of G.S.O. updating and continuing to make available the print and digital listing of central offices, intergroups and answering services for the United States and Canada (Item F25) and requested that it be added to the G.S.R. and D.C.M. kits, and the A.A. Group Handbook.

TREATMENT AND ACCESSIBILITIES

Committee Considerations:

- The committee reviewed the progress report on the pamphlet “A.A. for the Older Alcoholic” and requested that a draft pamphlet or progress report be brought to the 2022 Conference Committee on Treatment and Accessibilities.
- The committee reviewed the progress report on audio interviews with A.A. members who are in the Armed Forces and made the following suggestions:
 - » Move forward with the production of audio files ensuring appropriate sound quality for distribution on digital platforms.

- » Gather more audio military interviews from as broad a cross-section of A.A. members in active military duty as possible, including members of the Canadian Armed Forces and native Spanish- and French-speaking members.
 - » Develop a questionnaire to be used for future audio military interviews that include topics such as Post-traumatic Stress Disorder (PTSD), injuries, and barriers that sober alcoholics on active military duty face in getting sober.
 - » Seek the help of the Fellowship in reaching out to possible candidates for the audio military interviews.
 - » Utilize higher quality equipment professional services to record and oversee the production of the audio military interviews to improve sound and visual design quality.
 - » Utilize graphics such as the “Blue People” banner, alternate backgrounds and soundtracks to enhance the audio and visual design of the audio files presentations.
- The committee reviewed the Treatment Committee Kit and Workbook and forwarded a list of suggestions to the trustees’ C.P.C./Treatment and Accessibilities Committee.
 - The committee reviewed the Accessibilities Committee Kit and Workbook and forwarded a list of suggestions to the trustees’ C.P.C./Treatment and Accessibilities Committee.
 - The committee agreed to the concept of developing digital versions of workbooks and other service material and suggested having an opt-in choice to receive electronic versus print versions.
 - The committee suggested updating the A.A. Guidelines on Accessibilities to include references to intellectual disabilities and learning difficulties.
 - The committee requested ongoing reviews and revision of materials to replace the term “special needs” with “accessibilities” across all A.A. literature, including service material.
 - The committee was provided an update on the Remote Communities guidelines and look forward to a draft version.

TRUSTEES

Committee Considerations:

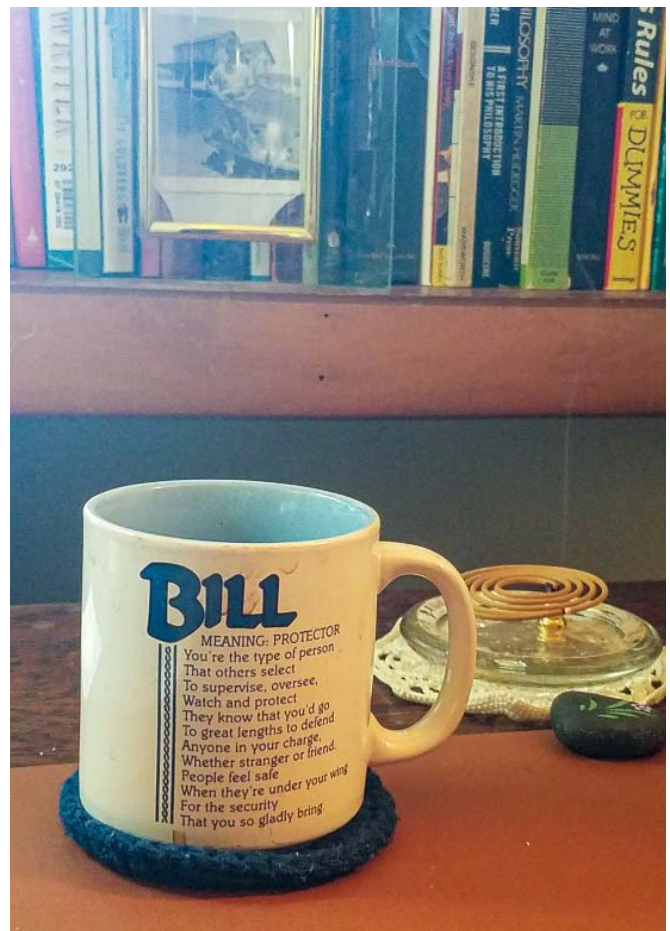
- Regarding the Statement of Concern and motion to censure the General Service Board, the committee agreed that the unity of Alcoholics Anonymous is the most important treasure we have as a Fellowship. The committee also agreed that A.A.’s service structure is equally valuable.

The committee appreciated the extensive additional input provided by the interim general manager of G.S.O. and the chair of the A.A.W.S. Board. The committee noted that the General Service Board and

A.A.W.S. board have a good understanding on finances and organizational strategy and expressed appreciation for the progress being made related to bringing modern communication formats and financial reporting to the General Service Office.

The committee also discussed the authority delegated to the General Service Board and legal responsibilities involving communication, financial prudence and transparency. The committee noted that several major decisions previously made by the General Service Board and corporate affiliate, A.A.W.S., Inc., were not fully or promptly reported out to the Fellowship. The committee recognized that the lack of providing clear, comprehensible answers in a timely manner has caused many in the Fellowship to have strong feelings on all sides of this issue.

- The committee reviewed the resumes, and approved as eligible for election, all Class B trustee candidates for the East Central region, Southeast region, and trustee-at-large/U.S.
- The committee encourages the General Service Board to actively pursue the exploration of thread-based forums and new communication models to improve communication between the General Service Board and the Fellowship.
- The committee reviewed the status report provided by the chair of the General Service Board in response to



a committee consideration from the 2020 Conference Committee on Trustees regarding amending the Bylaws of Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc., Article III, Directors regarding proposed new member trustees. The committee noted the ideas from the author about changing the relationship of the three corporations to each other and to the Conference.

- The committee reviewed and discussed the revised “Procedures for a Partial or Complete Reorganization of the General Service Board, the A.A.W.S. or AA Grapevine Boards,” and requested that the trustees’ Nominating Committee consider further review, with specific attention placed on the time frame and procedure for the selection of Regional Trustees.

The committee appreciated the details and comprehensive work in the revised plan and made editorial suggestions to mirror the updated Conference Charter. The committee requested that a revised plan be brought back to the 2022 Conference Committee on Trustees.

Recommendations Not Resulting in Conference Advisory Actions

These recommendations were presented but did not achieve a majority.

LITERATURE

- This pamphlet, “The A.A. Group... Where it All Begins,” be revised to omit the line on page 13, “Nonalcoholics may attend open meetings as observers,” as follows:

The paragraphs on page 13 currently read:

Closed meetings are for A.A. members only, or for those who have a drinking problem and “have a desire to stop drinking.”

Open meetings are available to anyone interested in Alcoholics Anonymous’ program of recovery from alcoholism. Nonalcoholics may attend open meetings as observers.

Be revised to read:

Closed meetings are for A.A. members only, or for those who have a drinking problem and “have a desire to stop drinking.”

Open meetings are available to anyone interested in Alcoholics Anonymous’ program of recovery from alcoholism.

Recommendations Passed by Simple Majority

These recommendations passed on a simple majority vote but did not achieve the two-thirds vote to become a Conference Advisory Action.

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

- That the General Service Conference invite Appointed Committee Members from trustees’ committees to

attend the 71st General Service Conference, except sessions designated for delegates or trustees only, on a one-year trial basis, as non-Conference members to share points of information. (*Note: This agenda item was considered using the Conference Polling process.*)

- That the procedure for floor actions which is currently as follows:

When a floor action is to be heard, its maker will be given two (2) minutes to state the rationale behind the action, after which the chair shall ask if there is a motion that the Conference decline to consider the floor action. A motion to decline to hear a floor action:

- » Must be made without comment
- » Requires a second
- » Is not debatable
- » Requires a two-thirds majority

Be changed to:

When a floor action is to be heard, its maker will be given two (2) minutes to state the rationale behind the action, after which the chair shall ask if there is a motion that the Conference consider the floor action.

A motion to hear a floor action:

- » Must be made without comment
- » Requires a second
- » Is not debatable
- » Requires a simple majority

TRUSTEES

- The General Service Conference charge the General Service Board with the setup of quarterly virtual meetings of Conference Members, to begin following the October 2021 General Service Board Weekend. These meetings would follow several weeks after each Quarterly Board Meeting, to allow Conference Members the opportunity to request additional information, ask clarifying questions, and to secure a greater sense of transparency.

Floor Actions Not Resulting in Conference Advisory Actions

- The original “Ad Hoc Committee Progress Report — Google Grants and the 7th Tradition” from the trustees’ Finance Committee, dated March 30, 2020, be immediately released to all members of the 71st General Service Conference. We feel strongly that this information is indispensable for the purposes of looking at the Google Grants through the lens of our A.A. principles. (*Conference declined to consider*)
- Edits to the chapters “To Wives,” “The Family Afterward” and “To Employers” (pages 104-149) in the book *Alcoholics Anonymous* will be allowed, but the Preface, the Forewords, “The Doctor’s Opinion” (pages xi-xxxii), “Dr. Bob’s Nightmare” and the Appendices remain as is. (*Withdrawn by the submitter*)

■ Committee Considerations

An Advisory Action of the 1990 General Service Conference states: “Items discussed, but no action taken or recommendation made, as well as committee recommendations which are not adopted, be included in a separate section of the Final Report.” Listed by committee, such items are included here “in their entirety” per Advisory Action of the 2019 General Service Conference.



AGENDA

Committee Considerations:

- The committee expressed appreciation for the special Board presentation related to the participation of online groups in the U.S./Canada service structure at the 72nd General Service Conference.

The committee agreed that a sharing session with more time for a broader range of perspectives from among Conference members would be helpful. The committee requested that the General Service Board conduct an interactive sharing session at the 73rd General Service Conference on the participation of online groups in the U.S./Canada service structure and include the following question within the framework of the sharing session:

- » What are the successes and challenges at the group, district and area levels with respect to this topic?

ARCHIVES

Committee Considerations:

- The committee reviewed the Archives Workbook and expressed satisfaction with the content. The committee also received a verbal report on some of the revisions and updates to the draft workbook, including:
 - » New shared experiences and a new subsection from local archivists on specific topics pertaining to archival work;

- » Revised Guidelines for Collecting Oral Histories to include text offering suggestions on ways to conduct ASL interviews with members in the Deaf community to offer a wider diversity of sharing;
- » Replaced gender-specific language throughout the workbook;
- » Updated Archives policies; and other minor editorial updates.

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

Committee Considerations:

- The committee reviewed a progress report on the LinkedIn page implementation and an update from the senior digital communications analyst. The committee requested that a progress report be brought back to the 2023 Conference Committee on CPC and suggested that it include the following content:
 - » An additional cadence strategy that increases the number of posts per month developed over the year.
 - » A strategy of posting often, to increase the search result ranking.
 - » Posts targeted to professionals on topics such as A.A. anonymity, Self-Support, cooperation without affiliation, and our public relations policy.
- The committee also discussed a comprehensive approach in exploring and optimizing digital resources.

es. The committee requested that the staff secretary send a memo to the trustees' Public Information Committee with the following suggestions to be included as part of the Comprehensive Media Plan (CMP):

- » Explore effective ways to post videos and documents on non-A.A. platforms.
- » Noting the multiple committee and Board discussions on the use of QR codes, identify where and how to approach QR code usage in A.A. materials at CPC/PI events.
- The committee reviewed the suggested revisions to the draft pamphlet "A.A. in Your Community" and received an update from the executive editor. The committee offered additional suggestions and asked the staff secretary to forward a memo to the trustees' CPC/TA committee with additional sharing and suggestions on the content. The committee requested that a progress report or final draft pamphlet be brought back to the 2023 Conference Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community.
- The committee reviewed a progress report on the development of an outward facing pamphlet for mental health professionals and expressed their appreciation. The committee noted that utilizing a focus group was a useful approach to explore and identify the needs of mental health professionals when they are addressing the suffering alcoholic. The committee asked that the staff secretary forward a memo with additional suggestions to the trustees' CPC/TA committee. The committee requested that a progress report or draft pamphlet be brought back to the 2023 Conference Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community.
- The committee considered a request to create a new pamphlet designed to help CPC committees reach as many doctors as possible and took no action, noting that many healthcare professionals may lack the time to meet with CPC committees and that health care systems differ in the U.S. and Canada. The committee suggested that service material could be developed for A.A. members on how to speak with their own healthcare provider about Alcoholics Anonymous.
- The committee reviewed the CPC Kit and Workbook and asked that the following suggestions be incorporated:
 - » Develop a disclaimer that clarifies that the printed version of the items in the kit may not reflect the most up-to-date revisions on aa.org. Online versions will reflect the most updated versions.
 - » Include a list of changes of revised pamphlets and service materials based on the AAWS literature policy.
 - » Include experience from online, in-person and virtual CPC events and activities.
 - » Use accessible formats for all digital devices.

CORRECTIONS

Committee Considerations:

- The committee reviewed the Corrections Kit and Workbook and provided a detailed list of revisions to the trustees' Corrections Committee for their consideration. During their discussion, the committee noted the increased use of online A.A. meetings in correctional facilities and suggested that GSO staff gather shared experience regarding online meetings in correctional facilities for addition to the Corrections Workbook.
- The committee discussed the request to reconsider use of the term "person in custody" in A.A. literature and took no action. The committee affirmed the need for language that is inclusive and non-stigmatizing, as expressed by the 71st General Service Conference. The committee also discussed that implementation of the advisory action was already in place and that it would be premature at this time to reconsider the action.

- The committee discussed the request to limit changes to the book *Alcoholics Anonymous* and took no action. While the committee discussed the concerns expressed by the Fellowship, the committee noted that we operate on a system of trust and checks and balances and agreed that A.A.'s Twelve Concepts adequately provide guidance to our trusted servants to make decisions that reflect the informed group conscience of the Fellowship as a whole.

Note: As a result of the 2021-22 Equitable Distribution of Workload plan, this item was on the agenda of the Conference Committee on Corrections.

- The committee suggested that during the development of the Fifth Edition Big Book the trustees' Literature Committee consider including a reference in the section of Appendices III and V that additional information is available on www.aa.org.

The committee discussed the request to make A.A. literature changes slowly and with A.A.'s primary purpose in mind and took no action. The committee agreed the cadence and role of the annual General Service Conference already provides the appropriate guidance. The committee also noted that through Concept Four, "The Right of Participation," all members of Alcoholics Anonymous are invited to participate in the year-long process of the General Service Conference.

Note: As a result of the 2021-22 Equitable Distribution of Workload plan, this item was on the agenda of the Conference Committee on Corrections.

FINANCE

Committee Considerations:

- The committee reviewed the Self-support Packet and requested that the trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee undertake a full review of the service items in the packet. The committee compiled a list of suggestions for the service material in order to provide

language that is clear and consistent for the U.S. and Canada.

- The committee requested that the trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee review the service materials and the pamphlet "Self-Support: Where Money and Spirituality Mix" to clarify that although contributions are sent to the General Service Office, contributions are made to the General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous. The committee asked that an update report or draft pamphlet reflecting the changes be brought to the 2023 Conference Committee on Finance for review.
- The committee discussed the agenda item "Consider request to add a historical disclaimer to the front of the book Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions" and took no action. The committee agreed that the current introduction in the book Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions already addresses concerns regarding the language in the book.

Note: As a result of the 2021-22 Equitable Distribution of Workload plan, this item was on the agenda of the Conference Committee on Finance.

- The committee discussed the agenda item "Consider request that all proposed changes to the book Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions be handled in footnotes" and took no action. The committee agreed that they did not want to mandate a specific format for possible changes to a future Conference. The committee noted that future proposals for changes should be considered by the group conscience of each Conference.

Note: As a result of the 2021-22 Equitable Distribution of Workload plan, this item was on the agenda of the Conference Committee on Finance.

GRAPEVINE AND LA VIÑA

Committee Considerations:

- The committee reviewed the progress report on the AA Grapevine Workbook revisions and looks forward to having it available on the website, in English and Spanish. The committee also forwarded editorial suggestions for the workbook to the Grapevine office.
- The committee reviewed the progress report on the Grapevine and La Viña Instagram accounts and requested a progress report be brought back to the 2023 Conference Committee on Grapevine and La Viña. The committee appreciated the diligence of the AA Grapevine Corporate Board in considering anonymity protection when developing content for both Instagram accounts. The committee also appreciated the dedication and enthusiasm the staff applied to the Instagram accounts. The committee also forwarded suggestions to the Grapevine office to encourage members to submit anonymity-protected content to Instagram pages.
- The committee agreed to forward to the AA Grapevine Corporate Board the suggestion that Grapevine produce in the year 2023 or later:

1. Best of Dear Grapevine (working title)
Previously published letters from the pages of Grapevine by A.A. members which were printed in the magazine's letters section, Dear Grapevine.
 2. Book for Newcomers (working title)
Previously published stories by A.A. members sharing helpful tools and suggestions during their first year in sobriety.
 3. Best of La Viña II (working title) (La Viña book)
Spanish-speaking A.A. members share their experience, strength and hope, from the pages of La Viña.
 4. Prayer & Meditation (working title) (La Viña Book)
Previously published stories by Spanish-speaking A.A. members sharing about the many ways they practice Step Eleven (possibly including some translated stories from the GV version).
- The committee discussed the wide-ranging impact the AA Preamble change has had on the Fellowship. The committee felt that after careful consideration of Fellowship feedback, it would be premature to quantify the impact when many A.A. members are still either uninformed or ambivalent about the change. The committee emphasized that at every level of our Conference process there is a reciprocal responsibility of all A.A. members and trusted servants, of participation and communication, to embrace the guiding principles of trust and transparency.
 - The committee requested that the Grapevine office consider the feasibility of producing or utilizing American Sign Language (ASL) content.

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/ REGIONAL FORUMS

Committee Considerations:

- The committee reviewed the update report submitted by the trustees' committee regarding surveying the Fellowship on methods of closing the Big Meetings at the International Convention. The committee understands that a survey has been developed to gather information from the Fellowship regarding aspects of the 2025 International Convention; and that a question(s) regarding use of the Lord's Prayer and options to the use of the Lord's Prayer (e.g., the Third Step Prayer, the Seventh Step Prayer and A.A.'s Declaration of Unity) will be added to the survey. It is anticipated that the survey will be dispatched in May 2022 via mail and through multiple communication platforms (e.g., Box 4-5-9, AA Grapevine/La Viña, etc.); and that a progress report be brought back to the 2023 Conference Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums.
- The committee discussed ways to encourage interest in Regional Forums and attract first-time attendees and suggested:
- Consider options to the title "Regional Forum" utilizing more current language.

- Continue utilizing digital communication options; however, also continue non-digital options to ensure full accessibility and participation by members who may not have access to technology.
- Theme: “90 Years — Language of the Heart” / « 90 ans — Langage du Cœur » / “90 años — Lenguaje del corazón”

LITERATURE

Committee Considerations:

- The committee reviewed the 2022 matrix of A.A. recovery literature. The committee agreed to follow up with the Publishing department with suggestions regarding the usefulness and purpose of the recovery literature matrix and looks forward to reviewing the matrix at their meeting during the 2023 General Service Conference.
- The committee reviewed a draft pamphlet based on A.A.’s Three Legacies and offered additional suggestions for the trustees’ Literature Committee to consider. The committee requested that a draft pamphlet or progress report be brought back to the 2023 Conference Committee on Literature.
- The committee reviewed a progress report on the update of the pamphlet “Too Young?” The committee requested that a progress report or draft pamphlet be brought back to the 2023 Conference Committee on Literature.
- The committee reviewed a progress report on the update of the pamphlet “A.A. for the Black and African-American Alcoholic.” The committee requested that a progress report or draft pamphlet be brought back to the 2023 Conference Committee on Literature.
- The committee reviewed a progress report on the update of the pamphlet “A.A. for the Native North American.” The committee requested that a progress report or draft pamphlet be brought back to the 2023 Conference Committee on Literature.
- The committee reviewed a progress report regarding development of a Fourth Edition of the book *Alcohólicos Anónimos*. The committee requested that a progress report or draft manuscript be brought back to the 2023 Conference Committee on Literature.
- The committee reviewed a progress report regarding the translation of the book *Alcoholics Anonymous* (Fourth Edition) into plain and simple language. The committee requested that a progress report or draft manuscript be brought back to the 2023 Conference Committee on Literature.
- The committee reviewed a progress report regarding strategy to make current literature accessible in all possible formats. The committee encourages the trustees’ Literature Committee to continue in their efforts to make literature accessible in all formats and provided several suggestions for more e-literature and other accessible digital platforms, such as Liquid Mode PDF for mobile screens.
- The committee reviewed the Subcommittee Report on Tools to Access the Big Book (TABB) and several requests for development of study guides from the Fellowship. The committee also reviewed the minutes of the discussions on this item by the trustees’ Literature Committee. The committee noted that additional information would be needed in order to provide direction on these requests. The committee requested that the trustees’ Literature Committee provide further information regarding the purpose of the



proposals and examples of what Big Book or *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* study guides would look like.

- The committee reviewed a draft of the Literature Committee workbook and noted that the development of the workbook is moving in the right direction. The committee provided several suggestions regarding the length and content of the workbook and requested that a revised draft be brought back to the 2023 Conference Committee on Literature for review.
- The committee discussed the changes to the text of the book *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* resulting from advisory actions of the 71st General Service Conference and took no action. The committee noted that there does not appear to be a consensus on the changes among A.A. members at the local level.
- The committee reviewed a progress report regarding development of a Fifth Edition of the book *Alcoholics Anonymous*. The committee requested that a progress report or draft manuscript be brought back to the 2023 Conference Committee on Literature.

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

Committee Considerations:

- The committee reviewed the progress report from the Subcommittee on Equitable Distribution of Workload regarding year one of the three-year pilot. The committee noted that the plan allowed fifty more Delegates to participate more equitably in the Conference Committee process and appreciated the spiritual aspect of that accomplishment. The committee also noted the workflow, communication, and scoring tool challenges documented in the report, as well as the significant challenges to areas and to the group conscience process caused by moving up the deadline for submitting proposed agenda items to September 15. The committee hopes that whatever can be done to address these challenges will be done over the next two years of the pilot.
- The committee reviewed the GSO general manager's report regarding General Service Conference site selection, noting with appreciation the level of detail regarding specific sites considered. The committee requested that the next site selection report provide detail on the financial, logistical, and spiritual implications of holding the General Service Conference at other locations throughout the eight regions of the U.S./Canada service structure, perhaps in rotation with the New York City metropolitan area.
- The committee reviewed the dates for the 2026 General Service Conference. In order to provide additional flexibility to the General Service Office management in contracting the most cost-effective and appropriate venues for the General Service Conference, the committee agreed to select three proposed dates for the 76th General Service Conference. The committee selected the following dates in order of preference for

the 76th General Service Conference: April 26–May 2, 2026; April 19–25, 2026; and May 3–9, 2026. The committee noted that these proposed Conference dates do not conflict with any significant holidays and allow the Fellowship ample time before the Conference to review and discuss agenda items. The committee asked that all Conference members be notified of the final dates for the 76th General Service Conference as soon as they are finalized by GSO management.

- The committee reviewed with appreciation the progress report on the development of a process using virtual meeting technologies for polling the General Service Conference between meetings and looks forward to development of the process.
- The committee reviewed the Progress Report from the trustees' Ad Hoc Committee on the Participation of Online Groups in the U.S. and Canada Service Structure and expressed appreciation for the ad hoc committee's work. Given the Fellowship's interest in this topic and a desire for accountability to the Conference, the Policy/Admissions committee requests a progress report be provided as part of their background material in advance of the 73rd General Service Conference.
- The committee considered the request to revise the pamphlet "Questions and Answers on Sponsorship" to reflect shared experience on service sponsorship and took no action. The committee felt that the topic of service sponsorship is already addressed well in the current version of the pamphlet "Questions and Answers on Sponsorship" and in the current *A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts for World Services*.

Note: As a result of the 2021-22 Equitable Distribution of Workload plan, this item was on the agenda of the Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

Committee Considerations:

- The committee reviewed and accepted the 2022 Public Information Comprehensive Media Plan (CMP). The committee expressed support for the vision and architecture and reported that this version of the CMP brings a practical and implementable plan into vision. The committee agrees it serves as an inventory of ongoing work and plans, a guideline for the General Service Office and AA Grapevine Office in their work, budgeting processes, and HR planning to effectively support A.A. members in carrying the message to all who suffer from alcoholism.

The committee offered the following suggestions for the next iteration of the CMP to be brought back to the 2023 Conference Committee on Public Information.

- » Continue to focus on standardizing a unified stylistic approach in our messaging and media.
- » Create a synopsis or executive summary of the CMP as the complete document is detailed.

- » Now that we have a CMP that outlines many channels of work the committee requested the Trustees ensure we do not lose the work that is captured and avoid trying to branch off into too many directions and digital platforms.
- » Consider the creation of a short video capturing how a Comprehensive Media Plan can be a helpful guidepost as we seek to use new and existing communication platforms, in keeping with our Traditions.
- » The committee recognized that we are a Fellowship of varying technical abilities. The committee noted the importance of ensuring we are not leaving anyone with technical barriers behind.
- » Include additional information in the CMP on how Alcoholics Anonymous can connect with the professional community.
- » Use consistent A.A. language throughout the CMP versus more marketing or business terminology.
- The committee reviewed and accepted the trustees' PI Committee report on the usefulness and effectiveness of the AAWS YouTube account. The committee offered the following suggestions and looks forward to a report to be brought back to the 2023 Conference Committee on Public Information.
 - » Staff continue to update the AAWS YouTube account to maximize its effectiveness as a social media channel to carry the message to the alcoholic.
 - » Improve the ability to search and locate our AAWS YouTube channel as members have shared it is difficult to find and many are unaware that we have a YouTube channel.
 - » Consider adding more Spanish video content.
- The committee reviewed and accepted the 2022 trustees' Public Information Committee report on the Google Ads performance. The committee encouraged GSO to develop an annual project calendar relating to Google Ads. The committee noted that the office should continuously optimize the Google Ads campaigns based on standard best practices in keeping with A.A. Traditions focusing on target audiences utilizing A.A. literature we currently have and that may be developed. The committee offered the following suggestions and looks forward to the report to be brought back to the 2023 Conference Committee on Public Information:

The GSO Communication Services department in cooperation with the staff secretary should make the following updates to the campaigns to ensure improved campaign performance.

- » Evaluate and experiment with ad targeting
- » Creation of more diverse content
- » A/B test ad copy and design
- » Add/remove keywords and negative keywords
- » Change keyword match type

- » Test multiple landing page options
- » Approve/deny basic campaign suggestions provided by Google Ads
- » Review analytics on messaging to ensure it is reaching the target audience
- » Include keyword testing of AA Google Ads searches to ensure they are being made available to those seeking help with a drinking problem.
- The committee reviewed and accepted the GSO Communications Services department report on the AAWS Meeting Guide App. The committee looks forward to a report to be brought back to the 2023 Conference Committee on Public Information. The committee suggested that the Meeting Guide App keep its focus on providing information on locating A.A. meetings.
- The committee reviewed and accepted the 2021 annual reports from the trustees' Public Information Committee regarding aa.org. The committee finds the website is easier to navigate and user-friendly. The committee suggested that GSO continue to improve our search engine optimization, setting priorities and reasonable goals to move forward.
- The committee reviewed and accepted the 2021 annual report "AAGV/La Viña Website, Marketing and



Podcast” regarding aagrapevine.org. The committee finds recent modernization of the Grapevine website to be effective and inviting. The committee finds the AA Grapevine Podcast is well received by many A.A. members and an effective method for sharing the collected voices of A.A. members. The committee noted that the current hosts might limit attraction to all members, potential members, or professionals and to consider the full intended audience regarding diversity, attraction, and belonging.

- The committee reviewed and accepted the distribution and tracking information for the video PSAs:

1. Sobriety in A.A.: My Drinking Built a Wall
2. Sobriety in A.A.: When Drinking Is No Longer a Party.

The committee encourages enhancing our future tracking and distribution to include comparison analytics to other non-profits with public service announcement distribution.

- The committee reviewed and accepted the 2022 report on the “Relevance and Usefulness of Video Public Service Announcements.” The committee found the current Conference-approved PSAs to be relevant and useful. In assessing the need for a new video PSA, the committee did not see the need at this time.
- The committee reviewed and accepted the 2022 trustees’ Public Information Committee feasibility research on paid placement of PSA videos on streaming platforms and requested that further research be conducted. The committee offered the following suggestions and looks forward to a report to be brought back to the 2023 Conference Committee on Public Information.
 - » Committee members would like to see additional research comparing paid versus donated media value ads and the effectiveness of these different approaches.
 - » Include research on Canadian streaming platforms to better understand PSA regulations and the specific streaming platforms found within Canada.
 - » Focus on obtaining A.A. member feedback from various age groups on the desire from the Fellowship to embark on A.A. paid placement ads on streaming platforms.

- The committee reviewed the progress report and GSO Podcast Plan and considered all the proposals, and the work completed this past year. The committee met with the Grapevine publisher, Communication Services staff, and Publishing staff who responded to key questions. The committee suggested that the trustees’ Public Information Committee, GSO Communication Services department, and AAWS Publishing department in cooperation with the staff secretary, focus on proposal one, to consider moving in the direction of creating a GSO Podcast using the AA Grapevine podcast experience.

The committee shared that the focus described in the 2021 Advisory Action “Podcasts providing sharing

within the Fellowship and information about A.A. to the public be produced and distributed by GSO in cooperation with the Grapevine Office,” is on target and that GSO can create episodes on many service-related discussion topics. The committee feels that the different topic focus will help avoid competing with the Grapevine Podcast. To support the successful continued development of the GSO Podcast the committee offers the following suggestions and looks forward to a progress report to be brought back to the 2023 Conference Committee on Public Information.

- » Entrust GSO to manage the podcast’s creation and adherence to A.A. principles to allow the seamless production of a regular series of episodes.
- » Ask the trustees’ Public Information Committee to research the best methods for future podcast episodes to be completed in Spanish and French.
- » Develop the methodology to invite participants in recorded sessions based on topics to include our trustees, staffs, and members in the episodes.
- » Establish internal and external resources to support the production of the GSO Podcast. It may be helpful to engage freelance support that brings experience on creative Podcast development and formatting.
- » Implement analytics as described in the GSO Podcast Plan to report annually to the Conference Committee on Public Information.
- The committee considered the suggestion to revise the flyer “A.A. at a Glance” and requested that the trustees’ Public Information Committee and staff secretary focus improvements based on the following suggestions and looks forward to a progress report or draft flyer to be brought back to the 2023 Conference Committee on Public Information.
 - » Keeping most of the content messaging of this effective Public Information tool, modernize the look and language of the flyer.
 - » Remove any reference to the word “hopeless drunks” to focus more on the solution, not the problem in this communication.
 - » Update the contribution and self-support language to remove any reference to a dollar amount of contribution.
- The committee considered the suggestion to revise the pamphlet “Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings” and asked that the trustees’ Public Information Committee move forward with the update. The committee asked that the staff secretary start with the draft pamphlet provided for review. In addition, the committee shared their own editorial revisions. Finally, the committee requested the staff secretary send a memorandum to the AAWS Publishing department of all changes and looks forward to a progress report or draft pamphlet to be brought back to the 2023 Conference Committee on Public Information.

- The committee considered the request to replace the “A.A. Fact File” with a service material version of a new digital P.I. Press Media Kit. The committee reviewed the new digital P.I. Press Media Kit and offered suggestions to the “Who are A.A. members” and the “24-hour plan” sections.
- The committee considered the request to create a new form of communication to address anonymity on social media by reviewing a draft survey developed to gather shared experience from the Fellowship. The committee requested the trustees’ Public Information Committee and staff secretary focus on distributing the survey to all age demographics, particularly a young population, and obtain results that will inform decisions on any future new form of communication. The committee looks forward to a progress report to be brought back to the 2023 Conference Committee on Public Information.
- The committee discussed the content and format of the PI Kit and Workbook. The committee noted the updated content list provided by the staff secretary and agreed to all the changes.

REPORT AND CHARTER

Committee Considerations:

- The committee accepted a report from the Publishing department outlining the General Service Office process for timely and accurate preparation and publication of the 2022 General Service Conference *Final Report*.
- The committee discussed the General Service Conference *Final Report* and noted the following:
The committee reiterated their support for last year’s committee consideration and appreciated the use of digital versions and encouraged the Conference coordinator to continue noting the availability of these in pre-Conference documents.
The committee noted the importance of the *Final Report* and encouraged area delegates to make its local reporting innovative and fun, especially considering the use of new digital technologies.
The committee also noted the importance and effectiveness of making use of Fellowship Connection to connect the trusted servants in the service structure to the digital version of the *Final Report*. The committee suggested that the following local efforts might be helpful in these initiatives:
» An area or district thank you letter and an invite to the area assembly with a link to the *Final Report*.
(**Note:** Fellowship Connection lists GSRs and these trusted servants can be introduced to their DCM and/or area delegate and be invited to participate in the local district and area discussions of the General Service Conference.)
» Areas consider making the *Final Report* accessible in newly digital formats.

» The creation of a local anonymity-protected, voice-only PowerPoint.

(**Note:** The *Final Report* reflects Conference actions and discussions, therefore the committee wanted to express that the *Final Report* is an extension of the experience we learn about in *The A.A. Service Manual*.)

- The committee discussed the request to include the GSR preamble in the pamphlet “GSR: Your Group’s Link to A.A. as a Whole” and took no action. The committee agreed that the GSR pamphlet adequately describes the role and purpose of a GSR. The committee agreed that this statement is better left to local group autonomy.
Note: As a result of the 2021-22 Equitable Distribution of Workload plan, this item was on the agenda of the Conference Committee on Report and Charter.
- The committee reviewed the progress report from AAWS Publishing on a new section to be added at the end of the *Twelve Concepts for World Service* titled “Amendments.” Bill W. references an Amendments section in the introduction to the *Twelve Concepts for World Service* and the committee wanted to reaffirm the 2021 advisory action that: “A new section be added at the end of the *Twelve Concepts for World Service* titled ‘Amendments,’ and that it contain an updated version of the Concept XI essay that incorporates the information in the current footnotes and endnotes, along with comprehensive descriptions of the current General Service Board committees.” The committee requested that the staff secretary work with AAWS Publishing on a draft update of the section to be brought back to the 2023 Conference Committee on Report and Charter.
- The committee reviewed several chapters of *The A.A. Service Manual* and wanted to note the following.
- *The A.A. Service Manual* can be utilized for all individuals involved in the General Service structure. The text is not limited to new people in service or only GSRs. Class A trustees, appointed committee members, nontrustee directors and other roles in general service should be able to draw upon the experience shared in specific chapters.
- The committee followed up on the 2021 committee consideration regarding updating and continuing to make available the print listing of Central Offices, Intergroups and Answering Services for the United States and Canada (Item F25). The committee discussed the estimated cost to fulfill this request as well as results of a poll involving 107 Intergroup/Central Offices and decided unanimously to request the General Service Office retire this document and remove it from aa.org. The committee noted that cooperation between local areas, districts and Intergroups/Central Offices is important in helping prospective A.A. members find Alcoholics Anonymous, highlighting that local services, coupled with data stewardship, can help ensure accuracy of Intergroup/Central Office locations. In addition, the committee encouraged communica-



tion and sharing of ideas through the ICOAA seminar and the General Service Conference. The committee recognizes an overdependence on GSO and recognizes that in some cases the necessity and importance of local relationships is overlooked.

- The committee discussed the request that the chapter titled “The Doctor’s Opinion” be returned to page one, as it was in the First Edition of the book *Alcoholics Anonymous* and took no action. The committee noted that Bill W. was involved in the repagination of *Alcoholics Anonymous* for the second edition. It was also noted that such a change would impact other pieces of A.A. literature that reference pages in the book *Alcoholics Anonymous*. The committee added that they did not recognize a strong “spiritual need” to revert to the original pagination.

Note: As a result of the 2021-22 Equitable Distribution of Workload plan, this item was on the agenda of the Conference Committee on Report and Charter.

- The committee discussed a possible edition of *The A.A. Service Manual* in American Sign Language (ASL). While aware of the long list of projects and current workload at GSO, the committee requested that the AAWS Board research the need for and feasibility of a translation of *The A.A. Service Manual Combined with*

the Twelve Concepts for World Service into ASL and asks that a report be brought to the 2023 Conference Committee on Report and Charter. In addition, the committee encourages local areas, districts, and Intergroups/Central Offices to make ASL interpretation and service opportunities more accessible to the Deaf community.

TREATMENT AND ACCESSIBILITIES

Committee Considerations:

- The committee discussed and accepted a progress report on the development of a revision to the pamphlet “A.A. for the Older Alcoholic.” The committee requested that the trustees’ Cooperation with the Professional Community/Treatment and Accessibilities Committee keep the following suggestions in mind:
 - » Include stories of only those who found recovery from the age of 60 years or older.
 - » Form a working group to help gather sharing from A.A. members who found recovery after age 60.
 - » Consider who is the target audience.
 - » Conduct a broader call out for stories through multiple distribution methods.
 - » Include stories of senior alcoholics with health issues, are hard of hearing, are immigrants, and have experience in finding recovery or barriers to online meetings.
 - » Consider a new format for the pamphlet that is more accessible, noting that the current foldable format is challenging to open and navigate pages for those who may have dexterity challenges.

The committee also provided additional notes on gaps in the stories to the committee secretary to be forwarded to the trustees’ Cooperation with the Professional Community/Treatment and Accessibilities Committee.

The committee requested that a progress report or draft pamphlet be brought to the 2023 Conference Committee on Treatment and Accessibilities.

- The committee reviewed and accepted a progress report on military audio interviews and suggested that the trustees’ Cooperation with the Professional Community/Treatment and Accessibilities Committee:
 - » Reach out to military senior leadership.
 - » Seek interviews from members in various military/armed forces branches.
 - » Consider broader distribution channels, through diverse communication methods such as AA Grapevine, La Viña, WhatsApp, and LIM.
 - » Distribute a questionnaire to interviewees for the audio-military project.
 - » The military consultants on the trustees’ Cooperation with the Professional Community/Treatment and Accessibilities Committee develop a project plan that will include reporting to the entire trustee committee.



- The committee discussed the draft version of the A.A. Guidelines for Remote Communities and offered the following suggestions:

- » The committee encourages GSO Publishing to continue to maintain the most current cultural terminologies.
- » Remove the names from the sharing in the guidelines (though currently anonymity protected; highlight the message rather than the name).
- » Remove the section “Three Challenges” and replace it with the title “Challenges in carrying the message to underserved populations” and include broader sharing with culturally sensitive language.
- » Remove the current sharing on sponsorship from the section “Spanish-Speaking Women in A.A. Remote Communities” and include sharing that positively highlights the importance of sponsorship.
- » Also include in the section “Spanish-Speaking Women in A.A. Remote Communities” information on special-interest meetings/groups, like what is shared in the Conference-approved pamphlets “Hispanic Women in A.A.” and “Women in A.A.”
- » Expand the section and title on online group/meeting resources to include a broader cross-section of digital sharing and resources.

The committee asked that the staff secretary revise

the service piece and looks forward to it being made available to Remote Committees once the updates have been made.

- The committee discussed the contents and format of Treatment Kit and Workbook. The committee noted with appreciation that the suggestions provided in the 2021 Committee Consideration will be implemented at the next Kit update.
- The committee discussed the contents of the Accessibilities Kit and Workbook and suggested that the section “Sharing Experience” in the workbook include experience on A.A. members with service animals.
- The committee discussed the content and format of the Kit and Workbooks. The committee encourages GSO to continue to explore and develop digital approaches to publishing and updating A.A. resources so that changes can be updated more quickly and efficiently with the most up-to-date resources for local committees. The committee also noted the importance that print versions also be made available to those who prefer to receive printed materials.
- The committee considered a request to remove the sentence “Nobody has ever died of lack of sleep” in the section “Getting plenty of rest” in the booklet *Living Sober* and took no action. The committee noted that the section includes this comment later in the chapter: “If the condition persists, it may be advisable to check with a good physician who understands alcoholism well.”

Note: As a result of the 2021-22 Equitable Distribution of Workload plan, this item was on the agenda of the Conference Committee on Treatment and Accessibilities.

TRUSTEES

Committee Considerations:

- The committee reviewed the résumés, and approved as eligible for election all Class B trustee candidates for the Eastern Canada and Pacific regions.
- The committee considered a request to revisit highlighting service roles at the group level in the pamphlet “The A.A. Group” and took no action. The committee appreciated the discussion about the role and attitude of humility of trusted servants. They acknowledged that the phrases “holding office” and “officer” are used in several sections of the pamphlet, and have equivalent meaning to being a trusted servant. It was also noted that groups are free to adapt the inventory questions to suit their needs.

Note: As a result of the 2021-22 Equitable Distribution of Workload plan, this item was on the agenda of the Conference Committee on Trustees.

- The committee reviewed the pamphlet “Do You Think You’re Different?” and requested that the trustees’ Literature Committee begin to look at the accuracy and effectiveness of direct translation practices, result-

ing in an ineffective vehicle to presenting an authentic and culturally relevant message to linguistic communities.

- The committee also requested that AA Grapevine consider using “Do You Think You’re Different?” as a recurring theme. This would allow for the presentation of a diverse group of current voices finding a common identification.
- The report of the trustees’ Nominating Committee noted they had begun discussion of thread-based forums and that more discussion is needed. The Conference committee had a discussion on thread-based forums which could allow better communication throughout the Conference structure and is forwarding a summary of their suggestions to the trustees’ Nominating Committee.

Recommendations Not Resulting in Conference Advisory Actions

These recommendations were presented but did not achieve a majority.

LITERATURE

- The draft pamphlet “The Twelve Steps Illustrated” be approved with minor editorial revisions.
- A second volume of the book *Experience, Strength and Hope* be developed with stories dropped from the Fourth Edition of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, and that a progress report be brought to the Conference Committee on Literature once development of the publication is in progress.

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

- The paragraph in the story “Freedom from Bondage” which was removed due to pagination issues from the fourth edition of the book *Alcoholics Anonymous* be restored in all future printings and publications in which the story is included.

Note: As a result of the 2021-22 Equitable Distribution of Workload plan, this item was on the agenda of the Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions.

Recommendations Passed by Simple Majority

There were no recommendations passed on a simple majority vote that did not receive the two-thirds vote necessary to become a Conference Advisory Action.

Floor Actions Not Resulting in Conference Advisory Actions

- With the translation of the book *Alcoholics Anonymous* (Fourth Edition) into plain and simple language, that the Twelve Steps, the Twelve Traditions, and the Twelve Concepts, not be translated into plain language in any way: that these remain in the existing form in English as in previous editions of the book *Alcoholics Anonymous*. (*Conference declined to consider.*)

- The General Service Conference impose a one-year moratorium on any new agenda item received through September 15, 2022, with new agenda items held to be placed on the agenda for the 74th General Service Conference, allowing the General Service Board and its corporate affiliates time to adjust and align their processes to accommodate the 2022 Policy and Admissions recommendation to provide simultaneous translation of all background material. (*Conference declined to consider.*)
- The trustees’ Ad Hoc Committee on Participation of Online Groups develop a plan to create one or more non-geographic Areas for online and telephone groups in the U.S./Canada General Service Conference structure, with a progress report on the plan to be presented to the 73rd General Service Conference Committee on Policy and Admissions.
- That the following GSR Preamble be added to the pamphlet “Your Group’s Link to A.A. as a Whole”:

The GSR Preamble

We are the General Service Representatives. We are the link in the chain of communication for our groups with the General Service Conference and the world of A.A.

We realize the ultimate authority is a loving God as he may express Himself in our Group Conscience. As trusted servants, our job is to bring information to our groups in order that they can reach an informed group conscience. In passing along this group conscience, we are helping to maintain the unity and strength so vital to our fellowship.

Let us, therefore, have the patience and tolerance to listen while others share, the courage to speak up when we have something to share, and the wisdom to do what is right for our group and A.A. as a whole.

(*Conference declined to consider.*)

- The trustees’ Committee on the General Service Conference evaluate the current process of developing Conference background material and bring back to the 2023 General Service Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions a plan that describes the process of developing background material, keeping in mind the Conference desire for background material to be targeted, balanced and with relevant historical content.
- The Advisory Actions from Panel 71:
 - Advisory Action 18 for changes to page 117 phrase “opposite sex” with the word “partner”
 - Advisory Action 19 changes to page 66, “No one wants to be angry enough to murder, lustful enough to rape, gluttonous enough to ruin his health. No one wants to commit the deadly sins of anger, lust or gluttony” in the book *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, be returned to the original text. (*Conference declined to consider.*)
- The 1995 Conference Advisory Action be reaffirmed that the first 164 pages of the Big Book, the Forewords, “The Doctor’s Opinion,” “Doctor Bob’s Nightmare” and the Appendices remain as is.

■ Committee Considerations

An Advisory Action of the 1990 General Service Conference states: “Items discussed, but no action taken or recommendation made, as well as committee recommendations which are not adopted, be included in a separate section of the Final Report.” Listed by committee, such items are included here “in their entirety” per Advisory Action of the 2019 General Service Conference.



AGENDA

Committee Considerations:

- The committee discussed the composition of the Conference Inventory Planning Committee and suggested that the composition be similar to the makeup of the General Service Conference: delegates, trustees, nontrustee directors, and staff members from the General Service Office and AA Grapevine.
- The committee discussed the current use of virtual meeting technologies and electronic surveys and noted that the GSB Quarterly report could help communicate updates about the development of a Conference Inventory Plan. The committee suggested that the trustees' General Service Conference Committee consider the use of modern communication technologies that could advance the development of the Conference Inventory plan.
- The committee reviewed the questions and framework of the 2013-2015 Conference Inventory Plan noting that it received extensive time and preparation. The committee also noted that the 2013-2015 Conference Inventory did not produce a report on procedural flaws. The committee requested that the trustees' General Service Conference Committee consider the same framework in the development of a 2025 Conference Inventory plan.
- The committee discussed the role of non-voting A.A. consultants on trustees' committees, noting that they could be invited to participate on trustees' commit-

tees on a voluntary non-compensatory basis, when expertise is needed. The committee requested that the trustees' General Service Conference Committee consider the use of a consultant with relevant experience in planning the 2025 Conference Inventory.

- The committee reviewed the 2023 General Service Conference (GSC) evaluations and noted improvements implemented at the 73rd GSC.
- The committee reviewed the 2023 progress report on Conference Improvements from the trustees' General Service Conference Committee. The committee appreciated the suggestions for improvement provided and suggested the exploration of available translation technology to support participation at the Conference in English, French and Spanish.
- The committee reviewed the positive feedback from delegate committee chairs on their quarterly communications with their corresponding trustees' committee chairpersons. The committee encouraged continuation of this practice to support communication within the Conference process.

ARCHIVES

Committee Considerations:

- The committee reviewed the newly revised Archives Workbook and noted the updates that were suggested by previous Conference Committees on Archives and other updates implemented by GSO Archives staff. The committee discussed the section “Sharing on

Digital Archives” in the Archives Workbook that includes shared experiences from local Archives committees on maintaining digital collections. The committee noted that the section was last updated over eight years ago and contains outdated information. The committee suggested that the section “Sharing on Digital Archives” be refreshed with new stories from local archivists.

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

Committee Considerations:

- The committee considered a request to retire the pamphlet “A Member’s Eye View” and took no action. The committee agreed that some members consider the pamphlet a useful tool for carrying the A.A. message. However, the committee expressed support for removing the pamphlet from Cooperation with the Professional Community materials as it may appear outdated and less effective for providing information about A.A. to the professional community.
- The committee reviewed the progress report on the LinkedIn page and received a verbal update from the Communication Services Department. The committee noted the improvement in the consistent cadence of posting and expressed their appreciation for the strategic planning and thoughtfulness which goes into posting to the LinkedIn page. The committee commended the sustained activity and strategy, mindful of A.A. Tradition, to ensure consistency and the best possible results with a continued focus on content for the professional community. The committee looks forward to receiving a progress report submitted to the 2024 Conference Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community.
- The committee reviewed a progress report on the development of an outward-facing pamphlet for mental health professionals and expressed their appreciation for the work completed to date. The committee supports the continued efforts to interview additional mental health professionals with a focus on professionals who are not A.A. members. The committee suggested a theme and direction to move forward, and that interviews seek to identify the myths and misconceptions that could prevent a clear understanding of Alcoholics Anonymous. Additionally, the committee suggested the trustees’ CPC/TA Committee consider other vehicles of communication beyond a pamphlet to make the message more relevant for current mental health professionals. The committee requested that a progress report be brought back to the 2024 Conference Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community.
- The committee reviewed the content and format of the CPC Kit and Workbook and noted the updates that were suggested by the 2022 Conference Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community. The committee provided several minor suggestions for updates to be included in the next printing.

CORRECTIONS

Committee Considerations:

- The committee suggested that the assignment of new delegates to the Conference Committee on Corrections be balanced to allow for a more even rotation of panels.
- The committee suggested that AA Grapevine consider including shared experience on sponsoring persons in custody in the July prison issue and future issues.
- The committee agreed to forward to the trustees’ Committee on Literature a suggestion to consider inclusion of language related to sponsorship of persons in custody in the pamphlet “Questions & Answers on Sponsorship.”
- The committee reviewed the Corrections Kit and Workbook. The committee noted that extensive changes were made to the workbook over the last two years. The committee provided a brief list of suggested changes to be considered at the next reprint.
- The committee acknowledged the work completed by the Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. Service Material ad hoc committee and expressed support for the recommendations put forth by the committee.

Note: As a result of the 2022-2023 Equitable Distribution of Workload plan, the following item was on the agenda of the Conference Committee on Corrections.

- The committee discussed the 2021 and 2022 versions of the service piece “Safety and A.A.: Our Common Welfare” and concluded that the service piece is a necessary and useful tool for A.A. groups. The committee suggested revisions to be considered for inclusion in the next printing of the service piece.

FINANCE

Committee Considerations:

- The committee reviewed the Conference-approved level of \$10,000 for individual Bequests to the General Service Board from A.A. members and took no action. The committee feels the level was doubled in 2019 and is still appropriate as is. The committee also felt that the current limit captures the spiritual elements embodied in our principles, reminding members that modest personal contributions align with the concept of personal anonymity.
- The committee reviewed the Conference-approved maximum annual contribution of \$5,000 to the General Service Board from an individual A.A. member and took no action. The committee felt that the current limit was satisfactory and captures the spiritual elements embodied in our principles reminding members that modest personal contributions align with the concept of personal anonymity.
- The committee reviewed the Self-Support Packet and approved the changes requested by the 2022

Conference Committee on Finance. The committee also noted that the pamphlet “Self-Support: Where Money and Spirituality Mix” will be updated to clarify that the General Service Board is the entity which receives all voluntary A.A. contributions and that the General Service Office performs contribution processing.

- The committee discussed the change of the Grapevine Subscription Liability in the Reserve Fund. The committee requests that the Finance Department clearly identify in all reporting to the Fellowship the portion of the Reserve Fund that is represented by the Grapevine Subscription Liability along with an explanation of the breakdown.
- The committee requests that to better align with the duties described in the Service Manual for the Conference Finance Committee, committee members receive the monthly AAWS/GSB consolidated financial statements along with an executive summary from the Chief Financial Officer.

(Note: As a result of the 2022-2023 Equitable Distribution of Workload plan, the following item was on the agenda of the Conference Committee on Finance.)

- The committee considered a request to discuss proposed agenda items related to changes to the book *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*. The committee suggested that the Trustees’ Literature Committee seek input from the Fellowship (including but not limited to Area delegate feedback) regarding any possible future changes to literature written by A.A.’s founders. The committee requested that a progress report be brought back to the 2024 Conference Committee on Finance. (Mindful of budgetary restraints, the committee suggests financial prudence when determining how best to obtain Fellowship sharing.)

Questions to be considered might include:

- Should suggested revisions be subjected to a 2-year Conference review process.
- Should any future suggested changes retain the original writing with footnotes for text being updated or should founder’s writings remain unchanged?
- Should there be a threshold for review (group, district, area)?
- Should the changes to the book *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* by 2021 General Service Conference remain?
- Should a new policy regarding Bill W.’s writing be created as a guide to future changes?

GRAPEVINE AND LA VIÑA

Committee Considerations:

- The committee reviewed the AA Grapevine Workbook and provided some editorial suggestions and ways to access the workbook more easily.
- The committee reviewed the progress report on the

Grapevine and La Viña Instagram accounts and provided some suggestions.

- The committee agreed to forward to the AA Grapevine Board the suggestion that AA Grapevine, Inc. produce in the year 2024 or later:
 1. *Grapevine Cartoons & Jokes III* (working title) (GV book)
 2. Original members’ cartoons, jokes, and humor of the past few years, previously published in Grapevine.
 3. *Emotional Sobriety III* (working title) (GV book) Members share how they have changed after years of being in the A.A. program and how they have found peace and serenity in sobriety. Stories previously published in Grapevine.
 4. *Veteranos Hispanos en AA* (Voices of Oldtimers) (working title) (La Viña book) Members who have been in A.A. a long time share their experience, strength, and hope. Stories previously published in La Viña.
 5. *Cómo llegamos a creer* (How We Came to Believe) (working title) (La Viña book) A.A. members share stories about their own personal journey with Step Two, how they found their Higher Power and what helped them. Stories previously published in La Viña.
 6. *Spiritual Awakenings* (La Viña book) (GV book translated into Spanish) A.A. members share stories about their journey with Step Two and connecting with a Higher Power.

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/ REGIONAL FORUMS

Committee Considerations:

- The committee discussed the update report on methods of closing the Big Meetings at the International Convention, which summarized the survey data indicating that there was not an overwhelming desire by the Fellowship to change the current practice. The consensus of the committee was to keep with the current practice of closing the Big Meetings at the International Convention wherein the chair has the choice of closing the meeting with either the Lord’s Prayer, the Serenity Prayer, or the Responsibility Statement.
- The committee discussed ways of encouraging interest in Regional and Local Forums and attracting first time attendees and suggested:
 - » That the General Service Board add virtual elements to Regional Forums, or even add a virtual fifth forum to the annual calendar.
 - » Disseminate advance information about events using flyers, posters, announcements in Grapevine and La Viña, podcasts, Instagram messages, invitations in ASL, QR codes, and *Box 4-5-9* articles.

LITERATURE

Committee Considerations:

- The committee reviewed minor graphic and editorial updates that improve the final appearance and clarity of the pamphlet “Young People in A.A.” which was approved by the 2022 General Service Conference.
- The committee reviewed a draft of the Literature Committee workbook. The committee made minor editorial suggestions and looks forward to the new Literature Committee workbook being made available.
- The committee reviewed a draft pamphlet based on A.A.’s Three Legacies and requested that the material gathered for the draft pamphlet be made available to the Fellowship as service material, not a pamphlet. The committee suggested that the service material be included in the General Service Representative (GSR) and District Committee Member (DCM) service kits.
- The committee reviewed a progress report regarding the translation of the book *Alcoholics Anonymous* (Fourth Edition) into plain and simple language and agreed with the general direction of the project. The committee requested that the project continue to move forward and that a draft or progress report be brought back to the 2024 Conference Committee on Literature.
- The committee reviewed a progress report on the update of the pamphlet “A.A. for the Black and African-American Alcoholic” (working title). The committee noted the progress made on the development of the pamphlet and requested that a draft or a progress report be brought back to the Trustees’ Literature Committee and the 2024 Conference Committee on Literature.

The committee noted with appreciation the efforts made by the trustees’ Literature committee to ensure that the members of the working group that participated on the pamphlet “A.A. for the Black and African-American Alcoholic” represented the community reflected in the pamphlet. The committee suggested that the 2018 report “Reaching Out to African-American Alcoholics” be provided as a possible resource for future projects involving carrying the message to other communities.

- The committee reviewed a progress report regarding development of a Fourth Edition of the book *Alcohólicos Anónimos* (Spanish). The committee requested that a progress report or draft manuscript be brought back to the 2024 Conference Committee on Literature.
- The committee reviewed a progress report regarding the update of the pamphlet “A.A. for the Native North American.” The committee discussed efforts to distribute the call for stories to the widest possible native North American population in the U.S. and Canada. The committee requested that a draft or progress report be brought back to the 2024 Conference Committee on Literature.

The committee noted with appreciation the efforts made by the trustees’ Literature committee to ensure

that the members of the working group that participated on the pamphlet “A.A. for the Native North American” represented the community reflected in the pamphlet.

- The committee reviewed a progress report regarding development of a Fifth Edition of the book *Alcoholics Anonymous*. The committee requested that a progress report or draft manuscript be brought back to the 2024 Conference Committee on Literature.
- The committee discussed new proposed agenda items (PAI’s) related to the plain language Big Book translation and took no action. The committee acknowledged the concerns of members, groups and areas in the Fellowship regarding the oversight of the process of a translation of the book *Alcoholics Anonymous* (Fourth edition) into plain and simple language. The committee noted that these concerns will be addressed at a special session during the 2023 General Service Conference.
- The committee discussed an update on the adaptation of the video animation of the pamphlet “The Twelve Concepts Illustrated” published by the General Service Board of A.A. Great Britain. The committee acknowledged that the project of adapting the video for use in the U.S./Canada structure is pending for budgetary reasons. The committee looks forward to a report on the status of this project being brought to the 2024 Conference Committee on Literature.
- The committee discussed a proposal for Big Book or *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* study guides and took no action. The committee suggested that currently approved projects be completed before considering new materials.
- The committee reviewed the 2023 matrix of A.A. recovery literature. The committee agreed to continue providing suggestions regarding the usefulness and purpose of the A.A. recovery literature. The committee looks forward to reviewing the matrix at their meeting during the 2024 General Service Conference.
- The committee reviewed a draft of the revised pamphlet “The Twelve Steps Illustrated” and chose not to proceed with the graphic approach. The committee requested that the Publishing Department develop a new draft and that a progress report or a draft be brought to the 2024 Conference Committee on Literature.

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

Committee Considerations:

- The committee reviewed the dates for the 2027 General Service Conference. In order to provide additional flexibility to the General Service Office management in contracting the most cost-effective and appropriate venues for the General Service Conference, the committee agreed to select three proposed dates for the 77th General Service Conference, as follows (in order of preference): May 2-8, 2027; April 11-17, 2027; May 23-29, 2027. The committee noted that

these proposed Conference dates are the best choices available for avoiding conflicts with significant holidays. The committee asked that all Conference members be notified of the final dates for the 77th General Service Conference as soon as they are finalized by GSO management.

- The committee reviewed the GSO general manager's report regarding General Service Conference site selection. The committee appreciated the detailed analysis of the costs and logistics of holding the Conference at sample facilities in four of the eight regions. The committee is not requesting a site selection report from the General Manager in 2024, recognizing that contracts have been executed with hotels in the New York area for 2024, 2025, and 2026, and that site selection for the 2027 General Service Conference could be impacted by the results of the Location Plus Committee and possible relocation of the General Service Office. The committee is requesting that the trustees' General Service Conference Committee conduct a survey of current General Service Conference members regarding the spiritual implications of holding the Conference outside the New York area. An additional option to explore in the survey could be alternating between holding the Conference in the New York area and the Akron/Cleveland area. The committee looks forward to reviewing the survey results or a progress report at the 74th General Service Conference.
- The committee reviewed the "Report of the GSB Ad Hoc Committee on Participation of Online Groups in the U.S./Canada Service Structure" and expressed appreciation for the report, particularly the results of the survey to delegates. The committee agreed that an important next step would be for delegates to find out more about the online groups in their areas and requested that the ad hoc committee provide them with sample questions they may use in that inquiry. The committee looks forward to the next iteration of the ad hoc committee and the continued exploration of the possibilities for the participation of online groups in the U.S./Canada general service structure.
- The committee reviewed the progress report from the 2023 Subcommittee on the Equitable Distribution of Workload (EDW) regarding year two of the three-year pilot. The committee appreciated the improvements made to the joint meetings and the simplification of forms and processes. The committee requested that the trustees' General Service Conference Committee (TGSCC) explore all possibilities for extending the deadline for submitting Proposed Agenda Items (PAIs) to allow areas more time to consider items at their Fall assemblies. The committee also requested that TGSCC conduct a survey of delegates to find out the effect EDW has had upon their areas, especially related to the submission deadline and the engagement of members and groups in the group conscience process. Finally, the committee requested that TGSCC consider creating a simple video or other communication that would rein-

force the idea that PAIs can be submitted year-round, as well as help the Fellowship better understand the role of PAIs as a document to reflect the outcome of a group conscience rather than a petition or suggestion box.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

Committee Considerations:

- The committee discussed a request for Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. to establish an Instagram account in line with the Twelve Traditions and encouraged Communication Services to continue with planning for the account. The committee suggested that Communication Services provide additional information on the intended messaging, target audiences, analytics, and total cost to maintain the account. The committee requested that a new proposed plan be brought back to the 2024 Conference Committee on Public Information.

The committee offered the following suggestions for the next iteration of the proposed plan:

- » Posting *Daily Reflections*, "What's New" from GSO, and press releases, are duplicative to what we share on our A.A. website and Meeting Guide app news. The committee requested a detailed strategy on the target audiences for internal versus external messaging to be communicated within a potential future Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. Instagram account.
- » Including more information in the proposed plan, specifying how distinct messaging and target audience of a potential Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. Instagram account differs from the existing AA Grapevine and La Viña Instagram accounts.
- » Providing information on the total expense including the staff expense for managing the account.
- » Including a section defining the key performance indicators that will indicate the channel is successful in carrying the message to members and potential members.
- » Capturing the need for a social media management platform, like Hootsuite, in the proposed plan.
- » Performing ongoing evaluations of our communications channels to meet members and alcoholics on the platforms they utilize.
- » Developing a policy with defined criteria that would allow AAWS to explore and implement new external platforms as technology changes.
- The committee discussed feasibility research of paid placement of PSA videos on streaming platforms. The committee noted that paid placement is an important new addition for airing and tracking our already produced, relevant and useful PSAs on streaming platforms. The committee requested that the trustees' Public Information Committee consider several vendors and develop a plan detailing target audiences,

analytics, and cost for how we would begin to use such streaming platform channels in the U.S./Canada Service Structure and that a report be brought back to the 2024 Conference Committee on Public Information.

- The committee reviewed the report on the 2022 A.A. Membership Survey process and offered the following suggestions for improvement for future surveys.
 - » Provide the survey method process, including the timeframes and actions that delegates will need to perform, to the Conference Committee on Public Information each year that a triennial membership survey is requested to be considered.
 - » Encourage all the delegates who participated in this 2022 A.A. Membership Survey to complete the process evaluation to inform process improvements as needed.
 - » Design a pilot study to complete two surveys using convenience sampling, which focuses on gaining information from participants (the sample) who are “convenient” to access. These samples could be collected using the A.A. website, and the A.A. Meeting Guide App, and the same questions as the 2022 A.A. Membership Survey.

The goal is to examine any potential differences in data patterns across the three different collection methodologies, the traditional A.A. survey process and the two channels listed above. Ideally, collection of this type of data would follow the collection of the traditional A.A. membership survey data within 1-2 years from 2022, so that no portion becomes dated. The committee requested that the trustees’ Public Information Committee design a pilot study and that it be brought back to the 2024 Conference Committee on Public Information.

- The committee reviewed the report titled, “The 2022 A.A. Membership Survey Results Reporting” and agreed with the development of a dynamic A.A. web page to disseminate the complete results of the 2022 A.A. Membership Survey. The committee appreciates that each infographic developed to reflect the survey results is designed to be a part of a library of results and will be made available for use by A.A. members, the professional community, and the media. The committee liked the concept that local A.A. members and service committees will be able to share direct experience with GSO regarding how they are using these tools, via the A.A. web page “how are you using this information?”
- The committee reviewed the progress report on the 2022 Young People’s Video project. The committee expressed support for the vision and architecture of the ongoing project to obtain user generated content. The committee reviewed two submitted videos and is requesting that the trustees’ Public Information Committee review the project’s process, A.A. website webpages, project flyers and the technical requirements to ensure that we are communicating appropriate information to obtain the desired user generated

content. The committee offered the following suggestions to consider and requested a progress report to be brought back to the 2024 Conference Committee on Public Information.

- » Expand the submission timeframe to include fifteen second minimum up to three minute maximum for videos submitted by members.
 - » Clarify that we are seeking user generated content video submissions from young members creatively carrying a message to other young people. Focus is requested to be on the experience of getting sober young and to reflect the diversity of the Fellowship. The committee is seeking shared experiences that will relate to the “young” alcoholic who has yet to come to A.A.
 - » Review of the two submissions to determine if we can make additional edits to tighten the message in the framework of what it was like, what happened and what it is like now focusing on the key messages that have an impact and identification.
 - » Provide communication to all delegates with the goal of producing excitement and engagement for the Young People’s Video project for the members in their local areas.
- The committee reviewed and accepted the 2023 Public Information Comprehensive Media Plan (CMP). The committee expressed continued support for the vision and architecture of this version of the CMP. The com-



mittee shared that the plan provides a great framework and guardrails that capture the public information work, messaging and channels GSO and AA Grapevine are using to make the Fellowship, general public, media, and professionals aware of the relevance of Alcoholics Anonymous.

The committee offered the following suggestions for the next iteration of the CMP to be brought back to the 2024 Conference Committee on Public Information.

» Consider the creation of a section on how projects requesting user generated content, such as the Young People's Video Project, fit into our Comprehensive Media Plan and messaging for Alcoholics Anonymous.

- The committee reviewed the progress report on the request to create a new form of communication to address anonymity on social media. The committee requested that the trustees' Public Information Committee and staff secretary focus on developing and administering a survey, to all age demographics, particularly a young population with the goal of obtaining results that will inform decisions on any future new form of communication. The committee looks forward to a progress report to be brought to the 2024 Conference Committee on Public Information.
- The committee reviewed and accepted a progress report on revision to the flyer "A.A. at a Glance" and looks forward to a progress report or draft flyer to be brought to the 2024 Conference Committee on Public Information.
- The committee reviewed and accepted a progress report on revision to the pamphlet "Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings" and looks forward to a progress report or draft pamphlet to be brought to the 2024 Conference Committee on Public Information.
- The committee reviewed and accepted a progress report on revision to the flyer "A Message to Teenagers." The committee provided support for the fact that there is a need for a flyer or format that can be handed off to professionals or young people in hard copy and would like it to include a QR code, if possible. The committee looks forward to a progress report or draft work to be brought back to the 2024 Conference Committee on Public Information.
- The committee reviewed and accepted the final distribution and tracking information for the video PSAs:
 1. Sobriety in A.A.: My Drinking Built a Wall
 2. Sobriety in A.A.: When Drinking is no longer a Party.The final one-year campaign results for the U.S. were 125,192 airings, 615,956,841 impressions and \$34,506,580 in media value. The final Canadian results for the campaign were 11,485 airings.

The committee noted these results are an excellent return for the self-support contributions spent to produce these two PSAs. The committee requested a "call to action" be provided to all delegates with the goal

of producing excitement and engagement for how the local public information service committees can increase the airings and ongoing usage of our relevant PSAs.

- The committee reviewed and accepted the 2024 report on the "Relevance and Usefulness of Video Public Service Announcements." Discussion included that PSAs are conversation starters about A.A. or how to get help for a problem with alcohol for people who view them. The committee found the current Conference-approved PSAs to be relevant and useful. The committee is excited to learn we are finalizing a one-year contract with a no cost channel called Mesmerize Point, to distribute PSAs on digital TV screens in doctor offices, private pharmacies, and community-based organizations with our relevant messaging made available to viewers. The committee looks forward to a Mesmerize Point progress report being brought back to the 2024 Conference Committee on Public Information. The committee did not see the need at this time for a new video PSA.
- The committee reviewed and accepted a progress report for the GSO podcast development. The committee noted the planning, development, and production of episodes on many service-related discussion topics. The committee reiterated that the planned topic focus will help avoid competing with the Grapevine Podcast. The committee appreciated that the plan is to produce up to eight episodes to introduce a recognizable, consistent, and enthusiastic voice for the GSO podcast. The committee agreed, before the launch, it is important to "bank" these initial episodes for the initial rollout to ensure a regular cadence. The committee noted it would be good to use relevant archival recordings in the podcast, as applicable to an episode. The committee looks forward to a progress report to be brought to the 2024 Conference Committee on Public Information.

The committee reviewed and accepted the trustees' PI Committee report on the usefulness and effectiveness of the AAWS YouTube account. The committee offered the following suggestions and looks forward to a report to be brought to the 2024 Conference Committee on Public Information.

 - » The committee noted that stagnant growth of the channel and requested the trustees' PI Committee to consider ways to encourage members to use the channel as a public information tool.
 - » The committee requested consideration of the use of hashtags for the channel.
- The committee reviewed and accepted the Communications Services report on the AAWS Meeting Guide. The committee looks forward to a report to be brought to the 2024 Conference Committee on Public Information. The committee suggested that the Meeting Guide keep its focus on providing information on locating A.A. meetings.

- The committee reviewed and accepted the 2022 annual reports from the trustees' Public Information Committee regarding aa.org. The committee finds the website is easy to navigate and user-friendly. The committee suggested that GSO continue to improve its website search functionality.
- The committee reviewed and accepted the 2022 trustees' Public Information Committee report on Online Business Profiles. The committee suggested care be taken to ensure the GSO response messages avoid sounding canned. The committee looks forward to a report to be brought to the 2024 Conference.
- The committee reviewed and accepted the 2022 annual report "AAGV/La Viña Website, Marketing and Podcast" regarding aagrapevine.org. The committee noted that the current host style and delivery could limit attraction to the podcast by all members, potential members, or professionals and to consider the fully intended audience regarding diversity, attraction, and belonging.
- The committee discussed the content and format of the PI Kit and Workbook. The committee noted the contents of the kit are useful to local Public Information Committees. The committee provided the staff secretary with suggested updates to the PI Workbook.

REPORT AND CHARTER

Committee Considerations:

- The committee noted that some sections of *The A.A. Service Manual* need more detailed review of language clarity by the General Service Board and affiliate boards before being revised. The committee asked that the Publishing Department "short order" supply of the current *A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts for World Service, 2021-2023 Edition* to ensure sufficient inventory until a proposed 2024 printing.
- The committee accepted a report from the Publishing Department outlining the General Service Office process for timely and accurate preparation and publication of the proposed *A.A. Service Manual, 2023-2025 Edition* and the 2023 General Service Conference *Final Report*.
- The committee reviewed a list of editorial updates from the Publishing Department for *The A.A. Service Manual* and accepted the updates.

In keeping with the 2018 Advisory Action that the General Service Board, the AAWS Board and the AA Grapevine Board biennially review *The A.A. Service Manual* and forward necessary updates to the Conference Committee on Report and Charter, the committee reviewed the current updates from the AAWS Board and the AA Grapevine Board. The committee noted the importance that the Conference Committee on Report and Charter receive any proposed edits in a timely window prior to Conference to give thoughtful review of any proposed edits.

The committee provided suggestions regarding *The A.A. Service Manual* to be forwarded to the three boards, GSO, and the Grapevine Office.

- The committee considered a request for specific changes to the 2021-2023 version of *The A.A. Service Manual* and suggested that the requests be considered in the 2024 review of the updated manual.
- The committee considered a request to rescind the 2018 Advisory Action regarding a footnote in the Resolution concerning "register" and "Groups" and took no action. The committee noted that the footnote sufficiently clarifies the current terminology for groups that list with the U.S./Canada service structure.

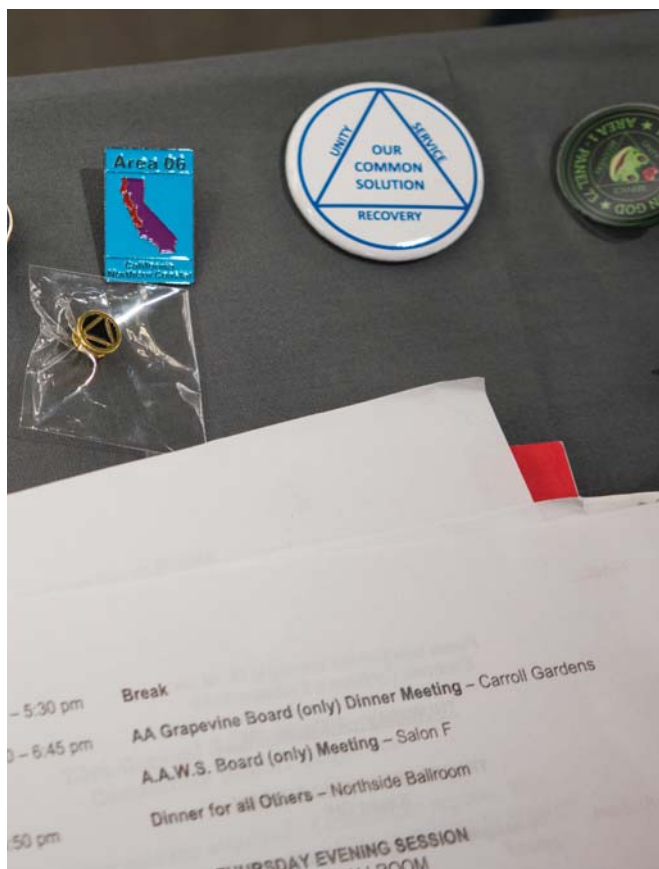
However, the committee suggested the following:

- » Add the following text from footnote 4 in The Resolution: "AAWS neither monitors nor oversees the activities or practices of any A.A. group. Groups are listed solely for purposes of accurate communications" to the A.A. Group chapter of *The A.A. Service Manual*.
- » That GSO provide clear and consistent language disclaimers on GSO digital platforms and informational materials to clarify that the purpose of listing groups at GSO is distinct from listing meetings on the Meeting Guide App.
- The committee discussed the 2021 Advisory Action that a new section be added at the end of the *Twelve Concepts for World Service* titled "Amendments," and that it contain an updated version of the Concept XI essay that incorporates the information in the current footnotes and endnotes, along with comprehensive descriptions of the current General Service Board committees. The committee reviewed draft language provided by the Publishing Department and provided suggestions to the staff secretary. The committee requested that the trustees' Literature Committee provide an updated draft or progress report to the 2024 Conference Committee on Report and Charter.
- The committee reviewed a GSO Publishing feasibility report for an ASL translation of *The A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts for World Service*. The committee noted the importance that A.A. materials be translated in the order of the most widely expressed needs of the Fellowship.
- The committee asked that the staff secretary forward notes from the committee to the trustees' Cooperation with the Professional Community/Treatment and Accessibilities Committee to continue discussion on this important topic, to gain insight from members of which ASL materials are most in need for members and potential members.

TREATMENT AND ACCESSIBILITIES

Committee Considerations:

- The committee discussed the suggestion that an Accessibility Inventory be conducted throughout A.A.'s



services and structure and suggested that the trustees' CPC/TA Committee take an inventory of what resources are currently available from the General Service Office and the AA Grapevine to meet accessibility-related challenges and consider the best methods for communicating about those resources to the Fellowship.

- The committee discussed carrying the message to alcoholics with intellectual or information processing challenges, communication challenges and diverse neurological abilities, and suggested that:
 - » The trustees' CPC/TA Committee review accessibility-related service material and consider updating it with new shared experience on this topic.
 - » The AA Grapevine consider publishing an issue dedicated to the experiences of people with intellectual or information processing challenges, communication challenges and diverse neurological abilities and those who sponsor them.
 - » The trustees' Literature Committee consider revising the pamphlet "Questions and Answers on Sponsorship" to add language on working with alcoholics with intellectual or information processing challenges, communication challenges and diverse neurological abilities.
- The committee discussed the progress report on a proposed Bridging the Gap workbook. The committee noted that information on Bridging the Gap and other contact programs already exists in the Treatment and Corrections Workbooks and suggested instead that

sharing be collected from the Fellowship and combined with existing resources to develop A.A. Guidelines on Bridging the Gap.

- The committee reviewed the progress report on the pamphlet "Bridging the Gap" (P-49). The committee appreciated the work that has been completed on the updated draft pamphlet for A.A. members and suggested additional revisions. The committee also agreed that the distinction between Treatment and Corrections activities be maintained in literature from GSO and requested that references to Corrections and to the video "A New Freedom" be removed from the draft. The committee requested that a progress report or revised draft be brought to the 2024 Conference Committee on Treatment and Accessibilities.
- The committee reviewed the progress report on updates to the pamphlet "Bridging the Gap" and suggested that the trustees' CPC/TA Committee convert the newly developed draft pamphlet "For Professionals How A.A. Bridges the Gap" into a single sheet service piece or a service card.
- The committee reviewed the progress report on Military Audio interviews and requested that the Military Audio project be expanded to include veterans. The committee also suggested that the Military Audio project continue to seek interviews with francophone members. The committee requested that sample audio and an update report be provided to the 2024 Conference Committee on Treatment and Accessibilities.
- The committee reviewed the draft A.A. Guidelines for Remote Communities and asked the staff secretary to revise the service piece. The committee looks forward to the guidelines being made available once the updates have been made.
- The committee reviewed the Treatment Committee Kit and Workbook. The committee noted that some changes suggested for the Treatment Committee Kit and Workbook in recent years have not yet been implemented. The committee suggested that the staff secretary work with the Publishing Department to update these materials.
- The committee reviewed the Accessibilities Kit and Workbook and strongly suggested that the material be updated to reflect the fact that some members and potential members experience various forms of discrimination including racism which creates a barrier or accessibility challenge. The committee also noted that some of the already suggested changes to the kit and workbook had not been implemented and suggested that the staff secretary work with the Publishing Department to update the materials.

TRUSTEES

Committee Considerations:

- The committee reviewed an update report regarding the pamphlet "Do You Think You're Different?" The



committee requested that a draft pamphlet or progress report be brought back to the 2024 Conference Committee on Trustees.

Note: As a result of the 2021-22 Equitable Distribution of Workload plan, the above item was on the agenda of the Conference Committee on Trustees.

- The committee reviewed the résumés and approved as eligible for election all Class B trustee candidates for Northeast Regional trustee, Southwest Regional trustee, and trustee-at-large/Canada.
- The committee thoroughly discussed the General Service Board's actions at the January 29, 2023 Board Planning and Sharing session that led to the resignation of the board chair. The committee agreed that the board's failure to fully utilize the spiritual principles of Alcoholics Anonymous to address leadership problems was deeply concerning. The committee also agreed that failure to expedite communication to the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous about the board chair's resignation and lack of transparency regarding the board's decision resulted in widespread mistrust and disunity. After lengthy and prayerful discussion the committee took a vote to censure the General Service Board, failing to achieve substantial unanimity.
- The committee met individually with each current General Service Board trustee to hear their vision for the future of Alcoholics Anonymous, assessment of the current state of the board, and what actions can

be taken to improve communication. The committee agreed the board must improve communication with the Fellowship, including listening to the Fellowship. The committee suggested that the board utilize an externally facilitated process to make organizational improvements.

- The committee requested that the General Service Board find time and space to continue to develop spiritual practices in harmony with the A.A. principles of reflection, accountability, and healing. The committee encourages the board to continue their work on reviewing and clarifying the board's code of conduct, whistleblower policies, and confidentiality policies to provide a clear path to remedy any possible problems within the General Service Board.

Recommendations Passed by Simple Majority

These recommendations passed on a simple majority vote but did not achieve the two-thirds vote to become a Conference Advisory Action.

GRAPEVINE AND LA VIÑA

- The committee recommended that alternate delegates be provided access to the same Conference materials as their sitting delegates, except for materials shared during Conference week.

Recommendations Not Resulting in Conference Action

These recommendations were presented but did not receive the two-thirds vote necessary to become a Conference Advisory Action.

AGENDA

- The reading of Area Highlights from the 73rd General Service Conference be suspended and included in the 2023 Conference *Final Report*, to allow discussion of the following topics:

Are the decisions of the General Service Board producing Unity within the Fellowship and inspiring confidence in the Board's future functions?

The General Service Board Code of Conduct

Is the prudent reserve being used as the Conference intends?

Note: The Conference Committee on Agenda cautioned during the opening session of the General Service Conference to consider this motion from the floor regarding changing the Conference week schedule. ***The motion failed.***

Floor Actions Not Resulting in Conference Advisory Actions

- Starting in 2024, voting for trustee elections may utilize paper or electronic ballots. (***Conference declined to consider***)
- The 2016 Conference Advisory Action stating: "General Service Conference delegates be provided a copy

of the final approved annual General Service Office and AA Grapevine budgets with the Pre-Conference material for all future Conferences” be reconfirmed. **(Conference declined to consider)**

- The 73rd General Service Conference censure the General Service Board due to poor communication to the Fellowship regarding the resignation of the former Chair of the General Service Board and for the process that was followed regarding the acceptance of her resignation. **(Motion failed)**
- To enhance trust among General Service Conference members, the following actions be taken:
 - » The General Service Board prepare a report delineating the history of their Confidentiality Policy and the reason(s) for enacting it, submitting it for review to the Conference Trustees’ Committee at the 2024 General Service Conference.
 - » The General Service Board initiate a review regarding the need for a less restrictive Confidentiality Policy, submitting a draft or progress report to the Conference Trustees’ Committee at the 2024 General Service Conference.
 - » The existing Confidentiality Policy of the General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc., be made null and void. **(Conference declined to consider)**
- The General Service Board create an Ad Hoc Joint committee on Communications throughout our service structure that includes trustees, delegates, and staff members. **(Conference declined to consider)**
- Following the work of the trustees’ ad hoc committee on policy review, Conference members be asked to sign a code of conduct which guides how we work together including but not limited to:
 - » Confidentiality
 - » Communications
 - » Mutual respect
 - » Social media
 - » Transparency

This code should include an acknowledgement that mistakes will be made and should suggest mechanisms for righting any wrongs.

This code should follow in spirit and language the principles outlined in our 12 Steps, 12 Traditions, 12 Concepts and our Conference Charter.

This code should be reviewed annually by the Conference Committee on Policy and Admissions. **(Motion failed)**

- The General Service Board begin to develop supplemental reporting focused on the actual costs of the various service items we provide, with an initial draft being brought back to the Conference Committee on Finance for review at the 74th General Service Conference.
- These reports should include the budgeted costs of these items, any changes to the budgeted amounts,

the long-term trends of the costs, as well as a reasonable projection of future costs for the services, when possible. Expenses to consider shall be regarding initial development, ongoing content creation, maintenance and upkeep, as well as any other substantive ancillary costs. **(Conference declined to consider)**

- Beginning with the 2024 GSC, the delegate chair and alternate delegate chair for the following year’s GSC, will be elected in the Conference session scheduled immediately following completion of all committee reports and completion of the discussion of, and voting on, floor actions (if any). Following the election of the delegate chair and alternate delegate chair for the following year’s GSC, each primary Conference committee will convene and elect their own committee chair and alternate committee chair for the following year’s GSC, according to each Conference Committee’s own Composition, Scope and Procedure, with the newly elected delegate chair and alternate delegate chair ineligible to stand for primary or secondary Conference Committee chair or alternate chair. Following the election of the primary committees’ committee chair and alternate committee chair, each secondary Conference committee will convene and elect their own committee chair and alternate committee chair for the following year’s GSC, according to each committee’s own Composition, Scope and Procedure, with the newly elected delegate chair, alternate delegate chair, and committee chairs ineligible for secondary committee chair or alternate chair. At the Conference session immediately following the election of all Conference Committee chairpersons and alternate chairpersons, the newly elected chairpersons and alternate chairpersons will be announced to the full GSC.

The process for selecting the delegate chair and the alternate delegate chair for the following year’s GSC will be:

1. The first and second-year delegates from a region will nominate one candidate from among the willing first year delegates of their region by ballot, utilizing the Third Legacy procedure. A first-year delegate may decline to be considered as a nominee for election for delegate chair or alternate delegate chair.
2. From the nominees (one per region), two of the nominee names will be selected by lot, i.e., by “going to the hat.”
3. From the two names selected by lot, the delegate chair for the following year’s GSC will be elected by third legacy procedure, with each region casting one ballot per a decision process of that region’s own choosing. The candidate elected/selected by the regions in the Third Legacy procedure will serve as the delegate chair for the following year’s GSC, beginning at the close of the current GSC. The second candidate will serve as the alternate delegate chair for the following year’s GSC, beginning at the close of the current GSC. **(Conference declined to consider)**

■ Committee Considerations

An Advisory Action of the 1990 General Service Conference states: "Items discussed, but no action taken or recommendation made, as well as committee recommendations which are not adopted, be included in a separate section of the Final Report." Listed by committee, such items are included here "in their entirety" per Advisory Action of the 2019 General Service Conference.



AGENDA

Committee Considerations:

- The committee discussed the printing and distribution of a comprehensive summary of the 2025 Conference Inventory and noted that the cost estimates for printing and shipping could change in the next year. The committee suggested that a plan to print and distribute the comprehensive summary of the 2025 General Service Conference Inventory be brought back to the 2026 Conference Committee on Agenda.
- The committee reviewed the 2023 Conference evaluation summary noting the new streamlined format that included a list of proposed improvements with a list of cost savings. The committee noted several improvements were being made at the 74th General Service Conference. The committee looks forward to reviewing the 2024 evaluation summary at the 2025 General Service Conference.
- The committee reviewed the 2023 evaluation questionnaire that includes opportunities for Conference Members to share feedback about the changes implemented to the 2024 Conference Week Schedule, and to weigh in on proposed future changes.
- The committee discussed the improvements to the schedule of the 2024 General Service Conference implemented by the trustees' General Service Conference Committee and appreciated the thoughtful and thorough cost saving measures to the Conference budget.
- The committee also discussed Area Service Highlights presentations during the Conference week. The committee felt that these presentations about service areas could provide Conference Members with an opportunity to learn how local committees carry the A.A. message, foster participation, and overcome challenges. The committee also noted that conducting Conference business can encompass sometimes harsh experiences while Conference Members reach a group conscience on Committee recommendations and felt that Area Service Highlights can provide balance. The committee also noted the priority of completing Conference business in a timely manner and suggested that including Area Service Highlights in the Conference Manual could provide other Conference Members with opportunities to make notes and be informed about other service areas.
- The committee discussed a Saturday evening meet-and-greet gathering of Conference Members and the Sunday night A.A. Banquet that includes a plated dinner. While the committee appreciates the prudent review of the Conference budget, the committee

requested that the trustees' General Service Conference Committee continue with these pre-Conference gatherings. The committee felt that including these pre-Conference events provide Conference Members with unifying, welcoming, and cohesive experiences that help usher in the Conference Week.

- The committee also noted that meal stipends could provide Conference Members with opportunities to spend some quiet time during a busy Conference week schedule. The committee requested the trustees' General Service Conference Committee consider ways to add 2-3 additional meal stipends for Conference Members.
- The committee discussed opportunities to give more time to complete Conference business and felt that reinforcing the mechanics of the Conference agreed to by Conference Members would be useful.
- The committee discussed the value of Workshops during the Conference week and noted that local committees conduct workshops based on these topics and provide opportunities to inform delegates with a broad range of experiences.
- The committee discussed the number of videoconference meetings that occur within service areas, regions, and for Conference Members. The committee felt that some local events share misinformation, or incon-

sistent materials, which is troubling. The committee discussed ways that could help clarify and support accurate information and felt that the three Board chairpersons could explore aligning their efforts to share information within the Fellowship.

ARCHIVES

Committee Considerations:

- The committee discussed the recent update to the Archives video *Markings on the Journey* and accepted the verbal report on the status of the video by Gospelizing Director. The committee requested that the AAWS Board continue to explore all means of delivery and distribution of the video, not to be limited to DVD, Flash Drive, or downloadable digital file on the AAWS Online Bookstore.
- The committee reviewed the newly revised Archives Workbook and made the following suggestions for inclusion in a future printing:
 - » Add appropriate images to enhance the content, where applicable, as determined by the GSO Archives Department.
 - » In the section "What to Collect?" add reference to digital materials in the suggested list of materials local archives might consider collecting.

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

Committee Considerations:

- The committee reviewed a progress report on the development of an outward facing pamphlet for mental health professionals and noted the continued work moving forward toward the production of the pamphlet. The committee requested that a progress report or draft pamphlet be brought back to the 2025 Conference Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community.
- The committee suggested the trustees' Cooperation with the Professional Community/Treatment-Accessibilities Committee (TCPC/TA) consider developing additional service materials as follows:
 - » A "hard copy" service piece for local Cooperation with the Professional Community (CPC) committees to provide to professionals in their face-to-face contact and when exhibiting or presenting at professional events.
 - » That the service piece includes newly designed infographics gleaned from existing content in the draft pamphlet for mental health professionals.
 - » That the service piece also includes a way to link to material for the mental health professional, such as the content of interviews already conducted and content from the draft pamphlet.
 - » That the presentation of materials developed reflects a modern look and feel appealing to professionals.



The committee requested that a progress report on the development of the service piece be brought to the 2025 Conference Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community.

- The committee discussed the impact of the Comprehensive Media Plan (CMP) in carrying the message to the professional community and provided the following suggestions to be forwarded to the trustees' Public Information Committee regarding the CMP:

» That the Conference Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community contribute annual input to the revision of the CMP and collaborate with the Trustees' Public Information Committee for effective use of technology in how we reach professionals using current industry standards and adapting to new and emerging technologies including, but not limited to:

- ▶ QR codes
- ▶ Infographics
- ▶ Templates for CPC outreach to professionals
- ▶ Audio
- ▶ Podcast features
- ▶ And additional media

- The committee considered the request to develop a pamphlet for the unhoused alcoholic in A.A. and took no action. The committee felt that a pamphlet would not be an effective tool to carry the message to the unhoused community. The committee suggested that the trustees' Cooperation with the Professional Community/Treatment-Accessibilities Committee consider exploring methods of how to better serve the unhoused population.
- The committee reviewed the content and format of the Cooperation with the Professional Community (CPC) Kit and Workbook and noted the updates that were suggested by the 2023 Conference Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community. The committee provided suggestions for updates to be included in the next printing of the Workbook; minor formatting updates to the list of the Kit contents, and recently updated CPC service material in the Kit. Minor editorial changes to CPC materials are to be forwarded to Publishing.
- The committee suggested considering CPC pamphlets as topics for podcasts or other formats to aid local committees in their service work.
- The committee reviewed the three existing Cooperation with the Professional Community videos for professionals available on aa.org and requested that the trustees' Cooperation with the Professional Community/Treatment and Accessibilities Committee explore the option of repurposing the videos, including updating the scripts with new voiceovers while also using stock footage and images to replace outdated video/images. The committee requested that a progress report be brought back to the 2025 Conference Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community.

- The committee reviewed the progress report on the LinkedIn page and received a verbal update from the Communication Services Department. The committee noted the formatting and content to include informing professionals in three languages within the limitations of the platform and best practices for posting to social media. The committee requested that a progress report be brought back to the 2025 Conference Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community.

CORRECTIONS

Committee Considerations:

- The committee reviewed the Corrections Kit and Workbook. The committee noted that the suggestions made by the 2023 Conference Committee on Corrections had been included in the Workbook and provided an additional editorial update for the Contents of Corrections Committee Kit List.
- The committee requested that the staff coordinator on the corrections desk gather shared experience on how local corrections committees encourage and engage members in corrections service. The collected shared experience would be available upon request from the corrections desk.
- The committee suggested that AA Grapevine consider including shared experiences on how to encourage and engage A.A. members in Corrections service within their July prison issue.

FINANCE

Committee Considerations:

- The committee reviewed the video "Hope: Alcoholics Anonymous" for effectiveness and relevance and took no action. The committee agreed that the information in the video is still relevant, and the video is still useful. The committee also agreed that it wouldn't be prudent to update the video at this time. *
- The committee reviewed the progress report reflecting shared experience from the Fellowship on possible future changes to literature written by A.A.'s founders and took no action. After thorough consideration and mindful reflection of the comments received from Founders' Writings sharing sessions, as well as the valuable input received from the Fellowship via Area Delegates, the committee agreed that current Conference procedures provide a process wherein future proposals for changes can be considered by the group conscience of each Conference, negating the need for a mandated policy.†

†Carryover from a previous EDW plan

*2024 EDW distribution

- The committee discussed a request that the General Service Board develop supplemental financial reporting focused on the actual costs of the various service items we provide. The committee requested that the Trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee produce

an initial draft of the supplemental financial reporting based on projects and that a draft be brought back to the Conference Committee on Finance for review at the 75th General Service Conference. The committee requested that:

- » The draft include reporting on the following service items:
 - ▶ Development of certain new literature titles.
 - ▶ Cost of capital projects such as software, app, and website development.
 - ▶ Maintenance cost of software, apps, and website.
 - ▶ International services.
- » The frequency of reporting is suggested to be quarterly and be included in quarterly reports.
- » The level of detail reported should include:
 - ▶ Revenue numbers for items we sell (and identify “no cost” items, perhaps providing separate sections for priced items vs. “no cost” items). Also, include reporting on any draws from the reserve fund for any item.
 - ▶ All long-term costs such as server fees, development costs as platforms evolve, and ongoing content creation such as podcasts, apps, Instagram accounts, etc.
- » Additionally, if any project under development is included as a Conference agenda item, then the relevant parts of the new financial reporting would be included as background for the item.

GRAPEVINE AND LA VIÑA

Committee Considerations:

- The committee requested that the Grapevine Board develop a plan for a more effective La Viña subscription procedure, fulfillment process and customer service experience and that a progress report be brought back to the 2025 Conference Committee on Grapevine and La Viña.
- The committee requested that the Grapevine Board develop a Grapevine and La Viña financial reporting system that is clearer and easier to understand for the Fellowship.
- The committee explored the services provided by AA Grapevine and how they should be funded and took no action. The committee felt they needed feedback from the Fellowship and requested that the Grapevine Board conduct a survey to the membership to identify relevance, usefulness and financial viability of products and services provided by the AA Grapevine, such as Podcast, Instagram and YouTube, with a report to be brought back to the 2026 Conference Committee on Grapevine and La Viña.
- The committee considered a request to develop a pamphlet on the Asian and Asian-American alcoholic in A.A. and took no action. Because of the anticipated cost and workload associated with developing a

new pamphlet at this time, the committee suggested that the need expressed in this agenda item may be addressed in other AAWS and AA Grapevine publications instead.

Note: As a result of the 2021-22 Equitable Distribution of Workload plan, the above item was on the agenda of the Conference Committee on Grapevine and La Viña.

- The committee reviewed the AA Grapevine Workbook and provided some editorial suggestions.
- The committee agreed to forward to the AA Grapevine Board the suggestion that AA Grapevine, Inc. produce in the year 2025 or later:
 1. Sober Holiday Stories (working title)
A helpful book where members share about the joys and challenges of staying sober through the many holidays of the year.
 2. Dating & Relationships (working title)
Members share stories about learning how to date in sobriety and/or how their relationships have changed since they’ve been in A.A. awhile.
 3. Lo Mejor de La Viña III (Best of LV III) (working title) (La Viña book)
The stories demonstrate the various ways members get active in A.A. to stay sober, carry the message and live useful and rewarding sober lives.
 4. En las prisiones (Jails and institutions) (working title) (La Viña book)
Stories by sober Hispanic members who have experienced A.A. in prison and are helping one another and carrying the message.
 5. La derrota (Surrender) (working title) (La Viña book)
A.A. members share what helped them get sober, surrender and handle their new lives of recovery.

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/ REGIONAL FORUMS

Committee Considerations:

- The committee discussed a report concerning virtual programming for the 2025 International Convention. The committee agrees with including a two-day 8 session virtual track in the program. The committee believes that the \$35.00 (USD) per attendee fee for the programmed virtual session track is prudent and provides a desired accessibility for members who may not be able to attend the convention in person. The committee made the following suggestions to the trustees’ International Convention Regional Forums Committee related to the two-day 8 session virtual program track:
 - » That there be virtual hospitality suite.
 - » That virtual technology support be provided.
- The committee requested that the trustees’ International Convention and Regional Forums Committee explore ideas to develop a new declaration to be adopted at the 2030 International Convention. The concept is to



review the history of The Responsibility Statement or the “I Am Responsible” Declaration that was introduced at the 1965 International Convention in Toronto. In addition to the history of the “Unity” declaration that was introduced at A.A.’s 35th Anniversary International Convention held in Miami Beach, Florida in July 1970. The committee looks forward to a progress report being brought back to the 2025 Conference Committee on International Convention and Regional Forums.

- The committee discussed ways of encouraging interest and participation in Regional Forums and made the following suggestions:
 - » Continue to announce Regional Forums at all local A.A. events within the Region.
 - » That the staff coordinator on the regional forum assignment communicate with the Area Contact and Volunteer Committee earlier in the Regional Forum planning process.
 - » That the staff coordinator on the regional forum assignment continues to disseminate Regional Forum information early and often using all modes of communication including email, aa.org website, Meeting Guide App., *Box 4-5-9*, and AA Grapevine and La Viña.
 - » Consider creating short current anonymity protected videos about Regional Forums that can be shared on our communication channels.

- » That the General Service Board consider adding the use of current technology including streaming, virtual and/or hybrid components to the Regional Forum; and the possibility of using local A.A. resources.
- » Consider adding an additional full virtual forum.

LITERATURE

Committee Considerations:

- The committee reviewed a progress report on revisions to the pamphlet, “The Twelve Steps Illustrated.” The committee requested that a new draft, partial draft, or progress report be brought back to the 2025 Conference Committee on Literature. The committee discussed post-Conference follow-up processes at the General Service Office. The committee noted the value of communication memos for clarity and process transparency.
- The committee reviewed a progress report on revisions to the pamphlet “A.A. for the Native North American.” The committee noted that the introduction section has been drafted and that outreach efforts have been efficient, effective, and resulted in an increased number of story submissions. The committee requested that a draft or progress report be brought back to the 2025 Conference Committee on Literature.
- The committee reviewed a progress report on the development of the Fourth Edition of the book *Alcohólicos Anónimos – Spanish*. The committee noted that the story submissions reflect a broad and diverse cross-section of the A.A. Fellowship, reflecting each of A.A.’s Three Legacies. The committee requested that a draft manuscript or progress report be brought back to the 2025 Conference Committee on Literature.
- In addition to recommending permanent suspension of the “Too Young?” video adaptation, the committee noted the potential value provided by other projects currently in development such as the “Young Peoples’ Video Project” which address similarly stated needs.
- The committee reviewed a progress report on revisions to the pamphlet “Questions and Answers on Sponsorship.” The committee noted that much of the work was outside of the scope of the committee consideration from the 2023 Conference Committee on Treatment/Accessibilities. The committee requested that the work going forward reflect the 2023 Treatment and Accessibilities suggestion to “consider updating the pamphlet ‘Questions and Answers on Sponsorship’ to add language on working with alcoholics with intellectual or information processing challenges, communication challenges and diverse neurological abilities.” The committee requested that a progress report or draft pamphlet be brought back to the 2025 Conference Committee on Literature.
- The committee reviewed the 2024 Recovery Literature Matrix and noted the need for procedural guidance through rotation memos and a reference to the informa-

tion provided within the “AAWS Policy on Publication: Keeping A.A. Literature Current.” The committee requested that a footnote be added to the Literature Matrix referencing the value of this policy as a resource.

- The committee requested that the list of formatting priorities, as established by A.A. World Services, Inc. Publishing Department, be included within future Recovery Literature Matrixes.
- The committee requested that A.A. World Services, Inc. consider developing guidelines relative to style and format to provide greater consistency of appearance and presentation between individual pieces of Conference-approved literature.
- The committee discussed Reflexiones Diarias, the Spanish translation of the Daily Reflections book. The committee suggested that AAWS consider providing Reflexiones Diarias in a large-print format.
- The committee reviewed a progress report on the development of the Fifth Edition of the book Alcoholics Anonymous. The committee looks forward to a progress report or draft manuscript to be brought back to the 2025 Conference Committee on Literature.
- The committee reviewed a progress report on the video animation of the pamphlet “The Twelve Concepts Illustrated.” The committee requested that the project proceed with Phase II Option I to include translation of narration voiceover and visual text into French and Spanish.

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

Committee Considerations:

- The committee met February 8, 2024, to consider a request from the trustees’ General Service Conference Committee and General Service Board that a trustee of the Great Britain General Service Board, Joanna Faul and the Great Britain General Service Office General Secretary, Ranjan Bhattacharyya, be approved to attend the 2024 U.S./Canada General Service Conference as observers. The committee agreed to grant admission which is in keeping within the scope of the committee, per the 2022 Policy/Admission Advisory Action.
- Regarding the Equitable Distribution of Workload (EDW) process, the committee requested that the trustees’ Committee on the General Service Conference and Conference Coordinator develop a finalized operational procedure and implementation plan. The committee requested that a progress update be brought to the 2025 Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions on the finalized EDW implementation.
- The committee suggested that the trustees’ Committee on the General Service Conference create a proposal providing simpler methods of balancing conference workload which might include, but not limited to, the following suggestions:
 - » Reimagining current Conference committees in ways that could accommodate heavier workloads.

» Some Committee literature on recovery or more general topics of service could be moved under the purview of committees which historically have agendas with less items. Some Conference-approved items that don’t set policy but rather, reflect factual information might be moved to service material, to allow for more timely updates.

» Providing Conference committees a clear understanding and list of all items within their scope and purview. (Example: A committee that has an agenda item of “Review Kit and Workbook” does not necessarily have less “work” to do but rather an opportunity to do a more thorough review of the pamphlets and service material under their purview within the contents of the kit, that can often unintentionally get neglected and become increasingly dated when a committee’s agenda becomes lengthier.)

» That the function and purpose of Equitable Distribution of Workload (EDW) be more centered on *lessening* the workloads of committees that may not have ample time to complete their work rather than focusing on *adding* to agendas to lengthen the work.

» Adding additional Conference Committees or secondary Conference committees.

» The Conference Agenda Routing (CAR) form may be an unnecessary internal reporting mechanism for the General Service Office and a simpler method of documenting Proposed Agenda Item (PAI) review might be considered.

» An adjustment to the Conference schedule to allow for more committee time to handle additional workload, in lieu of presentations and workshops.

- The committee also discussed the need for updated language to the current Proposed Agenda Item (PAI) form and provided the following suggestions:

» Include clarifying language that PAI submissions received past the deadline would not be considered for the upcoming General Service Conference (GSC) but would be considered for the following year.

» The note provided in section 3 of the form, also be included at the top of the form in **bold** font.

» Under section 3 add a question, “If this item is being submitted by an individual, was the item forwarded to another level of group conscience and if it was not considered, please provide an explanation.”

(Note: This section could use a “check box” system for Area, District, group, individual, or other.)

If the “individual” or “other” box is selected, then the submitter would be asked to provide additional information as to why. This question would have an asterisk and would be required to be answered before submission.

- The committee reviewed the GSO General Manager’s memo regarding General Service Conference site selection. The committee asked that the General Manager provide a progress report regarding site selection for

the 77th and 78th General Service Conferences as soon as they are finalized.

- The committee reviewed the dates for the 2028 General Service Conference. In order to provide additional flexibility to the General Service Office management in contracting the most cost-effective and appropriate venues for the General Service Conference, the committee agreed to select these proposed dates for the 78th General Service Conference, as follows (in order of preference): April 23-29, 2028; May 7-13, 2028; April 2-8, 2028. The committee noted that these proposed Conference dates are the best choices available for avoiding conflicts with significant holidays. The committee asked that all Conference members be notified of the final dates for the 77th and 78th General Service Conference as soon as they are finalized by GSO management.

- The committee reviewed the “Report of the GSB Ad Hoc Committee on Participation of Online Groups (POG) in the U.S./Canada Service Structure” and had a wide-ranging discussion.

The committee expressed appreciation for the Ad Hoc report, particularly the results of the survey to online groups. Based upon the Ad Hoc report findings, the committee noted that at this time there are no clearly expressed needs outlined in order to move forward with the creation of an additional delegate area for online groups. The committee noted that the suggestion of a future guideline service piece on the participation of online groups may be a helpful resource to consider for the future as information continues to be shared and gathered from the U.S./Canada service structure.

- The Committee discussed a suggestion to revise procedures for electing the delegate chairperson, Conference Committee chairpersons and their alternates and took no action. The committee noted that the timing of the election at the close of the final committee meeting as well as the process for electing Conference committee chairs is an effective voting procedure.

The committee also noted that while the process for electing the General Service Conference Delegate chair from the remaining delegates (not yet selected for Committee or alt chair) remains a viable procedure, a more effective, improved, communication would be useful in outlining the current roles and responsibilities.

There was consensus by the committee that all Area Delegates have been chosen by their areas as qualified and ready to serve in many capacities at the Conference. While some delegates may choose not to be included in the election, any qualifying delegate who wants to be considered be allowed to submit their name. The committee suggested that the trustees’ Conference committee develop a guideline “For the Role and Responsibilities of Delegate Chair” that could be included in the Conference manual and be read prior to the election at the delegate’s only meeting. The committee asked that the Staff secretary send a memo

to the trustees’ Conference Committee with suggestions for content in the guideline.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

Committee Considerations:

- The committee reviewed the memo from the General Service Office Chief Financial Officer related to tracking Public Service Announcements. In addition, the committee reviewed background addendum on both distribution and tracking of TV PSAs, noting that \$48,000 to track PSAs has been accepted as an audit requirement. The committee requested that this expense be allocated to the trustees’ Finance and Budgetary Committee budget. The committee suggested that for the tracking of PSAs more cost-effective means of tracking be researched.
- The committee reviewed and accepted a progress report on the development of a General Service Office podcast. The committee noted the planning, development, and production of episodes on many service-related discussion topics and looks forward to a progress report with analytics data on the first season of this audio service material to be brought back to the 2025 Conference Committee on Public Information.
- The committee reviewed and accepted the 2023 Report on the Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. Meeting Guide app. The committee offered the following suggestions and looks forward to a report to be brought to the 2025 Conference Committee on Public Information:
 - » Consider a suggestion to add A.A. literature to the Meeting Guide app.
 - » Consider creating a mechanism for listing online meetings on the Meeting Guide app without tying them to particular locations.
 - » Consider adding a clarification to the location information on the Meeting Guide app to specify that locations (like churches) do not imply affiliation.
 - » Consider adding an option to make Seventh Tradition contributions possible through the *Meeting Guide* app.
- The committee reviewed and accepted the 2023 Reports on aa.org. The committee made the following suggestions and looks forward to a report being brought back to the 2025 Conference Committee on Public Information.
 - » The committee suggested that the trustees’ Public Information Committee explore adding chat functionality to the aa.org website, noting that the General Service Offices of Australia and Great Britain have already adopted this feature on their websites.
 - » The committee suggested that the trustees’ Public Information Committee explore adding meeting information feature to aa.org by connecting to the local feeds that populate Meeting Guide.
- The committee reviewed and accepted the 2023 annual report from the AA Grapevine and La Viña website, marketing, podcast and app, noting appreciation for

the continued growth of the podcast and expressed support for the AA Grapevine app. The committee made the following suggestions:

- » The committee suggested that future AA Grapevine reports include more detailed analytics on their communication channels.
- » The committee requested the opportunity to review the AA Grapevine Five Year plan.
- » The committee offered suggestions for the AA Grapevine App and Podcast and suggested that the staff secretary forward these to the AA Grapevine Publisher.
- The committee reviewed and accepted the 2023 Analytics Working Group Report and noted all the work that had gone into laying out a framework for improving analytics reporting in the future and looks forward to a report to be brought to the 2025 Conference Committee on Public Information.
- The committee discussed the revised proposal for Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. to establish an Instagram account and took no action, noting that a social media policy should be established before additional social media platforms are added.
- The committee suggested that efforts to collect user-generated Young People videos be permanently suspended and that the web page and portal for these submissions be taken down.
- The committee requested that consideration be given to adding a QR code to the flyer “A.A. at a Glance” (F-1).
- The committee suggested that consideration be given to adding a QR code to the pamphlet “Speaking at Meetings Outside of A.A.” (P-40).
- The committee suggested that the staff secretary ask that delegates gather feedback on how young people would like to be communicated with and submit the shared experience back to the staff secretary before October 1, 2024, using an online survey tool. The committee requested that a report be brought back to the 2025 Conference Committee on Public Information.
- The committee reviewed and accepted the progress report on the request to create a new form of communication to address anonymity on social media and understands that responses to questionnaire were collected during a one-month period in March and April 2024. The committee looks forward to a progress report to be brought to the 2025 Conference Committee on Public Information and offered the following suggestions:
 - » That future surveys have fewer questions and that efforts be made to communicate clearly with delegates about future requests for sharing from the Fellowship.
 - » That future staff reports to the Conference Committee on Public Information include information about anonymity and social media work by the Public Information Desk.

» That findings from the questionnaire on social media and anonymity be incorporated into the pending social media policy.

» That future surveys of this type be shared more broadly with the Fellowship understanding that large-scale requests for sharing from the Fellowship may incur additional expense.

- The committee reviewed the progress report on the A.A. Membership Survey Convenience Sample Pilot and looks forward to a report being brought back to the 2025 Conference Committee on Public Information. The committee requested that staff provide more clear and timely communications about Membership Survey processes that impact delegates and their areas.
- The committee reviewed and accepted the 2024 Public Information Comprehensive Media Plan (CMP). The committee expressed continued support for this version of the CMP, but noted that when a major re-write is completed, a coversheet outlining the changes would be useful. The committee expressed appreciation that the plan details useful guardrails and captures the public information work, messaging, and communication channels the General Service Office and AA Grapevine are using to make the Fellowship, general public, media, and professionals aware of Alcoholics Anonymous.

The committee offered the following suggestions for the next iteration of the Comprehensive Media Plan to be brought back to the 2025 Conference Committee on Public Information.

» That continued review of the Comprehensive Media Plan focus on ensuring that each section focuses on strategic goal setting versus facts or operational processes.

» That the trustees’ committee consider adding Alcoholics Anonymous World Services Inc. brand guidelines to the Comprehensive Media Plan.

» That developing guidelines for using the Comprehensive Media Plan in other parts of the service structure would be useful.

» That consideration be given to adding a list of the PSAs and when they were approved to the Comprehensive Media Plan.

» That a more robust analytics section would be a useful addition to the Comprehensive Media Plan.

» That trustees’ Public Information collaborate with any other trustees’ committee that has responsibility for content areas detailed in the Comprehensive Media Plan and identify ways for the corresponding conference committees to collaborate with one another on the relevant sections of the CMP.

» That consideration be given to accepting user generated content from members who are under the age of 18.

- The committee suggested that once a social media policy is completed, a section about the social media policy be added to the Comprehensive Media Plan.



- The committee reviewed the 2023 report on the “Relevance and Usefulness of Video Public Service Announcements.” Committee members noted that the membership survey seems to indicate that members are not finding A.A. through the media. The committee expressed general criticism about the tone and communication style of the current PSAs.
- The committee suggested that the annual report on “Relevance and Usefulness of Video Public Service Announcements” be revised to more clearly articulate the process for suggesting changes or retirement of any PSAs.
- The committee requested that any suggestions to retire Public Service Announcements be communicated as agenda items.

The committee suggested that the trustees’ Public Information Committee reimagine the overall strategy for Public Service Announcements (PSAs) and offered the following suggestions:

- » Noting the challenge of balancing budget constraints and the need to update our PSAs, that the trustees’ PI Committee consider less expensive methods of creating and modifying content.
- » That shorter PSAs are more useful (:60 is too long).
- » The committee suggested that consideration be given to working with Australia’s service structure to use the Australian Public Service Announcements in the U.S. and Canada.
- The committee also suggested that the staff secretary continue to encourage local Public Information committees to distribute Public Service Announcements (PSAs) in their local areas.
- The committee accepted the Progress Report on the Feasibility of Paid Placement of PSAs on streaming

platforms and noted that while the information it contained is useful, questioned whether the currently available Public Service Announcements would be effective on streaming platforms.

- The committee suggested that before Public Service Announcements are placed on streaming media, methods for measuring their impact should be established.
- The committee suggested that trustees’ Committee Public Information create two plans for placing PSAs on streaming media with a focus on reaching a general audience with budgets not to exceed \$50,000 and \$100,000. The committee suggested that the trustees’ Committee on Public Information keep in mind A.A.’s Twelve Traditions in developing this plan.
- The committee discussed the progress report on the Mesmerize Point Public Service Announcement (PSA) distribution channel and was pleased to see the ongoing opportunity to reach a large audience at no cost. The committee suggested that the trustees’ Public Information Committee renew the annual contract with Mesmerize Point for the 2024-25 year, providing it could be done so at no cost. The committee suggested that the trustees’ PI Committee research whether there are opportunities like Mesmerize Point available in Canada.

The committee expressed support for requesting more data about the impact and reach the PSAs have through Mesmerize Point. The committee looks forward to a report to be brought to the 2025 Conference Committee on Public Information.

- The committee expressed support for adding QR codes to our Public Service Announcements (PSAs) as soon as possible and requested that the Communication Services Department provide estimates for the cost of

doing so and suggested the work be done if it could be completed for less than \$5,000.

- The committee reviewed and accepted the 2023 Report on the Alcoholics Anonymous World Services YouTube account.

The committee noted that the PSA playlist on Alcoholics Anonymous World Services (AAWS) YouTube page only includes two videos, suggesting that the tool would be more useful if all PSAs were included in the playlist.

- The committee offered the following suggestions regarding the AAWS YouTube page and looks forward to a report to be brought to the 2025 Conference Committee on Public Information.

» The committee suggested that the trustees' Public Information Committee consider organizing the YouTube page more effectively.

» The committee pointed out that the YouTube page is not intuitive to navigate and suggested that efforts be made to change how translations of videos get displayed.

» Noting the Search Engine Optimization (SEO) challenges, the committee reported that a search of YouTube using keywords like AA or Alcoholics Anonymous did not bring users to the AAWS page and suggested that additional work on SEO be considered.

» For future reporting to this committee, the committee requested that trustees' Public Information Committee consider tracking the impact of outreach efforts (for instance an email blast) and whether those efforts impact the traffic on YouTube.

» The committee questioned whether YouTube and Vimeo are both needed.

- The committee reviewed and accepted the 2023 Report on Google Ads. The committee noted appreciation for the formatting of the report and made the following suggestions:

» That efforts should be made to maximize our use of the Google Ad grant each month.

» That staff continue to look at whether search terms (like aa.org) used with Google ad groups are the best use of the Google Ad Grant program. The committee looks forward to a report to be brought to the 2025 Conference Committee on Public Information.

The committee reviewed and accepted the 2023 Report on Online Business Profiles (OBP). The committee offered the following suggestions for Online Business Profiles and looks forward to a report to be brought to the 2025 Conference Committee on Public Information.

» That Online Business Profile analytics reporting be more consistent with quarterly reporting of activity per quarter.

» That Online Business Profile responses be provided as background each year.

» That Online Business Profiles cross link with other sites managed by AAWS.

» That in responding to Online Business Profiles consideration be given to the principle of attraction.

- The committee discussed the content and format of the Public Information Kit and Workbook and noted contents of the kit are useful to local Public Information Committees.

- Noting that a Public Information Workbook revision is underway, the committee agreed to provide with emailed suggestions for the Workbook to the staff secretary

REPORT AND CHARTER

Committee Considerations:

- The committee reviewed a list of editorial updates from the Publishing Department for *The A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts for World Service* and accepted the updates.

- The committee accepted a report from the Publishing Department outlining the General Service Office process for timely and accurate preparation and publication of the proposed *The A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts for World Service*, 2024-2026 Edition and the 2024 General Service Conference Final Report.

- The committee discussed the current process for reviewing substantial updates to *The A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts for World Service* and agreed that it lacks cohesiveness and accountability. The committee expressed their concerns to the Board chairs and General Manager and suggest that the General Service Board explore the creation of a corresponding Trustees' committee for Report and Charter comprised of members of all three boards and the General Service Office and that a progress report be brought back to the 2025 Conference Committee on Report and Charter.

- The committee underwent a multi-year process of assessing the accuracy and effectiveness of the redesigned 2021-2023 edition of *The A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts for World Service*. While further functional clarity is needed, in order to prevent a further delay in printing, a significant number of revisions were identified and corrected. The committee requests that the General Service Board assign a dedicated trustee liaison to the Report and Charter conference committee to ensure the accurate implementation of those revisions to the 2024-2026 *The A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts for World Service* for printing in 2024.

- The committee reviewed the draft of the new section "Amendments" to be added to the Twelve Concepts for World Service. The committee agreed that a full reexamination is needed to achieve the intent of this section, to be of benefit to the Fellowship as a clear source of reference. The committee requests that the General Service Board review the draft along with the committee's feedback and provide an updated draft or

progress report to the 2025 Conference Committee on Report and Charter.

- The committee noted that there may be policy implications associated with Simple Majority items and suggested this question be referred to the Conference Committee on Policy and Admissions for further consideration.

TREATMENT AND ACCESSIBILITIES

Committee Considerations:

- The committee reviewed and accepted the progress report on the Military Outreach Project noting the importance of adding interviews with A.A. members who are veterans. The committee forwarded to the trustees' Cooperation with the Professional Community/Treatment and Accessibilities Committee the following suggestions:

- » Focus on creating a landing page for the military audio interviews on the General Service Office's website www.aa.org.
- » Prioritize an interview with a Canadian Francophone A.A. member in the military.
- » Include the military audio interviews on A.A.'s YouTube page using a simple image.

The committee requested that a progress report on the Military Outreach Project be brought back to the 2025 Conference Committee on Treatment and Accessibilities.

- The committee requested that the staff coordinator on the Accessibilities desk solicit current shared experience from the Fellowship on outreach efforts to Veteran Affairs (VA) and active military in the U.S. and Canada to be utilized in service material. The committee looks forward to a progress report at the 2025 General Service Conference.
- The committee reviewed the Treatment Kit and Workbook and forwarded to the trustees' CPC/Treatment and Accessibilities Committee a list of minor edits to the workbook to be implemented at the next printing.
- The committee reviewed the Accessibilities Kit and Workbook and forwarded to the trustees' CPC/Treatment and Accessibilities Committee a list of pamphlets/resources to be added to the kit.
- The committee reviewed updated Bridging the Gap service materials and made further suggestions for consistency across Bridging the Gap materials.
- The committee reviewed the accessibilities inventory provided by the trustees' CPC/Treatment and Accessibilities committee and suggested minor edits. The committee asked that the staff coordinator on the Accessibilities desk make the list available to download from the Accessibilities Committee's page on aa.org and share the link with the staff coordinator on the Cooperation with the Professional Community desk for

potential distribution among professionals and inclusion on the A.A. LinkedIn page. The committee also asked the staff coordinator on the Accessibilities desk to share the list periodically in activity updates.

The committee requested that a progress report be brought back to the 2025 committee on how useful this list has been to local accessibilities committees.

- The committee reviewed the pamphlet "A.A. in Treatment Settings" (P-27) and recognized its continued effectiveness and relevance. The committee suggested that the Publishing department update the cover of the pamphlet and add current information on how to contact A.A.
- The committee reviewed the Remote Communities and Cooperation with Elder Community resource lists and forwarded several suggestions to be added to the lists to the trustees' CPC/Treatment and Accessibilities Committee.
- The committee reviewed the progress report on updating A.A. service material to better carry the message to alcoholics with intellectual or information-processing challenges, communication challenges and diverse neurological abilities and noted that much of the service material is not relevant to the subject. The committee asked the staff coordinator on the Accessibilities desk to follow up on the 2023 General Service Conference considerations related to the revisions to the pamphlet "Questions and Answers on Sponsorship" and the publication of an issue of AA Grapevine magazine with stories from neurodiverse alcoholics.

The committee forwarded a list of service material that could be updated to the trustees' CPC/Treatment and Accessibilities Committee.

The committee looks forward to a progress report to be brought back to the 2025 Conference Committee on Treatment and Accessibilities with shared experience from the Fellowship on neurodivergence and alcoholism to inform service material updates.

TRUSTEES

Committee Considerations:

- The committee reviewed the résumés and approved as eligible for election all Class B trustee candidates for West Central Regional trustee and Western Canada Regional trustee.
- The committee reviewed an update report regarding the pamphlet "Do You Think You're Different?" The committee noted that the trustees' Literature Committee has called for story submissions with an April 30, 2024, deadline. The committee requested that the trustees' Literature Committee provide a draft pamphlet or progress report to the 2025 Conference Committee on Trustees.

Note: As a result of the 2021-22 Equitable Distribution of Workload plan, the above item was on the agenda of the Conference Committee on Trustees.

- The committee discussed the agenda item to consider guidelines and parameters regarding the deadline to submit Conference agenda items and took no action. The committee affirmed that Proposed Agenda Items (PAIs) received after the current year's deadline are processed in the following year.

Recommendations that achieved Simple Majority — These items did not receive the two-thirds majority required to pass as a Conference Advisory Action.

TRUSTEES

The committee recommended the following change to the Scope of the Conference Committee on Trustees' Composition, Scope, and Procedure:

Currently reads:

2. The committee reviews the resumes of all newly nominated Class A and Class B trustees of the General Service Board and nontrustee directors of the corporate boards (AAWS and the AA Grapevine). The committee reviews the slates of members and officers of the General Service Board and the slates of corporate board directors, before the Conference meeting, and expresses disapproval, if any.

Revised to read:

2. The committee reviews the resumes of all Class A and Class B trustees of the General Service Board and nontrustee directors of the corporate boards (AAWS and the AA Grapevine). The committee reviews the slates of members and officers of the General Service Board and the slates of corporate board directors, before the Conference meeting, and expresses disapproval, if any.

Recommendations Not Resulting in Conference Action

These recommendations were presented but did not receive the two-thirds vote necessary to become a Conference Advisory Action.

FINANCE

- The committee recommended that the General Service Board hold one Quarterly Board weekend a year virtually when possible. The committee is respectful of the General Service Board Bylaws, and Concept 3, Right of decision of the General Service Board Chair.
- The committee recommended that the Trustees Emeriti of the General Service Board be invited to the Annual General Service Conference and to the General Service Board weekends at their own expense.

AGENDA

Motion made at Opening Session:

- The committee recommended suspension of oral presentation of all Area Service Highlights during the 74th

General Service Conference to allow for additional time on the agenda for general sharing and questions.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

- The committee recommended that a social media policy be developed for all current and future social media channels and requested that a draft be brought back to the 2025 Conference Committee on Public Information.
- The committee recommended that to better provide equality in availability and messaging, starting with the July 2024 General Service Board Meeting, that unedited but anonymity-protected minutes, including trustees' committee reports in English, Spanish, and French, be provided to all Conference members within three weeks following quarterly Board Weekends. Minutes should retain the current format and scope.

Floor Actions Not Resulting in Conference Advisory Actions

- A pamphlet for the unhoused person that specifically addresses alcoholism, what A.A. is and is not, who is welcome at A.A. meetings, and includes stories from AA members who have experienced homelessness be developed and a draft or progress report be brought back to the appropriate 2025 Conference committee. ***(Conference declined to consider)***
- PAIs requesting censure and reorganization have no submission deadline and be forwarded directly to Conference Committee on Trustees. ***(Not Approved)***
- All memorandums between Conference Committee and Trustees Committees or Boards be made available to all members of the Conference. ***(Conference declined to consider)***

Motion passed to recommit Floor Actions #5-#15 to the appropriate trustees' Committee or Corporate Board

Floor Action #5:

It was recommended that:

The Conference affirm that La Viña continue to be published by the AA Grapevine and supported by the General Service Board as a service to the Fellowship. La Viña continues to be published utilizing AA Grapevine resources in order to achieve efficient production and distribution.

Submitted on April 18, 2024, by

Richard O.

Panel 74 A8, San Diego/Imperial California, Delegate

Floor Action #6:

It was recommended that:

The Grapevine Board develop a plan for a more effective La Viña subscription procedure, fulfillment process and customer service experience, and that a progress report be brought back to the 2025 Conference Committee on Grapevine and La Viña.

Submitted on April 18, 2024, by

Irene D., GSO Staff Member

Floor Action #7:

It was recommended that:

All non-offensive PAIs submitted for consideration of the 72nd, 73rd and 74th General Service Conferences regarding the change made to the A.A. Preamble by the 71st General Service Conference be grouped as one item, and forwarded to the appropriate 75th General Service Conference committee with the following suggestion: given the importance and interest of this issue, consider forwarding the item to the general service areas for wider discussion, looking toward a fair and reasonable solution to the division within the Fellowship by the use of different copyrighted Preambles.

Submitted on April 18, 2024, by

Ilir T.

Panel 74 A12, Delaware, Delegate

Floor Action #8:

It was recommended that:

The additional feedback from the Conference Committee on Literature identified in their memo to the Publishing Department on sticking points for the Plain Language draft manuscript be implemented in the draft before printing.

Submitted on April 19, 2024, by

Nick K.

Panel 74 A41, Nebraska, Delegate

Floor Action #9:

It was recommended that:

Whenever any changes are brought to the Conference floor to the Founders' writings, considered by this motion to be:

1. The book *Alcoholics Anonymous* — specifically, the first 164 pages, the chapter "The Doctor's Opinion," Forewords to the first and second editions, the Appendices on Spiritual Awakening and the Traditions, and Dr. Bob's Nightmare
2. The book *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*

the Conference must achieve a supermajority of 75% for the General Service Board to act upon it. However, the General Service Board shall not immediately act upon the Conference's directions, and instead, shall request all Area Delegates to conduct further discussions in their respective Areas. Area delegates' report backs will be conducted the second following General Service Conference at which the Conference may amend or change the previously approved change to the Founders' writings described above. For final action by the General Service Board, the Conference must achieve substantial unanimity.

Submitted on April 19, 2024, by

Ilir T.

Panel 74 A12, Delaware, Delegate

Floor Action #10:

It was recommended that:

The AA Grapevine Board develop a 5-year financial plan

for the Grapevine with the goal to reduce shortfalls and increase revenue to be brought back to 2025 Conference Committee on Grapevine and La Viña.

Submitted on April 19, 2024, by

Pablo H.

Panel 73 A93, Central California, Delegate

Floor Action #11:

It was recommended that:

Reaffirming the 1975 Advisory Action that in reports to their areas delegates place more emphasis on group support. Delegates should emphasize to the groups the effect that inflation has had on the contribution dollar and the necessity for adjusting contributions accordingly to support services provided by the General Service Board.

Submitted on April 19, 2024, by

Suzanne S.

Panel 73 A30, Eastern Massachusetts, Delegate

Floor Action #12:

It was recommended that:

Delegates who require translation be provided with all documents, materials, reports, communications, etc., in their native language, with all necessary information to be able to fulfill their role as trusted servants, bearing in mind the traditional Right of Participation.

Submitted on April 19, 2024, by

Julio A. Maldonado

Panel 74, A77, Puerto Rico, Delegate

Floor Action #13:

It was recommended that:

In the flyer "A.A. At a Glance" — in the last paragraph on page one under the heading "Who can attend A.A. meetings?" that the last sentence "Closed" discussion meetings are for alcoholics only" be changed to: "Attendance at a 'closed' meeting is limited to A.A. members and persons who have a desire to stop drinking."

Submitted on April 19, 2024, by

Irma V. B.-N.

Western Canada Regional Trustee

Floor Action #14:

It was recommended that:

The explanations of the Steps, Traditions, and Concepts be removed from the Plain Language Big Book.

Submitted on April 19, 2024, by

Jimmy W.

Panel 74, A64 Tennessee, Delegate

Floor Action #15:

It was recommended that:

The Plain Language Big Book be retitled to: "The Plain Language Guide to A.A.'s Twelve Steps of Recovery."

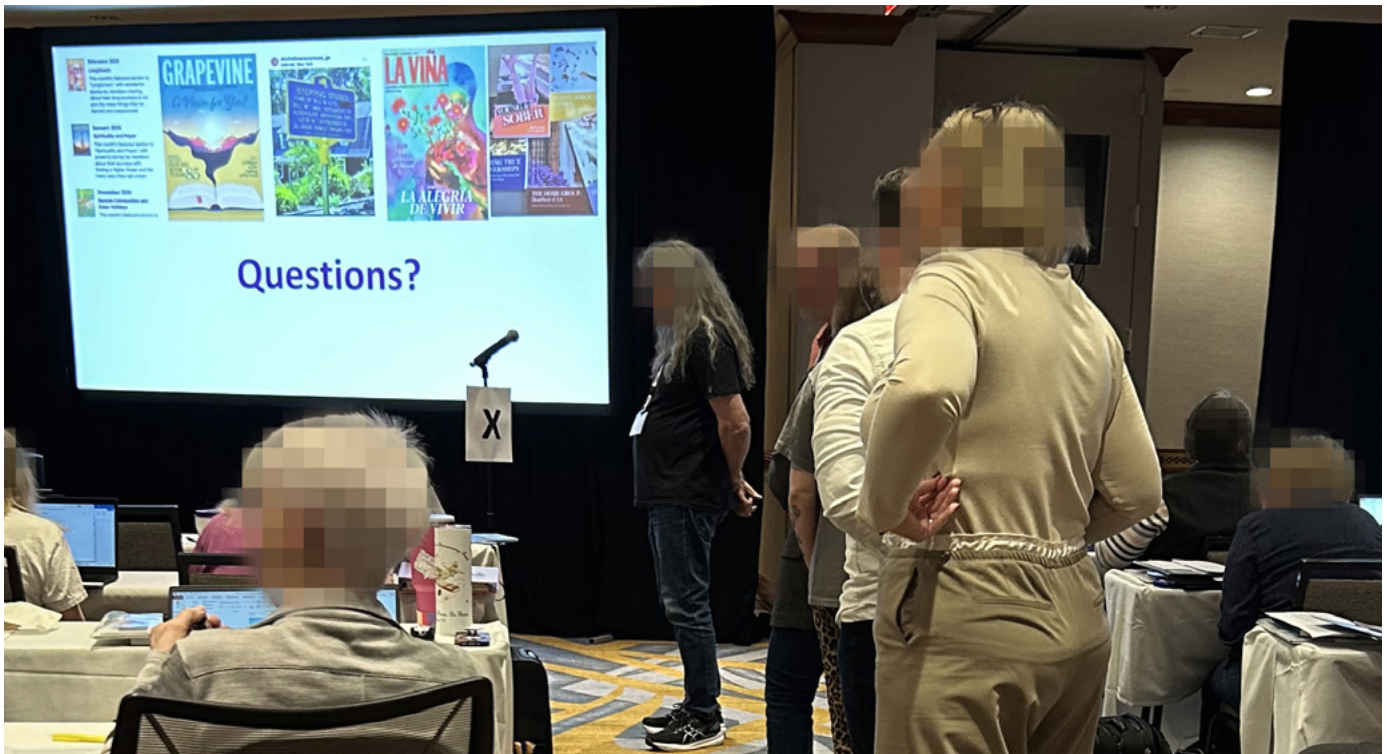
Submitted on April 19, 2024, by

Debbie H.

Panel 73, A39 Western Missouri, Delegate

■ Committee Considerations

An Advisory Action of the 1990 General Service Conference states: "Items discussed, but no action taken or recommendation made, as well as committee recommendations which are not adopted, be included in a separate section of the Final Report." Listed by committee, such items are included here "in their entirety" per Advisory Action of the 2019 General Service Conference.



AGENDA

Committee Considerations:

- The committee discussed the progress report on planning for the 2025 Conference Inventory, noting the report back sessions. The committee also discussed the 2013-2015 Conference Inventory, noting the absence of a Conference planning committee to identify actionable items to follow up, led to achieving few outcomes. The committee felt that establishing a planning committee would ensure effective follow-up from the 2025 Conference Inventory.
- The committee discussed the request to suspend oral presentations of Area Service Highlights during the General Service Conference but continue publishing them in the Final Report and took no action. The committee agreed that suspending oral presentations would not provide significant time savings during the week. The committee agreed that these Area Service Highlight presentations provide an opportunity to hear from different areas how they carry the A.A. message. The committee noted that over the last two years, recommendations from this committee to suspend oral

presentation of Area Highlights failed.

- The committee reviewed and discussed a pilot proposal for a Harmony and Effectiveness Session and agreed to take no action. The committee discussed the 2024 Advisory Action related to meeting outside of the annual meeting for general sharing sessions at least two times per year utilizing virtual meeting technology. The committee noted that the General Service Board Chair works with the Delegate Chair set the date and time as well as determine what issues currently facing the Fellowship would be chosen as topics. The committee requested that more input from Delegates, Trustees, Directors and Staff Members be obtained by the General Service Board Chair and the Delegate Chair, to support the development of each session's agenda. The committee requested that the agenda could be distributed in advance to Conference Members. The committee agreed that these current opportunities, such as biannually sharing sessions and the "What's on Your Mind" sessions held during each Conference week, provide ample opportunity for Conference Members to discuss harmony and effectiveness.

- The committee reviewed the 2024 Conference evaluation summary and noted several improvements were being made at the 75th General Service Conference. The committee requested to include visual quantitative graphics to recap the feedback and looks forward to reviewing the 2025 evaluation summary at the 2026 General Service Conference.
- The committee reviewed the 2025 evaluation questionnaire noting the request for feedback from Conference Members on the Opening Sunday Banquet. The committee requested that the trustees' General Service Conference Committee consider alternatives such as allowing attendees to bring a guest at future Conferences at their own expense. The committee noted the costs for coordinating a visit for Conference Members and guests to Stepping Stones, following the 2024 General Service Conference, was offset by their voluntary contributions.
- The committee reviewed the 2025 progress report on Conference Improvements and appreciated the thoughtful and thorough efforts to incorporate improvements based on feedback by Conference Members. The committee appreciated the reinstatement of the Saturday Meet-and-Greet gathering. The committee also noted the effort to address improving the Conference Mechanics, by revising "How the Conference Operates." The committee agreed the ability to make Floor Actions during the opening session should be allowed in cases of urgency or importance.
- The committee discussed a proposed printing and distribution plan for a comprehensive report of the 2025 Conference Inventory and took no action. The committee noted the current cost estimate for printing and shipping reports and that there is currently a plan to distribute an electronic version. Additionally, the committee noted that an eight page summary will be included in the 2025 Final Conference Report.
- The committee reviewed a range of feedback from Conference Committee chairs regarding the quarterly communication with their corresponding trustees' committee chairs. The committee agreed that clarification of the expectations responsibilities would strengthen these efforts during the Conference process and suggested adding new content to existing communications to chairpersons such as "Information and Suggestions to Conference Committee Chairpersons" and trustees' orientation would be useful. Additionally, the committee discussed the corresponding quarterly trustee committee reports, noting that these drafts

are approved at the subsequent quarterly Board meeting. To provide additional framework and set expectations to the quarterly touch points, the committee suggested the General Service Board distribute final drafts of quarterly trustee committee reports to the Corresponding committee chairperson for information purposes only.

ARCHIVES

Committee Considerations:

- The committee received a verbal report by the GSO Archivist on the status of suggested changes to the Archives Workbook by the previous year's Conference Committee on Archives. The revisions will be implemented in the next printing of the Archives Workbook and also include:
 - » Recent revisions to policies, procedures such as the Deed of Gift Form, Categorization of "Archival Materials for Access and Use" and similar updates.
- The committee also suggested that the GSO Archives department consider reordering sections to enhance the overall flow of content in the Workbook.

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

Committee Considerations:

- The committee reviewed the content and format of the Cooperation with the Professional Community (CPC) Kit and Workbook and noted the updates that were suggested by the 2024 Conference Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community. The committee provided suggestions for additional updates to be included in the next printing of the workbook. The committee also offered minor updates and editorial changes to CPC service materials, including guidelines, along with formatting changes and updates to the kit contents, including:
 - » Refined use of QR codes
 - » Updates to the CPC PowerPoint presentation
 The committee noted that the requested changes will be forwarded to the AAWS Publishing Department.
- The committee offered suggestions to forward to the Communications Services Department for ways to better inform professionals who visit aa.org about A.A. resources.
- The committee discussed the shared experience on informing professionals how A.A. can serve as a resource for unhoused and neurodivergent alcoholics and took no action. The committee noted that there is

a duplication of efforts within conference committees regarding neurodivergent alcoholics. The committee agreed that there was no new information compelling to reverse the 74th General Service Conference decision to take no action.

- Regarding the redirection of the pamphlet for mental health professionals, the committee requested that the staff secretary forward a memo to the Publishing Department, including the following suggestions to shape additional content and update the layout and format:
 - » Include hyperlinks to the stories and shared experiences previously provided in the interviews and the earlier draft pamphlet.
 - » Update subject titles, including the following:
 - Brief FAQ
 - How A.A. may be helpful to mental health treatment
 - How do I suggest A.A.?
 - How to find us?
 - » The committee further requested that the trustees' Cooperation with the Professional Community/Treatment and Accessibilities Committee review these recommendations and considerations for the new pamphlet, and that a report on how this work will be done be brought back to the 2026 Conference committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community. The committee requests that the report should include what options were considered, what progress was completed, and if the considerations were not implemented, those reasons be included in the report.
- The committee requested that AAWS explore increasing the cadence of LinkedIn posting and what resources would be required to support that effort.
- Regarding the development of a new CPC video, the committee requested that the most cost-effective means of producing the video be used, utilizing in-house resources when available. The committee also requested that the video should reflect the diversity of the Fellowship.
- The committee requested that AAWS consider addressing "singleness of purpose" as part of the social media policy currently being developed.
- The committee requested that the trustees' Cooperation with the Professional Community/Treatment and Accessibilities Committee contribute annual input to the revision of the Comprehensive Media Plan (CMP)

and collaborates with the trustees' Public Information Committee for effective use of technology in how we reach professionals using current industry standards and adapting to new and emerging technologies.

CORRECTIONS

Committee Considerations:

- The committee reviewed the Corrections Kit and Workbook. The committee noted that the suggestions made by the 2024 Conference Committee on Corrections had been included in the Workbook. The committee provided additional updates for the Correction Kit and Workbook including:
 - Information on A.A. literature on tablets
 - Meeting Guide App Information
 - Editorial suggestions
 - Additional hyperlinks in the Corrections kit
 - Reference for the A.A. Group Handbook for Groups That Meet in Correctional Facilities (CF-36) in the Corrections Workbook
- The committee reviewed a progress report on the development of a pamphlet on the transgender alcoholic in A.A. and expressed support for the process



that has occurred to date. The committee requested that a progress report be brought back to the 2026 Conference Committee on Corrections.

- The committee reviewed and accepted the 2024 Data Report from the tablet vendor Edovo. The committee recognized the interest in A.A. audiobooks on Edovo tablets and suggested that the production of an audiobook of the *Plain Language Big Book* be explored while taking into consideration costs and project prioritization.
- The committee acknowledged the work of the Corrections Survey completed by the staff on the corrections assignment and expressed support for the shared experience to be made available upon request and that sharing from the survey be included in the Corrections Workbook.
- The committee reviewed a request to update Appendix IV in the book *Alcoholics Anonymous* to include other awards and commendations received by A.A. since 1951 and suggested that the trustees' Literature Committee add a footnote to Appendix IV of the 5th Edition *Alcoholics Anonymous*, directing members to the Awards and Recognition section on www.aa.org for information on more recent awards.
- The committee noted the availability and usefulness of the A.A. Group Handbook for Groups That Meet in Correctional Facilities (CF-36) and suggested that updates be made by the staff on the corrections assignment.

FINANCE

Committee Considerations:

- The committee discussed the 2024 floor action to reaffirm the 1975 Advisory Action that delegates emphasize to the groups the effect that inflation has had on the contribution of the dollar and the necessity for adjusting contributions accordingly, to support services provided by the General Service Board and took no action. The committee discussed that each delegate has the autonomy to report financial information and may include details of the services being provided which will help districts, groups and individuals adjust their contributions accordingly.
- The committee reviewed the Conference-approved maximum annual contribution of \$7,500 to the General Service Board from an individual A.A. member and took no action. The committee noted that the maximum annual contribution was increased in 2024 and agreed that the current level remains appropriate.

- The committee tabled the review of the self-support packet with the understanding that review of the packet will be undertaken by the 2026 Conference Committee on Finance.

GRAPEVINE AND LA VIÑA

Committee Considerations:

- The committee reviewed the report on AA Grapevine/ La Viña media platform and approved the reports. The committee suggested that this item be relocated from the Public Information Committee to the Grapevine/ La Viña Committee in the future.
- The committee reviewed the financial reporting system for Grapevine and La Viña and were satisfied with the results.
- The committee reviewed the progress report on a more effective La Viña subscription procedure, fulfillment process and customer service experience, and recognized improvement. The committee encouraged the AA Grapevine Board and staff to continue to address ongoing subscription and fulfillment concerns from the membership, and to provide an updated progress report to be brought back to the 2026 Conference Committee on Grapevine and La Viña.
- The committee reviewed the AA Grapevine Workbook and provided editorial suggestions to the Grapevine staff.
- The committee requested that the trustees' Committee on Conference and the Grapevine Board explore ways to increase representation of the Hispanic community on the Conference Committee on Grapevine and La Viña.
- The committee agreed to forward to the AA Grapevine Board the suggestion that AA Grapevine, Inc. produce in the year 2026 or later the following:
 1. Women's Book II (working title) (GV book): Women A.A. members share stories of experience, strength and hope.
 2. Best of If Walls Could Talk (working title) (GV book): A collection of A.A. meeting room photos (taken by members) from around the U.S., Canada and the world showing the interesting places we get together to stay sober and help alcoholics.
 3. Amor, Unidad y Servicio (Love, Unity and Service) (working title) (La Viña book): Hispanic members share their gifts of sobriety through service in A.A.

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/ REGIONAL FORUMS

Committee Considerations:

- The committee received updates on the upcoming 2025 International Convention, including:
 - » Over 31,000 people have registered for the Convention to date. The attendance of the 2025 International Convention is estimated at 35,000 with the current trend of week-to-week registrations, 60 days away from the event's start date. Reporting included this event's accommodation and expense to travel challenges, as well as concerns about traveling across the border as some of the reasons impacting people's decisions to attend.
 - » The Convention Consultant shared that we are not receiving as many responses from our event accessibility survey. It has been distributed multiple times to registered attendees who identified their desire to receive further information about accessible services for this Convention. The lack of responses has an impact on our ability to estimate the need for scooter and wheelchair equipment rentals, and how many attendees will take advantage of our Accessible Shuttle Service. Therefore, we are making decisions on transportation vehicles to have on hand based on the information we have. In addition, we have a plan on how we can add vehicles if the need arises.
 - » The first-ever 2025 International Convention Virtual Program Session Track online offering will have enhanced attraction communications after May 9, 2025, to remind those unable to attend in person they have a pathway to participation in our 90th Anniversary celebration.
 - » There is a final site visit planned for the coordination team in early June 2025 where the important onsite volunteer training will take place, as well as a city-wide emergency tabletop exercise to prepare for the 2025 International Convention.
 - » This is the fifth International Convention where online registration was available. Communications have been made to ensure that all attendees are prepared for the Convention experience and understand how to prepare for attendance and get around the Convention campus and the city of Vancouver.
 - » Preparations are in place for the anonymity-protected post-event broadcast of the Friday night Flag Ceremony.
- » The advance Program Guide has been sent to all registrants and is being made available on GSO's A.A. website and distributed through our communication channels. This program emphasizes A.A.'s Anonymity Traditions to attendees and the Box 4-5-9 spring issue features the article "Countdown to Vancouver."
- » The Convention app will be launched in May 2025 for download on mobile devices.
- » The International Convention will have an Anonymity Booth and a "Carry the Message" pavilion featuring booths providing information on A.A.'s Cooperation with the Professional Community, Corrections, Grapevine/La Viña, Public Information, Accessibilities and Treatment committee service.
- The committee reviewed a report on the development of the new declaration to be adopted at the 2030 International Convention. The committee is in full support of the trustees' IC/RF Committee's concept of creating a declaration related to our third legacy of service and the Fellowship's participation in the group conscience of Alcoholics Anonymous, recognizing that individual voices and actions help shape our collective wisdom.
- The committee considered the request that all sovereign states' flags be a part of the Flag Ceremony at an International Convention. The consensus of the committee members is that it is important to explore this option to understand any impacts such inclusion may create (e.g., cultural, timing). The committee requested that the trustees' IC/RF committee begin exploration regarding the inclusion of sovereign states to the Flag Ceremony at the International Convention, including reaching out to gather sharing from indigenous populations. The committee also suggested including a question in any post-Convention surveying of attendees that would help obtain information on how many members in attendance at the 2025 International Convention were from First Nations sovereign states, helping to gain an understanding of total numbers we might be considering adding to a Flag Ceremony. The committee looks forward to a plan or progress report being brought back to the 2026 Conference Committee on IC/RF.
- The committee reviewed the Final Report of the Subcommittee on Regional Forums Improvements and expressed their gratitude for all thoughtful and thorough work done by the IC/RF trustees' committee. The committee specifically noted appreciation for the bud-

get considerations, the live broadcast option pilot and the plan to better serve interpretation needs.

- The committee reviewed the Report from the Subcommittee to Review Regional Forums Request for Information (RFI) Forms and appreciated that while the GSO makes the final decision for the date and location of Regional Forums that they continue to collaborate with the regions and areas during the planning process.
- The committee discussed ways of encouraging interest in Regional and Local Forums and attracting first-time attendees and expressed appreciation for the incorporation of previous committee considerations. The committee requested that the General Service Office record a GSO Podcast episode showcasing Regional Forums.

LITERATURE

Committee Considerations:

- The committee suggested, in keeping with the subtitle of the book, that the Publishing Department review the pagination and print-size of the *Plain Language Big Book*.
- The committee suggested that, if the recommendation to expand the book Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions is approved, that the title not be changed, though a subtitle similar to *The A.A. Service Manual* should be included.



- The committee reviewed the Recovery Literature Matrix and requested that year-to-year information be collected and presented to cover page views, downloads, audio content, and other points of digital access.
- The committee suggested that a sortable and malleable format of future Recovery Literature Matrixes be shared with the Conference Committee on Literature as a committee-eyes only document.
- The committee had a robust discussion about the progress report and project timeline for the development of the Fourth Edition of the book *Alcohólicos Anónimos* (Spanish). The committee requested that a manuscript or progress report be brought back to the 2026 Conference Committee on Literature.
- The committee had a thoughtful discussion about the progress report and project timeline for the development of a Fifth Edition of the book *Alcoholics Anonymous*. The committee requested that a manuscript or progress report be brought back to the 2026 Conference Committee on Literature.
- The committee reviewed the progress report on the development of a pamphlet for the Asian and Asian American Alcoholic and requested that a progress report or draft manuscript be brought back to the 2026 Conference Committee on Literature.
- The committee discussed the need for plain language literature in Spanish and French and took no action. The committee looks forward to further expressions of need being voiced from within the service structure.
- The committee discussed the need for the development of an application for the sale of digital literature and took no action. The committee looks forward to further information on current efforts and wider sharing from within the service structure.

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

Committee Considerations:

- In keeping with a request from the 74th General Service Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions, the committee noted the February 11, 2025, memo update from the General Manager to all Conference members on site selection and dates. The 77th and 78th General Service Conference will be held at the New York Marriott Marquis hotel in New York City. The 77th General Service Conference will take place April 11-17, 2027. The 78th General Service Conference will take place April 23-29, 2028.
- The committee reviewed the dates for the 2029 General Service Conference. In order to provide additional flex-

ibility to the General Service Office management in contracting the most cost-effective and appropriate venues for the General Service Conference, the committee agreed to select these proposed dates for the 79th General Service Conference, as follows (in order of preference): April 29 – May 5, 2029; April 15-21, 2029, May 6-12, 2029; The committee noted that these proposed Conference dates are the best choices available for avoiding conflicts with significant holidays. The committee asked that all Conference members be notified of the final dates for the 79th General Service Conference as soon as they are finalized by GSO management.

- The committee discussed the Equitable Distribution of Workload (EDW) progress report and draft plan. The committee noted with appreciation the updates made to simplify workload, workflow, and efficiency since the 74th General Service Conference.
- The committee also discussed the possibility of standing committee items being addressed by Conference committees outside of the Conference week. The committee acknowledged that if a process to address standing Conference committee items outside of the annual Conference week were to be explored, that serious consideration on the implications affecting Article Nine in the Conference Charter be discussed and reflected within any draft plan.
- There was ongoing discussion, but not limited to, the suggestions presented in the EDW report. Standout topics included:
 - » Including a more defined plan on a comprehensive approach with a collective shift in composition, scope, and procedures with special attention to committee scopes.
 - » Consider the implications of changes to processes that would affect stakeholders including, but not limited to, GSO Staff assignments, trustees' and Conference committees.
 - » Reimagining current Conference committees in ways that could accommodate heavier workloads. There also may be parallel benefits which would benefit the efficiency of trustee committees and Staff assignments.
 - » A defined plan in which committee literature on recovery or more general topics of service could be moved under the purview of committees which historically have agendas with less items. Such a decision might provide more balance for committees and provide Staff assignments more opportunities to

focus on possible needed revisions that may need to be brought to the attention of the General Service Conference for accuracy and consistency of content.

- » Include a draft process to move Conference-approved items that don't set policy but rather, reflect factual information to service material category (requiring an Advisory Action for the shift to service material) to allow for more timely updates such as, the Conference approved, "GSR" pamphlet, D.C.M. Flyer, and "The A.A. Group" pamphlet.
- » Explore how projects could potentially move across Conference Committees without the need to return to their originating committee until resolved.
- » On EDW items, there may be reasons regarding the evolution of a topic that a trustees' chairperson may request to retain it with a corresponding conference committee.
- » An adjustment to the Conference schedule to allow for more committee time to handle additional workload, in lieu of presentations and workshops.
- » A more agile framework could foster greater cooperations between trustees' and Conference committees.
- » Findings from the 2025 General Service Conference inventory may guide where the priorities to address distribution of workload may lie.
- » In light of the expressed need to address tangible actions of EDW the committee suggested that the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference create a proposal providing a more focused approach identifying the most critical issues affecting workload and a potential path on how to implement comprehensive shifts to Committee composition, scope, and procedures and that this proposal be brought back to the 2026 Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions.
- » The committee discussed the process of Simple Majority Items and suggested noting the history of recommendations not passing, attaining simple majority but not substantial unanimity in committee history and actions for the purpose of providing information and context for future Conference committees.
- » The committee considered a request that a super majority of voting members be required to change or amend Founders' Literature and took no action. The committee expressed the importance of this topic but also noted that developing a policy on possible voting requirements and procedures may be pre-

emptive prior to defining what would be categorized as co-founders' writings.

To provide clarity on the nuances between similar PAIs on potential changes that were forwarded about the co-founders' writings to the Report and Charter and the Policy/Admissions committees, both committees met briefly during their Tuesday committee times to ensure the distinct function of these agenda topics and avoid potential overlaps or confusion.

The committee noted that, prior to approving a defined procedure on future considerations for changes to co-founders' writings, a two-year process might be considered prior to a voting decision by the Conference to provide more opportunity for input from the fellowship.

- » The committee considered a request to develop guidelines for the roles and responsibilities of temporary replacement delegates. The committee discussed appreciation for the draft guidelines presented to the committee and suggested that any future policy decisions be reflected in the guideline.
 - » The committee discussed a request to prioritize a list of selection criteria to inform the committee selection process and were pleased with current and suggested improvements to the process.
- The committee suggested prioritization efforts in the following order:

- ▶ That areas have the opportunity to be selected for any committee
 - ▶ Continue the process for a more even rotation on remaining committees
 - ▶ Striving to have wider regional representation across all committees
 - ▶ Limit adjacent areas from different regions
- The committee encourages the trustees' General Service Conference committee to explore utilizing Open-Source AI as a mechanism to improve the committee selection process.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

Committee Considerations:

- The committee reviewed and accepted the 2025 Public Information Comprehensive Media Plan (CMP).
- The committee reviewed the 2025 report on the "Relevance and Usefulness of Audio and Video Public Service Announcements," and offered the following suggestion:

» That the trustee's Public Information Committee consider offering further clarification on the process of creating new Public Service Announcement (PSAs) and for retiring or discontinuing PSAs.

- The committee also considered the suggestion forwarded by the trustees' Public Information Committee to remove reference to phone books in Public Service Announcement (PSAs) and took no action. The committee felt that this action would not represent a good investment of resources.
- The committee suggested that when developing new video content, including PSAs, that careful consideration be given to ensuring that new content appropriately reflects an awareness of and respect for the cultural and linguistic differences that exist between Canadian French-speaking members, Spanish-speaking members and those who primarily speak English.
- The committee discussed the suggestions made by the trustees' Public Information Committee to have Francophone and Hispanophone delegates review Public Service Announcements in French and Spanish and suggested that the trustees' Public Information Committee begin implementing this plan. The committee requested that a progress report on these efforts be brought back to the 2026 Conference Committee on Public Information.
- The committee discussed the Mesmerize Point PSA distribution channel and suggested that the trustees' Public Information Committee and AAWS end the relationship with Mesmerize Point and to explore whether other "point of care" content providers would be willing to run A.A. messages at no cost.
- The committee suggested that if adapted for use on AAWS media platforms, the Australian video "Cham-pain" be posted to the English language version of aa.org only.
- The committee suggested that the trustees' Public Information Committee create a plan to develop a new short video targeting culturally diverse audiences, appropriate for use as a PSA and on social media and other channels. The committee suggested that the new video be short, emotionally powerful, utilize a question-and-answer style, and feature no spoken dialogue.
- The committee suggested that if revised, the trustees' Literature Committee consider adding a QR code to the pamphlet "Understanding Anonymity" (P-47). The committee observed that for literature that typically sits in a literature rack, QR codes may be more useful on the front of pamphlets rather than the back.

- The committee reviewed and accepted the progress report on developing communications to address anonymity and social media.
- The committee suggested that the trustees' Public Information Committee consider a "refresh" campaign for ongoing distribution and tracking of PSAs in the U.S. and Canada, at an annual cost of no more \$15,000 and that a report be brought back to the 2026 Conference Committee on Public Information.
- The committee discussed the report on the A.A. Membership Survey and expressed appreciation for the comprehensive work. The committee suggested that the planning for a 2026 A.A. Membership Survey include the following:
 - » Continued use of random sampling for the main Membership Survey.
 - » That any publications related to Membership Survey be based on the data generated by the random sample version of the Membership Survey.
 - » That an external survey methodologist be consulted as part of developing a plan for the next Membership Survey. The committee suggested that the survey methodologist be consulted about whether the convenience sample methodology could be adjusted to mitigate bias.
 - » A trial for utilizing four-year interval between Membership Surveys be piloted, with plans to evaluate this shift after an appropriate interval.
 - » Taking into account staff workload, the committee requested that information about expense, including the costs for survey tabulation, analysis, report writing and development of communications to the Fellowship be detailed in the plan for the next Membership Survey.
 - » Discussion of purpose/audience for the survey should be considered, with caution that revisions to the questions should be minimized in order to optimize the ability to consider changes in results over-time.
 - » Careful consideration should be given to supporting the area delegates in the Membership Survey data collection process through workshops and discussion.
 - » Upon completion of the next Membership Survey, planning for a formal debrief from the trustees' Public Information Committee to the Conference Committee on Public Information about the results of the next Membership Survey.
 - » That consideration be given to developing multi-media tools to support discussions of future Membership Surveys
- » In the plan for the next Membership Survey, the trustees' Public Information Committee is encouraged to consider how to address additional concerns including:
 - Whether consideration should be given to surveying meetings as well as groups.
 - Whether counting the number of A.A. members would be an appropriate goal.
 - Whether the Membership Survey infographics created in 2022 have been useful for local committees.
- » The committee suggested that the future Membership Survey planning should consider how the survey might be used to address outstanding questions including:
 - How do we make sense of ongoing gendered differences in meeting attendance?
 - Why has A.A. failed to make meaningful progress on attracting and retaining a more racially/ ethnically diverse Fellowship?
 - The most recent survey indicated that the Fellowship is aging, and not attracting as many young members. How should we understand and respond to this shift?
- The committee reviewed the report on the survey of Area Delegates regarding communications with young people. The committee expressed appreciation for the report, and offered the following suggestions:
 - » That findings from the survey of Area Delegates regarding communications with young people be incorporated into communications with young people planned in the future.
 - » That there is a need for additional resources for communicating with young people, noting however that consideration should be given to treating young members as members, rather than as a separate or different population.
 - » That the trustees' Public Information Committee explore avenues for direct participation of young people in the development of a new service card for young people.
- The committee suggested that the trustees' Public Information Committee explore whether a texting platform could be used for regular communications to the Fellowship in order to reach members who don't prefer email.

- The committee suggested that the trustees' Public Information Committee consider including a QR code on a new service card aimed at young people, pointing users to resources specific to young people on aa.org.
- The committee reviewed and accepted a progress report for the GSO podcast, Our Primary Purpose. The committee noted appreciation for this audio service material and for many of the topics covered on the podcast. The committee looks forward to a report with analytics data for the podcast to be brought to the 2026 Conference Committee on Public Information and offered the following suggestions:
 - » The committee suggested that the A.A. World Services consider developing a plan to create Spanish and French versions of the GSO podcast, Our Primary Purpose, and suggested that pilot episodes in each language be created.
 - » The committee suggested that consideration be given to developing an episode of the GSO Podcast, Our Primary Purpose, focused on anonymity and social media.
 - » The committee requested that A.A. World Services consider a suggestion that when featuring individual experiences on the GSO Podcast, Our Primary Purpose, that multiple perspectives on the topics be included in the segment.
- The committee reviewed and accepted the 2024 Report on the Alcoholics Anonymous World Services (AAWS) Meeting Guide. The committee expressed enthusiastic support for the Meeting Guide app and offered the following suggestions:
 - » The committee suggested that consideration be given to having Meeting Guide app sync with calendar applications.
 - » The committee requested that the trustees' Public Information Committee ensure that all updates to Conference-approved literature, including Daily Reflections be reflected on Meeting Guide app.
- The committee reviewed and accepted the 2024 annual report on Alcoholics Anonymous World Services (AAWS) web site, aa.org and offered the following suggestions:
 - » The committee suggested that AAWS explore adding a chat feature to aa.org and looks forward to an update report being brought back to the 2026 Conference Committee on Public Information.
 - » The committee suggested that AAWS explore ways to improve the aa.org search feature function in French and Spanish (including use of accent marks and diacritics).
- The committee reviewed and accepted the 2024 report on the usefulness and effectiveness of the AAWS YouTube account. The committee offered the following suggestions and looks forward to a report to be brought to the 2026 Conference Committee on Public Information.
 - » The committee noted ongoing challenges with search engine optimization (SEO) for YouTube and expressed appreciation for work already being done to add new content to the platform on a regular basis.
 - » The committee suggested that consideration be given to posting short versions of video Public Service Announcements as YouTube shorts.
- The committee reviewed and accepted the 2024 Report on the usefulness and effectiveness of the AAWS Google Ads and looks forward to a report to be brought to the 2026 Conference Committee on Public Information. The committee noted appreciation for the ongoing work with Google Ads and expressed support for maximizing use of the Google Ad grant each month and for continuing to monitor changes to the Google ad for non-profit program for any changes that impact aa.org.
- The committee reviewed and accepted the 2024 Report on Online Business Profiles. The committee expressed appreciation for the work and looks forward to a progress report being submitted to the 2026 Conference Committee on Public Information.
- The committee reviewed and accepted the Progress Report on improving analytics across media platforms. The committee noted with appreciation all the work that had gone into laying out a framework for improving analytics reporting for the future and looks forward to a report to be brought to the 2026 Conference Committee on Public Information.
- The committee discussed the grid of public information materials.
- The committee reviewed and accepted the progress report on the Young People's video project and expressed gratitude for the work and asked that an update report be provided to the 2026 Conference Committee on Public Information.
- The committee suggested that the trustees' Public Information Committee explore opportunities to use already collected (but not posted to aa.org) user-generated young people videos for other content areas.
- The committee discussed the content and format of the P.I. Kit and Workbook. The committee agreed to provide the staff secretary with any suggested updates to the P.I. Workbook.

REPORT AND CHARTER

Committee Considerations:

- The committee reviewed the progress report for the development of the new section “Amendments” to be added to the Twelve Concepts for World Service. The committee carefully reviewed the thoughtful discussions following the 2021 Advisory Action and provided suggestions on the organization and format of the section. The committee requested that the staff secretary send a memo to AAWS Publishing clarifying the intention and rationale, and that it be considered in the development of an introduction to the “Amendments” section. The committee looks forward to a draft of this suggested version being included in the Report and Charter background for the Fellowship to review in preparation for the 76th General Service Conference.
- The Conference Report and Charter Committee discussed the requests for a revision to Article Three of the Conference Charter in relation to changes to the co-founders’ writings and took no action. The committee noted that further clarification was needed on the definition of co-founders’ writings prior to considering changes in policy or to the Conference Charter.
- To provide clarity on the nuances between similar PAIs on potential changes that were forwarded about the co-founders’ writings to the Report and Charter and the Policy/Admissions committees, both committees met



briefly during their Tuesday committee times to clarify discussion of these agenda items and mitigate the risk of overlap or contradiction.

- The committee discussed ways to reach future trusted servants and reviewed the Conference Final Report through the lens of those unfamiliar with the Conference process, suggesting that the General Service Office consider developing a podcast episode in future seasons to help in this effort, and that AA Grapevine and La Viña consider including similar sharing in future issues.
- The committee accepted a report from the Publishing Department outlining the General Service Office process for timely and accurate preparation and publication of the A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts for World Service, 2024-2026 Edition and the 2025 General Service Conference Final Report.
- The committee suggested that the Publishing Department consider adding hyperlinks to the digital version of the Conference Final Report similar to the 2024-2026 digital edition of the A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts for World Service.
- The committee reviewed the report of the General Service Board outlining the creation of a Trustees’ Ad Hoc Committee for Report and Charter. The committee appreciates the board’s communication of its intent to implement the committee’s suggestions and looks forward to collaborating with this committee going forward.
- The committee discussed whether there was a widely expressed need for the A.A. Service Manual to be included in physical GSR kits. The committee highlighted a variety of experiences at the local level and appreciated learning about the creative ways in which some Areas provide the A.A. Service Manual to their trusted servants. While no action is recommended at this time, the committee noted that bringing greater awareness to the manner in which Areas and the GSO cooperate to meet the needs of all trusted servants would be helpful to assess the need for additional resources. The committee also provided suggestions to the Group Services coordinator for the GSR Welcome Letter.

TREATMENT AND ACCESSIBILITIES

Committee Considerations:

- The committee suggested the following editorial revisions to the draft flyer “Where do I go From Here?” (F-4):
 - » Remove “Find A.A. Near You” website and QR code.
 - » Add a QR code to the AAWS Meeting Guide app and remove the chair logo.

- » Move the blue block of finding A.A. information to below the title.
- » Remove AA Grapevine general website and replace it with the AA Grapevine podcast link and QR Code.
- » Move the “A.A. Conference-approved” note to end of flyer.
- The committee reviewed and accepted the progress report on the Military Outreach Project. The committee looks forward to all the veteran and active-duty interviews being made available on aa.org and A.A.’s YouTube page.
- The committee requested updates to the language on aa.org/military to be more inviting and engaging to inspire veteran A.A. members to volunteer for audio interviews. The committee suggested including the contact email militaryoutreach@aa.org on the website. The committee asked that the staff secretary work with the Communication Services Department (CSD) to make the landing page more accessible and searchable. The committee requested that the term “military” be added to the filter function of the Media Library on aa.org.
- The committee suggested repurposing existing content to develop a 10-second audio highlight to be included on the aa.org/military webpage to attract people to listen to the full interviews. The committee suggested posting the outreach communication requesting participation in veteran audio interviews to the AAWS LinkedIn page, along with any new military member audio interviews.
- The committee suggested that the Communication Services Department (CSD) consider the use of the following additional social media hashtags for aa.org/military:
 - » #MilitaryCommunity
 - » #VeteranSupport
 - » #VeteranVoices
 - » #RecoveryJourney
 - » #LifeInRecovery
 - » #PeerSupport
 - » #GivingBack
 - » #AccessibilityMatters
- The committee reviewed the progress report on the Fellowship’s outreach efforts to A.A. members in the military. The committee noted that the report included limited sharing, while the military interviews themselves include vital insight on how members of the military find A.A. information captured in the interviews can help local committees in their outreach efforts. The

committee requested that the staff secretary extract this information from the interviews and provide it to the Fellowship as requested from the assignment.

- The committee discussed the newly developed “Accessibility Resources Flyer” made available on aa.org. The committee provided several suggestions to the staff secretary and requested that the “Accessibility Resources Flyer” be posted to the AAWS LinkedIn page two times a year.
- The committee discussed the newly revised service piece “Making the A.A. Message Accessible” (F-107) with added sharing from neurodivergent alcoholics and provided several suggestions to be included in a future revision.
- The committee suggested that the Accessibilities Checklist (SMF-208) be updated with suggestions to support neurodivergent members.
- The committee reviewed the contents of the Treatment Kit and Workbook. The committee provided the following suggestions:
 - » Return to the 2023 version of the Singleness of Purpose section of the Treatment Workbook.
 - » Add hyperlinks to the digital version of the Treatment Workbook.
- The committee reviewed the contents of the Accessibilities Kit and Workbook and provided suggestions to the staff secretary for the next revisions.
- The committee reviewed the Remote Communities and Cooperation with Elder Community resource lists and provided suggestions for the next revisions.
- The committee suggested that AA Grapevine/La Viña consider publishing a book with stories from A.A. members in the elder community.
- The committee suggested that the CD version of the book *A.A. Comes of Age* be made available as an audiobook on aa.org.
- The committee suggested that the production of an audio version of the *Plain Language Big Book* be prioritized as an audiobook project.
- The committee suggested that the American Sign Language (ASL) version of the pamphlet “The A.A. Group... Where it All Begins” (P-16) be prioritized as an ASL project after hearing the expressed need from the staff secretary.

TRUSTEES

Committee Considerations:

- The committee reviewed the resumes and approved as eligible for election all Class B trustee candidates

for East Central Regional trustee, Southeast Regional trustee, and trustee-at-large/U.S.

- The committee had a wide-ranging and thoughtful discussion about the current process of placing proposed agenda items (PAIs) on the final General Service Conference agenda. The committee strongly agrees that the fellowship, through their representative delegates, have more voice in the final decision.
- The committee reviewed the sub-committee Grievances about General Service Board Actions report and the Proposed Methods to Censure the General Service Board and, after a thoughtful and robust discussion, took no action. The committee discussed how one of four possible paths to censure was linked to a separate conference proposed agenda item. If the proposed General Service Conference Harmony and Effectiveness sharing session was not adopted, then the remaining three methods did not offer sufficient change.
- The committee discussed the request to include the version of the Lasker Award text from A.A Comes of Age in Appendix D in the book *Alcoholics Anonymous* and took no action. The committee considered the full text of the Lasker Award contained in A.A. *Comes of Age* sufficient documentation.
- The committee discussed the updated General Service Board policies, noting the importance of having a trustee code of conduct policy in today's litigious environment. Potential Class A candidates are reassured by sound board policies when considering service on the General Service Board.

Recommendations that achieved Simple Majority — These items did not receive the two-thirds majority required to pass as a Conference Advisory Action.

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

- The committee recommended that the trustees' Cooperation with the Professional Community/Treatment and Accessibilities Committee replace the three existing videos — "A.A. Video for Healthcare Professionals," "A.A. Video for Legal and Corrections Professionals," and "A.A. Video for Employment/Human Resources Professionals" — with a new video, in English, Spanish, and French. The video should be developed with a format and message that can reach all professionals with multipurpose applications which can be delivered across multiple platforms. The com-

mittee requests that a progress report or draft video be brought to the 2026 Conference Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community.

LITERATURE

- The committee recommended that the current publication Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions be expanded to include the Twelve Concepts for World Service and essays on the Twelve Concepts for World Service.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

- The committee recommended that a new Service Card, postcard sized or smaller, aimed at young people, be created and that it be made available digitally and for purchase and for inclusion in the PI Service Kit.
- The committee recommended that the General Service Board, keeping in mind A.A.'s Twelve Traditions, develop a strategy and vision for digital communications including social media and increase resources for these tools to enhance efforts to carry the message.

Recommendations Not Resulting in Advisory Actions

These recommendations were presented but did not receive the two-thirds majority necessary to become a Conference Advisory Action.

FINANCE

- The committee recommended that the suggested area contribution for delegate expense for the Conference be removed and that the full estimated amount be provided so that each area can determine what amount they can contribute.
- The committee recommended pausing the retrofit of the General Service Office until the Trustees Finance & Budgetary Committee develops a plan to replenish the reserve fund to a minimum of nine months and bring back a progress report to the 76th General Service Conference.

GRAPEVINE/LA VIÑA:

- The committee recommended that the Grapevine Board develop a revised La Viña five-year plan covering years 2026-2030 to be brought back to the 2026 Conference Committee on the AA Grapevine and La Viña. The revised plan should reflect a focus on actionable, realistic and achievable goals, and the background materials should include at least five years of financial history that substantiates its projections.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

- The committee recommended that the A.A. World Services social media policy currently under review be brought back to the 2026 Conference Committee on Public Information for approval prior to implementation.
- The committee recommended that the trustees' Public Information Committee develop a plan to accept user-generated content from members under the age of 18, with the understanding that questions of legal responsibility or liability may need to be explored. The committee requested that an update report or draft plan be brought back to the 2026 Conference Committee on Public Information.
- The committee recommended that in addition to the Membership Survey conducted using random sampling, the trustees' Public Information Committee conduct a Convenience Sample Membership Survey in 2026.
- The committee recommended that the General Service Conference add an agenda item to the 2026 agenda for the Policy and Admissions Committee to explore creation of a new conference committee to which some of the Public Information agenda could be assigned.

TRUSTEES

- The committee recommended the pamphlet "Do You Think You're Different?" be retired.

Floor Actions Not Resulting in Advisory Actions

- The 75th General Service Conference issues a censure, expressing formal disapproval for past behavior of the General Service Board for the following reasons:
 - » Contributing to an environment that lead to the resignation of experienced and trusted Board members;
 - » Ineffective, inconsistent, and non-transparent communication to the Conference;
 - » Unacceptable behavior by trustees including harassment, intimidation, and bullying;
 - » Undermining the spiritual handshake with the Conference, as described in Concept VI, by not following a Conference Advisory Action.Accordingly, the Conference directs the General Service Board to:
 - » Continue to take its inventory, with specific focus on improving accountability to the Conference;
 - » Report to the Conference on inventory findings and the specific actions taken to address these concerns. **(Not Approved)**

- Change the election procedure of the GSC Delegate Chair to the following: Each Conference Committee will nominate a willing and eligible candidate to stand for Delegate Chair after their election of Conference Committee Chair and Alternate Chair on their last committee meeting day of the General Service Conference. The nominee will be determined by each individual Conference Committee. The newly elected Conference Committee Chair will not be an eligible candidate for Delegate Chair. The Alternate Conference Committee Chair will be an eligible candidate. After the Trustee elections at the GSC each nominee will have a 1–2-minute opportunity to give a brief history and qualification. The Delegate Chair will then be elected by Third Legacy Procedure of the voting Area Delegates. Only the voting Area Delegates will be able to vote for their Delegate Chair. The Policy & Admissions Committee will be tasked to create a scope for the Delegate Chair Position based on what the committee determines are the needs of the Area Delegates of the GSC and for that to be brought to the 76th GSC. The Delegate with the most votes will be the newly elected Delegate Chair, the runner up will be the GSC Mail Administrator. The Delegates with the third and fourth most votes will be the alternates, if the need to serve arises. **(Conference declined to consider)**
- The GSB Revisit the Advisory Actions of the 71st General Service conference regarding the A.A. Preamble and approve the following as the only conference approved A.A. Preamble.

"In Alcoholics Anonymous, we share our experience, strength and hope with each other that we may solve our common problem and help others to recover from alcoholism.

The only requirement for membership is a desire to stop drinking. There are no dues or fees for A.A. membership; we are self-supporting through our own contributions. A.A. is not allied with any sect, denomination, politics, organization or institution; does not wish to engage in any controversy; neither endorses nor opposes any causes. Our primary purpose is to stay sober and help other alcoholics to achieve sobriety."

(Conference declined to consider)
- The GSB, by and through its Trustees Committees, reduce the number of standing agenda items at each GS Conference to allow more room for PAIs submitted by the Fellowship. That workbooks, service material and guidance type pamphlets, for example, be reviewed every three to five years instead of annually or biennial-

ly, and that they be alternated so that each conference committee has no more than one or two standing agenda items each year. Status updates and progress reports on continuing agenda items be discussed during joint committee meetings instead and reported to the conference through the Trustee committee conference reports. Themes, discussion topics, book titles, and the like be polled to the delegates electronically using survey methodology. Etc. **(Conference declined to consider)**

- That the current code of conduct be repealed. The Steps, Traditions, and Concepts (with the warranties) serve as complete set of principles, codified for all in A.A. to resolve all questions of proper conduct; in other words, a comprehensive code of conduct. The Charter and Bylaws provide the mechanism connecting us to the outside world, and the Bylaws require adherence to these 3 sets of principles. The Charter and the Bylaws of the General Service Board are legal instruments, empowering the trustees to manage & conduct world service affairs (Concept VII). **(Conference declined to consider)**
- The GSO begin the process of adding QR codes (linked to aa.org) to all new and reprinted literature. **(Conference declined to consider)**
- The Conference hereby allow the Conference Agenda Committee the right of decision over the Conference theme, presentation(s) and workshops, allowing the Conference to focus on the more important matters facing the Fellowship today. **(Conference declined to consider)**
- That in order to assist in the improvement of the prudent reserve, the GSB set a policy which does not allow the budgeted income from all streams including, but not limited to, contributions, sale of literature, including Grapevine and La Viña subscriptions and book sales, for any given year to exceed the amounts of the immediately preceding year. Further, and consistent with such policy, that outward expenses be adjusted, with necessary cost cutting measures, so that all expenses, obligations or support does not exceed budgeted income. This to be in effect until the prudent reserve reaches the Board's policy of 9-12 months and thereafter as the Board may deem fit pursuant to its Reserve Fund Policy. **(Conference declined to consider)**
- That a joint subcommittee comprised of representatives from the General Service Board, A.A. World Services Board, AA Grapevine Board, the General

Manager, and the Grapevine Publisher be formed to: Reevaluate the viability and timing of the 11th floor construction project, with an estimated cost of up to \$2 million, with the intent to cut our losses.

- » Determine whether to retain or release the 8th floor at 475 Riverside Drive.
- » Delay any further construction or long-term occupancy decisions until a future relocation process — fully informed by the evolving needs of the Fellowship — can appropriately assess and determine space requirements. **(Conference declined to consider)**
- » The GSB explore reorganizing the GSC Committee system; that it should consider a topic neutral system and submit a progress report to the appropriate 2026 GSC Committee. **(Conference declined to consider)**

Recommendations recommitted to conference committees

TRUSTEES

- The committee recommended that motions to censure or reorganize the General Service Board be sent directly to the Conference Committee on Trustees, for committee eyes only.

FINANCE

- The committee recommended that an FAQ addressing, "What happens if a group decides not to hear a GSR report?" be added to Chapter 1 FAQs section on page 12 in the next revision of The A.A. Service Manual.

Recommendations recommitted to trustees' committees

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY/TREATMENT AND ACCESSIBILITIES

- That the pamphlet A.A. in Treatment Settings (p-27) [SP-27 in Spanish], in the section that says, "Alcoholics Anonymous does not:", be amended as follows:

[A.A. does not] "provide detoxification or nursing services, hospitalization, drugs or any medical and psychiatric treatment,"

should read:

[A.A. does not] "provide or directly engage in detoxification services, nursing, hospitalization, medicine or any medical, psychiatric, psychological or therapeutic treatment."

Additional Committee Considerations That Did Not Result in Recommendations

Advisory Action 40 of the 1990 General Service Conference states: "Items discussed, but no action taken or recommendation made, as well as committee recommendations which are not adopted, be included in a separate section of the Final Conference Report." Those committee recommendations which are not adopted (less than 2/3 of the total Conference votes in favor), but which received at least a simple majority of the votes, are considered "strong suggestions" of the Conference. All items, listed by committee, are as follows:

AGENDA

- A letter to the committee chairperson regarding Seccion Mexico was discussed and found to be outside the scope of this committee.
- The committee discussed whether there is a need for a specific place in the Conference Agenda to discuss the needs and current challenges of the A.A. groups in the U.S. and Canada and unanimously agreed that this is an issue for areas, districts and groups.
- The committee discussed the submission of floor actions at the General Service Conference and unanimously agreed to ask the 1996 Policy/Admissions Committee to consider that the submission of all floor actions be withheld until after the voting on committee reports.

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

- The committee discussed the suggestion for a thorough review of all C.P.C. literature and service material to insure that duplication is avoided and that A.A.'s primary purpose is clearly stated.

The committee requests that the trustees' C.P.C. Committee begin a thorough review of all C.P.C. literature and service material, and send a progress report as background to the 1996 Conference C.P.C. Committee. The goals of the literature review would be to:

- a) Encourage that A.A.'s single purpose is foremost.
 - b) Make suggestions for eliminating unnecessary duplication and redundancy.
 - c) Look for opportunities to simplify and clarify C.P.C. information.
 - d) Explore the possibility of combining two or more existing pieces.
 - e) Review titles of existing C.P.C. information and suggest changes as appropriate.
- The committee recognized with appreciation the preliminary work and suggestions on the "Alcoholics Anonymous and Employee Assistance Programs" leaflet by the trustees' C.P.C. Committee, and urged that the ideas presented be considered in the thorough review of all C.P.C. literature to be undertaken by the trustees' C.P.C. Committee.
 - After thorough discussion on the suggestion that a video be developed for internal A.A. use to encourage participation in C.P.C. service work and to provide suggestions for making presentations to professional groups, the Committee decided to take no action because of the availability of less expensive

methods to encourage A.A. members to participate in C.P.C. service work.

- The committee felt that the literature review underway and the publication of the new C.P.C. Workbook respond to the need for specifics on presentations to professional groups.
- The committee discussed these two questions: 1) Are we doing enough to carry the A.A. message to the alcoholic who still suffers inside and outside of the Fellowship?; and, 2) Are we meeting the needs of those we serve, or have we become self-serving?

- The committee concluded that these were wonderful inventory questions that inspired a thoughtful exchange of ideas. The concerns raised by these questions guided us in our deliberations of other Agenda items.

Strong suggestion of the Conference (recommendation where the vote was less than 2/3, but more than 1/2 in favor):

- After reviewing the history of the guidelines for traveling C.P.C. exhibits, that the trustees' C.P.C. Committee continue to follow these principles:

- a) The C.P.C. exhibit continue to be sent, upon invitation and within budgetary constraints, to such national conventions of professional organizations that may be reasonably presumed to have a significant concern with alcoholics.
- b) The list of exhibits at professional conventions be reviewed by the trustees' C.P.C. Committee at least twice a year.
- c) Local committees be encouraged to exhibit at local or regional professional conventions, and that such exhibits be supported at the most appropriate local level, i.e., district, intergroup, area.
- d) The C.P.C. staff person continue to facilitate such requests, bearing in mind the principles of attraction, cooperation and self-support.

CORRECTIONAL FACILITIES

- The committee voted not to proceed with studying the feasibility of an audio cassette to encourage A.A. members to get involved in carrying the message to members inside the walls. It was felt that such a cassette was not needed at this time.
- The committee decided that it was not desirable or feasible to have a firm policy that G.S.O. send a Big Book to every inmate who requested one. It was felt that this should be left more to the autonomy of area and local Correctional Facilities committees.
- The committee accepted a report of the trustees' Correctional Facilities Committee on proposed minor editorial changes in the Correctional Facilities Workbook. The staff was asked to work with Publications to make the requested changes in the next printing of the C.F. Workbook.
- The committee discussed a suggestion to add to the workbook more guidelines for taking meetings into juvenile detention centers. The committee reviewed a report from area correctional facilities chairs and agreed with a majority of area chairs responding that separate guidelines were not desirable at this time.
- The committee asked the trustees' Correctional Facilities Committee to study ways to get more A.A. members involved in the Correctional Correspondence Service, noting that G.S.O. usually has a list of male inmates waiting for correspondence, and that most area committees are not at this time set up to provide Correspondence Services.

- The committee voted to ask the trustees' Correctional Facilities Committee to discontinue development of a letter to wardens of correctional facilities in the U.S. and Canada providing information about Alcoholics Anonymous, citing the need for local autonomy.
- The committee voted to change the first paragraph on page six of the Correctional Facilities Workbook, at its next printing, to include various types of long-term and short-term correctional facilities where the message may be carried by C.F. committees.

FINANCE

- The committee discussed the proposal that the General Service Office of Alcoholics Anonymous be separately incorporated as a wholly owned corporation of the General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous and concluded with substantial unanimity it was not necessary to separately incorporate G.S.O.
- The committee considered the proposal that:

Prices of the Big Book and other literature sold by A.A.W.S. be gradually reduced over a seven-year period to their cost of production and distribution and;

Prices of the individual items sold by A.A.W.S. may be above or below their individual cost and different levels of discounts can be established by A.A.W.S. for different categories of customers as long as the overall revenue from the sales of the Big Book and other literature is equal to the overall cost of their production and distribution and;

A.A.W.S. present each Conference with a report that shows: (1) the cost of producing and distributing the Big Book and other literature sold by A.A.W.S.; (2) the current prices; and (3) the expected prices over the remaining years of the seven-year period; and unanimously concluded that the proposal did not need to be implemented. The committee unanimously supported the current efforts of A.A.W.S. to reduce literature prices.
- The committee reviewed history of Conference delegates fees, area contributions, and past advisory actions and were unanimous in taking no action.
- The committee reviewed history of the maximum contribution G.S.O. may accept from an individual in one year and was unanimous in its decision to take no action.

GRAPEVINE

- The committee discussed editorial content of the Grapevine and urged that the editorial policy of the Grapevine continue to follow our Statement of Purpose.
- The committee discussed a letter regarding the proposed generic Grapevine and unanimously suggested that the Grapevine Corporate Board not produce a generic Grapevine at this time, but rather, continue to focus on our Statement of Purpose and increasing subscriptions of the Grapevine.
- The committee discussed a list from the Grapevine Corporate Board of proposed related items for production in 1997 and suggested that no action be taken and that an additional proposal be presented to the 1996 Conference Grapevine Committee for possible production in 1998.

LITERATURE

- The committee reviewed the proposed additions to the "Landmarks in A.A. History" section in *A.A. Comes of Age* and

referred it back to the trustees' Literature Committee for further review regarding the true historical significance of various events in A.A. (i.e. publication dates of various books, International Conventions, and deaths of Milton Maxwell, Dr. Jack Norris, Sister Ignatia and Dr. Silkworth.) The committee suggested that either all major events in A.A. history be inserted or the "Landmarks in A.A. History" section remain as it is written.

- The committee reviewed the report "Should There Be a Fourth Edition of the Big Book, A Report on Area Response" and concluded there was no need to publish a Fourth Edition of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, at this time.

There is evidence in the Area Report of some interest in the Fourth Edition, but the committee felt that it was not conclusive. The committee believed that, if more information in the proposed content of a Fourth Edition were made available to the Fellowship, there could be a more definitive response.

The committee referred the idea of a Fourth Edition back to the trustees' Literature Committee suggesting they prepare an outline of the proposed content of a Fourth Edition for consideration at the next Conference. This outline could indicate the proposed changes including which stories would be dropped and what kinds of stories would be added—keeping in mind A.A.'s singleness of purpose.

If the next Conference Literature Committee agrees, a new questionnaire could then be sent out to the Fellowship through area delegates in order to gauge the level of interest in a Fourth Edition.

- The committee considered whether or not the first 164 pages of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, should have the same rewrite status as the Steps, Traditions and Warranties of Article XII of the Conference Charter. The committee tabled any action in light of the previous recommendation at this Conference regarding no changes in the first 164 pages of the Big Book, the Preface, the Forewords, "The Doctor's Opinion," "Doctor Bob's Nightmare" and the Appendices, and referred the agenda item to the Conference Report and Charter Committee for discussion at the 1996 Conference.
- The committee considered a request to prepare a pamphlet on a portion of the "Doctor's Opinion" from the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, and felt there was no need at this time.
- The committee considered a request to publish a new A.A. book (suggested title "Our Stories"), comprised of Bill's and Dr. Bob's stories, and stories from the First and Second Editions of the Big Book which were not included in the Third Edition. In view of the request asking the trustees' Literature Committee to prepare a questionnaire and an outline on a Fourth Edition, the committee felt this question could be added to the questionnaire in order to get feedback from all areas so that an informed decision could be made at a future Conference.
- The committee discussed a request for a pamphlet, an information piece, a video or inclusion of a section in *The A.A. Service Manual* on the "Circle and Triangle." The committee felt that the 1994 Conference recommendation on the discontinuance of the circle and triangle logo on all Conference-approved literature was sufficient, and that there was no need for additional material. (Use of A.A.'s trademarks and logos is also explained in *The A.A. Service Manual*, 1994-1995 edition, page S103.)

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

- The committee discussed the following questions:

Does the Conference accurately reflect the needs and concerns of A.A. groups?

Has the Conference become too important to some and unimportant to many? If so, how can we bring our focus and involvement into balance?

Do we have a sufficient number of A.A. groups desiring to participate in the Conference to afford a reliable cross section of A.A. opinion to ensure that the Conference continues to be the actual and effective conscience for our whole society, or has the Conference become a minority voice?

The committee recognizes these questions as legitimate and feels that a short report of our discussion would be inadequate. We further recognize the need for continuing discussion at all levels and request that this sharing proceed and that reports of that sharing be sent to the Policy/Admissions Committee.

- The committee requests that the trustees' Committee on the Conference include the 1995 recommendation regarding floor actions in the Conference Kit which goes to all Conference members each January.
- The committee requests that the trustees' Committee on the Conference provide space on the agenda for an Archives presentation on alternating years.

Strong suggestions of the Conference (recommendation where the vote was less than 2/3, but more than 1/2 in favor):

- The Conference reaffirm the 1986 recommendations regarding floor actions:

"With regard to proposing Floor Actions in the final hours of the Conference the 1968 recommendation, which was as follows, be reaffirmed:

'That when questions of importance for the Conference could not be sent to the areas in advance, consideration be given to an oral presentation early in the Conference sessions, with discussions and voting to be taken at a later date during the Conference.'

And that the 1986 recommendation, as follows, be reaffirmed:

"That when matters of great significance having a long term effect on the Fellowship or of substantial expense are presented to the floor in the waning hour of the Conference, such matters be referred to the appropriate committee at the next Conference in order for the group conscience to be as informed as possible."

- The 1987 Conference Action be reaffirmed as follows:

"While the committee recognizes the need for and encourages the development of area Archives and Archives committees, with the resulting benefit to General Service and the Fellowship as a whole, a Conference Archives Committee should not be formed at this time because the needs of local Archives committees are being well served by the trustees' Archives Committee and the General Service Office Archivist."

PUBLIC INFORMATION

- The committee discussed as it relates to Public Information whether we are doing enough to carry the A.A. message to the alcoholic who still suffers inside and outside A.A., and felt that though we are doing well, we can always do better by informing the membership of the tools and the methods available for public information. One delegate described the skit presented in their area to show members how to do public information talks/presentations to schools and others. This skit will be sent

to the General Service Office to aid in preparing an article in the P.I. section of *Box 4-5-9*.

- The committee discussed whether we are meeting the needs of those we serve, or if we have become self-serving and definitely agreed that we are not self-serving as long as we keep our egos in check, keep an open mind and that decisions can be reached to meet the needs of those we serve.
- The committee reviewed the Public Information Workbook and were enthusiastic about the new and concise format and made no changes. One suggestion was to include the guide letters separately in the folder for those committees who might not have access to a typewriter/word processor, but the committee felt that these letters are guides/examples and should have some local personalization before they are sent out.

REPORT AND CHARTER

- The committee discussed the suggestion to review the entire manuscript of the *Twelve Concepts for World Service in The A.A. Service Manual* (1994-1995 edition), reaffirm the Twelve Concepts, and amend current practices to reflect these principles. After reviewing the manuscript of the Twelve Concepts, the committee felt it is not necessary to reaffirm them. As far as amending current practices, it was felt this was outside the defined scope of this committee.
- After reviewing the section in *The A.A. Service Manual* (1994-1995 edition) entitled "Past Delegates Can Be Helpful" to determine if there is a need to update, expand, or relocate the position of this text to reflect current activities and practices, the committee felt that no changes are necessary at this time.
- The committee reviewed the wording for the method of Conference approval of the trustees' slate, officers of the General Service Board and directors of corporate boards used throughout the "Current Conference Charter" (page S31), Bylaws of the General Service Board (page S106) and *The A.A. Service Manual* (1994-1995 edition) for consistency with Article 10 of the "Original Conference Charter—1955" (page S26), and found no inconsistencies.
- After reviewing Article Two, paragraph four of the "Current Conference Charter" (page S31) in *The A.A. Service Manual* (1994-1995 edition), the committee did not find it contrary to the spirit of Warranty Six, Concept XII, or in conflict with Tradition Four (Long Form) and Warranties Three, Four and Five.
- The committee considered the suggestion that the term "ex-alcoholic" as it appears in the Bylaws of the General Service Board be replaced with another term. The committee felt that since the term "ex-alcoholic" is adequately defined in the Bylaws of the General Service Board on pages S109-110 of *The A.A. Service Manual* (1994-1995 edition), no change is necessary.
- The committee considered whether the section "Conference Language" in *The A.A. Service Manual* (1994-1995 edition) should be placed before the Conference Charter, and felt no change was necessary.
- The committee considered whether the definition of an A.A. group in *The A.A. Service Manual* (1994-1995 edition) should be placed before that of the G.S.R., and felt no change was necessary.
- The committee considered whether the definition of a district in *The A.A. Service Manual* (1994-1995 edition) should be placed before that of the D.C.M., and felt no change was necessary.
- The committee considered whether the section in Personal

Views entitled "How I Got Interested in General Service" should be placed as early as possible in *The A.A. Service Manual* (1994-1995 edition), and felt no change was necessary.

- The committee considered whether the following statement on page S55 in *The A.A. Service Manual* (1994-1995 edition) be deleted: "We are actually asking them to take time out from the nuts and bolts of recovery to think about another phase of their new lives—this one seemingly very long-range," and felt no change was necessary.

- The committee considered including information in Chapters II and III in *The A.A. Service Manual* (1994-1995 edition) on rotation similar to the language used about delegate rotation, and felt no change was necessary.

TREATMENT FACILITIES

- Are we doing enough to carry the A.A. message to the alcoholic who still suffers inside and outside of the Fellowship?

We will probably never do enough to carry our message to the alcoholic who still suffers inside and outside the Fellowship, but we can become involved in the treatment facilities service, i.e. informing non-A.A. people about what A.A. can and cannot do, carrying meetings into treatment facilities, helping long term patients start their own meetings, providing "bridging the gap" service, providing A.A. literature, and most importantly taking time to share one on one; and in all areas of service realize the importance of keeping commitments. The inventory process is invaluable in helping us discover what we need to do and of course, sponsorship is where it all begins.

- Are we meeting the needs of those we serve, or have we become self-serving?

A.A. is a "selfish program"—the more we serve others the better our quality of sobriety seems to be. We become self-serving when we try to take the "easier softer way" by taking the alcoholic to a treatment facility with no A.A. followup. Once again, it's important to remember to sponsor "one on one." Let's not become complacent by letting our literature do our Twelve Step work for us.

- Give examples of how treatment facilities committees can keep members aware of the usefulness of A.A. tools, i.e., films, literature and the A.A. Grapevine, in their service work.

Many treatment facilities committees meet regularly to share experience and seek help. Roundtable discussions and workshops are wonderful ways for new workers to benefit from the experience of A.A. members who have been longer in service. Some A.A. tools are: Treatment Facilities Workbook; A.A. Pamphlets (particularly "A.A. and Treatment Facilities" and "Bridging the Gap"); the A.A. Grapevine; and Videos: "Hope," "A.A. An Inside View," "A.A. Come Rap With Us," and "It Sure Beats Sitting In A Cell."

- How have changes and cutbacks in treatment facilities services affected the work of A.A.?

Changes and cutbacks in treatment facilities services have provided more opportunity in many areas for A.A. members to give "hands-on service" to alcoholics coming to A.A. after brief inpatient treatment, and also to those who are receiving some type of outpatient treatment or simple detox. Many of our newer members have never had the chance to work with a "wet drunk." Treatment Facilities Committee members need to recognize the importance of meeting newcomers "where they are." They may be a day or an hour away from a drink—or may be sober several weeks and familiar with the A.A. program.

- Review Treatment Facilities Workbook. Discuss possibility of revising format to conform with Public Information and Correctional Facilities Workbooks:

After much discussion on the pros and cons of changing the format of the Treatment Facilities Workbook, the committee unanimously agreed that the workbook is more useful in its current loose-leaf binder form.

CONFERENCE COMMITTEE ON TRUSTEES

- The committee reviewed a draft of the Procedures for Formation of New Regions and/or Alterations in the Regional Map and expressed appreciation to the trustees' Nominating Committee for the work accomplished to date. It was the sense of the committee that more specific information is needed regarding changes in regional boundaries and how the need for additional regional trustees would be met. Therefore, the proposed procedure is being returned to the trustees' Nominating Committee for further work with assurance that suggestions and input from members of the Conference Committee on Trustees will be forthcoming.

- The committee considered the suggestion to approve new trustees individually and unanimously agreed that current procedures are satisfactory.

- The committee reviewed and approved as eligible for election all candidates for regional trustee for Northeast and Southwest U.S. and for Trustee-at-Large/Canada.

The 45th General Service Conference Voted Not to Consider the Following Proposed Floor Actions:

Floor Action #1 (proposal not considered):

That the A.A.W.S. Board's permission to Great Britain to adapt the *Twelve Concepts for World Service* for their own requirements be withdrawn pending review and recommendation by the Conference Report and Charter Committee at the 1996 General Service Conference.

Floor Action #2 (proposal not considered):

Area 44 requests that the 21 trustees of the General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous meet with representatives of the two service structures in Mexico (Central and Seccion). The purpose of this meeting, if needed, is to mediate the conflict and to bring to the 1996 Conference recommendations which would preclude reoccurrence of this type of conflict in any other situation/country.

Floor Action #3 (proposal not considered):

Seccion Mexico has sent three letters to our General Service Conference asking the Conference to review their petitions of grievance, which is their right under Concept V of World Service. To fulfill our spiritual responsibility I propose the following motion:

"That this Conference review and discuss these petitions and forward a response to Seccion Mexico"

Floor Action #4 (proposal not considered):

The Conference recommends that the General Service Board and its subsidiary boards, A.A. World Services, Inc. and A.A. Grapevine, Inc., initiate no litigation in defense of copyrights and trademarks, in accordance with Tradition 10 and Warranty 5.